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Kajal Dhochak and Neelam Sirohi reach gold-medal bouts at World Wrestling Championships, becoming India's first two women finalists at same edition of event

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IS AI **RESHAPING** THE WORLD

AI MAY BE THE WORLD'S NEW FOOD INSURANCE

For years, AI learned our tastes and optimised our screens. But the real economy doesn't run on recommendations. It runs on cold chains that hold through the night, on crops that don't fail quietly, on ships that reach port before a contract expires. These problems are unglamorous, deeply physical, and extraordinarily expensive when they go wrong. A single cold chain failure can wipe out a week's margin. A missed weather signal can mean a missed harvest. This is where AI is now showing up as more than a simple convenience. It's showing up as infrastructure in systems that sense crop stress before yield is lost, engines that reroute shipments before a port closes, and models that predict a demand spike before a shelf goes empty. In a world of accelerating climate volatility and tightening food security, the question is no longer whether AI belongs in agriculture, but about whether the industry can afford to wait any longer to let it in.

Sagar PV | CTO, MINDSPRINT

iToons — Ajit Ninan & Sunil Agarwal

TIMES TECHIES
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WHEN CYBER ALARMS RING, INDIA GETS TO WORK

India-based teams at some of the world's biggest cybersecurity firms help build, test and deploy protections

Akhil.George@timesofIndia.com

When critical vulnerabilities in PHP triggered a worldwide security response, engineers of a global cybersecurity company in India were helping a bank work out where it was exposed. Using TrendAI's tools, they identified vulnerable systems, provided instructions for deploying protections and explained which software updates were needed.

"In India, our priority was to translate the response into action," says Sharda Tickoo, country manager for India & SAARC at TrendAI. "We helped customers understand whether they were exposed, what protections were available and how to apply virtual patches."

The recent AI-powered cybersecurity scare gives us a glimpse into how India teams at global cybersecurity companies contribute to the response to threats: developing detection capabilities, testing security rules and helping customers deploy them. With AI helping researchers uncover vulnerabilities and potentially accelerating attackers' efforts to exploit them, that work is becoming more urgent.

> Our India team works with our global teams on cyber threat intelligence and research and contribute to SecOps products that help detect and respond to threats. PHP2Shell shows how responding to a widely used software vulnerability takes coordination across the security community. Our platforms analysed the PHP vulnerabilities and their potential exploit paths, developed and validated IPS signatures, and published mitigation guidance. This gave customers an additional way to block known exploit attempts while they applied the PHP security updates.
> **Abhishek Narula** | VP PRODUCT ENGINEERING, FORTINET

> In India, our priority was to translate the PHP response into action. We helped customers understand whether they were exposed, what protections were available and how to apply virtual patches, with detailed, step-by-step guidance. Our solution engineering teams help customers put these tools into use and relay real-world feedback to our global research teams so rules can be fine-tuned where needed. Virtual patching provides an additional layer of protection, but it does not replace applying the relevant vendor's security update.
> **Sharda Tickoo** | COUNTRY MANAGER, INDIA & SAARC, TRENDAI

> Our India Development Centre plays an important role in the company's global R&D operations. Engineering teams sitting out of here contribute to core cybersecurity products. On the threat response front, our engineers collaborate tightly with our global Unit 42 threat intelligence and research. When the PHP vulnerabilities surfaced, the scale of potential exploitation was massive, making virtual patching an urgent necessity. Our global engineering and Unit 42 teams played a pivotal role in analysing the threat and rapidly publishing threat briefs, supporting customer incidents and guidance.
> **Kunal Ruvala** | SVP & GM, INDIA, PALO ALTO NETWORKS

CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS MONTH SPECIAL

The latest incident

PHP, used to run websites and web applications, recently came under scrutiny after the discovery of critical vulnerabilities that could allow attackers to run commands on vulnerable servers without logging in. AI-assisted research helped identify a critical flaw. PHP's maintainers led the software fixes, while security companies developed protections to help customers defend themselves during the rollout of updates.

One such protection is a virtual patch: a security rule that recognises and blocks attempts to exploit a weakness without changing the vulnerable application itself. It buys organisations time to install the software update, particularly where taking a service offline requires careful planning. Virtual patching was widely used by several cybersecurity companies to help deal with the PHP incident.

"Virtual patching provides an additional layer of protection, but it does not replace applying the vendor's security update," Tickoo says.

That's why Tickoo says India's solution engineering teams also help organisations deploy exposure checkers, detection tools and filters, then relay feedback to global researchers so protections can be refined where necessary. The research teams developing TrendAI's protections are global, while India's engineers and architects help put those tools to work in customers' environments. Banks and other critical organisations need clear instructions about which systems are exposed, which protections they already have and what to update.

Tickoo says that while AI has made creating protective rules more efficient, engineers must still examine how exploits work, check that rules cover vulnerabilities adequately and test whether they mistakenly flag legitimate business traffic.

"AI helped us ship updates quickly. The challenging part was to ensure the rule was effective and would not create false alarms," she says.

At Palo Alto Networks, the India Development Centre contributes to products ranging from firewalls to cloud security and tools for securing AI applications. Kunal Ruvala, SVP & GM for India at Palo Alto, describes a coordinated response involving researchers, software engineers and site reliability engineers, who help keep systems running reliably.

"When a major vulnerability emerges, the priority is to understand how it can be exploited, assess the potential impact on customers, and develop protections that can be deployed quickly," he says.

India teams use automated testing systems and large volumes of security data to check that protections distinguish attacks from legitimate activity before distributing updates.

For PHP, Palo Alto Networks' global engineering teams worked with Unit 42, its threat intelligence and incident response arm. The unit tracks hacking groups, studies their methods and helps organisations investigate and contain attacks. Unit 42's researchers also operate from India, working alongside the company's software and reliability engineers to develop and test protections. In the PHP response, Palo Alto's engineers analysed the threat and delivered virtual patching protections, alongside guidance on reducing customers' exposure. The engineering challenge, Ruvala says, lies in protecting customers while not disrupting ordinary business processes.

Abhishek Narula, VP of product engineering at Fortinet, says that for a global cybersecurity incident like the PHP one, one of the first steps they take is to establish what is credible and actionable. Researchers examine affected software, technical evidence and signs of exploitation before developing and testing detection rules.

Fortinet's India teams contribute to threat research and products that detect and respond to attacks. In the company's PHP response, its cybersecurity platform analysed possible attack paths, developed intrusion-prevention rules and validated them before sharing protections and guidance.

At SentinelOne, India-based engineers contribute to technologies that protect computers, cloud environments and security operations worldwide. A central engineering goal for the company nowadays is to move beyond identifying known malicious software and build systems that recognise an attacker's behaviour.

"Attackers may exploit previously unknown weaknesses, but what they do after gaining access—executing commands, downloading malicious tools, creating backdoors, or connecting to external infrastructure—often follows recognisable behavioural patterns," says Diwakar Dayal, managing director & area vice-president at SentinelOne for India & SAARC.

For a vulnerability such as PHP-2Shell, Dayal says this approach provides a way to spot suspicious activity after an attacker breaks in. SentinelOne's systems are designed to recognise those patterns and, where appropriate, stop the activity automatically. The engineering problem that India-based engineers are tasked with is to identify behaviour shared across different attacks, helping organisations defend themselves even when the particular weakness or malicious tool is unfamiliar. "Hackers can change their tools every day. But what they do once they break in often gives them away. That's what our technology looks for," he says.

> When a critical vulnerability like PHP2Shell emerges, the challenge is not just understanding the vulnerability. It is helping customers reduce their exposure before attackers can exploit it. Our global research and engineering teams work to understand the threat and assess how organisations may be exposed. The challenge is not simply stopping an attack. It's stopping the attack without interrupting the business. Imagine a bank, hospital or airline. A security system that mistakenly shuts down legitimate operations can cause enormous disruption.
> **Diwakar Dayal** | MANAGING DIRECTOR & AREA VICE PRESIDENT, SENTINELONE INDIA & SAARC

> If you look at Trellix globally, India is our primary engineering and innovation backbone. Today, approximately 70% of our global engineering capability and roughly 45% of our global workforce sits right here. Our headquarters in Bengaluru houses more than 1,000 employees spanning every single product line and corporate function, backed by an engineering center in Pune and regional teams in Mumbai. In terms of product ownership, the core platforms protecting over 50,000 enterprise and government customers globally are built and maintained directly by our India teams.
> **Ganesh Iyer** | MANAGING DIRECTOR, TRELLIX INDIA & SAARC

AI won't replace automotive engineers, but change them

Sujit John & Akhil George | TNN

On this page, we've said many times that the car is no longer just a machine built from mechanical parts. Sensors, software, data and algorithms are becoming as fundamental to a vehicle as brakes, steering and the powertrain. But what does this mean for automotive engineers? Caleb Munigety, head of enterprise AI at Bosch India, told us on our podcast last week that it means a career built around one discipline will increasingly have to stretch across several.

No, young engineers don't have to become experts in everything. But they must go deep in one discipline and have a broad enough understanding of how the other areas connect. Caleb, who holds a doctoral degree from IIT Bombay, said this T-shaped skill set will become increasingly important as AI changes automotive engineering.

The change is already visible in something as basic as braking. Traditionally, braking was largely a mechanical and electronic problem. Today, sensors collect data, software analyses it, and algorithms can determine how the system should respond. In an electric vehicle, braking can also generate energy that is returned to the battery – thanks again to algorithms. Similar changes are transforming steering, powertrains and safety systems.

"The idea is that if I am able to sit with the right engineering team and start asking the right questions, that's sort of an integrated view," Caleb said.

An experienced automotive engineer, Caleb said, does not suddenly need to become a data scientist or neural-network developer. Instead, the engineer should understand enough about AI to work effectively with specialists and challenge what AI produces.

He gives the example of a vehicle-dynamics engineer with years of experience. If an AI system produces an algorithm to optimise vehicle behaviour, the engineer does not need to write the neural network. But the engineer needs to know what questions to ask, what the system can and cannot do, and whether its answer makes engineering sense.

In fact, Caleb argued that traditional engineering fundamentals will become more important, not less. An AI system might generate a thermal-management design, for instance, but a domain expert has to ask whether it complies with thermodynamic principles, whether it will work after years of ageing and how it will perform in extreme conditions.

"The judgment call finally should lie with the automotive engineers," he said. "It has produced something, but is this really engineering?"

That puts a premium on what he called AI and data literacy. At Bosch, he said, the aim is not to turn every domain expert into an AI engineer. Instead, engineers are given curated content that helps them understand what AI is producing and make decisions about it.

> The journey of a future mobility engineer, or for that matter any engineer, has to start with knowing the fundamentals in that domain. The second step is, because the world is increasingly digital and AI, they should build a certain fluency in AI, data systems, software systems. The third important thing is, have real-world experiences. That means they need to talk to people in the field, go for internships ... People often gather certificates. But learning is one thing, doing is another. They must build, test, fail, correct, improve. If one can go through this journey, then their employability will be higher when people like us hire.
> **Caleb Munigety** | HEAD, ENTERPRISE AI, BOSCH INDIA

AI CAREER EDGE

AI's touching entire engg lifecycle

Caleb said AI is touching the entire engineering lifecycle. AI can analyse large volumes of requirements from engineering teams, customers and regulators. It can then generate design alternatives, optimise configurations and improve simulations.

During manufacturing, AI can be used for quality inspection and predictive maintenance. For autonomous vehicles, it can generate synthetic data for rare "corner cases" that would be difficult or dangerous to collect in the real world. AI can also generate software code and, after vehicles are on the road, use data from connected vehicles to improve their performance.

The biggest transformation, he said, will come when all these capabilities connect rather than operate as isolated tools.

Caleb encourages students to use simulation before rushing to physical prototypes. Simulation allows them to test a large number of alternatives cheaply, narrow the options and then build physical prototypes around the most promising designs.

Electric vehicles offer another obvious area for young engineers. Caleb said students should understand battery systems and, more importantly, how AI can make battery management intelligent.

But his advice is not to abandon internal-combustion technology overnight. Hybrids and the gradual transition to electric mobility mean engineers still need to understand the fundamentals across technologies.

I was first woman in my family to enter the corporate world

Miraj Fathima

I was born and raised in a middle-class family from Hyderabad. I completed my post-graduation, and started work at a call centre, the first of its kind in the city. I was the first woman in my family to enter the corporate world, and I was assigned the 'graveyard' shift. Night shifts at the time were uncommon and frowned upon especially for women. I was often met with judgements about my work timings and my commute during odd hours. Amidst all this noise, my mother was my pillar of strength pushing me to keep at it.

Early in my career, I was also hesitant to speak up in meetings, conscious of my modest educational background. But I also understood that finding my voice was crucial for my growth. I observed my colleagues speaking and the training programmes mandated by the call centre also helped me improve my proficiency quickly and articulate myself in English.

Through these experiences, I learned that success is as much a mindset game as it is about opportunities. For young, working women navigating their careers, resilience and agility are invaluable and three beliefs have consistently guided me.

CAREER LADDER FOR WOMEN

First of all, make life decisions with intention. Life often throws curve balls in the form of choices, and it is important that you take time to pause, reflect, and assess what aligns with your priorities. Once you choose, stand by that decision with conviction.

Commit yourself to lifelong learning. I did not begin my career with access to every opportunity I dreamed of and most of us usually don't. An MBA felt out of reach for me early on, but I focused on excelling in the path I chose. That commitment eventually led to being recognised by the leadership and sponsored for an executive MBA. Consistent learning opens doors and fuels your growth.

From the start of your career, always lift as you rise. Diverse teams bring diverse ideas and constantly challenge and evolve your perspective. It is important to utilise these DEI programmes available to you, seek mentorship and build a strong network for yourself. Even today, I continue to lead DEI initiatives and interact with women across the organisation. Every journey is unique but believing in your ability to grow can change everything.

Miraj Fathima is senior director of health benefits and health solutions at Carelon Global Solutions India

AI is making young engrs forget to think

Sujit.John@timesofindia.com

Mausam is worried. The professor and founding head of the Yardi School of AI at IIT Delhi said this is the first year he has found some IIT students not thinking when doing their project work. They depend entirely on AI. When something goes wrong, they cannot explain why. "They don't have the depth of understanding needed to know what is not working, why it isn't working and what they should do. And I am sure the problem is going to get much worse as time goes on," he said.

Older people who have learned the fundamentals in their domains, he said, have created a point of view. "They are able to make use of AI really well, they find AI to be an amazing augmenter because they know that AI is like a junior apprentice. It can make mistakes, you have to double check the work, you have to make sure you trust what it has done,"

HOW TO WORK WITH AI

he said. But it's different for younger folks who are growing up with AI in their toolbox. "They don't know it yet because they think their work is getting done very fast. But they are not learning much. And that is going to create a lot of problems," he said at a discussion recently that also had Harrick Vin, chief technology officer at TCS, and Priya Cherian, head of HR at Walmart Global Tech, as panelists.

What do the students say when you point this out? Mausam's answer was blunt: "I hope you have had children. Do they listen to you? ... When laziness is an option, we love it."

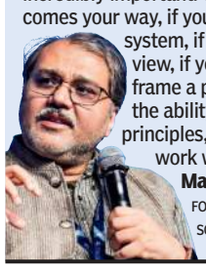
Meanwhile, at the workplace, AI is bringing structural changes. Vin said the workplace is moving towards what he called a hybrid workforce, in which people and machines continuously assist and augment each other. Machines will increasingly provide information, automate tasks, offer expertise and eventually help people make decisions.

As a result, employees will increasingly collaborate with and train machines, review their work and remain accountable for outcomes. That shift is already affecting job design. Software engineering, for instance, had become divided into front-end, back-end, database, cloud and security specialists. Vin said AI is helping push those roles back together into broader ones such as full-stack engineers. Similar consolidation is happening in technology operations. The workplace is moving from role and skill segregation to role and skill aggregation.

Priya looked at the problem from the employer's side. Companies, she said, should stop trying to predict exactly what every future job will look like. Work is changing too quickly. Instead, they should build organisations that can help employees adapt continuously. "You can't just have people be upskilled on AI and the organisation stay static," she said.

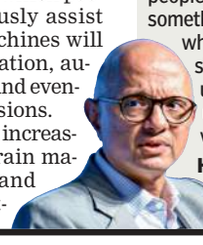
That requires a different kind of leadership too. Managers must accept that younger employees may understand new tools better than they do. Teams and employees need psychological safety so people can experiment and fail without fear. Performance systems must also reward outcomes rather than simply rewarding someone for using an AI tool or, worse, loading additional work onto someone whose AI use has made them more productive. "When these come together, the organisation starts evolving in the right direction," she said.

> When I started, I used to work in probabilistic models. Maybe people senior to me used to work in rule-based systems. Then deep learning happened, then transformers came, and now it's LLMs and agentic AI. We are constantly needing to rediscover ourselves. So, having strong fundamentals, which is the job of educational institutions to inculcate, is incredibly important. Whatever technology comes your way, if you have a value system, if you have a point of view, if you have the ability to frame a problem, if you have the ability to think from first principles, you will be able to work with that technology.
> **Mausam** | PROFESSOR & FOUNDING HEAD, YARDI SCHOOL OF AI, IIT DELHI

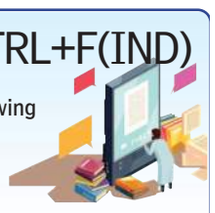


> I can't tell you the amount of time we spend trying to define roles or the future of work! But increasingly, it's becoming clear to me that we are chasing the wrong question. The real question is, given that this world is changing very fast, how do we help our associates adapt to it. We had our 5,000 Walmart (in India) associates going through an AI accelerator training programme recently in partnership with IIT Kharagpur. For me, the success was not about that training as much as about many of those associates coming back and applying those learnings to work on real Walmart problems. That's when the learning starts to stick.
> **Priya Cherian** | HEAD OF HR, WALMART GLOBAL TECH

> The role of people is changing from doers of work to collaborators and trainers of machines, reviewers of work done by machines and owners of critical thinking and creativity and essentially accountable for outcomes. In some sense, the role of people is shifting from how to do something to what to do, when to do, why to do. That's a fundamental shift. That means people have to understand things end-to-end, understand how to generate value, not how to do something.
> **Harrick Vin** | CHIEF TECHNOLOGY OFFICER, TCS



DEEP LEARNING CTRL+F(IND)



Deep learning is a way of teaching computers to find patterns by showing them examples. It uses layers of calculations, loosely inspired by connections between brain cells. Each layer picks out features: in a photo, early layers may detect edges, while later ones combine them into shapes or objects. During training, the system compares its answers with examples and adjusts its calculations to improve. Once trained, it can use what it learned to make predictions or create content. Deep learning powers tools such as speech recognition, image analysis and chatbots, but it can make mistakes when examples are incomplete or misleading.

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INDIA'S LARGEST ENGLISH NEWSPAPER

Ayush Badoni joins Kohli and Gambhir on the list of batters who scored double hundreds in back-to-back first-class innings, putting Delhi in command against J'khand in Ranji Trophy

Bubbling with joy, McD
Happy 30th Birthday

On this day in 1996, McDonald's began
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30 Years of
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In July, TOI, in association with Optum, launched the 2nd edition of Ideas for India, powered by Pigeon. We invited ideas that could pave the way to a developed India by 2047. Entries poured in by the hundreds. After an expert panel made the shortlist, an eminent jury picked 7 winners. Last Thursday, the winners were feted at an event in Delhi

Ideas For 2047 That Matter Most Now

How to unlock '1.4bn possibilities'

THINK ABOUT IT

Sarbananda Sonowal
PORTS, SHIPPING AND WATERWAYS MINISTER
- Build sovereign technology
- Make innovation inclusive
- Follow sustainable development practices

Bansuri Swaraj SOUTH DELHI MP
- Use AI to help decide cases that are largely adjudicated on documentary evidence within days
- Guaranteed appeal against AI decisions before a human panel
- Use AI to help govt track undertrial prisoners who have spent a substantial period in custody

Geetanjali Kirloskar
KIRLOSKAR SYSTEMS CHAIRPERSON & MD
- Build resilient businesses
- Strengthen energy security
- Improve product quality
- Adapt to geopolitical uncertainties

(From left) Geetanjali Kirloskar, Sarbananda Sonowal, Bansuri Swaraj and Rohit Agarwal, senior VP and head of innovation at Optum Global, during their session at **TOI** Ideas for India 2026

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

India has "millions of possibilities" to unlock on its path to becoming a developed nation by 2047. Realising this potential will require a sharp increase in research and development spend, greater investment in emerging technologies and skills, and a stronger focus on inclusive and sustainable growth, govt and industry leaders said at **TOI** Ideas for India 2026.

Ports, shipping and waterways minister Sarbananda Sonowal said India's ambition must extend beyond the scale of its achievements. "Sovereign technology must give India strategic autonomy; inclusive innovation must ensure that no section of Bharat is left behind; and sustainable development must safeguard the future of Bharat," he said.

Sonowal highlighted initiatives in the maritime sector, including the development of the Rs 76,000-crore greenfield Vadhavan Port in Maharashtra, a Rs 70,000-crore package to revitalise shipbuilding and the maritime sector, and a major push to transport cargo through coastal shipping and inland waterways. "Together, these initiatives will reduce our dependence on foreign transshipment hubs, improve logistics efficiency, attract investment and create new employment opportunities," he added.

Kirloskar Systems chairperson and MD Geetanjali Kirloskar said India had the opportunity to become a leader in critical technologies while improving living standards for ordinary citizens. Achieving 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047 would require industry to build resilient businesses, strengthen energy security, improve product quality and adapt to geopolitical uncertainties, she said.

Kirloskar stressed the need to significantly increase R&D spend, noting that India spends around $18 billion annually, equivalent to 0.65% of GDP. Greater investment in innovation and sectors such as semiconductors, AI, clean energy, biotechnology and advanced materials would be essential for global competitiveness. "India is not just a market of 1.4 billion people; it is an innovation base of 1.4 billion possibilities," she said, adding that 'Viksit Bharat' should be measured not just by economic size, but also by prosperity, happiness, sustainability and inclusive development.

South Delhi MP Bansuri Swaraj called for India to become a leader in AI rather than being merely a consumer, highlighting its potential to transform agriculture, education, healthcare, women's safety and the justice system.

Swaraj suggested that AI could help decide certain categories of cases, including cheque-bouncing disputes, matters under the Motor Vehicles Act and rent-control cases — within days rather than months or years, as these are largely adjudicated on documentary evidence. She proposed a guaranteed appeal against AI decisions before a human panel, stressing that AI should have no role in decisions involving personal liberty or incarceration.

She also proposed assigning a tracking ID to every criminal case so that AI could help govt track undertrials who had spent a substantial period in custody. "No Indian should be in jail merely because he did not file a bail application," she said.

Rohit Agarwal, senior vice-president and head of innovation at Optum Global, said India's ambition to become a $35-trillion economy by 2047 would require annual growth of 8-10%. However, success must also be measured by how widely opportunities and tech benefits reach people, he said.

"The future will not be created by one institution or one breakthrough; it will be created by millions of breakthroughs. India's greatest opportunity is not simply the number of people we have; it is the number of problem-solvers we are able to create," he said.

> **"India's greatest opportunity is not simply the number of people we have; it is the number of problem-solvers we are able to create**
>
> —**Rohit Agarwal,** SENIOR VP & HEAD OF INNOVATION, OPTUM GLOBAL

Optum PRESENTS TOI IDEAS FOR INDIA POWERED BY Pigeon

'Ideas are scarce, it's capital that is in abundance'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Photos: Piyal Bhattacharjee

Co-founder and CEO of OfBusiness Asish Mohapatra (left) and Surinder Singh, Optum Global's senior vice president-operations

If you have a business idea that you believe in, there is no dearth of capital, said Asish Mohapatra, co-founder of two unicorns, OfBusiness and Oxyzo.

But then came the caveat: "If you look for equity first, you will miss the bus. You have to believe that the scarcity is on your (ideas) side and the abundance is on the capital side." Instead, extract cash straight from the operations, through customer advances or supplier credit. Failing that, tap into debt, where India's liquidity runs a massive 20 to 22 times the availability of equity.

At the **TOI** Ideas for India 2026 summit, industry heavyweights dissected the evolving economy and the new opportunities, including the future of AI, global capability centres (GCCs) and startups.

"It's like Rancho said in '3 Idiots'. If you chase excellence, everything else chases you. In the beginning, they (investors) all invest behind the person," said Mohapatra.

Across the aisle, Optum Global senior V-P Surinder Singh shifted the lens to the grassroots — the medium- and small-scale industries that form the bulk of the Indian economy. Given a chance to invest, Singh wouldn't place his money into a mega-factory. He would invest it on shared digital capabilities for lakhs of starved MSMEs. While behemoths easily absorb advanced tech, small businesses are left stranded without demand forecasting or logistics intelligence. "Productivity cannot stop with large companies," Singh said.

Responding to a similar opportunity to invest, Mohapatra bypassed tech glamour entirely, arguing that India's core structural foundations remain cracked and needs capital. "India lacks the ability to build the tools that can create the future," he said, urging capital injection into heavy manufacturing, traditional thermal-backed power, infrastructure, and logistics. While green energy grabs headlines, "making thermal power efficient is what I would rather put money into", said Mohapatra.

On the question of AI, both speakers had compelling arguments to make. While Mohapatra stands as a watchful sceptic, maintaining that the immediate cost of AI implementation far outweighs returns for any business.

Singh counters that AI isn't an innovation theory anymore, it's the core operating agenda. The bottleneck isn't buying the software, it's building the data governance and risk frameworks to survive the future. "The problem for organisations that don't see benefits, or that are holding back and watching from a distance, is organisational readiness," said Singh.

In the end, Mohapatra revealed that his founders' fund has backed 50 to 60 startups in manufacturing and financial services, proving that a new wave of unicorn founders is recycling wealth back into smaller players.

And on the GCC front, with legacy IT hiring hitting a wall, India's 2,500 GCCs, which have mutated from cheap back-offices into global innovation powerhouses, Singh delivered the final verdict. "We are very far from peak GCC."

'Make in India everything that we currently import'

BCG India head **Rahul Jain** has called for a push to local manufacturing, arguing that India is well placed in the current geopolitical situation, thanks to its neutrality.

"India comes out as probably one of the best-placed countries, with a very strong neutral position across different countries, and a very strong resource base to provide materials, manpower and different kinds of technologies to the world," he said.

Jain said there was a need for local investment and capability scale-up, offering an opportunity for industry to invest big in manufacturing. "More than the export market, it's a great opportunity for us to compete and make locally everything we currently import," he said.

He also felt that the free-trade agreements being signed by India will help improve corporate competitiveness. "We will need to innovate and come up with technologically superior products, but at the same time we be cost-competitive. We will need scale; we will need to be frugal; we will need to invest in R&D, which has lagged in the past." TNN

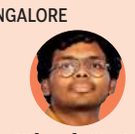
WINNERS

CARBON COPY
Living digital twin for blood coordination

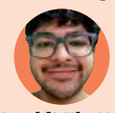
Abdul Mannaan Sayyad
VIT-ANDHRA PRADESH
An intelligent blood coordination system for thalassaemia patients that keeps a live virtual profile of patients' needs and donors' status

NYAYA SETU
Explainable AI for Lok Adalat referrals
IIIT BANGALORE

Adarsh Singh



Utkarsh Gupta



Harshit Khattar

Aarush Gupta

An AI tool that helps legal services committees identify pending cases suitable for Lok Adalat, giving a ranked shortlist

SABER
Sensor-agnostic satellite AI for disaster intelligence
ABV-IIITM GWALIOR

Hemateja Chandaluri

Shivansh Katiyar

Prabal Poddar

Srijan Singh

A foundation AI framework that gives disaster agencies all-weather satellite vision, showing flooded areas even when clouds block optical satellites

7RD COUNTER DRONE SWARM STACK
EdgeAI defence against hostile drone swarms, made in India

Sahaj Rastogi
CO-FOUNDER & CEO

Yash Mudgal
CO-FOUNDER & CTO

Vrinda Agrawal

Rahul Pachori

An EdgeAI counter-drone swarm stack that detects hostile drones and destroys them with small, low-cost autonomous interceptors, using technology India owns end-to-end

OSI TOOL
Oscillation Source Identification for a resilient, renewable-rich Indian grid

Karan Vasudev Katariya
PRIME MINISTER'S RESEARCH FELLOW

Prof Ashok Kumar Pradhan
IIT KHARAGPUR

An indigenous system that detects dangerous power grid oscillations, identifies the source, and helps prevent blackouts as India adds solar and wind power

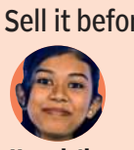
ECOWRAP
Turning agri waste into sustainable packaging
NIFTEM-THANJAVUR

Nasreen Fathima A

Diya AU

Turns crop waste into biodegradable cups, plates, bags and wraps, offering an affordable alternative to both plastic and stubble burning

CIRCULATE
Sell it before it's scrap



Hemalatha Venkatesan
TEAM LEAD

Dharshni RT
EASWARI ENGINEERING COLLEGE, CHENNAI

A surplus-exchange platform that connects workshops, construction sites and kitchens with nearby buyers, food recipients and local transporters

Why clean, affordable water will build developed India

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

> **"...The magnitude of the situation (water contamination) is so large that I don't think govt alone can take it on**
>
> —**Mahesh Gupta,** FOUNDER & MANAGING DIRECTOR, KENT RO

Expanding tap-water access must be accompanied by efforts to ensure that supplies remain safe throughout the year, said Mahesh Gupta, founder and managing director of Kent RO. He highlighted water contamination and affordability as major challenges for households.

In a fireside chat at the Ideas for India Summit 2026, Gupta said the govt's responsibility extended beyond providing connections to maintaining drinking-water quality. Asked about the Har Ghar Jal initiative, he said he expected public systems to deliver safe water but questioned their ability to do so consistently on such a large scale.

When asked whether gaps in access created a business opportunity for purifier manufacturers, he suggested that such a need might not exist if the govt could ensure adequate access to safe water. "But the magnitude of the situation is so large that I don't think govt alone can take it on," he added.

Gupta argued that water treatment faced new challenges as contaminants entered supplies. He highlighted microplastics, citing fibres released during clothes washing as one route through which plastics enter water.

"Fresh issues keep coming into the contamination of water. The new issue that has emerged in the last few years is microplastics in drinking water," he said.

He also addressed whether household purification remained beyond the means of many Indians. Gupta cited Kent's Rs 1,400 water filter as an affordable offering, while acknowledging that even this price could be high for many people. This highlighted the gap between offering a lower-priced product and making water treatment accessible to households with limited budgets.

Gupta also raised concerns about reliance on groundwater, saying extraction was reaching greater depths, and argued that contamination required sustained attention.

Degrees are important, but being job-ready is crucial in AI age

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

StoveKraft MD Rajendra Gandhi (left) and Prashant Mehra, partner and chief people and culture officer, Grant Thornton Bharat, at the session 'India@2047 as the world's talent engine: Skilling, jobs and youth'

As AI disrupts entry-level jobs and industries struggle to find skilled graduates, corporate leaders have called for greater investment and deeper partnerships between companies and universities to overhaul education, build practical capabilities and prepare India's workforce for emerging employment opportunities.

At **TOI** Ideas for India 2026, Rajendra Gandhi, founder and managing director of StoveKraft, said India's large workforce would not automatically translate into global competitiveness unless its capabilities matched industry requirements. "Today, industry is actually forced to do what universities are supposed to do," Gandhi said, pointing out that companies were spending time and resources training fresh graduates who lacked job-ready skills.

He advocated shifting the emphasis from degrees and certificates to demonstrable capabilities, particularly in manufacturing, robotics, automation and emerging technologies. Industry and academia, he said, must jointly shape education during students' learning years rather than leaving companies to bridge the gap after recruitment.

Prashant Mehra, partner and chief people and culture officer at Grant Thornton Bharat, said the corporate sector must also accept responsibility for employability instead of blaming universities.

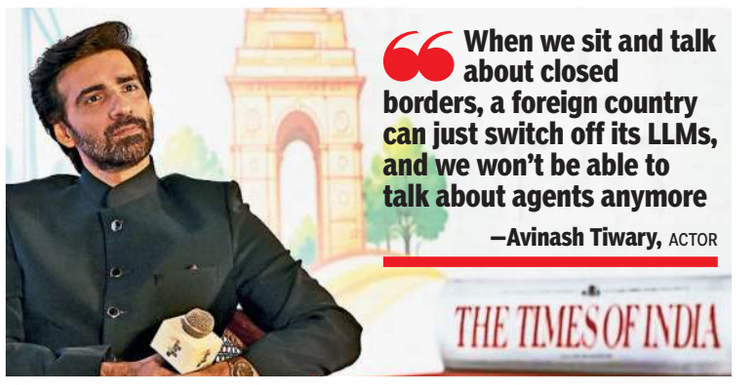
Highlighting the firm's partnerships with universities, he said industry professionals were helping design courses and serving as faculty members. At one university in northern India, 250 of 600 students received appointment offers from Grant Thornton on Day Zero, Mehra said. "Ultimately, education is application."

The challenge is becoming more complex with AI agents taking over routine tasks traditionally assigned to junior employees. Mehra said the conventional corporate employment pyramid was gradually becoming a diamond, with greater emphasis on human validation, critical thinking, judgement and supervision of technology. "So that pyramid is slowly becoming a diamond," he said, stressing that continuous upskilling would be essential rather than fearing technological displacement.

Gandhi urged startup and private-equity investors to look beyond tech ventures and invest in manufacturing entrepreneurship. "If startup or private-equity capital is chasing something, it should chase manufacturing," he said.

'Need more help. Indian innovation runs on charity'

Meghna.Dhulia@timesofindia.com



> **When we sit and talk about closed borders, a foreign country can just switch off its LLMs, and we won't be able to talk about agents anymore**
>
> —**Avinash Tiwary,** ACTOR

I've spent at least a year talking to a lot of innovators around the country, and I can probably say innovation in India runs on charity," actor Avinash Tiwary said at **TOI** Ideas for India 2026.

On his visits to Hyderabad and Bengaluru, he had met innovators, including engineering students developing solutions for agriculture and mining. Their ideas were often strong, he said; however, the harder part was getting access to laboratories, grants and funding to build prototypes.

Drawing on India's emergence as an IT powerhouse, Tiwary called for more support for homegrown innovation. Citing Telangana's T-Works, he urged people to build more prototyping facilities for building and testing new products. He also called for a clearer understanding of entrepreneurship, distinguishing between creating value in an existing market and creating an entirely new one.

That need to build Indian capabilities felt especially urgent when he spoke about AI. Dependence on overseas large language models (LLMs), he warned, could leave users vulnerable if access were restricted. "When we sit and talk about closed borders, a foreign country can just switch off its LLMs, and we won't be able to talk about agents anymore."

Tiwary also wondered whether young Indians were chasing too narrow a range of opportunities. Acknowledging the growing influence of content creators, he cited figures he had recently read about the creator economy and India's ambitions. "But my question is this. If a country is making trillions, and needs trillions by 2030, how does it feel when 40% of that country's youth want a slice of that 400-billion-dollar pie?"

Still, he saw potential in the audiences creators have built. Their reach, he said, could help Indian products and ideas find a market as the country develops new capabilities.

The question of what India could build also shaped his hopes for cinema. Filmmakers, he felt, should draw on the country's past while imagining its future — and tell stories that could influence aspirations beyond the screen. "As an artist, that is my one desire. To see films made about the future. Indian stories that create a global impact," he said.

He believed wider global distribution could boost India's cultural influence and talent. He felt OTT had opened doors for niche audiences and different genres, but shrinking budgets and pressure to turn a profit were encouraging safer choices.

The difference between streaming and cinema, he said, would still come down to the experience. Watching at home is intimate and often solitary; theatres offer scale, sound and the pleasure of watching together. His assessment came with a touch of humour: "Even my face looks beautiful there."

Idea that saved water with zero public funds

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Jal Shakti minister **C R Patil** praised PM Narendra Modi's "advance planning" — which, he said, helped India prepare itself and minimise the adverse impacts of El Nino, especially deficient rainfall. It was the idea of it, he said, that set everything rolling, and it would be the idea that would help shape a developed India.

"*Soch se hi sab kuch shuru hota hai* (Everything begins with an idea)," he said, adding that it was the thought of it, and subsequent action, that will make India a developed nation by 2047.

Patil said Modi saw the possibility of a water crisis much in advance, and had called for transforming "water conservation through people's participation" into a public movement.

He stressed that while the govt was doing its job, each citizen must also understand their duties, and contribute towards nation-building.

"We didn't invest a single rupee of govt money in building 1.5 crore water conservation structures," the minister said. "We designed them, we spoke to people and industry. We told them to undertake water conservation and rain harvesting works with corporate social responsibility funds."

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THE TIMES OF INDIA

INCLUDES 8 PAGES OF BANGALORE TIMES

INDIA'S LARGEST ENGLISH NEWSPAPER

Meta raises the planned size of its **largest-ever equity offerings to $97.5bn**, as the social media giant taps the public market to expand its AI infrastructure

Norway's NSM cybersecurity agency says **the number of "successful" cyberattacks against organisations in the country had tripled** in a year, in its first public evaluation of such risks

FLIPPED IT by THE TIMES OF INDIA

A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE. Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in **TOI**

Court allows Bollywood actor Imran Khan, a US citizen, **to remain in India until at least Nov 2**, pausing a govt order that asked him to leave for breaching immigration laws by participating in a protest

DOUBLE DELIGHT

Today's issue of **TOI** is organised in two sections, both equally packed with news and analysis.
To get the full reading experience of today's edition, make sure you don't miss the other section

OTHER BOOK TOP STORIES

- **HC: Bar non-Hindus who don't believe in deity from temples**
- **General medicine tops NEET-PG choices among top 100**
- **Shot at close range, 19-mth-old cheetah cub dies in Kuno**

K'taka roll shrinks by nearly 1cr; most deletions due to shifting

8.2 Lakh Net Increase From SIR Draft Rolls

Pearl.DSouza
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Bengaluru: The special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka concluded Tuesday, with the final electoral rolls showing an overall reduction of 99.76 lakh electors from the pre-SIR rolls, with the electorate shrinking from 5.54 crore on June 16 to 4.55 crore on Oct 27. At 2.29 crore, women outnumber men by 3.7 lakh, putting the gender ratio at 1,017 women per 1,000 men.

While the overall decline after SIR is of nearly 18%, Chief Electoral Officer Anbu Kumar said: "The net deletions from the list are about 73 lakh, considering only shifted and absent electors. The rest, about 27 lakh electors are categorised dead, duplicate or refused to sign."

The largest category among electors whose enumeration forms were not submitted was those who had permanently shifted residence, accounting for 65.45 lakh of the 1.08 crore electors left out of the draft rolls. The second-largest category was absent electors, at 19 lakh. This category includes electors who also refused to sign documents, according to the CEO's explanation.

The list also included 16.39 lakh dead electors and 7.09 lakh duplicate or already-enrolled electors. In addition to the 1.08 crore electors classified as absent, shifted, dead or duplicate (ASDD), Kumar told mediapersons that 61,960 electors who had been issued notices were marked ineligible for the final rolls after hearing. He said these included foreign nationals.

On the other hand, the Election Commission added a net 8.19 lakh electors during the claims-and-objections phase, after processing applications under Forms 6, 7 and 8.

"While it is hard to say how many of the ASDD-categorised electors came back to the final list, there have been about 8.19 lakh net additions after the draft rolls," Kumar said.

ECI data showed that the period between the draft and final rolls saw 10.08 lakh additions, 1.88 lakh deletions and 8.96 lakh modifications. The CEO's office also presented figures showing that the Commission removed 1.24 lakh permanently shifted electors through Form 7 generated automatically following applications for shifting under Form 8, and another 61,960 electors in the "ineligible" category.

Apart from these, 184 electors were marked absent and 762 duplicate entries were removed during the claims-and-objections process.

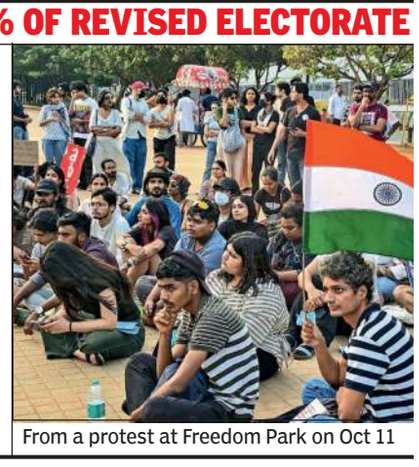
Responding to allegations of bulk applications under Form 7, including forms generated in the names of Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) and Assistant EROs, Kumar said none of the bulk applications had been accepted by the ECI, either online or offline.

▶FULL COVERAGE | P 2

▶CEO denies, P 2

GENERATION Z MAKES UP 20% OF REVISED ELECTORATE

- Karnataka's SIR **net deletions stand at 73 lakh, accounting for shifted or absent voters**
- 27 lakh voters **identified dead, duplicate** or refused to sign
- **Appeals filed against voter deletion** from lists are 361
- Shifted and absent voters **to be mopped up under** supplementary roll
- Gen Z forms 20% of SIR electorate; the total number of **voters aged 18 to 29 is 93,40,202**
- **Maximum deletions in BBMP South (48%),** Central (43.5%), North(43.2%)
- Auto-generation of Form 7, **because of filing Form 8 (shifting of voters)** deleted a total of 1.24 lakh names
- **Families of 14 BLOs to be given compensation** for death while on duty



From a protest at Freedom Park on Oct 11

94% back on rolls in Delhi after notice

Over 94% of the 33.1 lakh Delhi voters issued SIR notices have been verified and will be included in the final electoral roll. Notices were issued to 13.8 lakh voters for being unmapped to the 2002 revision and 19.3 lakh over logical discrepancies in their entries. The remaining cases are being processed. SIR began in Delhi on June 30. At the time, there were 1.45 crore voters on the rolls. TNN

Now, Robina is 'Ravindra' in Pilibhit

Days after **TOI** reported about "unauthorised changes" to at least 13,150 electors' details in 127-Pilibhit Sadar constituency, a fresh row erupted, with 23-year-old Robina's name being purportedly changed to 'Ravindra Singh' in 129-Puranpur (SC) seat. "These may not be clerical errors, but deliberate attempts," deputy district electoral officer Prasoon Dwivedi said. **P6**

B'luru now has 59L voters, down 43%

Bengaluru's final electoral roll now has 59.1 lakh voters, down 43% from 1.03 crore before SIR. Of the 46.9 lakh voters deleted from the rolls, 32.7 lakh were marked as permanently shifted. A month-long drive will see booth-level election officers contact excluded voters and facilitate re-enrolment through Form 6, subject to verification by election authorities. **P2**

MLC polls: Cong dealt a blow; NDA poised to sweep all 4 K'taka seats

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: In a major setback to the ruling Congress and chief minister D K Shivakumar, the BJP-led NDA is poised to win all four Karnataka Legislative Council seats that went to polls on Oct 23, with its candidates winning both teachers' constituencies and leading in the two graduates' constituencies as counting continued late into Tuesday night.

The NDA fielded three BJP candidates and one JD (S) candidate. While the BJP held three of the four seats before the elections, the Congress held one. If the trends hold, the alliance will secure all four seats.

JD(S) candidate A P Ranganath defeated Congress veteran and five-time MLC Puttanna in the Bengaluru Teachers' constituency, while BJP candidate Shashil G Namoshi registered his fifth victory in the North-East Teachers' constituency, defeating Congress nominee Sharanappa Mattur by 3,297 votes. He secured 15,596 first-preference votes against Mattur's 12,299.

Counting concluded at Kalaburagi, where around 30,253 voters had exercised their franchise. Of the votes counted, 28,380 were valid, while 1,873 were rejected.

BJP candidate Shashil Namoshi celebrates with party workers in Kalaburagi

▶Turns tables, P 3

Can't let pharma firms 'run amok' in the name of free market: SC

Supreme Court on Tuesday said the pharma industry cannot be allowed to "run amok" in the name of free market to fix MRP of medicines at a very high level, which in some cases happens to be more than 1,000% of the price at which they are sold to retailers, **reports Amit Anand Choudhary**. The court asked the Centre to explain the rationale behind the policy. It reserved its order on a plea to bring all non-patented medicines and medical consumables under a price control mechanism. Govt said it was aware of the problem and that was why it decided to cap the price of anti-cancer drugs. But the court told the additional solicitor general that govt "woke up" only after it intervened and passed harsh observations on the prevailing system. **Other bk, P 5**

Andhra, Odisha brace for cyclone

Andhra Pradesh and Odisha are bracing for Cyclone Arnab, a very severe cyclonic storm expected to make landfall near Visakhapatnam early Wednesday with winds of 125-135 kmph and gusts up to 150 kmph. The states set up nearly 4,000 shelters and evacuated thousands. **P6**

TOI HEALTH+

Nagging cough after cured infection needs a relook

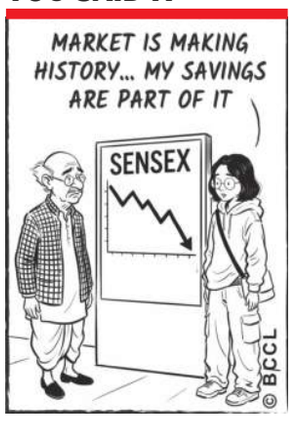
Scan the code to watch our podcast on **'Why does shingles strike decades after chickenpox?'**

+ much more on, **PAGE 9**

India invites Pak for inaugural SCO forum

India has invited Pak for the inaugural SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum next month. PM Modi proposed the forum during last year's SCO summit. The last Pak minister to visit India was Bilawal Bhutto in 2023. **P6**

YOU SAID IT



Panchayat bans Christian pastors

Boreya panchayat in Ranchi district of Jharkhand has barred Christian pastors from holding meetings, prayer-healing sessions or gatherings it claims are linked to religious conversion. The panchayat is in a scheduled area under PESA Act, 1996. TNN

SC: Need to balance right to free speech, privacy

New Delhi: SC on Tuesday acknowledged the importance of media's right to freedom of speech and expression but said this needed to be balanced with citizens' right to privacy and dignity and asked petitioner Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) to suggest how these two rights could coexist harmoniously, **reports Dhananjay Mahapatra**.

Entertaining DNPA's petition terming certain provisions of Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and the amendment to RTI Act redefining 'personal information' as an attempt towards pre-censorship of news content that violated the media's right to free speech and impeded media independence, SC said, "You are domain experts. You suggest to the govt and SC how to harmonise the two competing rights."

> Digital Personal Data Protection Act places myriad restrictions in the manner in which information is accessed, processed and disseminated
>
> —Digital News Publishers Association in SC

▶See other book, P 14

For production push, govt lists 120 products

To reduce dependence on imports and push domestic manufacturing, govt has identified around 120 products, including intermediates and capital goods with a separate plan for tunnel boring machines in the works after China imposed restrictions on their shipments. The range of products includes chemicals such as acetic acid, pharmaceutical products and inputs, medical technology related items, machine tools, including textile looms, cranes and products used in the aerospace sector. **Other bk, P13**

Venu Srinivasan family biz dispute escalates to court as both sides file caveats

G Balachandar | TNN

Chennai: The Venu Srinivasan family's dispute over division of business interests has taken a legal turn, with family members filing caveats in Chennai courts to ensure they are heard before any orders are passed in proceedings related to the dispute.

Persons familiar with the case confirmed that caveats had been filed by both sides even as Venu Srinivasan's wife Mallika Srinivasan and their daughter Lakshmi Venu reiterated their willingness to resolve the dispute amicably through dialogue.

"As stated earlier, Lakshmi Venu and Mallika Srinivasan reiterate their desire for an amicable resolution through transparent discussions and dialogue," they said in a statement on Tuesday.

The dispute centres on how the family's ownership interests and wealth should be divided between the two heirs — daughter Lakshmi Venu, vice chair of TAFE, and son Sudarshan Venu, chairman and MD of TVS Motor Company.

Mallika and Lakshmi have maintained that the March 2024 memorandum of understanding (MoU) did not constitute an economic settlement. They argue that arrangements concerning brand usage, trademarks and non-compete obligations cannot be equated with a division of family wealth, and that management responsibilities are distinct from the settlement of ownership interests.

Venu Srinivasan and his wife Mallika Srinivasan

▶See other book, P 13

Two 'encounter' deaths in Bengal in a day

Sanjib Chakraborty , Sukumar Mahato & Tamaghna Banerjee | TNN

Gaighata/Shamsherganj/Kolkata: Bengal police on Tuesday gunned down two persons in separate "encounters", the first accused of rape and murder in Gaighata, North 24 Parganas, and the other of killing a BJP worker in Murshidabad's Shamsherganj.

The double "encounter" in a single day — probably unprecedented in West Bengal since the Naxal turbulence of the late 1960s and early 1970s — came three months after the state's police shot and killed a rape-murder accused in Baruipur, South 24 Parganas.

Both the Gaighata and the Shamsherganj "encounters" happened in similar circumstances, with police claiming their guns were snatched during crime-reconstruction procedures.

▶Hooliganism, P 7

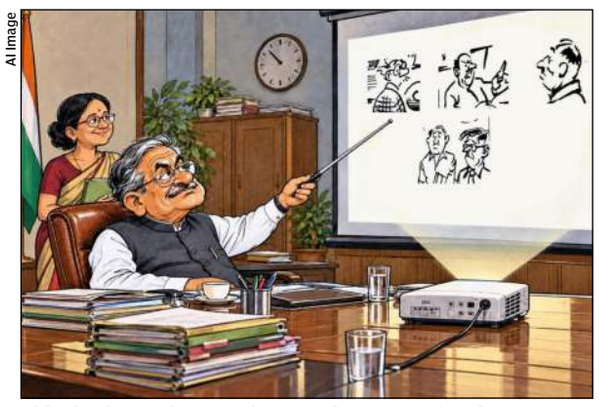
CabSec lists 12 types of secys: File throwers, file sitters, latecomers...

Dipak.Dash @timesofindia.com

New Delhi: It began as a regular meeting. But the senior bureaucrats who had gathered at a performance review meeting on Tuesday were in for a surprise — and not a particularly pleasant one, even though the point was made with a generous dose of humour.

Cabinet secretary T V Somanathan unveiled a presentation on 12 types of bureaucrats, which is believed to have left many present at the meeting squirming. Among the types listed by Somanathan were officers who ask women colleagues to come a bit too close for comfort to show them a document; those who throw files and speak rudely; and those who call in staff on Saturdays, then arrive late themselves.

Other entries included officers who call meetings after 7pm, sit on files, or send ministers decisions they could take themselves. Each type was accompanied by a cartoon, in many cases work by **TOI**'s legendary cartoonist R K Laxman.



AI Image

Apart from cartoons and indirect criticism, there was a quantitative component to the meeting too — the secretaries of various govt departments were ranked on various performance parameters.

The CabSec's broader message, officials said, was about running better meetings and making the workplace more conducive to getting things done.

He also informed officers about the Centre's plans to roll out the next round of reforms, Deregulation 3.0, from Jan 2027, aiming to cut red tape, simplify compliance and improve the ease of doing business.

▶Action on rly staff, P 7

MCOCA invoked in Tiger Shroff shooting case

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Mumbai: The city crime branch has invoked Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) in the Tiger Shroff firing case, citing the accused persons' alleged criminal backgrounds, financial motives and a fight for supremacy. According to police, six of the accused have criminal antecedents, while alleged wanted gang leader Anil Pandit has three chargesheets filed against him in criminal cases in Haryana and Punjab.

Pandit allegedly claimed responsibility for the firing . The communication reportedly also contained threats against actor Salman Khan and other members of the film industry. Police suspect the attack was intended not merely to target the actor, but also to create fear and strengthen the gang's influence.

A TALE OF TWO TRIUMPHS: HARRY KANE AND HURRICANE

25-YR DROUGHT ENDS FOR ENGLAND

AFP

England captain Harry Kane became the first Englishman to win football's highest individual honour, the Ballon d'Or, since Michael Owen in 2001, while Spain midfielder Alexia Putellas won the Ballon d'Or Feminin for the third time. The 33-year-old Kane struck 73 goals in 65 games for club and country last season, propelling Bayern Munich to a league and cup double, and England to the World Cup semifinals. Putellas was presented the women's award after winning the treble with Barcelona in the 2025-26 campaign, in addition to the Spanish Super Cup. She moved to Women's Super League side London City Lionesses in July after 14 years at Barca. Spain and Barcelona players swept the young talent awards, with Lamine Yamal picking up his third trophy and Vicky Lopez taking home the women's award for the second successive year | **Other book, P 14**

Abhiquake hits NZ as India chase 198 in 13.2 overs, clinch T20 series

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The official ICC rankings tell us that Abhishek Sharma is the world's second-best T20I batsman. What they don't say is that when he gets going, he's in a league of his own. The highest strike rate in T20I history — an incredible 196.8 —for any batter who's scored at least 500 runs. The fastest ton (in just 30 balls) among ICC full member nations. And the ability to make the scarcely believable seem commonplace.

On Tuesday, Abhishek was in full flow, hammering 113 off 38 balls, studded with nine fours and 11 sixes. For a while, it seemed he would break his own 30-ball record, but he eventually settled for a ton in 35 balls — still his second fastest. Incidentally, the slowest of his four centuries took 46 balls.

Wonder kid Vaibhav Sooryavanshi too got into the act. Opening alongside Abhishek, he smashed 45 off just 19 balls. India made a mockery of a chase of 199, getting there with 6 wickets and a whopping 40 balls in hand as India took an unassailable 3-0 lead in the 5-match series.

PTI

Abhishek Sharma (L) & Vaibhav Sooryavanshi scored a world record 118 runs in the Powerplay

▶Opening overlord, P 10

Three fishermen enter storage unit aboard boat in Kumta, die

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Karwar: Three fishermen died of suspected suffocation, while two others were rescued after they entered a fish storage compartment on a boat at Tadadi fishing harbour near Gokarna in Kumta taluk of Uttara Kannada district.

The fishermen entered the storage compartment to clean it after unloading the catch. They are suspected to have suffocated after inhaling toxic gases that had accumulated in the enclosed space. The deceased are Naushad, 48, Ameen, 40, and Aman, 26. They were working aboard the fishing boat Kuchaima, which had returned to the harbour after a fishing trip.

Two other fishermen were rescued; one of them is critical. A case has been registered at Gokarna police station.

Layoffs get new names, but sting just as much

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Bengaluru: Companies have never liked the word "fired". It sounds too much like what actually happened. So every few years, corporate vocabulary comes to the rescue with a softer term for the same hard conversation.

"Downsizing", "rightsizing", "restructuring", "optimisation", "organisational simplification", corporate vocabulary keeps evolving. The person leaving may notice little difference, but the PowerPoint or press statement certainly sounds nicer.

Now, AI is giving the corporate dictionary another reason to expand. Microsoft has just come up with a new one— "voluntary exit offer" or VEO. Some 60,000 of its employees will be offered VEO.

To be fair, Microsoft is not saying it's "firing" all of them. It's only giving them the option to leave. But what would go through the minds of all those who do not accept it? Won't they be working with the threat of the guillotine hanging over their heads?

Brand and business strategy specialist Harish Bijoor said the pressure on jobs remained, regardless of the terminology used.

"Positions are being rejigged and layoffs are the norm of the day," he said.

IT'S JUST WORDPLAY

Like fashion, corporate terminology moves in cycles. For as long as companies have been cutting jobs, they have been searching for gentler ways to describe it. The 1990s brought "rightsizing", recasting downsizing as a correction in organisational size. The 2000s popularised "restructuring" and "reduction in force", while the 2010s added "rebalancing", "streamlining" and "resource action". In 2023, it was the "year of efficiency".

Jobs disappear. The vocabulary survives.

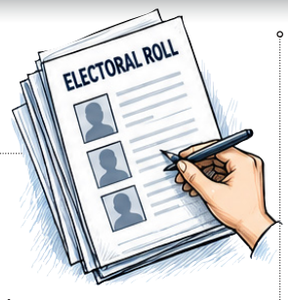
Jessie Paul, independent director and former CMO of Wipro, said AI is changing how companies think about workforce productivity and staffing. "AI is causing a seismic shift in per capita revenue expectations from employees – Anthropic lists a whopping $6.6 million in revenue per employee.

▶See other bk, P 13

KARNATAKA'S SIR EXPLAINED

From freezing of electoral rolls and door-to-door enumeration to disputed deletions, hearings and political protests, the special intensive revision became a months-long exercise in verifying voter eligibility. The draft rolls on Aug 24 left out 1.08-cr names, while 4.55-cr electors made the final list published on Oct 27. In this explainer, **Pearl D'souza** traces how the exercise unfolded, how voters could establish their eligibility, and what the numbers reveal

S THE STORY
The road to final rolls



JAN 1, 2025 – JUN 16, 2026 |
Applications before the freeze
Karnataka received 73.03 lakh applications before the rolls froze. These included 16.24 lakh Form 6 applications for inclusion, 604 Form 6A applications from overseas electors, 15.82 lakh Form 7 applications for deletion and 40.95 lakh Form 8 applications for modifications.

JUN 16, 2026 | Rolls frozen
Karnataka had 5.54 crore electors when the rolls were frozen. Bengaluru's electorate stood at 1.03 crore.

JUN 30 – AUG 17 |
Enumeration, three deadlines
House-to-house enumeration began on June 30, initially scheduled to end on July 29. Following concerns over the workload on booth-level officers (BLOs), the deadline was extended to Aug 8 and then Aug 17. During this phase, 12 BLOs died in incidents involving heart attacks, illness or accidents.

AUG 8–17 |
ASDDO list remains large
The list of electors marked Absent, Shifted, Duplicate, Dead or Others (ASDDO) stood at 1.09 crore on Aug 8. By Aug 17, it had fallen to 1.07 crore. The number of Form 6 applications rose from 3.83 lakh to 4.28 lakh over the same period.

AUG 17–24 |
Lists shared for scrutiny
ASDDO lists were shared with political parties to identify errors. Officials said an ASDDO classification did not automatically mean final deletion; affected electors could seek inclusion during the claims period. Actor Prakash Raj said he had been marked as shifted and had not received an enumeration form at his new address. His name was absent from the draft rolls.

AUG 24 | Draft rolls published
The draft list contained 4.46 crore electors, with 1.07 crore names missing. About 43.8 lakh electors were scheduled for notices: 23.45 lakh had not mapped themselves to 2002 records, while 20.35 lakh had discrepancies in their own or their parents' details.

AUG 24 – SEPT 23 |
Claims, objections and hearings
Electors were called to hearing centres, where long queues and inadequate seating were reported. From September 11, families could attend hearings for senior citizens, sick persons, persons with disabilities and electors overseas. Outstation students were subsequently accommodated on a case-by-case basis, including through video calls.

SEPT 24 – OCT 22 |
Notices disposed of, disputes intensify
Officials processed notices and claims. Reports of bulk Form 7 deletion applications from places including Bhalki and Bableshwar triggered political allegations. On October 1, Chief Minister DK Shivakumar and state ministers met the chief electoral officer over alleged mass-deletion attempts. An inquiry was ordered; officials later said some applications had been withdrawn or rejected for not meeting prescribed requirements.

OCT 7–12 |
Complaints and protests
Residents from Vijayapura who said they had been wrongly declared dead held a media briefing on October 7; an FIR was subsequently filed against BJP MLA Basanagouda Patil Yatnal. The following days saw protests, including a large gathering organised by Citizens for Justice and Peace at Freedom Park on October 8 and an AISA student march on October 11 that prompted the chief minister to order a probe into alleged police excesses. On October 12, the state said it had nearly met its deadline for issuing notices. Some Form 6 applicants began receiving EPIC numbers by SMS.

OCT 22–27 |
Final checks and publication
The hearing and claims period concluded on October 22. The centralised rolls were sent to electoral registration officers for final checks before the scheduled publication of the final list on Oct 27.

I INSIDE THE PROCESS
How revision worked

1 Mapping the voter
Each elector's details were checked against earlier electoral records, including the 2002 rolls. The link could be established through the elector's own entry or that of a parent.

2 Classify the records
Enumeration data was used to classify electors according to whether their details could be mapped to earlier rolls. Cases requiring further scrutiny were flagged for verification.

3 Verification of eligibility
Electors recorded as Absent, Shifted, Duplicate, Dead or Others were placed on the ASDDO list. Enumeration forms were distributed at addresses recorded in the 2026 rolls. Absence, relocation, refusal to sign or a duplicate entry lead to different classifications, which were subject to verification.

4 Issue notices & conduct hearings
After draft rolls were published, electors who could not map themselves to 2002 records, or whose details contained discrepancies, were scheduled for notices and hearings. Notices gave affected electors an opportunity to explain their circumstances and establish eligibility. The cases were examined before decisions were taken on inclusion.

5 Claims and objections
Electors could seek inclusion through Form 6, object to entries through Form 7, or request corrections and shifting of residence through Form 8. The authorities examined these applications before finalising the rolls.

6 Finalising the electoral rolls
The final list incorporated eligible additions, accepted corrections and decisions on disputed entries. A name missing from the draft list was not automatically a final deletion; eligibility had to be considered through the prescribed process.

What if your name is missing from the final rolls?

Eligible citizens can apply for inclusion using Form 6 through the prescribed election channels. They should check the application status and follow up with the relevant electoral registration authority if necessary.

R ROLLS AND RESULTS
Deletion, addition now complete

WHEN SIR BEGAN
Electoral rolls as on June 16, 2026
5.54 cr
2.76 cr | 2.25 cr

99.76 lakh fewer electors

AFTER SIR ENDED
Final rolls published on Oct 27, 2026
4.55 cr
2.25 cr | 2.29 cr

DURING THE PROCESS

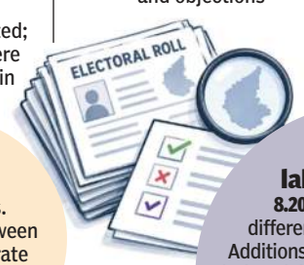
5.54 cr Enumeration forms generated

4.46 cr Forms submitted and digitised (80.52%)

1.08 cr Forms not submitted; these electors were not enumerated in the draft roll

43.82 lakh Notices generated and delivered; hearings recorded as completed

10.08 lakh Additions during claims and objections



1.88 lakh Deletions during claims and objections

8.96 lakh Modifications to electoral entries

61,867 Electors marked ineligible for the final roll

8.20 lakh more electors. Net increase between the draft electorate of **4.46 lakh** and the final electorate of **4.55 lakh**

99.76 lakh reduction and **8.20-lakh** increase use different comparison points. Additions and deletions recorded during claims and objections should not be treated as a complete explanation of the overall change

OTHER KEY FIGURES IN FINAL ROLLS

6.83 lakh Young electors aged 18-19

5.65 lakh Persons with disabilities (PwD)

3.92 lakh Electors aged 85 and above on the final rolls

60,923 Polling stations (up from 59,050)

Concept: **Chethan Kumar**
Design: **Ravi K**

Gen Z accounts for 20.5% of Karnataka electorate, emerges as key vote bank

Sandeep Moudgal & Pearl D'Souza | TNN

Bengaluru: The special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, which removed 99 lakh voters from the lists, has revealed a significant shift in Karnataka's voter demography, with Gen Z emerging as an important electoral force.

According to the final electoral roll data released by Karnataka chief electoral officer's (CEO) office Tuesday, the state has 86,56,838 voters aged between 20 and 29. Another 6,83,364 first-time voters have been added to the revised rolls, taking the total number of voters aged 18 to 29 to 93,40,202.

This puts the younger electorate at nearly 20.5% of Karnataka's voter population, making it a significant vote bank for political parties ahead of the 2028 assembly elections and 2029 Lok Sabha polls.

Gen Z voters are concentrated largely in urban centres, including Bengaluru, Belagavi, Mysuru and Kalaburagi. Bengaluru Urban district leads with 10.5 lakh voters in the 20-29 age group, followed by Belagavi with 7.9 lakh, Mysuru with 4.4 lakh and Kalaburagi with 4.2 lakh.

The numbers could prompt political parties to reassess their electoral strategies, particularly amid protests against the chief election commissioner and growing Gen Z-led demonstrations. The younger electorate could play a decisive role in determining electoral outcomes in the coming years, marking a departure from traditional focus on the working-age population.

However, voters aged between 40 and 59 continue to form the largest and most influential demographic, with a population of around 1.7 crore. Questions also remain over the accuracy of age-related data in the electoral rolls. Discrepancies in voters' recorded ages across age groups persist, with electors flagging errors that the Election Commission of India (ECI) did not rectify during the SIR exercise.

SIR cuts Bengaluru voters' count by 43%; city accounts for 40% of statewide deletions

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ANOTHER DRIVE: BLOs will be reassigned soon to identify missing voters

Bengaluru: The city has retained 59.1 lakh voters across its 28 assembly constituencies following the publication of the final electoral roll after the special intensive revision (SIR), marking a 43% decline from the pre-SIR count of around 1.03 crore.

The final roll has added just over two lakh voters to the draft electoral roll, which had 56.9 lakh voters. Of the total reduction of 1.1 crore voters across Karnataka during the revision, Bengaluru accounts for over 43 lakh, or around 40% of the statewide reduction. Of 46.9 lakh voters removed from Bengaluru's pre-SIR electoral roll under the ASDDO (Absent, Shifted, Duplicate, Dead and Others) categories, around 32.7 lakh were marked as permanently shifted.

A section of those excluded, particularly voters who have moved but continue to be eligible to vote in the city, are expected to be enrolled again during a special drive following the revision.

Greater Bengaluru Authority special commissioner (elections) Shilpa Nag and Bengaluru South ADEO KN Ramesh said booth-level officers (BLOs) deployed for SIR will be reassigned for a month-long drive to identify voters missing from the final list and facilitate their re-enrolment. "The BLOs will compare the pre-SIR list with the final SIR list and reach out to the excluded voters to initiate the Form 6 process of including them in the voter list," Ramesh said.

He added that around 30% of voters marked as permanently shifted were expected to return to the electoral rolls.

The special drive is intended to help eligible voters who were left out of the final list apply for inclusion. Such voters will have to complete the prescribed Form 6 process, with their applications subject to verification by the election authorities.

CEO denies suo motu Form 7 generation

▶Continued from page 1

Chief electoral officer Anbu Kumar said election officials had not generated Form 7 suo motu.

Asked why the reason for deletion was left blank in cases where Form 7 applications were filed by EROs and AEROs, Kumar said electors had been marked "ineligible" by officials concerned on grounds relating to citizenship or other eligibility criteria, following verification during the notice and hearing phase. Form 7 was generated on the basis of speaking orders.

1.7L+ applications beyond deadline

Data from the CEO's office showed that 1,78,175 applications for additions and deletions were processed after the Sept 23 deadline for filing claims and objections.

While 19.5 lakh applications for additions, deletions and modifications under Forms 6, 6A, 7 and 8 were received within the deadline, the CEO said more than 21 lakh applications were processed for the SIR exercise. This included an additional 89,570 Form 6 applications and 1.29 lakh Form 7 applications.

Govt yet to acquire land for B'luru-T'kuru quadrupling work

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AWAITING BOOST

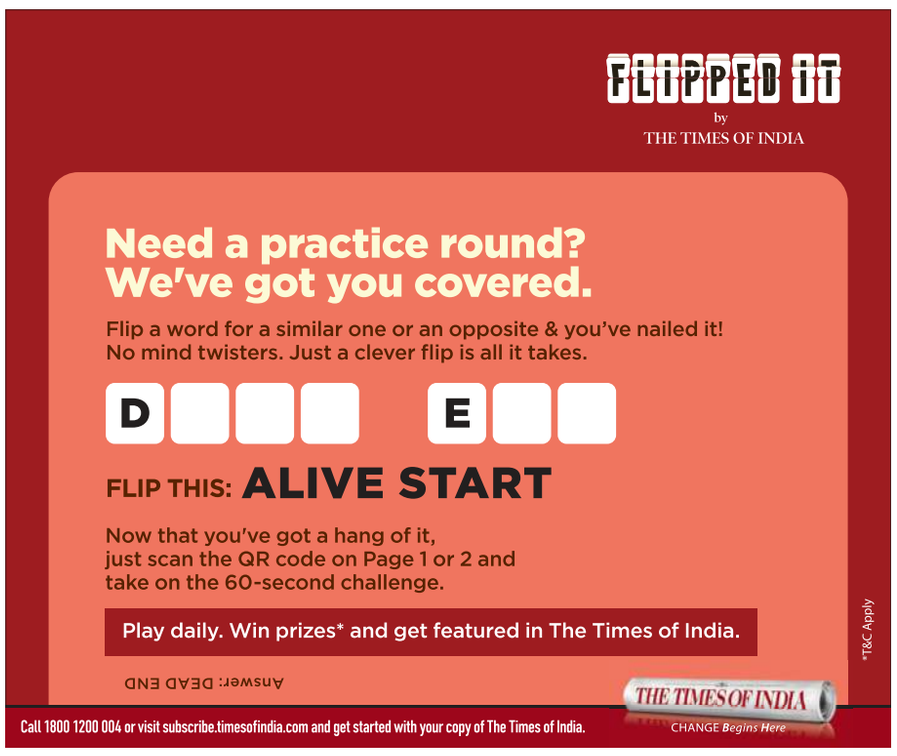
Bengaluru: As the rail quadrupling project between Bengaluru and Tumakuru heads towards land acquisition, South Western Railway (SWR) is banking on Karnataka govt for timely completion of the much-awaited project.

The 70-km project is expected to boost rail connectivity between two neighbouring cities witnessing high daily footfall. The railway ministry Saturday notified the appointment of three arbitrators for land acquisition with the special land acquisition officer (SLAO) as the competent authority for Bengaluru Urban, Bengaluru Rural and Tumakuru districts. The current regional commissioners of these districts will serve as arbitrators. In order to fast-track land acquisition, the ministry designated the quadrupling as a special railway project (SRP). The final location survey was completed with 51 villages being notified across three districts.

South Western Railway (SWR) sources believe land acquisition could start in a few months, though the exact timeline hasn't been revealed. "Land acquisition will be done by the state govt; we will be coordinating as per the survey and providing numbers. The status of the acquisition will be published only through the competent authority for land acquisition," a senior SWR official told **TOI**.

He added that land acquisition by Karnataka govt has been delayed on multiple occasions, slowing down rail works: "Many projects like Dharwad-Belagavi new line via Kittur have been pending since almost four years. We don't know the timeline; it all depends on state govt's interest."

SWR currently operates seven pairs of Memu (mainline electric multiple unit) trains on the route with around 18,000 passengers using these services daily. At Tumakuru station, 79 mail/express trains and 29 passenger trains have scheduled stoppages. SWR has also provided a stop for Vande Bharat Express operating between KSR Bengaluru and Dharwad.



Elders Act cases: HC calls for awareness drive, property registration guidelines

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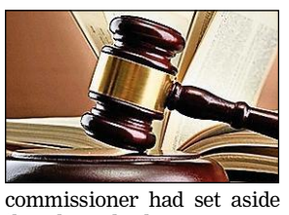
Bengaluru: With cases under Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007, on the rise, the high court has suggested that the state govt consider measures to create awareness among senior citizens about the legal consequences of transferring or relinquishing property during their lifetime.

In an order passed on Oct 14, Justice Suraj Govindaraj observed that such awareness should highlight the importance of understanding the nature and legal impact of documents before signing them, recording any obligation to provide maintenance or care, and the risks of transferring property that constitutes their principal source of livelihood or financial security. Senior citizens should also be informed about the legal remedies available if such transfers leave them without maintenance or support, he said. The observations came while the court examined a dispute involving a release deed executed by G Bairappa, 75, in favour of his daughter Girija and son-in-law Y Chandru.

Bairappa had approached the assistant commissioner, Bhadravathi, alleging neglect by the couple in connection with 1 acre 30 guntas of land at Hunasekatte village in Bhadravathi taluk. Allowing his application, the assistant commissioner had set aside the release deed.



Challenging the order, Girija and Chandru contended that the transaction was essentially a sale. They claimed to have paid Rs 7.3 lakh under an agreement of sale dated July 31, 2023, with the balance payable within six months. According to them, after the balance amount was paid, Bairappa executed a release deed in their favour, and the money was distributed among his sons. They further argued that the release deed contained no condition requiring them to maintain or care for Bairappa in return for the property. However, Bairappa disputed the authenticity of the documents relied upon to establish payment and nature of the transaction.

Justice Govindaraj said the court was not convinced by the documents produced by the petitioners. Material discrepancies and the absence of satisfactory supporting evidence regarding the payment were sufficient grounds to reject their contention. The judge directed that the matter be referred to the chief commissioner of income tax, Karnataka, for further action.

Body found in drain identified as 22-year-old office boy

Times News Network

The decomposed body found floating in a stormwater drain near Benson Town on Oct 23 is that of an office boy working in a private firm.

The postmortem report of Hariharan, 24, from Pulikeshinagar is awaited to ascertain the cause of death. The body was found in the drain at Muddamma Garden, but police did not notice any visible injuries or signs of assault.

Cops were able to establish Hariharan's identity as his parents had approached them with a missing-person complaint.

TAMIL NADU BAN IMPACT

Shortage of construction material hits Blue Line work

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Syed Asif

The shortage has affected depot construction & other works

Bengaluru: At a time when Namma Metro's opening timelines are already facing delays, Tamil Nadu's continued ban on transporting stones and construction aggregates to other states has impacted work on the Blue Line, affecting the supply of key construction materials.

A senior Bangalore Metro Rail Corporation Ltd official said contractors executing the 58-km Blue Line, connecting Silk Board with Kempegowda International Airport, are facing difficulties in procuring construction materials. While construction of the elevated corridor between Silk Board and KR Pura is at an advanced stage, work on KR Pura–KIA stretch is still on.

"Contractors said 30 to 40 per cent of construction materials would be sourced from crushers in Tamil Nadu's Krishnagiri district before the ban. Shortages of quarry dust, crushed stone and aggregates have affected several activities, including concreting, architectural finishing and other construction works," the official said.

The shortage has also affected depot construction, particularly the availability of railway ballast required for track laying. Along Outer Ring Road (ORR) stretch, multiple activities, including construction of entry and exit structures and travelators, are under way.

"The ban has disrupted construction activity over the past three months," said an engineer with a construction company executing works on ORR.

"Earlier, we were procuring aggregates from Hosur, which had around 14 quarry-crusher units supplying materials. Following the ban, supplies were disrupted for months, forcing vendors to shift procurement to just 4-5 crusher units in Bidadi. Aggregate prices, which were around Rs 800 per tonne earlier, have more than doubled now. This has added to the financial strain on contractors executing big projects," the engineer said.

Karnataka Truck Owners' and Agents' Association president GR Shanmugappa said the restrictions have also affected several other infrastructure projects in Bengaluru. "More than 40,000 tonnes of stone were being transported to the city before the ban; 600 to 700 truck owners have been affected now," he said.

WHY THE RESTRICTIONS?

TN had imposed restrictions citing rising domestic demand, inadequate supplies and prices of construction materials. The move was also intended to curb illegal mining and unauthorised transportation of stone materials

SC gives green signal for Metro work in Hebbal

Bengaluru: In a relief for BMRCL, Supreme Court has permitted it to proceed with construction of its ongoing Blue Line in Hebbal. A bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva gave this clarification after hearing a petition filed by BMRCL, pointing out that the status quo order passed on May 4 will not come in the way of ongoing Metro work.

The apex court is hearing a special leave petition filed by Lakeview Tourism Corporation, which had challenged the high court's April 10 order, quashing the acquisition of 55 acres and 13 guntas of land made in its favour. Calling it a monumental fraud, HC had directed a CBI investigation into the issue. TNN

JD(S) candidate turns tables, romps home by 908 votes

▶ Continued from page 1

In graduates' constituencies, BJP candidates SV Sankanur and KM Suresh were leading as counting continued. This is the second biennial legislative council election since Shivakumar became CM on June 3. In the June 18 elections to seven council seats from MLAs' quota, Congress won five seats and BJP secured two. However, the ruling party appeared to struggle to replicate that performance in teachers' and graduates' constituencies.

JD(S) candidate Ranganath won Bengaluru Teachers' constituency on his third attempt, defeating Puttanna by 908 votes. He secured 10,810 first-preference votes against Puttanna's 9,902.

Ranganath had lost to Puttanna in 2022 and 2024 elections. This time, he capitalised on a sympathy wave to secure victory. Puttanna had contested as a BJP candidate in 2022 before switching to Congress for 2024 by-election.

In West Graduates' constituency, BJP candidate SV Sankanur moved closer to a hat-trick of victories, extending his lead over Congress rival Mohan Limbikai to 3,556 first-preference votes after the second round of counting. Counting was expected to continue until 2am.

South-East Graduates' constituency witnessed a close contest between BJP candidate KM Suresh and Congress candidate Shashi Hulikuntemutt, with Suresh leading in the first round.

METRO WRAP

Close shave for 20 kids as bus hits vehicle

Twenty school children from a private institution, driver of their bus and an assistant escaped with minor injuries when a private company bus rammed their vehicle in Doddaballapur Tuesday morning. The school bus was heading to the institution when the vehicle rear-ended the bus that suddenly stopped in the middle of the road, police said. Locals protested against the company, saying its fleet of buses, carrying employees, was being driven recklessly.

Illegal firecrackers worth Rs 10L seized

Police booked 7 men on charges of illegally storing firecrackers inside a house in Kodigehalli, Doddaballapur. Cops seized 52 boxes of crackers, worth Rs 10 lakh.

Stammering camp

Samvaad Institute of Speech and Hearing, Hebbal, will organise a free camp for children and adults who stammer on Oct 31 and Nov 1, 10am to 4pm. The camp will focus on improving fluency and helping the participants gain better control over their speech. Call 9663388623 or 9845589061 for more details.

Nelamangala villagers on edge as leopard sightings increase; cub rescued from field

Pavan Kumar Pateel | TNN

SEPARATED FROM MOTHER

Bengaluru: Frequent leopard sightings in Nelamangala taluk on the outskirts of Bengaluru have triggered panic, with villages reporting attacks on pets and livestock.

In two separate incidents Tuesday, a month-old male cub was rescued from a field at Mallarabanavadi, while CCTV footage from Soladevanahalli captured a full-grown leopard prowling near houses and hunting domestic animals in daylight.

The cub was spotted by villagers near a clump of bushes in farmland. Believed to be barely a month old, it was found whimpering alone, apparently after being separated from its mother. Villagers secured the cub and alerted the forest department. A team led by Nelamangala range forest officer Manjunath shifted the cub to Bannerghatta Rehabilitation Centre for further treatment.

Meanwhile, residents of Soladevanahalli are on edge after CCTV footage showed a leopard moving close to residential properties and preying on domestic animals. Locals allege that leopards have been frequently straying into residential areas, targeting pet dogs and livestock.

Forest officials attribute the increased sightings to the leopard population in nearby wooded areas and agricultural patches. The animals are believed to be venturing closer to human settlements in search of easy prey.

Concerned about the potential threat, villagers have petitioned forest department officials to deploy baited cages and capture the leopards roaming near their homes.

Costs up 33%; realty sales slow down

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Bengaluru: Realty-related construction costs have risen about 33% while sales have slowed, squeezing builders in Karnataka. Reason: Tamil Nadu's ban on transporting construction materials has cut stone, sand and jelly supply to about 40%, with a crushers' shutdown adding to the strain.

Builders said there has been a shortage of sand and jelly, while cement and steel prices are 8-10% higher. Sand prices have risen from Rs 250-300 to Rs 450-800 per tonne, nearly doubling costs. Over 70% of Karnataka's stone crushers and another 15-20% near Tamil Nadu border, around Krishnagiri, are affected by supply disruptions.

Farook Mahmood, president emeritus, Bangalore Realtors Association India (BRAI), said: "The four-month Rera extension offers some relief, but projects could face delays of at least six months, as the Tamil Nadu ban extends until Jan 2027. Construction costs could rise by Rs 250-400 per square foot. Builders are sourcing materials from neighbouring states or available market stocks at higher prices. Delays will affect homebuyers, who may have to pay both pre-EMIs and rent while waiting for possession."

Suresh Hari, partner, Vishal Promoters & Builders, said: "Under Rera, we cannot revise prices once committed. At present, we have stored materials in advance and managed, but in the long term, there needs to be a regulatory mechanism."

Ramani Sastri, director, Sterling Developers, said: "The gap in all construction products is widening and projects are slowing down considerably. The cost of construction has gone up by about 15 to 18% and is likely to increase further. Rera extension can only help soften penalties of delays and nothing else."

Confederation of Real Estate Developers' Associations of India (Credai) said the industry welcomes and encourages measures to bring costs down. Bhaskar T Nagendrappa, president, Credai Karnataka, said: "The cost had gone up initially during the west Asia conflict, but now the recent ban has made it worse. We will meet govt officials next week and express our concerns and give solutions."

DEMANDS TO GOVT

- Resolve issue of double royalty
- Allow compliant crushers to operate for extended hours
- Coordinate with Tamil Nadu govt to permit royalty-paid materials with e-permits in border districts, deferring premium and approval fees for three months
- Expedite approvals and publish revised summary schedule of rates

2 more sim box sites found in TN, 10 devices seized

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Probe into the illegal sim box network operating in Bengaluru has widened across states, with Whitefield cybercrime police detecting two more sim farm sites in Tamil Nadu's Tiruchirappalli and Thanjavur districts and seizing 10 e-sim enabled box devices.

The breakthrough came during further investigation into an illegal sim box network which was busted at Kadugodi and Pattandur Agrahara.

Following the seizures, Maske Bapurav Ramrao alias Niranjan Maske, 20, and Yesh Patil, 21, were arrested, while two 17-year-old juveniles detained. All four belong to Gondia district, Maharashtra.

Police analysed the equipment, telecommunications records and digital evidence to determine whether the network's operations were confined to Bengaluru or extended to other locations. The leads pointed to Tiruchirappalli and Thanjavur, where the equipment was used for making cybercrime fraud calls.

The leads were shared with department of telecommunications, which resulted in the detection of two more sites. Investigation is now focused on tracing the entire operational chain across the country, including procurement and deployment of sim box and farm devices, use of cards and e-sim profiles, telecommunications infrastructure involved, and individuals who facilitated the operations.

TIMES NATION

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026

TMC MP MAHUA MOITRA ASSURES HC SHE WILL REMOVE X POSTS ABOUT BJP MP NISHIKANT DUBEY

PETROLEUM MINISTER PURI RULES OUT RAISING ETHANOL BLENDING BEYOND 20%, SAYS E20 SAVED GOVT RS 1.6L CR

Order preservation of SIR files & notings, petitioners urge SC

They Must Produce Evidence Before Court, Stop Rhetoric: SG

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

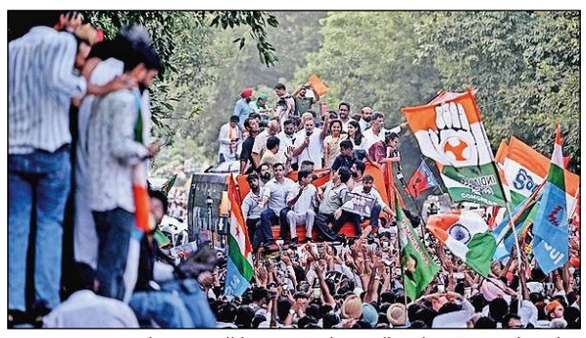
New Delhi: Some of the petitioners, including Rahul Gandhi and INDIA bloc netas, on Tuesday told the SC that the Election Commission "appeared to have accepted the charges relating to Form 6" and demanded preservation of files and file notings relating to the SIR exercise.

Senior advocates A M Singhvi and Menaka Guruswamy, appearing for petitioners who have questioned the commission's functioning and the CEC's alleged unilateral decision to conduct SIR of electoral rolls, made the assertions despite EC emphatically denying all allegations and filing an affidavit before SC stating that SIR orders were passed unanimously by the CEC and the two ECs.

Senior advocate Vikas Singh, appearing for one of the petitioners, refrained from making any claim and requested SC for a week's time to respond to EC's affidavit filed Monday. However, Guruswamy, also a RS MP representing TMC, said EC's affidavit "accepted charges about tampering of Form 6" and was silent about internal differences among the three-member EC, which the commission had said was part of deliberations and the post-discussion decisions were unanimous.

SG Tushar Mehta, appearing for Union govt, said the court would examine EC's affidavit and petitioners should not make the court a platform for political rhetoric. "They must place evidence before court to enable adjudication of their claims," Mehta said.

Bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana posted the matter for hearing on Nov 17 and said, "We are aware of everything and we will examine everything from the records."



Congress' protest in New Delhi on Oct 12 demanding the CEC's resignation

Cong slams EC affidavit, terms it 'deceitful & duplicitous'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Dubbing the Election Commission's affidavit in Supreme Court as "deceptive, deceitful and duplicitous", Congress Tuesday said CEC Gyanesh Kumar has been taking unilateral decisions and the EC's claims on Form 6 are contradictory.

Taking to X, Congress spokesperson **Jairam Ramesh** wrote, "Oh what a tangled web we weave, when first we practice to deceive." He said that as per the commission's claims, major SIR orders were formally approved by all three ECs.

"But two election commissioners objected on record to grave violations and illegal actions taking place on orders of CEC — their objections were disregarded. The commissioners were not even informed and learnt of these decisions from the news. This is not unanimity but unilateral decision-making," he said.

Ramesh said EC's stand on "illegal amendment to Form 6" is deceptive as it first claimed SC had approved the new declaration attached to Form 6 but changed its tune after SC contradicted its claim. "It now claims the new declaration form is separate, and Form 6 was not amended. But this is a deception — Form 6 could not be submitted online without filling this mandatory declaration," he said.

Ramesh said the EC has been silent on "illegal centralisation" of rolls through ECINET by overriding electoral registration officers (EROs) who are the statutory authority — which was put on record by the commissioners.

EC yet to reply to RTI query on panel

Election Commission is yet to respond to an RTI application seeking details of steps taken to address grievances raised by two election commissioners and copies of files, including notings, related to the issue, despite the 30-day statutory time-limit for giving a reply lapsing, said applicant Commodore Lokesh K Batra (retd) on Tuesday. TNN

UP CEO apologises for inappropriate remarks

Vijay Chopra | TNN

Lucknow: The office of UP chief electoral officer has issued a public apology for inappropriate remarks made through its official X handle while responding to a bizarre entry in the electoral roll for the Allahabad-Jhansi Graduates' constituency of the UP Legislative Council.

The controversy began after a voter slip showing Ravi Sharma's father's name as "Ram ne Sharma ko mara" (Ram hit Sharma) surfaced on social media.

Acknowledging the error, the CEO's office initially posted that computers and software were not casteist and that mistakes made by its office did not involve caste discrimination.

The post further remarked that it was fortunate Lord Ram had not killed someone from a minority community, otherwise he would have been labelled both casteist and communal.

The remarks drew criticism, with Aam Aadmi Party Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh questioning why Ram had been mentioned instead of other names. He also asked whether the CEO's computer was casteist or whether the office was pursuing a political agenda.

Pilibhit rolls row: Robina becomes Ravindra, Rais is now Dhanpal

Pilibhit: A row erupted in UP's Pilibhit Tuesday over alleged discrepancies in voters' names. In 129-Puranpur (SC), 23-year-old Robina's name was purportedly changed to "Ravindra Singh", while her father's name, Rais Ahmad, was replaced with "Dhanpal Singh". This comes days after **TOI** reported "unauthorised changes" to at least 13,150 electors' details in 127-Pilibhit Sadar, which saw a close contest in the 2022 polls. An FIR was registered against two SDMs/EROs, and a departmental probe was recommended against them. UP CEO Navdeep Rinwa termed the changes a "deliberate crime, rather than mistake".

Speaking to **TOI** on Tuesday, Robina, whose name appeared differently on the EC portal, said, "We've brought the matter to the notice of Puranpur SDM Nagendra Pandey." Pandey said, "Robina's altered name on our records was brought to my notice. EPIC number of Robina and Ravindra seemed to be the same. We're probing the matter and will reach a final conclusion soon." TNN

NDA wins Bihar MLC polls, rebel springs upset in Saran

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Patna/Pune/Lucknow: BJP-led NDA scored a win in Bihar MLC elections but suffered a shock defeat at the hands of a BJP rebel, while Maharashtra witnessed tight contests.

In UP, BJP won both Meerut MLC seats, and was leading in Lucknow teachers' as counting of votes for 11 constituencies across the state continued late into the night. Samajwadi Party was ahead in Varanasi and Agra. Polling was held on Oct 23.

In Bihar, BJP's Narendra Prasad Singh won Tirhut teachers' constituency, defeating independent candidate Bhushan Jha by 594 votes. CPI's sitting MLC Sanjay Kumar Singh finished third, ending the party's sole representation in the council.

The bigger upset came in Saran teachers' constituency, where BJP rebel Rahul Raj, contesting as an independent after being expelled by the party, defeated NDA candidate Anand Puskar of JD(U) and incumbent MLC Afaque Ahmad of Jan Suraaj.

Counting continued in the remaining Bihar constituencies. JD(U) MLC Neeraj Kumar was leading RJD's Dilip Patel in Patna graduates' constituency, while BJP's NK Yadav led in Kosi Graduates'. Patna teachers' seat saw a close contest between BJP's Nawal Kishor Yadav and RJD's Sanjeev Kumar.

In Meerut-Saharanpur graduates' constituency, BJP's Dinesh Goyal retained his seat, while Shrichand Sharma secured Meerut teachers' for the party. In Lucknow teachers', BJP's Umesh Dwivedi was leading SP's Sushil Kumar after 14 rounds of counting.

PTI

Polling officials handle ballot papers during the counting of votes for the MLC election, in Nagpur on Tuesday

Maharashtra's five MLC seats remained closely contested between BJP-led Mahayuti and opposition alliance Maha Vikas Aghadi, with results expected by Wednesday. NCP (SP) candidate Harshada Deshmukh led BJP's Smita Jadhav in Pune graduates' constituency, while BJP's Kaustubh Gawade was ahead in Pune teachers'. BJP's Sudhakar Kohale led Congress incumbent Abhijeet Wanjari in Nagpur, and Shiv Sena's Kiran Sarnaik held a sizeable lead in Amravati. In Aurangabad division, NCP's Satish Chavan trailed NCP (SP)'s Pratapsinh Patil.

Rahul: Oppn united against 'voter deletions'

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New Delhi: Alleging that crores of people across India were being deprived of their voting rights through the deletion of their names from electoral rolls, Congress MP and Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi Tuesday said all Opposition parties were united on the issue and would continue fighting to protect citizens' right.

"We have been raising this issue for a long time, but now the entire country is beginning to understand that votes are being stolen at the highest level. Poor people are being removed from electoral rolls, and their rights are being snatched away... An attempt is being made to create a new India for a select group of billionaires, where citizens have no rights and the poor are denied their due, leaving a country that serves only the interests of billionaires," he said, adding the Opposition would continue its campaign until CEC Gyanesh Kumar resigned or PM Modi removed him from the post.

Anindya Chattopadhyay

Rahul Gandhi listens to a participant at a public hearing in Delhi

Gandhi's remarks came while listening to Delhi residents recount their experiences at Ramlila Park in Trilokpuri, where a public hearing was organised by Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan, Jan Sarokar, Voter Adhikar Manch and National Federation of Indian Women.

Many raised concerns over the names of family members missing from the rolls and some said they had been wrongly marked as absent or shifted. Bijendra (60) said he was shocked to find that he had been marked 'deceased'.

Organisers said an audit presented at the hearing showed 2,097 of the 5,173 voters listed across surveyed polling booths had been removed from the electoral rolls, accounting for 40.5% of the electorate.

Gandhi's remarks came while listening to residents recount their experiences at Ramlila Park in Trilokpuri, where a public hearing was organised by Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan, Jan Sarokar, Voter Adhikar Manch and National Federation of Indian Women.

GLASS, FACADES AND FENESTRATION

READER ENGAGEMENT INITIATIVE

Beyond the surface

From high-performance glazing to sustainable facade and fenestration solutions, advances in materials and design are changing how buildings interact with people and their surroundings

Respedit.Chennai
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A building's character is often defined by its most visible elements, from windows and doors to exteriors. Yet some of the most significant developments in modern architecture lie in what these elements can do. A glass facade can help regulate indoor temperatures, a well-designed window can improve ventilation, and an intelligently engineered building envelope can cut energy bills. What was once largely about appearance now shapes how a building performs.

This shift is bringing glass, facades, fenestration and aluminium systems into sharper focus. Across residential, commercial and institutional projects, architects and developers are looking beyond conventional solutions, placing greater emphasis on durability, safety and the changing needs of the people who use these spaces.

MATERIALS THAT DO MORE

Advances in glazing technology, thermal insulation and precision-engineered aluminium systems are widening the possibilities of contemporary construction. High-performance glass can manage heat and natural light, while improved framing and sealing solutions deliver better acoustic insulation. Automated windows, smart shading systems and adaptable facade designs give occupants greater control over indoor environments, allowing buildings to respond more effectively to external conditions.

DESIGN WITH PURPOSE

Sustainability is influencing how construction materials are selected, manufactured and maintained. Recyclability, resource conservation and long-term performance are drawing greater attention as the industry looks for ways to minimise its environmental impact.

These developments are also drawing architects, engineers, manufacturers and developers into closer collaboration, with innovation increasingly driven by the need for solutions that are practical, cost-effective and suited to different climatic conditions.

Ultimately, the value of a modern building lies not simply in the statement it makes on the skyline, but in the experience it offers within. As technology and architecture become more closely integrated, the next generation of buildings will be judged as much by how they perform as by how they look.

THE TIMES OF INDIA

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Why Bumrah, Hardik need different fitness playbooks

As domestic, international and IPL workloads increase wear and tear, experts turn to routines tailored to ensure injured players can return to optimum levels. Getting the balance right is key as the clock ticks down to cricket's marquee event next year

Hardik Pandya hits the pitch during a 2025 IPL match in Ahmedabad. The India all-rounder is currently recovering from an injury

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A cricketer can recover from an injury and still be unprepared for the demands of a match. For Indian cricket, that gap has become an uncomfortable question: why are players breaking down again after rehabilitation, despite increasingly sophisticated monitoring of their bodies?

Over the past 18 months, injuries and interrupted comebacks have put BCCI's fitness programme under scrutiny. With the 2027 ODI World Cup approaching, uncertainty over the availability of players such as Jasprit Bumrah and Hardik Pandya complicates planning for selectors and coaches.

The debate is focused on sports science and medicine: doctors, physiotherapists, strength coaches and cricket coaches working together to help players perform, recover and reduce their risk of injury. BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru, which succeeded the National Cricket Academy (NCA), is central to that effort.

The aim is to understand how much work each player can handle, when they need recovery and whether they are ready to compete again. Indian cricket has been investing in this approach for over a decade. Its implementation remains a work in progress.

Beyond Running Harder

Soham Desai, India's former strength and conditioning (S&C) coach, now with IPL franchise Lucknow Super Giants, says the game is still moving from conventional fitness training towards preparing individual bodies for specific cricketing demands. "In Indian cricket, S&C is still perceived to function like fitness instructors and trainers," Desai tells **TOI**. "Earlier, the answer to everything was to go through fitness drills without accounting for burnout/injury risks." That distinction matters. Being able to complete a demanding run does not, by itself, establish how well a fast bowler can withstand repeated spells, or how quickly he will recover between matches.

The debate became particularly visible in 2016-17, when the Yo-Yo test gained prominence under then captain Virat Kohli's emphasis on fitness. The test involves shuttle runs at increasing speeds, with brief recovery intervals. Yuvraj Singh's failure to meet its requirements became a selection controversy. But a single benchmark cannot tell the whole story, says Ashish Kaushik, a former India physiotherapist who headed sports science at NCA. Players have different bodies, roles and training histories. Their assessments need to reflect those differences.

What The Tests Tell You

The newer Bronco test is another running assessment: players run out and back over 20m, 40m and 60m, then repeat that sequence five times, covering 1.2km against the clock. It provides a measure of endurance. Such assessments supply information for a player's programme. They do not provide a complete verdict on his readiness to play cricket.

Kaushik argues that the interpretation matters more than the name of the test. A player's usual results provide a reference point against which changes can be assessed; another player's score may be an unsuitable target.

"First, these are assessments, not tests. One should do it three-four times a year. Players must not be made to feel that these are about pass or fail. It has to be non-threatening to them," says Kaushik.

The broader monitoring continues between formal assessments. Wearable devices record physical activity, while support staff watch how a player moves, practises and responds to training. Numbers are one part of that picture.

Why Bumrah And Siraj Differ

'Workload management' means controlling the amount and intensity of training and competition, while allowing recovery. The difficulty is establishing the right balance for each player.

That became a public argument during India's 2025 tour of England. Bumrah was restricted to three of the five Tests, while Mohammed Siraj played throughout the series. Siraj's sustained intensity prompted questions about why one bowler needed protection while another kept going.

The explanation from India's batting coach Sitanshu Kotak was that workloads are assessed against individual baselines: the point at which each bowler struggles to perform at his best differs.

Siraj himself once needed convincing that bowling more was not always helpful. In 2017, as he approached an India call-up, he could bowl at maximum intensity for hours. The India 'A' support staff spent considerable time explaining the risk of an injury interrupting his progress. Desai says players from that period subsequently developed a much clearer understanding of when to push themselves and when to recover.

Reducing work is only one part of the approach. In an Aug 11 account of its procedures, the BCCI said CoE head VVS Laxman had also highlighted the danger of bowlers being insufficiently prepared for the demands placed on them. The centre sets individual workload ranges and monitors bowling weekly.

Ready For A Match?

The distinction between recovery and readiness becomes crucial after injury. 'Return to play' is the process of rebuilding a player's strength, cricketing skills and workload before clearing him for competition.

Bumrah's breakdown ahead of the 2022 T20 World Cup, after returning for a T20I series, prompted discussions involving then coach Rahul Dravid, captain Rohit Sharma and the sports science team. Injury prevention became a greater focus, with plans drawn around each player's calendar.

The preparation looks months ahead, including the conditions expected at a major tournament and the matches leading into it.

"Suppose the team wants Bumrah to bowl and endure a certain amount of load while bowling at 140 kmph in another 6-12 months. Then his workload after an injury needs to be gradually increased without forcing him to hit 140 kmph right away," explains Desai.

The intended benefit is a player who can sustain the required performance once he returns. Harshit Rana and Nitish Kumar Reddy's fitness struggles underline the importance of that preparation, particularly for players expected to contribute with both bat and ball.

Medical clearance is one stage. Cricket coaches must also assess whether the player can perform his role. Match simulations help bridge that gap.

In its August explanation, the BCCI said rehabilitation progresses through medical treatment, strength work, cricket skills and increase in workload. Players must meet physical and skill benchmarks and complete two return-to-play matches before clearance. Laxman also cautioned that recovery dates cannot always be fixed: progress determines the timetable.

That makes communication with selectors and team management essential, especially when a player is being considered for an upcoming tournament. "One has to gauge the risk, given the stakes of the tournament. It can backfire both for the player and the team if he breaks down in the middle of the tournament," says Kaushik.

Spinner Kuldeep Yadav returned from injury in 2022 able to generate more pace through the air, thanks to biomechanics that connected physical preparation with his bowling technique

The IPL Handover

Maintaining a continuous plan becomes harder as players move between international, domestic and franchise cricket. Each team has its own staff, expectations and immediate priorities.

IPL franchises invest heavily in fitness programmes and employ specialists from around the world. Desai nevertheless warns that training expectations can overlook a young Indian player's background or the work he has already done during the domestic season.

"Australian coaching staff expect a young Indian player to pull off training drills that are very common in Australia. It has to be a very focused and empathetic approach," says Desai. His prescription is regular discussion between conditioning staff, cricket coaches and physiotherapists, so the training plan reflects both the player's existing workload and the franchise's expectations.

Driven By Data

The player's trust is equally important. Someone anxious about missing a major tournament may find a cautious rehabilitation plan difficult to accept. Desai favours conversations that explain its purpose through cricketing goals: bowling at the required pace, scoring runs and extending a career.

Nor does every useful intervention involve working harder. When Kuldeep Yadav returned from injury in 2022, he credited Kaushik with helping him generate more pace through the air. That involved biomechanics — studying how the body moves and applies force — to connect physical preparation with bowling technique.

For Kaushik, better research specific to Indian cricket and clear accountability for those running sports science are priorities. For Desai, the challenge is getting the different departments to work together consistently. "The use of technology has increased. So has the number of injuries. Injuries will be a part of sport. A cohesive effort between all departments can only execute a better system that can limit the damages."

HOW SCIENCE AIDS FITNESS

There was a time when the cricket team's fitness approach was one of damage control. Technology like athlete management system (AMS) was introduced in 2010, with aggressive investment in sports science medicine (SSM) coming in 2015

What Is SSM? Sports science medicine is a multi-disciplinary field that combines physiology, biomechanics, psychology, and nutrition to improve performance. Scientific training helps sportspersons avoid injuries and ensures speedy recovery while workloads are managed for optimum output

Cricket Team's Fitness Drills

Olympic weightlifting Introduced amidst resistance, though players with 'explosive' body types like Kohli, Umesh Yadav and Bhuvneshwar responded amazingly. Drastic improvement in fast bowling and fielding standards from 2018

Bronco test Players run 20m, 40m, and 60m out and back for five unbroken sets, in different drills, totaling 1,200m. Measures endurance, stamina, and recovery. Hockey players complete it in 4.15-4.30 mins; base for cricket players is 5.15-5.20 mins

Yo-Yo test | Athletes run 20m back and forth to audio beeps, followed by a short active recovery period. It measures how well a person can repeat high-intensity efforts. Footballers hit scores of 20 and above; base mark for Indian cricket set at 16.5

2K test Player has to run 2km in a given time. Measures endurance, pacing, and recovery. In Indian cricket, 9-10 mins is benchmark. Aussie players believed to do it in 7.30-8 mins

Odisha & Andhra brace for Arnab, evacuate thousands

Flights, Trains Cancelled Amid IMD Red Alert

Nalla Babu, Riyan Ramanath & Diana Sahu | TNN

Cyclone Arnab triggers giant waves on Ennore Expressway in Chennai. The key expressway, heading to Chennai Port, was closed for traffic

Visakhapatnam/Bhubaneswar: Andhra Pradesh and Odisha Tuesday braced for Cyclone Arnab as the "very severe cyclonic storm", packing sustained winds of 125-135 kmph and gusts of up to 150 kmph, closed in on the Andhra coast, where the landfall is expected near Visakhapatnam early Wednesday, sooner than initially anticipated.

The two states have set up nearly 4,000 cyclone shelters and moved thousands of people to safety. At least 21 flights were cancelled at Vijayawada and Visakhapatnam airports Tuesday, affecting services to Chennai, Bengaluru, Visakhapatnam and Kadapa. For Wednesday, 15 flights at Vijayawada airport have been cancelled, an official said.

The East Coast Railway cancelled more than 20 trains connecting Visakhapatnam, Secunderabad, Kirandul, Jagdalpur, Rourkela, Sambalpur, Rayagada, Howrah, Bhubaneswar and Koraput on different dates between Oct 27 and Nov 5. The South Coast Railway has cancelled 24 trains scheduled for Wednesday.

The cyclone has already claimed a life in Visakhapatnam, where a 65-year-old man died of electrocution Tuesday evening after he came into contact with live electric wires that had snapped and fallen into stagnant water.

IMD has issued a red alert for extremely heavy rainfall Wednesday in Visakhapatnam and several other districts. Waves along the coast are expected to reach heights of one to two metres.

Andhra CM N Chandrababu Naidu said the administration is fully prepared to respond to emergencies.

Meanwhile, Odisha has shut schools and anganwadi centres across several districts until Oct 28. The airports in Bhubaneswar and at Jeypore and Utkela were placed on alert. Bhubaneswar airport director Prasanna Pradhan said flight operations were expected to remain normal for now.

The cyclone also brought rain to parts of West Bengal. In south Bastar of Chhattisgarh, the sky was overcast while and cool winds swept Sukma and adjoining districts. Sukma, close to Andhra and Odisha, has declared a holiday for all schools on Oct 28.

India gets 52% less rain in Oct; Arnab may cut deficit

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Pune: India received just 33.9 mm of rain against a normal of 69.9 mm between Oct 1 and 26, recording a 51.5% deficit, as per IMD, even as the northeast monsoon brought rain to parts of southern India. However, the rainfall scenario in Oct could change over the next two to three days due to very severe cyclone Arnab, with Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Odisha likely to receive good rainfall, an IMD official said. Rain could also extend to parts of the Indo-Gangetic plains after the cyclone's landfall.

The shortfall in Oct follows a 13% deficient southwest monsoon, raising concerns over the lack of a widespread rainfall recovery as the post-monsoon season progresses.

State-wise figures revealed steep deficits across parts of western and central India, but showed above-normal rain in Tamil Nadu and close to normal in Kerala.

Maharashtra received just 2.6mm of rain against its normal of 71.1mm between Oct 1 and Oct 26, a deficit of 96.3%. Gujarat recorded 0.3mm against 18.8mm, a shortfall of 98%, while Madhya Pradesh received 2.9mm against 31.3mm, Chhattisgarh 3.9mm against a normal of 58.1mm, and Odisha 16.9mm against 105.8mm.

The dry spell also affected parts of the southern peninsula, where the northeast monsoon is an important source of rainfall. Telangana received 5.2mm against a normal of 88.9mm, Andhra Pradesh 68.2mm against 139mm, and Karnataka 73.3mm against 118.4mm.

Tamil Nadu, however, received 217.5mm against a normal of 144.2mm, an excess of 51%. Kerala recorded 268mm against 271mm.

Parts of northwest India recorded above-normal rainfall during the period. Delhi received 35.4mm against a normal of 11.7mm, an excess of 203%, while Haryana recorded 25.2mm against 8.9mm, 183% above normal. In contrast, Rajasthan recorded just 4.7mm against 10.6mm, a deficit of 55%, and UP 15.8mm against 27.9mm."Earlier, during El Niño years, the southern peninsula usually received good rainfall. But in recent years, that correlation has weakened. Even during an El Niño year, we are expecting normal to slightly below-normal rainfall," the official said.

HC to hear blue drum murder case convicts' appeal on Nov 30

Prayagraj: The Allahabad High Court on Tuesday admitted an appeal filed by the two convicts in the blue drum murder case challenging their death sentence by a Meerut court and fixed November 30 for hearing. A bench of justices Salil Kumar Rai and Padam Narain Mishra passed the order on the criminal appeal by Muskan Rastogi and her partner Sahil Shukla. PTI

India says UNSC reform must grant veto to all permanent members

New Delhi: Govt reiterated at the UN that as long as the veto power exists in the Security Council, it must be held by all permanent members of a reformed council and not just the current P5 countries.

While the veto issue may arise only in case of any new permanent member that may be admitted, India's position always has been that there should be no discrimination in the Security Council and also no second class of permanent members without veto.

"Fairness and justice demand that all permanent members enjoy the same rights and responsibilities." said Indian ambassador to UN P Haish while participating in a debate in the UNGA on the veto question. "India's position on the veto is principled and well known. It is aligned with the Common African Position. We reiterate that as long as the veto exists, it must be held by all permanent members of a reformed council," he added. The official emphasised that a reform that expands the UN Security Council by creating another category of long-term members without the veto effectively makes them 'second-class' members and would not change the decision making dynamic of the P5.

India's top diplomat at the UN in New York stressed India's position that the veto, which is right now a prerogative only of the five permanent members of the UN Security Council, is a responsibility that must be exercised with great restraint . TNN

India invites Pakistan minister for SCO meet

New Delhi: India has invited Pakistan for the inaugural meeting of the SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum that it will host next month. PM Narendra Modi had proposed the dialogue forum during his visit to Tianjin last year for the SCO summit, saying it would work to foster greater people-to-people ties and cultural understanding within the grouping.

Aurungzeb Khan Khichi, minister for national heritage and culture, has been invited for the dialogue.

The Eurasian bloc continues to enjoy immunity from India-Pakistan tensions, allowing rare high-level visits from both sides even in the absence of any substantive bilateral engagement between the two countries for over a decade. The last Pakistan minister to visit India was Bilawal Bhutto in 2023 for a meeting of the SCO foreign ministers. EOM S Jaishankar travelled to Pakistan the next year for the meeting of SCO heads of govt. On both occasions, there was no bilateral meeting. TNN

Now, police parade semi-nude accused in Kol's 'walk of shame'

Dwaipayan.Ghosh @timesofindia.com

Kolkata: Thirty-six hours after an 18-year-old, his father and the youth's friend were forced to walk naked at gunpoint in Behala's Sarsuna by family members of a 13-year-old girl as punishment for the teen allegedly kissing her, police on Tuesday paraded three of the accused shirtless and barefoot at the same site, claiming they were "recreating the crime scene".

The three men — the father of the minor girl, her maternal uncle and a friend of the uncle — were brought to Khudiram Pally Manasatala in a police SUV.

With ropes tied around their waists, they were made to walk over 100 metres semi-naked as residents lined both sides of the road, many filming the scene. Police and paramilitary personnel formed a human chain to prevent attacks by angry neighbours. The fourth accused in the case is the girl's mother.

HC had earlier said police may arrest an accused but 'cannot intentionally disgrace the accused'

While the girl's father and uncle were arrested on Monday, the uncle's friend, Shankar Shaw, was apprehended early Tuesday. Cops are probing if he alerted the girl's family after allegedly spotting the couple kissing and provided the firearm used to threaten the victims.

"At least five others, and even those who shot videos of the three men being forced to walk naked, are under the lens. Raids are on to nab them," said a senior officer who declined to elaborate on the "recreation of the crime scene".

In June, the Calcutta high court had observed that police may arrest an accused but "cannot intentionally disgrace the accused".

Human rights group APDR questioned the police action. Its general secretary, Altaf Ahmed, said, "Where in police procedure is this allowed? Is it written in BNS? The police are supposed to uphold the law… not take the law into their own hands."

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Modi: Build AI to secure systems, serve humanity

But Scientists Must Test Tech Veracity: PM

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Speaking at 'Emerging Science, Tech and Innovation Conclave', Modi referred to emerging AI-era cybersecurity threats to financial networks and national security

New Delhi: Artificial intelligence can give us answers quickly but the responsibility of testing the veracity of the answer must lie with the scientist alone, Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** said as he urged the country's scientific community to innovate boldly.

Speaking at the 'Emerging Science, Technology and Innovation Conclave' on Tuesday, Modi referred to emerging AI-era cybersecurity threats to financial networks and national security, as he called for developing AI-based and quantum security solutions that protect national systems and serve humanity. Modi said in the age of AI, there were new challenges. "While AI can rapidly execute routine tasks to boost productivity, it must enrich rather than restrict independent thinking, allowing researchers to use saved time for harder problems, new experiments, and idea validation," he said. "Our goal is to develop such technologies which empower India and also contribute to solving the problems of humanity," he added.

The PM's remarks came at a time when there are calls for regulation of AI amid fears that it may go rogue and the govt's moves to draft a consultation paper on what should be the nation's AI policy.

The PM underlined how scientific judgment will evolve in the age of AI during the second quarter of the 21st century, He emphasised that while AI could rapidly execute routine tasks to boost productivity, it must enrich rather than restrict independent thinking, allowing researchers to use saved time for harder problems, new experiments, and idea validation. The three-day Conclave brought together leading scientists, policymakers and global experts to deliberate on emerging technologies and innovation priorities.

Asserting that a 'Viksit Bharat' (developed India) will be built on strong foundations of scientific research, discoveries and the spirit of innovation, he appealed to every researcher, industry leader, startup founder and student to set a concrete three-year target identifying which technology, prototype, pilot project or product they will help develop to make India a global hub for solutions.

Somanathan seeks action on rly staff ration cards

▶ Continued from page 1

At a meeting of senior bureucrats on Tuesday, Cabinet secretary T V Somanathan urged faster inter-ministerial consultations. The finance and commerce ministries, he is learnt to have said, should send their views promptly to avoid delays. He also noted that officers' performance scores often cluster close to 10 on a scale of 1 to 10, leaving the ranking system with little room to demarcate the stars from the merely satisfactory.

Meanwhile, the department of food and public distribution took the opportunity to flag that around 1 lakh railway employees have ration cards allowing them to receive free foodgrain under the PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana. Calling it a disciplinary issue, Somanathan directed Railway Board chairman Satish Kumar to ensure that the employees surrender their cards.

Indian Army debunks fake clips of China incursion in Arunachal

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Army says these videos are misleading propaganda being spread by mischievous elements

New Delhi: Indian Army has rubbished a series of videos on social media that falsely claimed that Chinese troops have taken control of some areas in Arunachal Pradesh, pointing out that these are misleading propaganda being spread by some mischievous elements.

On its official fact-check account on X, Indian Army has debunked a deepfake video circulating on social media that falsely attributed remarks regarding China taking control of areas in Arunachal to Lt Gen Girish Kalia. The Army also clarified that a TikTok video of an exercise in Kazakhstan is being circulated with misleading claims that Indian and Chinese troops are facing off in Arunachal Pradesh. In a third post, the Army has pointed out that Pakistani propaganda accounts are circulating a digitally manipulated video falsely attributing remarks to a former Army Commander on Arunachal.

Regarding the fake video on a Lt General, the Army fact-check post said on Sunday, "A digitally altered video is being circulated with fabricated remarks attributed to Lt Gen Girish Kalia, claiming that China has taken control of Asaphila, Longjou and Taksing Circle in Arunachal Pradesh and that the Indian Army has been denied essential supplies. The misleading video attempts to portray fabricated statements as a leaked admission by a senior Indian Army officer. The video uses Synthetic Generated Information to falsely attribute remarks to Lt Gen Girish Kalia."

The Army clarified that the original footage is related to a press briefing delivered by then GOC 28 Infantry Division, Maj Gen Girish Kalia, in Kupwara, Jammu & Kashmir, on Oct 27, 2023, where he addressed infiltration attempts across the LoC, reporting 10 foiled attempts, elimination of 27 terrorists and recovery of warlike stores and narcotics.

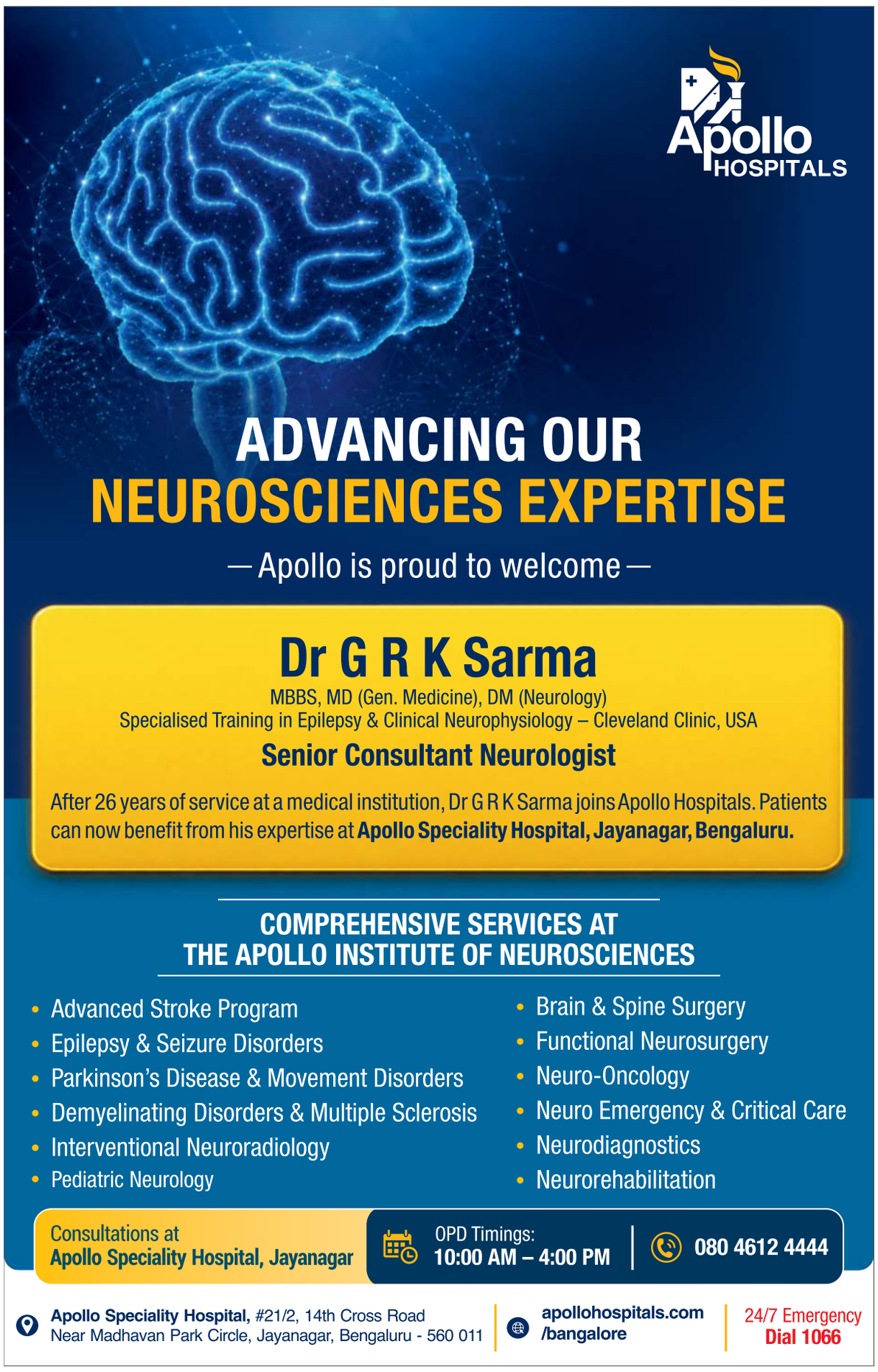
In a third post on Monday, the Army pointed out that "Pakistani propaganda accounts are circulating a digitally manipulated video falsely attributing remarks to former Army Commander, Western Command, Lt Gen Manoj Kumar Katiyar (Retd), claiming he warned that Arunachal Pradesh could become India's next major military flashpoint."

Bengal CM: Hooliganism will not be tolerated

▶ Continued from page 1

The first, in which Gaighata rape-murder accused Prahlad Das, 23, was killed, happened at 2.30am on Tuesday. The second, in which Samiul Sheikh, 46, was gunned down in Shamsherganj, happened 12 hours later, at 2.30 pm. Samiul was accused of killing BJP worker Sujit Mondal.

Chief minister Suvendu Adhikari told reporters while emerging from Bengal police headquarters in Bhavani Bhawan on Tuesday evening that he had given police a free hand in two areas: action against drug abuse and narcotics trafficking, and crime against women. He asserted that hooliganism would not be tolerated and those taking the law into their hands would face action through due legal process.



CONTRAPUNTO

If I can get my dress on,
my weight is under control

– DOLLY PARTON

House That?

Can US midterms result rein in Trump on Iran, and helps cool oil prices, the world's asking

With US midterm polls round the corner, the question the world is asking is how will the result impact global energy prices. There's no denying that the current elevated price of crude is artificial, having been created by Trump's disastrous war on Iran. As foreign minister Jaishankar has remarked, crude above $100 per barrel cannot be treated as normal. But with Brent hovering around the $115 mark, and Strait of Hormuz locked up with ships still coming under attack, there's only one way oil prices are coming down – by ending the Iran war. But Trump may have other plans, and could again escalate hostilities with Iran after midterms. He has already dispatched a third aircraft carrier to the region, along with 10,000 additional soldiers. Resumption of full-scale conflict will be terrible for the world, especially big oil importers like India.

So, how can Trump be restricted from going down this path? If Democrats win either one or both houses of Congress. Current projections suggest that the House of Representatives is likely to flip to Democratic control. Flipping the Senate will be tougher. Even so, a Democratic-majority House could potentially rein in Trump through control over funding.

Democrats could threaten to cut defence spending to force Trump to obtain permission from Congress to continue the war. Trump has been skirting around this – the War Powers Act requires Congressional approval for prolonged wars. But should Democrats take control of the lower House, he will have less wriggle room. Of course, he can still veto any binding legislation or resolution that Democrats press on him. But with many Republicans also against the war, and public mood souring, he can't deflect indefinitely.

But if Trump ignores a Democratic Congressional victory and pursues the war, it then falls on Republicans to take a stand. Resumption of full-scale hostilities could see oil hit $120 or more, and remain elevated throughout 2027. That then could dent Republican prospects in 2028 presidential polls. Trump may not care, because he can't run again. But other Republican hopefuls like Vance and Rubio do. If Democrats score big in the midterms, and Trump remains adamant, perhaps it will be time for GOP to stand up to the MAGA chief, and rein in his war-making.

Very Fat Chances

As GLP-1 drugs recast the world in their image, canny investors can hatch new grow-rich schemes

Globally, one in every eight persons is obese, and what wouldn't they do to change that! On current evidence, many of them – either rich or covered by healthcare in rich countries, and many well-off Indians – are turning to GLP-1 drugs, better known by brand names like Ozempic and Wegovy. In US, about 10mn adults used these drugs last year; JP Morgan expects the number of American users to cross 30mn by 2030. And Pfizer estimates the market for obesity drugs at $150bn by then. If you're an investor, that's a solid opportunity, and not the only one, because GLP-1 drugs are affecting the market for everything in unforeseen ways.

Take food, for example. GLP-1 users are likely to be calorie-conscious, at least while they're on these drugs. Don't expect them to dig into chocolate brownies then. Instead, there's a whole new snack market shaping up, loaded with protein, fibre and vitamins. But fortified snacks aren't enough, so the $74bn US supplements market is also growing rapidly. What's not doing so well is the pub business. Heineken's sounded a warning about a likely dip in beer sales, because GLP-1s kill appetite, make users nauseous, and put them off multi-pint binges. So, pubs are thinking of new strategies to remain profitable.

Losing many kilos also affects people's wardrobes. Since buying new clothes every week is expensive, anyone in the alteration business – tailors and cobblers – is doing well. Meanwhile, demand for new clothes is bound to multiply, as people buy them on hitting their lowest weight, while under GLP-1s, and again after putting on weight a year after stopping them – gaining 60% of the lost weight, on average. Profits are better if you're in the business of fixing sagging faces, the so-called "Ozempic face" caused by rapid weight loss. Cosmetics firms are rushing to launch injectable fillers and collagen treatments, another multi-billion-dollar line of business. Plus, they're concocting new scents, because when people can't have their fill of food, research shows they're likely to compensate with foody scents. So, expect more cocoa, coffee cake, and toffee apple in the air. An economist might call these positive externalities. An investor would grab them.

Buy-buy. Bye-bye

When today's purchase becomes tomorrow's unwanted white elephant

Jug Suraiya

With the festive season in full swing, media are chock-a-block with ads urging us to buy everything from TV sets and fridges to holidays in exotic places.

The buy-buy season is good for media that make a lot of ad revenue. It's also good for the economy as a whole as every rupee you spend turns into income for someone else, from shopkeeper to producer.

But buy-buy booms, which are not of a festive nature, come with drawbacks, three of which are sitting in my home in the form of air purifiers. Bunny and I bought them several years ago when air pollution, particularly in winter, made daily headlines, superseding minor news items like earthquakes, economic upheavals, and armed conflict. Like many others, we bought air purifiers, contraptions – which every now and then, more now than then, would flash a warning sign of FO, which wasn't a rude injunction to buzz off, but meant Filter Out for cleaning – that supposedly purified the air in the vicinity of the devices, leaving unanswered the question as to what happened to our lungs when we went out or even to the loo, which didn't have such gadgets.

second*opinion*

Then came Covid, and the air purifiers were forgotten in the new panic attack brought about by the virus, which resulted in a pandemic of purchasing. Like millions of others, we bought face masks, oximeters that read oxygen levels in our bodies, and an ultra-violet box into which anything coming into the house had to be sanitised by ultra-violet rays.

No one thought that while the ultra-violet did a great job of killing viruses *inside* the box, the *outside* of the box remained an unsanitised Noah's Ark for any number of stowaway pathogens.

Then, as suddenly as it had sprung on us, the Covid scare ended. The oximeters were consigned to a forgotten drawer. The raddiwala was prevailed upon by bribery to take away the UV box. So by all means go on a buy-buy junket. But don't be surprised if, later, it becomes a bye-bye junk it.

River, Dam & Protest: Be Smart

Disquiet in Arunachal over a hydel project must be handled with care. Genuine concerns have to be separated from shady outfits, looking to sabotage India's strategic, energy & water security imperatives

Uttam Sinha

The importance of sensitively handling the ongoing unrest in Arunachal, against the building of Menga Dam, a 1,600MW Subansiri Upper Hydel Project (SUHP) cannot be overemphasised. What can also be not overemphasised is the dual imperative, strategic and environmental, of SUHP, and the 11,200MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP).

The non-negotiable strategic point is that India's planned dams in Arunachal are vital to build the infra capacity required to meet China's massive upstream activity – its 60GW hydel project at the Great Bend, near India's border, for one. This project, the world's largest in history, is not a single dam, but five cascade hydropower stations.

The environmental impact lies in Arunachal's role as the country's hydel powerhouse, to propel India's transition towards renewable energy, which heavily rests on hydropower, its water storage goals, and meeting carbon neutral status by 2070.

Significantly, while China commands an upstream advantage, its leverage is not absolute. Brahmaputra gains most of its volume only after it enters India. Tibet contributes a mere 14% of the river's total annual flow. A staggering 86% is generated within India, by intense monsoon rains, mostly, and a network of torrential tributaries in Arunachal and Assam. This hydrological asymmetry gives India a quiet but crucial edge. And its strategy, therefore, is backed by science – a unified approach that integrates multiple elements such as water storage, embankments, flood diversion, and inland navigation.

China's under-construction 60GW mega dam was flagged by CM Pema Khandu as an existential threat to his state's tribes and livelihoods. What China's multiple dam projects across Tibet's great rivers do is enable a one-sided manipulation of river discharge, increasing manifold the risk of sudden inundation – triggering flash floods – or dry-season water scarcity downstream. India has to, naturally, develop comparable capacity, in anticipation of such risks. A reservoir can reduce flood intensity and facilitate flow augmentation.

Arunachal's dams can also expand India's bargaining power in hydro-diplomacy, especially since Beijing is not party to any water-sharing treaty on Brahmaputra. Additionally, Beijing's limited data-sharing, only during flood season, amounts to tokenism. There are no round-the-year or real-time updates. Take the dry months, for instance. While India may have plenty of water on its side, it is during the lean season that water from China becomes crucial, however small in percentage. Upstream water matters during dry months, when every contribution becomes more significant. Therefore, having a multipurpose dam with storage, like SUMP, is critical. Upshot is that even if Beijing calls its projects run-of-the-river schemes, the cumulative impact of cascade dams, throughout the year, remains unpredictable. Thus, India must shore up its counter.

The protests that turned violent in various places, over the weekend, have to be taken in all seriousness. Grievances on the ground, such as the issue of displacement, are genuine concerns, and have to be revisited in a transparent and collaborative manner. Khandu has done well to indicate as much. For, per govt, many of the issues, such as displacement, for instance, have been discussed with various local representatives.

However, what is not in doubt either is that there is definite intelligence and evidence of a certain level of instigation, and attempted sabotage. There is sufficient reason to believe there are also propped-up actors, among the dissenters, interested in stalling the projects. Which is why GOI and state govt need to handle the protests on ground with kid gloves.

The primary objective has to be to separate genuine tribal grievances from external political manipulation. Identify, corral and separate the instigators, or outfits and so-called leaders reportedly working under external influence, from genuinely worried local communities. Reportedly, a farmers' forum has estimated that 27 villages may be impacted, and about 1.5L people displaced. There are also concerns over potential loss of heritage sites such as Kekar Monying.

Authentic concerns have to be addressed holistically. For this, transparency is critical. It is all too easy to aggravate communities, some among whom may be vulnerable to outside forces. So, while the state must counter external instigation, it should also keep alive communication with local leaders and communities. On that, a much greater degree of communication is required by govts to spell out the advantages of the projects. It is equally essential to highlight the dangers of 'Chinese whispers', which can only be countered by clear and constant dialogue. Locals must be assured that dam projects being planned have been scientifically assessed.

Downstream defences can be robust once social and ecological disputes are settled amicably. Strategically, India cannot lose prior appropriation advantage – the age-old doctrine of first in time, first in right. The country that first establishes beneficial utilisation of a river gains legal leverage. India thus cannot afford to delay its projects.

For timely project implementation, after all due processes, New Delhi's goal must be to be mindful of local concerns. It cannot afford to meet its environmental or national security needs with a disillusioned border population. Any infra project, carried out transparently and equitably, brings border stability with roads, communications, and a more expansive civilian and economic footprint. National interest projects must include people's cooperation, the optimal way to blunt Beijing's opacity, and unpredictability.

The writer is a senior fellow at Manohar Parrikar IDSA

Lula & The Beautiful Game Of A Few Brazil Footballers

Many stars, Ronaldinho & Neymar among them, opted for far-right. But some, like Barcelona's Raphinha, and many fans, went left, in footsteps of soccer legend Socrates

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Sections of the internet are saying Raphinha sacrificed a Clasico (Barcelona vs Real Madrid) so that Lula could win elections in Brazil. The Barcelona captain could pick only one of two fights – he chose the larger picture.

Much as that is unfair to Real Madrid's terrific choke-hold ways, we also know that's not true. What is true is that Raphinha was the lone Brazilian national footballer who had openly backed Lula, pitted against far-right Flavio Bolsonaro.

Equally telling, while the rest of Raphinha's Selecao teammates feigned neutrality, the Canarinhas, Brazil's women footballers, led by Ary Borges, were publicly endorsing Lula's progressive causes. Lula had trailed Bolsonaro into the final round. If anything, the dramatic final verdict told you that had their national teams been as robust as their EVMs, Brazil would still be something of a force at World Cups.

So, is Brazilian football, like they once did with the game, showing the world a way?

Brazilian election laws, and internal club statutes, prohibit football clubs as legal entities from taking political stances. But, football fan clubs are as vibrant as the samba schools – and as organised. As the far-right took seemingly unbeatable early cycle leads, club fan groups mobilised in a last-ditch push for Lula. Social media posts show fans of Palmeiras – a club identified as far-right – coming out in droves to campaign for Lula.

Yet, this election divided Brazilian sport, especially football, right down the middle.

In 2014, when World Cup came to Brazil, the young protested. Jobs, healthcare, housing, and education demanded more attention than organising a football tournament. Football was what the world sought from Brazil. But, Brazil had moved on. At the Brazil World Cup, predominantly white elite spectators filled stands.

This was the class who could afford expensive tickets, and were happy to wear their political affiliations on their chests. In yellow tees that screamed "Fora, Dilma!" (Dilma Out!) Brazil's wealthy were vocal in their opposition to the incumbent president, Dilma Rousseff, a Lula protege.

This, even as their fabled national team crashed to the most humiliating moment in its romanticised history – a 7-1 hammering that could have been worse had the Germans not relented.

Today, the team continues to flounder, while many footballers, having seen social mobility from favelas to global riches, no longer make secret of their fondness for far-right regime aspirants.

"If you follow Bolsonaro, don't follow me." Juninho Pernambucano, mid-2000s Olympique Lyon mainstay, and football's greatest but least-known freekick genius, was clear. "I get sick when I see right-wing Brazilian footballers supporting fascists. They forget that they used to be poor and they deny their origins."

Juninho may just have been talking about his former teammates. Rivaldo, Thiago Silva, Felipe Melo, Dani Alves, and Neymar, who memorably was once called a 'work from home' footballer.

This is why Raphinha is unique. He hails from a poor favela in Porto Alegre, the gateway to Brazil's rich agricultural south. A more illustrious son from Porto Alegre goes by the name of Ronaldinho. Son of a modest samba performer, as a kid Raphinha is said to have even performed once at Ronaldinho's birthday party. Brazil and Barcelona connect them. But, this is where the similarity ends. Because Ronaldinho was completing Bolsonaro's line-up by being Brazil's brightest jewel to throw his weight behind the far-right candidate.

"A soccer player has to have culture," Rai told a local TV channel in 1992, a time Brazilian society was in churn as it came to grips with new-found democracy. A Sao Paulo legend and a tireless votary against Bolsonaro's ideology, Rai is the younger brother of the late, great Socrates, that almost mythical figure in Brazilian football. With his Christ-like looks, faraway eyes, bohemian ways, and left leanings, Socrates was Che Guevara in football boots. His 1982 vintage delivered the last romantic idea of Brazil-ness to the world.

Rebel, philosopher, medical doctor, political thinker, and occasional footballer with a delectable back-heel, Socrates was briefly exhumed on Monday. Images of him, and his old friend, Lula, found new life. Brazil's football captain and the trade union leader had marched together as political allies at a rally of 2mn people in Sao Paulo, demanding a direct presidential election. It was 1984. The military dictatorship would end a year later.

That was the peak of 'Democracia Corinthiana', a unique form of socialism and equality devised by Socrates in the time of dictatorship in Brazil. "It was a tiny democracy within the larger scope of the dictatorship," Walter Casagrande, a Socrates disciple and Mexico World Cup teammate, told **TOI** in 2014. "We simply voted for everything. Everyone had a vote – right from the craque (star) to the kitman – and we practically ran the team."

"We used to play very well, and Corinthians is a big team here in Brazil. As a result, a lot of people began hearing of our ideas, and started to follow us."

Brazil's World Cup legacy – much older than their current run of modern democracy – was at its brightest when the military dictatorship was at its most brutal. What does that mean? This: as some Brazilian footballers are showing, you can always choose the larger picture.

Calvin & Hobbes

Sacred*space*

An intellectual? Yes. And never deny it. An intellectual is someone whose mind watches itself. I like this, because i am happy to be both halves, the watcher and watched. 'Can they be brought together?' This is a practical question.

Albert Camus

What Is The Highest Form Of Intelligence?

Narayani Ganesh

We are familiar with IQ, that measures cognitive intelligence and EQ, that refers to Emotional Intelligence. Spiritual Intelligence (SI) is another term for one's spiritual quotient or SQ, an attempt to gauge the capacity of an individual to deal with existential questions – how well she can grasp the meaning and purpose of life, of the role of humans as intelligent beings in the evolution of species, and how well one is able to rise above and beyond the mundane, transcending material challenges and deal with spiritual questions.

SI is perhaps the highest form of intelligence, one that perceives a reality that is free of all divisions and negativities, that reveals the oneness of all beings in an interconnected world that thrives on inter-being. SI enables one to celebrate life with all its goodness and drawbacks, without getting drawn into prejudices that lead to rigidity and hatred.

Says Prof Tushar Kant Mishra, of the Centre for Ethics and Values and School of Happiness, Delhi University, "Spiritual Intelligence works best in equanimity, not in animosity. It offers a way to address religious conflict through understanding and negotiation rather than elimination… especially where the coexistence of multiple faiths necessitates a profound sense of mutual respect and constructive collaboration." SI equips people to find meaning, fulfilment, and a sense of belonging, while upholding the dignity and freedom of religious traditions.

THE SPEAKING TREE

Arundyuti Das Basu

The person with SI will show signs of self-awareness, integrity, compassion, empathy, a sense of purpose, the ability to look at problems with a wider perspective, and show signs of resilience, tolerance and understanding, and will not buckle under stress. How does one cultivate all these qualities and attributes that contribute to increasing one's SI?

Awareness, meaning, evaluation, being centred, vision, projection and mission, are the seven steps to SI, says Richard Bowell. Krishn in Gita, 3:43, says to Arjun, that one should steady the mind with deliberate spiritual intelligence by realising the fleeting nature of the material world and transcending it. It is all about knowing the mind and letting it work in positive ways and not get overtaken by it.

SI is about direct, intuitive insight gained through practices like meditation rather than spending time only on intellectual analysis. Spiritual tools like meditation are focused on helping the practitioner move beyond the ego to become more aware of the larger picture where there is no separation between subject and object. The whole idea is to be alive to the present moment while being detached and observant. This is called Sakshi Bhav.

SI is all about focusing on Atmajnan, Self-knowledge, and the fact that the individual spirit is part of the infinite Brahmn or universal consciousness. Upanishads, too, talk of experiential wisdom that helps overcome suffering; that is, lived pursuit of truth is better than mere intellectual talk. Although the focus is on higher knowledge, this knowledge is rooted in practical wisdom that can lead to Self-realisation.

We tend to think intelligence is in our brain, that's it. But, there is a much bigger intelligence out there, what Sri Sri Ravi Shankar calls universal intelligence, and we individuals are just little reflections of that super intelligence. By cultivating SI, the individual can come to realise this and act in a way that promotes universal oneness, love, peace and harmony.

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On antibiotics? Sugary foods may make things worse for your gut

Pills damage the microbiome and sugar only disrupts it further, slowing down healing, shows new study

Eshan.Kalyanikar@timesofindia.com

"A spoonful of sugar helps the medicine go down."

As a metaphor, this 'Mary Poppins' song works wonderfully. But taken literally, it might do you more harm than good. The comfort food people crave when they are unwell and on medicines could actually make them sicker if it's high on sugar. A new study by researchers from New York, published in the journal Nature last month, has found that sugar-rich foods can only further disrupt an already fragile gut microbiome during antibiotic treatment.

"It's no surprise," says gastroenterologist Dr Vishal Seth from Pune. "Antibiotics are major disruptors themselves. They affect every bacteria living in the gut, whether good or bad. Adding sugar to the mix, especially through sugary drinks, sweets, and ultra-processed foods, can worsen the imbalance, leading to a rocky recovery from diarrhoea, bloating or abdominal discomfort."

Drop in diversity

The new study made the most of a natural experiment: it looked at meals of hospitalised cancer patients prior to stem cell transplants to determine the relationship between diet, antibiotics and the gut microbiome. The research was led by scientists from New York's Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center and NYU's Langone Health, along with City of Hope Cancer Center in Los Angeles.

They tracked 9,419 meals consumed by 173 patients. What they found was that for every 100g increase in sugary foods consumed while on broad-spectrum antibiotics, there was a 24% drop in gut microbiome diversity. "We sliced and diced the data in different ways," study author Dr Jonathan Peled, who is also physician scientist at Memorial Sloan Kettering, told CNN. "The theme that kept popping up was that the more sugary foods you eat (with particularly noxious effects from added sugars), it seemed to synergise with antibiotics to damage the microbiome," he added.

This finding is particularly relevant for India, where added sugar is an integral part of everyday eating and festivals, stresses gastroenterologist Dr Amit Gharat from Apollo Hospitals Navi Mumbai. "Multiple cups of sweetened chai, biscuits, rusks, packaged fruit juices, soft drinks and sweets can collectively contribute to sugar intake, sometimes without people being particularly conscious of it. During illness, patients may also gravitate towards sweetened beverages and foods for comfort," he says, adding that it's a useful reminder that diet also matters when we are taking medication.

Higher consumption of sweets and sugary foods has been linked to an increase in Enterococcus, a bacterium that can cause serious infections in vulnerable patients, points out Dr Gharat, adding, "While the study's findings cannot yet be directly applied to everyone taking a routine course of antibiotics, they highlight an important relationship between diet and gut health that deserves further investigation."

> Antibiotics already suppress good bacteria growth. When combined with a substance (sugar) that promotes bad bacteria, it naturally creates a problem. This is why we advise patients, especially those with gut conditions, to limit sugar while on these drugs
> **Dr BS Ramakrishna,** GASTROENTEROLOGIST

How sugar feeds gut bugs

The gut is home to trillions of microorganisms, including bacteria and viruses: some beneficial, others harmful. Microbial diversity and how these organisms interact with each other determine one's overall digestion and immune function.

Dr BS Ramakrishna, former editor in chief of Indian Journal of Gastroenterology who has spent decades studying the gut microbiome, explains that while there is no single answer, there is a clear indication of how sugar interacts with antibiotics in the gut.

"While simple sugars are rapidly absorbed in the upper intestine under normal conditions, excess sugar passes down to the lower intestine and promotes the overgrowth of specific bacterial strains that disrupt gut balance. This impacts overall gut metabolism. Antibiotics already suppress the growth of good bacteria. When combined with a substance that encourages bad bacteria, it naturally creates a problem. This is why we advise patients, especially those with underlying gut conditions, to limit sugar while on these drugs," says the Chennai-based gastroenterologist.

Sugar not good for gut anyway

It's simple logic: excess sugar creates an unfavourable environment for gut healing. "For us, it doesn't make a major difference whether the patient is on antibiotics or not. The negative impact of sugar is similar, but the medicine aggravates it," shares gastroenterologist Dr Harish KC from Bangalore.

Doctors agree that while combining sugar with antibiotics is not life-threatening for most patients, the complete clinical picture is still not clear. "The recovery period could be prolonged; we have some observational understanding for it. But controlled studies are needed to determine the exact quantities that cause impact, the extent of the damage, and which patients are most vulnerable," adds Dr Harish.

Dr Gharat calls for clear medical advice while prescribing an antibiotics course that emphasises on maintaining adequate nutrition, staying hydrated and limiting excessive added sugars. "Choosing whole fruits over packaged juices and including fibre-rich foods such as dals, legumes and vegetables, as tolerated, are sensible steps. This does not mean avoiding carbs or compromising on calorie and protein intake when one is already unwell," he says.

WHAT TO EAT WHEN ON ANTIBIOTICS

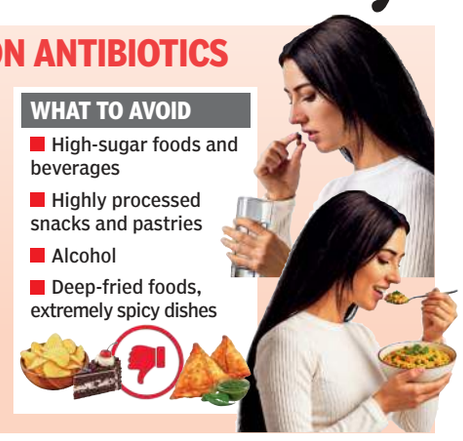
■ **Probiotics:** Fresh curd, plain yogurt, buttermilk. Fermented foods like idli, dosa

■ **Fibre:** Cooked vegetables (carrots, spinach, gourd, pumpkin), dal, whole grains like oats, brown rice, millets, fruits like banana, apple, papaya

■ **Comfort foods:** Khichdi, rice with light dal, vegetable or bone broths, steamed or boiled veggies

WHAT TO AVOID

■ High-sugar foods and beverages
■ Highly processed snacks and pastries
■ Alcohol
■ Deep-fried foods, extremely spicy dishes



KNOW YOUR VITAL STATS

Factors beyond food that cause sugar spikes

Our blood glucose naturally rises after meals, but food isn't the only reason it does. Sleep, stress and dehydration can also affect sugar levels. Here's how balanced habits can help, even if you don't have diabetes

Other triggers

■ **Exercise:** Adrenaline released during high-intensity exercise signals liver to pump more sugar into blood to give more fuel to muscles, causing a temporary spike

■ **Dehydration:** Less water in the body can concentrate sugar levels in blood

■ **Poor sleep:** Just one short night can reduce how efficiently the body uses insulin

■ **Skipping breakfast:** It can lead to an increased glucose response after lunch and dinner

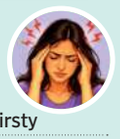
■ **Time of day:** Blood sugar may get harder to manage in the latter part of the day

■ **Sunburn:** Pain, physical stress can push glucose levels up

■ **Gum disease:** Can worsen blood sugar control; diabetes also raises gum disease risk

> **Every glucose spike isn't harmful. Our blood sugar level normally peaks around an hour after eating and tends to return to baseline within the next two hours. If a spike is brief in someone with normal metabolism, it's fine**
> **Adrian Brown,** ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR, NUTRITION AND DIETETICS, UNIVERSITY COLLEGE LONDON

What are the signs of a sugar spike?



■ You feel more thirsty
■ You need to urinate more often
■ You get a nagging headache
■ There's a short burst of energy, and then a 'crash' of fatigue

How to get fewer spikes

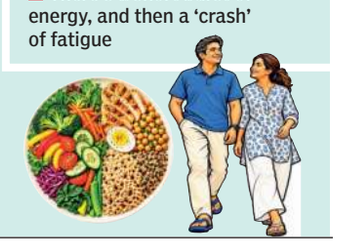
1 **Balanced plate:** 1/2 fibre-rich, non-starchy vegetables, ¼ protein, ¼ whole grains or other complex carbs

2 **Paired snacks:** Fruit with plain yoghurt, apple with unsweetened peanut butter

3 **Regular meals:** Aim for a consistent, balanced eating habit

4 **Movement:** Even a five-minute walk after meals can help moderate the glucose rise

Sources: UCLA Health, CDC, BBC



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SPOTLIGHT

Making Women's Cancer Care Exclusive and Comfortable

Women's health concerns, particularly those related to breast and gynaecological cancers, can often be difficult to discuss openly. Concerns about privacy, discomfort during examinations and anxiety around a possible diagnosis may prevent some women from seeking timely medical advice. This makes it important to create healthcare environments where women feel comfortable discussing their concerns, understanding their health risks and making informed decisions about their care.

Early detection and timely medical evaluation play an important role in the management of several cancers. However, access to appropriate screening and specialist care is only one part of the journey. Emotional reassurance, sensitive communication and the confidence to ask questions can also influence how women navigate diagnosis and treatment.

A WOMEN-CENTRED APPROACH TO CANCER CARE

Recognising these needs, Manipal Hospital Kanakapura Road has introduced Specialised Oncology for Women, Mindfully with You, Always (SOWMYA). Built around the philosophy of 'For Women, By Women', the initiative aims to provide a more comfortable and coordinated approach to women's cancer care, with an emphasis on privacy, dignity and personalised attention.

The programme brings together an all-female-led care approach to support women through consultations, screening, diagnosis, treatment and follow-up. By creating an environment where women can discuss intimate health concerns with greater confidence, SOWMYA seeks to address some of the barriers that may otherwise delay healthcare-seeking.

"Women need to feel comfortable and confident when discussing their health, particularly when it comes to breast and gynaecological concerns. Privacy, trust and compassionate communication can make a meaningful difference in helping them seek timely medical advice. Through SOWMYA, our aim is to create a supportive environment where women feel heard, understood and guided through every stage of their cancer care journey," says **Dr Monika Pansari, consultant, Breast and Gynaecology Onco-surgery (Surgical Oncology) and Robotic Surgery, Manipal Hospital Kanakapura Road.**

FROM SCREENING TO CONTINUED CARE

SOWMYA emphasises the importance of recognising potential health concerns early and seeking appropriate medical evaluation. Through women's cancer screening packages and access to relevant specialist consultations and diagnostic services, the initiative encourages a proactive approach to breast and gynaecological health. Screening recommendations and further investigations are guided by individual risk factors, age, symptoms and clinical assessment.

An important component of the initiative is Her Health Passport: My Breast Health Journey, a personalised breast-health programme designed to help women maintain relevant screening information, follow-up schedules and preventive health guidance. By supporting continuity of care, the programme encourages women to remain engaged with their breast health beyond an individual consultation or screening appointment.

For women who require further evaluation or treatment, access to coordinated oncology services can help them navigate the next steps of their care. This may include diagnostic investigations, surgery, systemic treatment, radiation therapy and follow-up, depending on the diagnosis and individual treatment plan.

CARE THAT GOES BEYOND THE DIAGNOSIS

A cancer diagnosis can bring uncertainty not only for the woman but also for her family. Understanding treatment options, preparing for procedures and managing the emotional demands of recovery can make the journey challenging. Clear communication, compassionate support and appropriate follow-up are therefore important alongside clinical care.

Through SOWMYA, these elements come together within a women-centred care pathway. The initiative reinforces the importance of seeking medical advice without hesitation, staying informed about screening recommendations and consulting qualified specialists when symptoms or concerns arise.

Ultimately, making women's cancer care more accessible also means making it easier for women to speak up, seek answers and receive care with dignity. By combining specialised oncology care with personalised support, SOWMYA aims to help women navigate their health journey with greater confidence, from preventive screening to diagnosis, treatment and follow-up.

Scanning the MAI leads to an advisory or a guidance related support rather than actual diagnosis or medical advice.

Scan for MAI, your 24x7 digital doctor on WhatsApp. Voice and Chat Enabled +91 6366 559 370

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TIMES SPORT

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026

ANAHAT SINGH ADVANCES TO QUARTERS IN CANADIAN WOMEN'S SQUASH OPEN

HARMANPREET KAUR MOVES UP TO EIGHTH IN ICC WOMEN'S ODI RANKINGS FOR BATTERS

Abhishek Sharma's 38-Ball 113 Powers India To Series-Clinching Win Against Kiwis In Wellington; Sooryavanshi Chips In With 19-Ball 45

OPENING OVERLORD

Getty Images

DOMINATOR: Abhishek Sharma celebrates his century on Tuesday

Rajesh.Pansare
@timesofindia.com

When Abhishek Sharma gets going, very few bowlers in the world can stop him. Tuesday in Wellington was one of those nights, with New Zealand's attack having no answers.

The Black Caps tried everything: short balls, yorkers, wide lines, slower deliveries and cutters. Nothing worked. Wherever they bowled, Abhishek found a way to send the ball to the boundary or clear it.

The contrasting Powerplays set the tone for the result. While Bhuvneshwar Kumar and Arshdeep Singh kept New Zealand's openers on a tight leash, India's batters blew the game apart, racing to a world-record 118 runs in the first six overs.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, promoted to open, showed no nerves or inhibition. He struck a boundary off Jacob Duffy early in the opening over, while Abhishek cleared the rope in the same 26-run over. Sooryavanshi went on to smash 45 off just 19 balls, with four fours and four sixes. Alongside Abhishek, he added 133 in only 43 balls for the opening wicket, effectively ending the contest.

Abhishek, who had struggled for rhythm during his 27 off 21 balls in the previous game, looked a completely different batter in Wellington. He launched Duffy over cover for six early on and never eased off thereafter.

With every towering hit, New Zealand's shoulders drooped further. Their frustration was evident as fielders could only watch, smile ruefully and return to their marks after yet another boundary.

What stood out was the quality and purity of Abhishek's strokeplay. This was not blind aggression or slogging. Full deliveries were carved through the off side, while anything short or on the pads disappeared through square leg and midwicket. Fully aware of the shorter square boundaries, he exploited them ruthlessly, scoring 92 runs in those areas.

Often criticised for a perceived weakness against deliveries square on the leg side, Abhishek has clearly worked on that aspect of his game. Of those 92 runs scored square of the wicket, 52 came on the leg side. The improvement was impossible to miss.

With India cruising at 64 in just three overs, New Zealand turned to off-spinner Michael Bracewell. Abhishek had occasionally been troubled by that match-up in the past, but this time he greeted Bracewell with two boundaries and a six, underlining his dominance.

Earlier, India's bowlers did just enough to keep New Zealand below the 200 mark. Bhuvneshwar (0/40) and Arshdeep (1/33) set the tone by conceding only six runs in the first two overs, but a 43-ball, 86-run stand between Finn Allen (40 off 25) and Daryl Mitchell (89 off 52) threatened to tilt the game in the hosts' favour. Nitish Kumar Reddy (1/38) provided the breakthrough, having Allen caught at long-on by Naman Dhir, who made a superb diving effort.

Axar Patel (1/36) then removed the dangerous Glenn Phillips (17). Although Mitchell and Bevon Jacobs (39 off 23) added 75-run for the fourth wicket, India kept them from fully cashing in at the death. New Zealand managed more than 10 runs in only one of the final five overs.

HIGHEST RUN-RATE FOR AN OPENING STAND OF 100+ IN T20Is (ICC FULL-MEMBER TEAMS)

Run Rate	Runs	Balls	Pair
18.55	133	43	**Abhishek Sharma/V Sooryavanshi** (Ind vs NZ, Wellington, Oct 27, 2026)
15	125	50	Jos Buttler/Phil Salt (Eng vs SA, Manchester, Sept 12, 2025)
15	145	58	BJ Bennett/T Marumani (Zimb vs Seychelles, Nairobi, Oct 19, 2024)

SCOREBOARD

New Zealand: T Seifert c Axar b Arshdeep 2, F Allen c Dhir b Reddy 40, D Mitchell not out 89, G Phillips c & b Patel 17, B Jacobs not out 39, **Extras: (lb7, w4) 11; Total: (3 wkts) 198; FoW:** 1-4, 2-90, 3-123; **Bowling:** Bhuvneshwar 4-0-40-0, Arshdeep 4-0-33-1, Prince 4-0-44-0, Axar 4-0-36-1, Reddy 4-0-38-1.

India: V Sooryavanshi c Mitchell b Fisher 45, A Sharma c Phillips b Jamieson 113, S Samson b Jamieson 18, S Iyer c Phillips b Santner 5, T Varma not out 1, N Dhir not out 4; **Extras: (lb1, nb2, w10) 13; Total: (4 wkts, 13.2 overs) 199; FoW:** 1-133, 2-178, 3-193, 4-195; **Bowling:** Duffy 2-0-44-0, Milne 2-0-33-0, Bracewell 2-0-36-0, Jamieson 3.2-0-45-2, Fisher 1-0-23-1, Santner 3-0-17-1.

Result: **India won by 6 wkts (with 40 balls remaining)**

Player of the Match: **Abhishek Sharma**

6 India have recorded their sixth bilateral series win in succession vs New Zealand in T20Is since 2020.

118/0 India's runs in the Powerplay (overs 1-6), a world record in T20Is, bettering Romania's 116/0 off 5.4 overs during the course of a 10-wicket win vs Serbia on June 26, 2021.

7.4 Overs taken by India to race to 150, the least to the landmark ever in all T20s, bettering the 8.2 overs taken by Sunrisers Hyderabad vs Lucknow Super Giants on May 8, 2024.

—**Stats:** Rajesh Kumar

"AS A BATTER, WE DON'T GO FOR MILESTONES. WE ALWAYS WANT TO WIN THE GAME FOR THE TEAM. SO THAT WAS THE PLAN. IT WENT WELL. I DON'T KNOW WHAT CRICKET HE (YUVRAJ) WAS PLAYING AT THE TIME. IT'S NOT THAT EASY AT ALL!"
— **Abhishek Sharma,** reacting to mentor Yuvraj Singh's jibe that he 'still couldn't get a fifty off 12 balls'

"A very special innings from Abhishek. Some of that hitting was world-class. That's why he is the best in the world at what he does. You can just tip your hat to that one."
—**Daryl Mitchell** marvels at Abhishek's innings

113 Abhishek Sharma has set an Indian record for the highest individual innings vs New Zealand in New Zealand in T20Is, bettering Suryakumar Yadav's 111* in Mount Maunganui on Nov 20, 2022.

4 Abhishek is now the fourth Indian batter to hit a hundred vs New Zealand in T20Is, joining Shubman Gill, Ishan Kishan and Suryakumar Yadav.

11 Sixes hit by Abhishek, the most by an Indian batter in a T20I innings vs New Zealand. Just one batter has hit more — 13 by Richard Levi during his 117* for SA in Hamilton on Feb 19, 2012.

4 T20I tons by Abhishek Sharma, making him the sixth batter to achieve the distinction after Rohit Sharma (5), Glenn Maxwell (5), Suryakumar Yadav (4) & Phil Salt (4).

11 Centuries by Abhishek in all T20s, the most by an Indian batter. He overtakes Virat Kohli's tally of 10. Just 2 batters have more — Chris Gayle (22) and Babar Azam (13).

Happy to return, but never chased it: Bhuvi

Rajesh.Pansare@timesofindia.com

BHUVNESHWAR

While the jury is still out on whether recalling Bhuvneshwar Kumar after a four-year break was the right call, and whether he should be considered for the 2027 ODI World Cup, the man himself is steering clear of that debate and focusing instead on enjoying his comeback.

The key to his return, Bhuvneshwar says, is that he "never chased it". And he intends to maintain that approach.

"It was always a dream and I'm happy to return. But I never chased it, so sitting out for four years didn't feel difficult because I was taking it one tournament at a time and focusing on challenges related to cricket and fitness. It never crossed my mind that I had to play to make a comeback. That thought process simplified things, and all credit goes to the last two IPL seasons because of which I'm here," Bhuvneshwar, who last played for India in 2022, said after India's on Tuesday.

He added that he will return to India after the T20I series to play in the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy and the Vijay Hazare Trophy, after which he will assess where he stands in terms of future opportunities.

Speaking about the match, Bhuvneshwar praised Abhishek Sharma and the manner in which he approached his innings. "He has been doing this for a couple of years now, so it's not the first time. Credit goes to Abhishek for batting like this. It wasn't easy out there. The way he batted and finished the game within the first six overs of a T20 innings takes a lot of skill, and Abhishek is doing it again and again," he said.

BCCI to back cricketers with disabilities: Saikia

Gaurav.Gupta@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: In a move to make cricket more inclusive, BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia has urged all 38 state associations to support differently-abled cricketers in their respective jurisdictions.

In a letter to the associations on Monday, titled 'Support differently-abled cricketers', Saikia wrote: "As deliberated and agreed during the 95th annual general meeting of the BCCI, held in Mumbai on Sept 18, 2026, all the member associations are requested to take appropriate measures towards the welfare, development and betterment of differently-abled cricketers within their respective jurisdictions."

He urged the associations to promote participation by providing players with "due encouragement, assistance and opportunities to grow in the game". A copy of the letter is with **TOI**.

Saikia said the associations' cooperation would help strengthen inclusivity and promote the development of differently-abled cricket across the country.

At its AGM, the BCCI had said the general body discussed measures with state units to support differently-abled cricketers, including providing appropriate facilities and resources for their development.

Ravi Chauhan, general secretary of the Differently Abled Cricket Council of India (DCCI), welcomed the move, saying the sport had been played in India for the past 40 years.

India 'A' denied by bad light

NABI

Lincoln: Pacer Auqib Nabi bowled an incisive opening spell with the new ball but bad light prevented India 'A' from recording a sensational come-from-behind win over New Zealand 'A' in the first unofficial 'test' which concluded in a draw here on Tuesday.

IND 'A' VS NZ 'A'

Chasing a target of 313 after India finished their second innings at 516, New Zealand 'A' batters found the swing and seam movement generated by Nabi (3/28 in 10 overs) too hot to handle.

The Indian rocked the home side's top-order with three quick wickets.

However, in cold and blustery conditions, the home side managed to escape with a draw despite being reduced to 187/9 as umpires stopped proceedings owing to fading light. Even though 17 overs were left in the day, the light didn't improve and the teams settled for a draw.

The players were in visible discomfort due to the chilly weather and KL Rahul, Yashasvi Jaiswal and Devdutt Padikkal were seen wearing beanies to protect their ears. The second unofficial 'A' 'test' will start on Oct 31 at the Hagley Oval in Christchurch.

Starting the day at 488 for 8, Akash Deep (25 off 17 balls) struck three mighty sixes to take the total past the 500-run mark and help India set a steep target for the hosts.

Nabi bowled three perfect in-cutters that sent back home skipper Rhys Mariu (2), Tim Robinson (0) and Matthew Boyle (4) to give the visitors the upper-hand.

Brief scores: India 'A' 113 and 516 (D Padikkal 199, S Sudharsan 91, Y Rathod 66, W Sundar 52; Gibson 3/80) drew with New Zealand 'A' 317 and 187/9 (C Heaphy 90*; Nabi 3/28, Padikkal 2/11). PTI

Mitchell Starc (4th from right) took 6/72

Oz mount thrilling fightback in decider

Cape Town: Mitchell Starc took four wickets in six balls to cap an Australian fightback on the first day of the third Test against South Africa at Newlands on Tuesday.

Starc finished with 6/72 as South Africa were bowled out for 329 shortly before the close in the Test-series decider.

South Africa started the day with a dominant batting display after Australian captain Pat Cummins sent them in. Marques Ackerman raced to 82 off 75 balls as he and Aiden Markram put on 140 for no wicket before lunch.

They took the stand to 158 before Ackerman charged down the pitch against Nathan Lyon and was stumped for 95, made off 94 balls with 12 fours and two sixes.

It was the start of an Australian fightback as six wickets fell for 74 runs in 25 overs.

Markram was caught at long leg off for 78 and Temba Bavuma was bowled for a duck before Starc dismissed David Bedingham (50) and Wiaan Mulder (0). Ryan Rickelton and Marco Jansen put on 95 for the seventh wicket before Australia took the second new ball shortly before the close.

Starc trapped Rickelton leg before wicket for 42 with his fourth delivery with the new ball, then bowled Jansen two balls later for 52. He wrapped up the innings by bowling Gerald Coetzee and having Kagiso Rabada leg before with the first and third balls of his next over.

Brief scores: South Africa 329 (Ackerman 95, A Markram 78, Jansen 52; Starc 6-72, Lyon 2-71) **vs Australia.** REUTERS

Sri Lanka end England hopes with big win over Pakistan

Lahore: Pace bowler Dilshan Madushanka grabbed a career best 5-34 as Sri Lanka cruised to a thumping eight-wicket win over Pakistan in Lahore on Tuesday, ending England's hopes of reaching the tri-series final.

The left-armer was well supported by spinner Sahan Arachchige, who took 2-24, to dismiss Pakistan for a paltry 110 in just 25.3 overs. The Sri Lankan batters reached the target in just 18.1 overs.

The victory is Sri Lanka's second in three games, enough to deprive the third team England of a spot in Sunday's final, for which Pakistan have already qualified with three wins.

The English, who have contrived to lose successive matches against Sri Lanka and Pakistan from winning positions, needed the hosts to win to have any hope of joining them in the final.

Consequently, Thursday's match between Sri Lanka and England is a dead rubber.

Brief scores: Pakistan 110 in 25.3 overs (Madushanka 5/34, Arachchige 2/24) **lost to Sri Lanka 114/2 in 18.2 overs** (K Mendis 62*) **by 8 wickets.**

Mandeep finds form as India hammer Bangladesh

HOCKEY

Instagram/Hockey India

JUBILANT: India opened their campaign with a big win

Jalandhar: Mandeep Singh returned to form with a fine hat-trick as five-time champions India hammered minnows Bangladesh 13-0 to start their title defence at the Asian Champions Trophy hockey tournament on a rousing note here on Tuesday.

Mandeep struck in the third, tenth and 54th minute, while skipper Harmanpreet Singh (2, 44), Dilpreet Singh (43, 44) and vice-captain Hardik Singh (60, 60) scored a brace each. Shilanand Lakra (15), Abhishek (18), Nilakanta Sharma (26) and Jugraj Singh (46) were the other Indian goal scorers in the lop-sided match at the Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium.

It was completely one-way traffic as play was mostly inside the Bangladesh half with India dominating the proceedings from the onset. India secured their first penalty corner from their first circle entry and Harmanpreet gave the hosts the lead with a powerful low flick in the second minute.

A minute later, Harmanpreet was again instrumental in India's second goal. The skipper's defence-splitting pass from the midfield was neatly picked up by Mandeep on the top of the circle and the striker then unleashed a fierce hit to double India's lead. India extended their lead in the 10th minute when Harmanpreet's long scoop found Abhishek inside the circle. Abhishek beautifully set it up for Mandeep to guide the ball into the net. Seconds from the first quarter, Shilanand made the scoreline 4-0 after a beautiful one-two with Sukhjeet Singh.

It trained goals for India as Abhishek was the next player to register his name in the scoresheet after a fine one-touch pass from Mandeep in the 18th minute.

Bangladesh goalkeeper Ashraful Shad made two brilliant saves to deny Nilakanta Sharma and Mandeep in the second quarter. Nilakanta then scored with a fine tomahawk from the top of the circle after being fed by Sukhjeet Singh and Abhishek in the 26th minute as India went into the half time break with a comfortable 6-0 lead. PTI

WPL AUCTION

FIVE FRANCHISES, 27 SLOTS, ₹8.15 CR UP FOR GRABS

Australia captain Sophie Molineux, 'keeper-batter G Kamalini and allrounder Sneh Rana will headline 146 players in the Women's Premier League (WPL) auction in Kochi on Wednesday. The 5 franchises will fill 27 slots with a total purse of ₹8.15 cr...

Kamalini on Mumbai's radar

Slots: 6 **Purse** | ₹0.9 cr

➤ Mumbai arrive with a settled nucleus. Their purse is limited. Kamalini is the name on their radar.

An overseas left-arm spinner for RCB

Slots: 5 **Purse** | ₹1.15 cr

➤ The defending champions have to shop smartly. They need 5 players, including 2 overseas, and have only Rs 1.15 cr. An overseas left-arm spinner is top priority.

UP has biggest purse

Slots: 8 **Purse** | ₹3.75 cr

➤ UP Warriorz enter with the largest purse and will prioritise batters who can deliver brisk starts.

Backup Indian pacer for Gujarat Giants

Slots: 3 **Purse** | ₹1.25 cr

➤ Gujarat Giants have retained 15 players, and like Mumbai, their core squad look settled. They will be looking at an experienced overseas batter and a backup pacer given Renuka Singh Thakur's frequent injury breakdowns.

DC need reserve keeper

Slots: 5 **Purse** | 1.10 cr

➤ Delhi Capitals have retained 13 players, 5 of them from overseas, leaving them with Rs 1.1 cr. They have Mamata Madiwala behind the stumps but with just 1 overseas slot available, they might scout for a reserve wicketkeeper.

Text: Vishal Menon

Kajal, Neelam script history, put India one step away from double gold

New Delhi: India's women's wrestling broke new ground on Tuesday, with Kajal Dhochak and Neelam Sirohi storming into the World Championships finals to become the first women from the nation to contest gold medals in the same edition of the tournament.

While Kajal will take on Ukraine's Anastasiya Alpyeyeva in the 76kg final, Neelam faces Japan's Yui Susaki in the 50kg title clash. Their double breakthrough surpasses Anshu Malik's impressive silver-winning run in 2021, when she became India's first woman to reach a Worlds final. Trailing 1-7 in the semifinals, Kajal, a two-time U20 world champion, mounted a stunning comeback to beat Kyrgyzstan's Aiperi Medet Kyzy 10-7. Neelam, 26, booked her place in the final with a commanding 7-3 victory over Kazakhstan's Zeinep Bayanova.

Meanwhile, Rajnita will fight for a bronze medal in the 65kg repechage against Japan's Nana Ikehata. TNN

HC halts BFI SGM called by suspended secretary

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New Delhi: The Punjab and Haryana high court on Tuesday put the Boxing Federation of India's (BFI) Special General Meeting (SGM), scheduled for Wednesday to consider a no-confidence motion against president Ajay Singh, in abeyance until Nov 13, forcing the rival faction to shelve its immediate challenge.

BOXING MESS

Justice Tribhuvan Dahiya issued interim order on Singh's petition challenging the Oct 8 notice convening the meeting. "The second respondent is directed to keep the general body meeting in abeyance till the next date of hearing," the court said.

The dispute escalated after Singh suspended secretary general Pramod Kumar, who subsequently challenged the president's authority. The rival faction questioned constitutional amendments adopted in Aug, while Singh's camp maintained they were valid. The order records Singh's contention that a SGM can be convened only by the president in accordance with the applicable BFI constitution, or upon a request from two-thirds of the executive committee (EC) members.

Respecting the order, the rival faction said the SGM would not be convened as its sole purpose was to consider the no-confidence motion. However, representatives of state units who have assembled in Delhi will meet to discuss their future course of action.

Sources in the faction said a caveat, a legal notice seeking an opportunity to be heard before an order is passed, was filed online but was not considered as court required physical filing.

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DP World PGTI chief Kapil Dev calls for golf to shed its 'elite' tag, saying the sport can offer career opportunities while helping people build relationships and friendships

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Far-right senator Flávio **Bolsonaro barred from leaving Brazil and ordered to surrender his passports** hours after losing the presidential election

Iran's Supreme Leader **Mojtaba Khamenei, unseen publicly since succeeding his slain father Ali Khamenei, met security chief Mohsen Rezaei** who recently held talks with a delegation from Saudi, Turkey & Pakistan

Israelis **vote in their highest numbers for more than half a century in the country's first election since the Oct 2023 Hamas attack,** effectively a referendum on the war-dominated rule of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu

Kylian Mbappe apologises for comments in which he apparently referred to Mao Zedong, the founding leader of Communist China, as a dictator, after facing backlash and losing brand deals

DOUBLE DELIGHT

Today's issue of **TOI** is organised in two sections, both equally packed with news and analysis.
To get the full reading experience of today's edition, make sure you don't miss the other section

OTHER BOOK TOP STORIES

- **SC: Can't let pharma industry "run amok" over free market**
- **Two killed in enocunter in West Begal in a day**
- **SC entertains petition by Digital News Publishers Assn**

Bar non-Hindus who don't believe from temples: HC

Not Applicable To Ayyappa, Sai Baba Shrines

K.Kaushik@timesofindia.com

Madurai: Anyone who isn't a Hindu is barred beyond the flagpole of an Agamic Hindu temple unless the person gives a written undertaking "affirming reverence for the deity", Madras high court has ruled on a PIL seeking stringent enforcement of the Tamil Nadu Temple Entry Authorisation Act. The court clarified the order isn't applicable to shrines to Ayyappa and Shirdi Sai Baba that attract devotees across religions.

A division bench of Justices G R Swaminathan and P Murugan said Agamic temples, whose construction and rituals strictly adhere to the agamas (traditions) prescribed in ancient Hindu texts, were justified in taking steps to maintain the sanctity of the premises.

The bench said it was "ironical" that Badrudeen Mustafa, the TVK legislator from Madurai Central, entered Madurai's Meenakshi temple for an inspection and even climbed a gopuram (gateway tower). "We notice in recent times that there are egregious breaches... He (Mustafa) claimed that he had a right to inspect if proper amenities are being provided. The said MLA had proclaimed that Sanatan Dharma ought to be eradicated."

Referring to petitioner K Thangam Venkatesh, HC said he was "entitled" to insist that the trustees of various Agamic temples in Tamil Nadu uphold Agamic injunction.

▶Chamchagiri, P 14

IN THE COURTS

- Survivor tells Bombay HC in Goa that **rape trial would disrupt her studies and life,** prompting court to quash charges against a 23-year-old man | **P 10**
- **'Why should acid be sold in the open market?'** Concerned over incidents of acid attacks, mostly on women by men, **SC tells govt to consider regulating retail sale** | **P 10**
- Bombay HC's Nagpur bench upholds family court order directing a man to pay ₹7,000 **monthly maintenance to his unmarried adult daughter** | **P 10**
- Govt informs SC it is drafting **a bill to prevent child porn, revenge porn** on social media, morphing videos to ridicule or defame personalities | **P 10**
- Delhi **HC refuses to stay probe against YouTuber** for alleged casteist remarks against a cop she had accused of sexual harassment

UNSC reform: India bats for veto right for all

India has said that all permanent members of a reformed UN Security Council must have veto powers, not just the existing five. Speaking at the UNGA debate on the veto question, ambassador P Haish said a reform that expands the UNSC by creating another category of long-term members without the veto effectively makes them 'second-class' members. **Other bk, P 6**

We'll die rather than give up land: Siang villagers on dam

Locals Oppose Any Drilling In Riverbed

Kangkan.Kalita1 @timesofindia.com

Geku: The paddy must be harvested in Nov. The anti-dam protests must go on. John Panyang and hundreds of Adi farmers in Arunachal Pradesh's Siang basin strap a dao to the waist and head to the fields. But carrying this 2-foot-long machete has become a flashpoint, turning an everyday ritual into another front in the fight for ancestral land.

Security forces have seized daos from villagers in Riga and Pangkang, across the Siang from Geku, following an attack on personnel with one. The move, part of heightened security measures amid protests and violence targeting the proposed 11,200 MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project, has triggered anger among the Adi people.

Govt sources said NHPC wants to conduct drilling for the project's pre-feasibility report. Villagers oppose any drilling in the riverbed, insisting they do not want a feasibility report prepared at all. They fear the security crackdown is meant to muzzle resistance.

27 VILLAGES JOIN STIR

- 27 villages across Upper Siang and Siang districts have joined the agitation
- **Most of Geku residents depend on farming,** while only 10 to 15 govt staff live among nearly 1k households
- Locals reject compensation in exchange 'for losing our homeland' to the project. **'Where will we go and what will we eat,'** asks one

Army: Fake videos on Arunachal on socials

Indian Army has rubbished a series of videos on social media that falsely claimed that Chinese troops have taken control of some areas in Arunachal Pradesh, pointing out that these are misleading propaganda being spread by some mischievous elements. It debunked three videos on X. TNN

"We will not abandon our settlement. We would rather die here than surrender our land. If the Chinese dam is the threat, why should our govt build another mega dam in the Siang belt, nearly 300km from the Line of Actual Control? Govt should explore alternatives closer to the border to counter China's plans," Panyang said.

▶Kept farmers away, P 14

Driver speeds away during airport check, runs over cop's leg

The driver of a car with a temporary registration plate sped away during a check near IGI Airport's T3, crashing through barricades and running over a policeman's leg. The vehicle was being inspected for illegal parking when the driver accelerated. Search is on for the driver. Police have registered a case, under culpable homicide charge. TNN

Digi Yatra trials for int'l flights from KIA

KIA has begun trials of Digi Yatra for international departures on select IndiGo and AI flights, extending its facial recognition-based, contactless passenger processing system to international travel. **P 2**

Indore woman alleges gang rape

A 20-year-old Indore woman has alleged she was gang-raped and assaulted by two men in a car. Police have registered an FIR. The wife of an accused has filed a counter that it was a conspiracy by the man's rivals. TNN

13 of 17 inmates who broke out of TN jail nabbed

Less than 24 hours after 17 remand prisoners escaped from a sub-jail in Theni in the biggest jailbreak in Tamil Nadu in three decades, police captured 13 of them following an extensive manhunt involving personnel and drones. Four escapees were caught during an overnight search, while another was trapped and brought back to prison by an alert auto driver. The rest were nabbed after being traced to a forest near the prison with the help of drones.

▶9 suspended, Other bk, P 5

Gen med tops NEET-PG choices among first 100

New Delhi: General medicine accounted for more allotments than radiodiagnosis among top entries in the first round of NEET-PG 2026 counselling, highlighting the competing career attractions of the two sought-after PG specialties, **reports Anuja Jaiswal.**

An analysis of Medical Counselling Committee's Round 1 allotment list shows 51 allotments in general medicine as against 28 in radiodiagnosis among the first 100 entries. Dermatology was a distant third with six allotments, while paediatrics and general surgery had three each. Doctors say the choices reflect different career priorities. Radiology attracts candidates because of its good work-life balance.

▶Helps earn more, P 14

GOOD IN LONG RUN

- **Radiology** attracts candidates because they can earn well **early in their careers**
- **However, AI may automate parts of image interpretation,** raising questions about how a radiologist's role may evolve
- **General medicine remains an evergreen specialty and** earns more in the long run

Pjb 'defiant' in DA case, chief secy to pay ₹1L

Punjab and Haryana HC on Tuesday ordered Punjab chief secretary KAP Sinha to deposit costs of Rs 1 lakh for failing to file a compliance report in the DA case, observing the "defiant attitude" adopted by govt respondents regarding compliance with its orders couldn't be ignored. On Aug 3, a division bench had ordered release of pending DA and dearness relief within a fortnight. **P 5**

Kerala judge son case: 4 cops suspended

Four police officers have been suspended for alleged lapses in handling the Cheranelloor case, in which the 17-year-old son of an additional district judge mowed down a two-wheeler rider, Kerala home minister Ramesh Chennithala said Tuesday. He said he had reprimanded the DGP after learning that the FIR did not initially include the charge of culpable homicide. TNN

Cheetah Nirva's cub dies of gunshot injuries, a first

P.Naveen@timesofindia.com

Bhopal: A 19-month-old male cheetah cub whose birth at MP's Kuno National Park was celebrated as one of the early success stories of the 2022 project to reintroduce the species in India died early Monday of gunshot injuries after being rescued overnight from Morena with multiple pellets lodged in its gut.

The radio-collared cub, one of Namibia-born Nirva's offspring, is the first reported casualty of a shooting since PM Narendra Modi launched Project Cheetah at Kuno just over four years ago. Cheetahs had been declared extinct in India in 1952.

A patrol squad found the animal injured on Sunday while it was ranging in the Morena territorial forest division, bordering Sheopur. Morena has a ravine-dotted terrain and is notorious as the region's "arms capital". It wasn't immediately clear why the cub was shot, possibly from close range. The preliminary thesis is that the shooter fired in panic after a chance encounter, possibly mistaking the juvenile cheetah for a leopard.

▶Spl strike force, P 14

DKS assures Wadiyars on Dasara tradition

Bengaluru: Chief minister DK Shivakumar Tuesday struck a middle path in the war of words between his govt and erstwhile Mysuru royal family matriarch Pramoda Devi Wadiyar over Mysuru Dasara celebrations, suggesting that his cabinet was working within the confines of democracy while maintaining age-old traditions. Shivakumar said he would discuss the issues with Pramoda Devi. "Had there been any errors, we will rectify those. The Dasara festival is a state festival," he added. TNN

ಶ್ರೀ ಡಿ.ಕೆ. ಶಿವಕುಮಾರ್
ಸನ್ಮಾನ್ಯ ಮುಖ್ಯಮಂತ್ರಿಗಳು
ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸರ್ಕಾರ

ಸಮಾಜ ಕಲ್ಯಾಣ ಇಲಾಖೆ

ಡಾ. ಜಿ. ಪರಮೇಶ್ವರ
ಮಾನ್ಯ ಉಪ ಮುಖ್ಯಮಂತ್ರಿಗಳು
ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸರ್ಕಾರ

ಪರಿಶಿಷ್ಟ ಜಾತಿಯವರ ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿಗಾಗಿ
ಕಲ್ಯಾಣ ಯೋಜನೆಗಳು

2026-27ನೇ ಸಾಲಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಈ ಕೆಳಕಂಡ
ಯೋಜನೆಗಳಿಗೆ ಅರ್ಜಿ ಆಹ್ವಾನ

ಗಂಗಾ ಕಲ್ಯಾಣ ಯೋಜನೆ
1.20 ಎಕರೆಯಿಂದ 5.00 ಎಕರೆ ಜಮೀನು ಹೊಂದಿರುವ ಸಣ್ಣ ಮತ್ತು ಅತಿಸಣ್ಣ ರೈತರಿಗೆ ಕೊಳವೆಬಾವಿ ಕೊರೆದು ಪಂಪ್‌ಸೆಟ್ ಅಳವಡಿಸಿ, ವಿದ್ಯುದ್ದೀಕರಣದೊಂದಿಗೆ ನೀರಾವರಿ ಸೌಲಭ್ಯ ಒದಗಿಸಿಕೊಡಲಾಗುವುದು.
ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚ : ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ನಗರ, ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ಗ್ರಾಮಾಂತರ, ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ದಕ್ಷಿಣ, ಚಿಕ್ಕಬಳ್ಳಾಪುರ, ಕೋಲಾರ ಮತ್ತು ತುಮಕೂರು ಜಿಲ್ಲೆಗಳಿಗೆ ರೂ. 4.75 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು ಹಾಗೂ ಬಾಕಿ ಉಳಿದ ಜಿಲ್ಲೆಗಳಿಗೆ ರೂ. 3.75 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು. ಇದರಲ್ಲಿ ರೂ. 50,000/- ಸಾಲವೂ ಸೇರಿರುತ್ತದೆ.

ಉದ್ಯಮಶೀಲತಾ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ಯೋಜನೆ (ಬ್ಯಾಂಕ್ ಸಹಯೋಗದೊಂದಿಗೆ)
1. ಸ್ವಾವಲಂಬಿ ಸಾರಥಿ: ಸರಕು ವಾಹನ/ಟ್ಯಾಕ್ಸಿ (ಹಳದಿ ಬೋರ್ಡ್) ಉದ್ದೇಶದಡಿ ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚದ ಶೇ.75 ರಷ್ಟು ಅಥವಾ ಗರಿಷ್ಟ ರೂ. 4.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳ ಸಹಾಯಧನ.
2. ಫಾಸ್ಟ್ ಫುಡ್ ಟ್ರಕ್ ಟ್ರೈಲರ್/ಮೊಬೈಲ್ ಕಿಚನ್ ಫುಡ್ ಕಿಯೋಸ್ಕ್: (ಸಫಾಯಿ ಕರ್ಮಾಚಾರಿ ನಿಗಮ ಹೊರತುಪಡಿಸಿ) ಫುಡ್ ಕಾರ್ಟ್ ವಾಹನಗಳ ಉದ್ದೇಶದಡಿ ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚದ ಶೇ.75 ರಷ್ಟು ಅಥವಾ ಗರಿಷ್ಟ ರೂ. 4.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳ ಸಹಾಯಧನ.
3. ಹೈನುಗಾರಿಕೆ: (ಸಫಾಯಿ ಕರ್ಮಾಚಾರಿ ನಿಗಮ ಹೊರತುಪಡಿಸಿ) ಹೈನುಗಾರಿಕೆ ಕೈಗೊಳ್ಳಲು ಎರಡು ಎಮ್ಮೆ/ಹಸುಗಳಿಗೆ ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚದ ಶೇ.50ರಷ್ಟು ಅಥವಾ ಗರಿಷ್ಟ ರೂ. 1.25 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳ ಸಹಾಯಧನ.
4 ಇತರೆ ಉದ್ದೇಶ: ಸಣ್ಣ ಕೈಗಾರಿಕೆ, ಸೇವಾ ಕ್ಷೇತ್ರ, ವ್ಯಾಪಾರ ಮತ್ತು ಇತರೆ ಉದ್ದೇಶಗಳಿಗೆ ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚದ ಶೇ. 70 ರಷ್ಟು ಅಥವಾ ಗರಿಷ್ಟ ರೂ. 2.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳ ಸಹಾಯಧನ.

ಸ್ವಯಂ ಉದ್ಯೋಗ ನೇರಸಾಲ ಯೋಜನೆಗಳು
1. ನೇರಸಾಲ ಯೋಜನೆ: ಕಿರು ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ಚಟುವಟಿಕೆಗಳನ್ನು ಪ್ರಾರಂಭಿಸಲು ನಿಗಮದಿಂದ ಸಹಾಯಧನ ಮತ್ತು ನೇರಸಾಲ ಮಂಜೂರು ಮಾಡಲಾಗುತ್ತದೆ. ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚ: ರೂ. 1.00 ಲಕ್ಷ, ಸಹಾಯಧನ: ರೂ. 50,000/- ಸಾಲ: ರೂ. 50,000/- (ಶೆ. 4 ರಷ್ಟು ಬಡ್ಡಿದರ).
2. ಕುರಿ ಸಾಕಾಣಿಕೆ ಯೋಜನೆ(ಸಫಾಯಿ ಕರ್ಮಾಚಾರಿ ನಿಗಮ ಹೊರತುಪಡಿಸಿ) : ಕುರಿ ಸಾಕಾಣಿಕೆ ಉದ್ದೇಶಕ್ಕೆ ನಿಗಮದಿಂದ ಸಹಾಯಧನ ಮತ್ತು ನೇರಸಾಲ ಮಂಜೂರು ಮಾಡಲಾಗುತ್ತದೆ. ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚ: ರೂ. 1.00 ಲಕ್ಷ, ಸಹಾಯಧನ: ರೂ. 50,000/- ಸಾಲ: ರೂ. 50,000/- (ಶೆ. 4 ರಷ್ಟು ಬಡ್ಡಿದರ)

ಭೂ ಒಡೆತನ ಯೋಜನೆ
ಭೂರಹಿತ ಮಹಿಳಾ ಕೃಷಿ ಕಾರ್ಮಿಕರಿಗೆ ಈ ಕೆಳಕಂಡ ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚದಲ್ಲಿ ಕೃಷಿ ಜಮೀನು ಖರೀದಿಸಿ ನೀಡಲಾಗುವುದು.
ಘಟಕ ವೆಚ್ಚ : ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ನಗರ, ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ಗ್ರಾಮಾಂತರ, ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು ದಕ್ಷಿಣ ಮತ್ತು ಚಿಕ್ಕಬಳ್ಳಾಪುರ ಜಿಲ್ಲೆಗಳಿಗೆ ರೂ. 25.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು ಮತ್ತು ಬಾಕಿ ಉಳಿದ ಜಿಲ್ಲೆಗಳಿಗೆ ರೂ. 20.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು
ಸಹಾಯಧನ : ಶೇ. 50%
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ಮೈಕ್ರೋ ಕ್ರೆಡಿಟ್ (ಪ್ರೇರಣಾ) ಯೋಜನೆ
ಮಹಿಳಾ ಸ್ವಸಹಾಯ ಸಂಘಗಳಿಗೆ (ಕನಿಷ್ಟ 10 ಸದಸ್ಯರು) ಕಿರು ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ಚಟುವಟಿಕೆಗಳಿಗೆ ಸಾಲ ಮತ್ತು ಸಹಾಯಧನ ಸೌಲಭ್ಯ ಒದಗಿಸಿಕೊಡಲಾಗುವುದು.
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2023-24, 2024-25 ಮತ್ತು 2025-26ನೇ ಸಾಲಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಆನ್‌ಲೈನ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಅರ್ಜಿ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಿರುವವರು ಮತ್ತೊಮ್ಮೆ ಅರ್ಜಿ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವ ಅವಶ್ಯಕತೆ ಇರುವುದಿಲ್ಲ.

https://sevaone.karnataka.gov.in/services/ ನಲ್ಲಿ ನೇರವಾಗಿ ಅಥವಾ ಕೆಳಕಂಡ ಸಂಸ್ಥೆಗಳ ಸಹಯೋಗದೊಂದಿಗೆ ಸಹಾ ಅರ್ಜಿ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬಹುದು.
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ಅರ್ಜಿ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಲು ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿನಾಂಕ :
30-11-2026

ಸನ್ಮಾನ್ಯ ಮುಖ್ಯಮಂತ್ರಿಗಳಾದ ಶ್ರೀ ಡಿ.ಕೆ. ಶಿವಕುಮಾರ್ ರವರು ಮಾನ್ಯ ಸಮಾಜ ಕಲ್ಯಾಣ ಇಲಾಖೆಯ ಸಚಿವರಾದ ಶ್ರೀ ಕೆ.ಹೆಚ್. ಮುನಿಯಪ್ಪರವರನ್ನು ಅಭಿನಂದಿಸುತ್ತಿರುವುದು.

ಡಾ: ಬಿ.ಆರ್. ಅಂಬೇಡ್ಕರ್ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ | ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಆದಿಜಾಂಬವ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ | ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಭೋವಿ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ | ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ತಾಂಡಾ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ ನಿಯಮಿತ | ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ರಾಜ್ಯ ಸಫಾಯಿ ಕರ್ಮಚಾರಿ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ | ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಪರಿಶಿಷ್ಟ ಜಾತಿ ಮತ್ತು ಪರಿಶಿಷ್ಟ ಪಂಗಡಗಳ ಅಲೆಮಾರಿ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ

ವೈಜ್ಞಾನಿಕ ಮನೋಧರ್ಮ ಬೆಳೆಸಿಕೊಳ್ಳುವುದು; ಪ್ರಶ್ನೆ ಮಾಡುವ ಮತ್ತು ಬದಲಾವಣೆಗೆ ಒಡ್ಡಿಕೊಳ್ಳುವ ಮನಃಸ್ಥಿತಿ ಬೆಳೆಸಿಕೊಳ್ಳುವುದು.- ಪ್ರತಿಯೊಬ್ಬ ಭಾರತೀಯನ ಸಂವಿಧಾನಬದ್ಧ ಮೂಲಭೂತ ಕರ್ತವ್ಯ

ವ್ಯವಸ್ಥಾಪಕ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಕರು ಎಲ್ಲ ನಿಗಮಗಳು | ಆಯುಕ್ತರು ಸಮಾಜ ಕಲ್ಯಾಣ ಇಲಾಖೆ | ಸರ್ಕಾರದ ಕಾರ್ಯದರ್ಶಿಗಳು ಸಮಾಜ ಕಲ್ಯಾಣ ಇಲಾಖೆ | ಮಾನ್ಯ ಅಧ್ಯಕ್ಷರುಗಳು ಎಲ್ಲ ನಿಗಮಗಳು

Goat-butting: Man gets life term for punching neighbour to death

Rajiv.Kalkod@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: A 40-year-old villager, who hit his neighbour in the chest, triggering a cardiac arrest that led to his death, has been convicted of murder and sentenced to life imprisonment with a fine of Rs 20,000.

The convict, **Ravi Kumar M**, an agriculturist from Bisuvanahalli in Doddaballapur Rural, was charged with murdering his 67-year-old neighbour, VT Chandrashekhar, on Aug 23, 2021, following a trivial dispute.

Police had also arrested Kumar's wife, Muniyamma, and brother, Muniyappa, for assisting in the crime. The court sentenced Muniyappa to six months' imprisonment and fined Muniyamma Rs 1,000.

The incident occurred after a goat belonging to Kumar ran towards Chandrashekhar's three-year-old granddaughter and knocked her down. When the girl began crying, Chandrashekhar came out and confronted Kumar, Muniyamma and Muniyappa, complaining that similar incidents had occurred repeatedly.

During the ensuing argument, Kumar punched Chandrashekhar hard on the left side of his chest, causing him to collapse. He was rushed to a private hospital, where he died.

Based on a complaint filed by Chandrashekhar's son, Purushottam, Doddaballapur Rural police arrested Kumar and filed a chargesheet against him for murder.

Public prosecutor TN Nataraj argued that Kumar's assault had directly caused the death and produced medical records to substantiate the claim. A senior police officer said testimonies from two neighbours, who witnessed the assault, along with evidence from doctors who conducted the autopsy, were crucial to securing the man's conviction.

In her order, judge K Nirmala noted that although Chandrashekhar had coronary artery narrowing, medical evidence established that the assault triggered the fatal event.

After reviewing the medical records, the postmortem doctor, Dr Praveenkumar, issued a final opinion stating that the chest blow was highly likely to have caused the dislodgement of a thrombus or plaque, resulting in the fatal heart attack. Without the blow to the chest, the victim might not have died, she noted.

Student harassed by biker in morning, followed for 2km

Times News Network

AI

RISING SAFETY CONCERNS

Bengaluru: A morning ride to college turned distressing for a 19-year-old student when an unidentified motorcyclist allegedly flashed at her, made obscene gestures and repeatedly honked while pursuing her and her friend for nearly 2km on Oct 23 in Hosakerehalli, Banashankari 3rd Stage, in south Bengaluru.

According to the complaint filed by the student, Pragati (name changed), a resident of Jayanagar, the incident occurred between 8.30am and 8.45am.

Pragati was travelling to college on a two-wheeler ridden by her friend when, near a bakery, an unidentified man riding a motorcycle approached them and engaged in obscene and sexually inappropriate behaviour by flashing in a public place.

The accused continued following the girls for about 2km, repeatedly making obscene gestures and honking. The accused escaped when the girls tried to raise an alarm.

The student approached Girinagar police the next day and filed a complaint. A case has been registered under BNS Sections 78 (stalking) and 79 (word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman), and efforts are on to trace the accused.

Digi Yatra trials for international departures

Bengaluru: Kempegowda International Airport has launched Digi Yatra trials for international departures on select IndiGo and Air India flights, extending its face-enabled, contactless passenger processing system beyond domestic air travel.

A press release said passengers will be able to establish their identity through e-passport chip validation on Digi Yatra app, followed by photo verification.

The initial trial will cover terminal entry and security, with the potential to extend up to boarding for select international flights. Immigration and emigration will remain separate statutory processes, and passengers must continue to carry required travel documents. George Fanthome, chief technical officer, Bangalore International Airport Limited (BIAL), said the trial combines secure digital identity with face-enabled processing to reduce repeated document checks across participating touchpoints.

Change in T1 pickup zones

The designated pickup zones for Uber and Ola at Terminal 1 have been relocated with effect from Wednesday. Passengers have been advised to follow the signages at T1 to locate respective pickup points. TNN

Board opposes postponing exams for census; date change unlikely

Sruthysusan.Ullas
@timesofindia.com

NOT AT COST OF STUDENTS' FUTURE

Bengaluru: Karnataka School Examination and Assessment Board (KSEAB), which holds SSLC and II PU exams, is likely to oppose the change of exam dates as requested by the census department.

On Oct 22, census authorities had sent a letter to the department of school education and literacy to reschedule the commencement of the II PU examinations to March 6, 2027, so as to ensure the availability of teachers for the population enumeration exercise in Karnataka. As per the tentative timetable released by KSEAB, the exam is to start on Feb 27.

While houselisting operations (HILO) in the state were completed by May 15, 2026, the second phase of Census 2027 – population enumeration (PE) – is scheduled from Jan 25 to Feb 28, 2027, followed by the revision round from March 1-5.

The census department said the PE exercise requires deployment of more than 1.5 lakh enumerators and supervisors across Karnataka. "A significant proportion of this manpower is expected to be deployed from the education department. The availability of required field functionaries throughout the enumeration period, including the revisional round, is essential to ensure complete coverage, accuracy and reliability of the data collected, as well as ttimely completion of census operations," the letter said. It has called PE an important national exercise, which provides comprehensive demographic, social and economic data on the population of the country, important for policy decisions.

KSEAB has now sent a file to the state govt, listing its opinion. As per sources, KSEAB is against a change in dates. "If II PU exam dates change, it will affect SSLC exams, evaluation process for both exams and the rest of the academic calendar like CET. The dates that have been published in the tentative timetable are those that are normally followed by the exam board every year," explained an official.

A senior official from department of school education and literacy, said: "Students' well-being and stress-free life are non-negotiables and it is our department's responsibility to ensure that. Hence, public examinations as per yearly schedule are the highest priority. As any change in its dates will have a cascading effect on students and their future, there will be no change in any examination dates."

The official added: "Jan and Feb are when preparation exams are held. It is also when last-minute revisions are done and weak students in particular are guided to perform better. If teachers are taken away during this period, it is going to affect the performance of students drastically."

It may be recalled that teachers were away for special intensive revision (SIR) work from June till Oct 22. Most govt schools reeled under teacher shortage and teaching was hit hard. When teachers were just beginning to return to classrooms, the letter for census recruitment landed.

The department is also pushing for Karnataka Teachers Non-Teaching Duties Bill that will regulate deployment of teachers for non-educational duties. like census and SIR.

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CHANGE OF NAME

I, Sreesh M Rajeeva, S/o Malali Subrahmanyam Rajeeva, residing at #273, 5th Cross, 12th Main, 5th Sector, HSR Layout, Bengaluru, hereby declare that I have changed my name from Sreesh M Rajeeva to Sreesh M Rajeev and shall henceforth be known as Sreesh M Rajeev for all purposes. Vide Affidavit No. IN-KA28424828182672Y, sworn before the Notary Public at Bengaluru on 27/10/2026. Both names refer to one and the same person.

I, VAHIDA NOOR, W/o M Noorulla, R/o No.2148, 3rd A Main, 5th Cross, RPC Layout, Vijayanagar, Blr-26. I have changed my name to VAHIDA BEGUM. Vide affidavit dated 27/10/2026, sworn before notary and Advocate HS Sakalesh Aradhya, Bengaluru.

I, Shrinivas Gaonkar, at B 12 A, Manipal, Udupi, Karnataka 576104. I have Changed my name to Shrinivas Santosh Gaonkar Affidavit by M. Rajendra dt 24-10-2026

I, SUSHMA NAVIN SHETTY, Spouse of No. JC-880664A, Nb Sub NAVIN KUMAR, resident of No.11, Second Floor, 'Ravi Chaya' Building, 10th Cross Road, 4th Main Road, Sampangiramanagara, Bangalore - 560 027 have changed my name from SUSHMA NAVIN SHETTY to SUSHMA K.S. vide Affidavit dated 22-09-2026 attested before Notary Public, Bangalore

I, Shivani Anil T (Aadhaar), Talla Shivani (PAN), T Shivani (other documents) D/O T Anil DOB 03/07/2001 R/o Byrathi, Bangalore-560077, changed name to Shivani Anil Tallavajhala vide affidavit dated 23/10/2026 sworn before Notary D Rajanna, Reg.No.12347, Bangalore.

I, B. Shyamala, daughter of the late M. Bhaskaran, residing at Horamavu, Bengaluru-43, have changed my name from B. Shyamala to Shyamala Guruprasad for all future purposes.

I, Abijit Chandrashekar Patil S/O, Chandrashekar Patil R/o 505, 3rd Main Road, A Block, 2nd Stage, Rajajinagar, Bangalore-560055 have changed my name to Abhijit Chandrashekar Patil.

I Ajai Kumar Sharma S/O Bishamber Dayal Sharma R/O# 407 Sree Charitha gardens,Marathahalli, Bangalore - 37, have Changed my Name from AJAI KUMAR SHARMA to AJAY KUMAR SHARMA vide affidavit dtd 17.10.2026 at halasuru Bengaluru

I, VINAY DANIEL WINFRED SUGUMAR, C/o. SUGUMAR THOMAS, residing at FLAT NO. B-405, ADITHI ANI LOTUS, SY. NO. 25-5, KURUDUSONNENA HALLI, BENGALURU – 560049, have changed my name to VINAY DANIEL WINFRED.

I, NEERAJ KUMAR, C/o. ASHOK KUMAR, residing at Arvind Skylands Apartment, Flat No. K-601, Jakkur Road, Nehru Nagar, Shivanahalli, Yelahanka, Bengaluru – 560064, have changed my name to NEERAJ KUMAR RAWAT.

LOST & FOUND

MY Name is Somashekar.S I lost my Original diploma in pharmacy certificate, Certificate No. 20398/AA, dated : 15.09.1998. if find any one pls kindly contact my phone no. 9846358433

NOTICE is hereby given to the general public that my client Ruby Sinha has lost the Org Sale deed Doc No. DSP-1-08076/2012-13 for the property bearing PID No. 150200200701101396, Khaneshumari No. 1107, Site No. 730, Khata No.657/1107, measuring 40x30=1200sqft, in a layout called "E K ENCLAVE LAYOUT", situated at Shivanapura Village,Dasanapura Hobli, Bangalore North Taluk, Anyone having claim/objection may contact the days of publication, failing which no claims will be entertained. UD Law Firm-8197547303.

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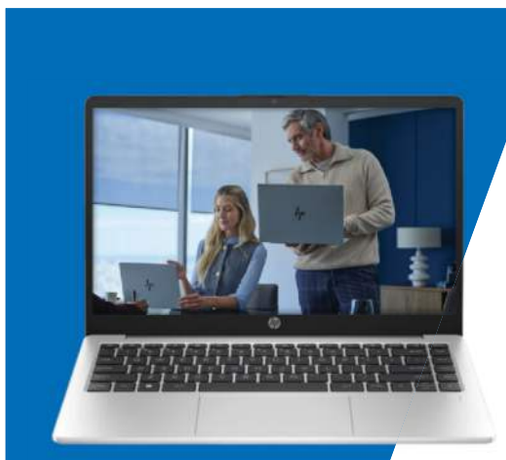

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Anna Bhagya: Indira food kits to offset decrease in rice production

Sandeep.Moudgal@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: With drought across the country set to take a heavy toll on food production, especially in Tungabhadra and Cauvery rice belts, the state govt is preparing to reduce its dependence on rice supplied by Centre for its flagship Anna Bhagya scheme.

The guarantee scheme requires about 2.3 tonnes of rice annually, raising concerns over supplies this year. Karnataka currently provides 5kg of rice per person each month under the Food Security and Safety Act and procures another 5kg from Food Corporation of India.

Anticipating possible curbs by the Centre, govt plans to replace the additional 5kg with a package of lentils, salt, oil and sugar under Indira food kits.

Food and civil supplies minister Rizwan Arshad told **TOI** tenders for the kits would be ready for rollout within a couple of months. "Considering the severity of drought, there are chances that the Union govt may deny Karnataka additional rice," Arshad said. "We are speeding up the process to roll out Indira food kits to diversify foodgrains distribution and reduce dependency on the Centre."

Revenue minister and DCM G Parameshwara had previously said food production would be severely affected over the next two months, with crop losses in Karnataka touching 80%. Paddy cultivation in Mandya, Raichur, Koppal and Ballari has been seriously affected.

Arshad said his department was also rationalising BPL cardholders and removing ineligible beneficiaries. KYC verification had been completed for 65% of cardholders. Govt would also launch a drive to include eligible people not currently on the BPL list.

STING VISIT: Congress state president BK Hariprasad called on former chief minister Siddaramaiah at his residence in Bengaluru Tuesday. The two had a lengthy discussion on political developments in the state

TOI

Winter session in Belagavi from Dec 7

The winter session of the legislature will be held in Belagavi from Dec 7 this year. A letter from the chief secretary to the legislature branch states that the cabinet, on Oct 15, had resolved to hold the session for 10 days in the last month of the calendar year. It directed authorities to make necessary arrangements. This would be DK Shivakumar's first session in Belagavi as CM.

Farmers to protest land acquisition

Santoshkumar.B@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Farmers and landowners from five villages in Devanahalli and Doddaballapur taluks are preparing to launch an indefinite protest against Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board's (KIADB) proposal to acquire 1,200 acres near the Foxconn facility, while social welfare minister KH Muniyappa has written to chief minister DK Shivakumar and industries minister MB Patil, urging them to drop the acquisition proposal.

The opposition comes amid growing concerns among villagers over the loss of agricultural land to industrial projects in neighbouring villages over the past three years.

Farmers from Dandudasa Kodigehalli and Sonnamaranahalli in Doddaballapur taluk, and Koira, Mayasandra and Meesaganahalli in Devanahalli taluk, are already holding village-level meetings to mobilise support for the protest.

Official documents show KIADB plans to acquire 1,200 acres across the five villages. It issued a preliminary notification about two weeks ago to acquire 369 acres in Dandudasa Kodigehalli and Sonnamaranahalli. The board is preparing to issue notifications for another 831 acres in Koira, Mayasandra and Meesaganahalli.

DEVANAHALLI

Chikkegowda KM, a farmer from Koira, told TOI that more than 1,000 people had recently protested the proposed acquisition at the Bengaluru Rural deputy commissioner's office. "All farmers are opposed to the acquisition," he said.

Chikkegowda said KIADB had acquired more than 1,000 acres in neighbouring villages, including Ramanathapura, Rabbanahalli, Aruvanahalli, Doddagollahalli, Byradenahalli, Linganahalli and Konaghatta in the past three years. He alleged that local politicians had discouraged farmers in those villages from opposing the acquisition, resulting in the loss of fertile agricultural land. "We will not make the same mistake. We will protest until the govt drops the proposal," he said.

Madhuchandra KG, another farmer, said villagers were preparing to erect a pandal for the indefinite protest. He claimed the villages proposed for acquisition fall within the Arkavathy river catchment area and alleged that establishing industries there would violate the law.

Meanwhile, farmers submitted a memorandum to Muniyappa, also the local MLA, seeking his intervention to stop the acquisition. In his letter to the CM and industries minister Patil, Muniyappa noted that the govt had already acquired more than 9,000 acres in Devanahalli taluk for the international airport and industrial projects. He urged the govt to avoid further land acquisition in the taluk.

Fires rise in Eastern Ghats, Western Ghats sees decline

Niranjan.Kaggere
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Wildfires are increasing in the Eastern Ghats but declining sharply in the Western Ghats, highlighting contrasting fire patterns across southern India's forests amid growing climate pressures and drought, a 21-year study has found.

Titled 'Changing fire regimes in wildlife reserves of southern India: Trends, drivers, and conservation challenges', the study, published in the journal Ecosphere, analysed satellite data from 13 wildlife reserves across Eastern and Western Ghats and other parts of India from 2002.

Led by conservation scientist Dr Narendran Kodandapani of Centre for Wildlife Studies, Bengaluru, and co-authored by the centre's CEO, Dr Krithi K Karanth, the study used Nasa's moderate resolution imaging spectroradiometer (MODIS) data to track burnt areas across 200,000sqkm of protected landscapes.

About 16,667sqkm burned during the 21-year period, with some areas experiencing repeated fires. Eastern Ghats accounted for 59% of the total burnt area, followed by Central India at 16.6% and Western Ghats at 8.4%.

Annual burnt area increased by 9.3% in Eastern Ghats and 4.6% in Central India. In contrast, Western Ghats recorded a statistically significant annual decline of 10.8%. Researchers said these divergent trends were obscured in earlier estimates that treated the regions as a single landscape.

LOSING SPARK: File picture of a fire at Bandipur Tiger Reserve. Western Ghats saw a 10.8% annual decline in fires

Drought, human activity

Climate and human-related factors together explained an average of 44% of the variation in fire activity across the 13 reserves, with the proportion ranging from 21% to 77% across individual reserves.

Drought emerged as a key driver, with climatic water deficit, soil moisture, temperature and other indicators of dryness showing varying associations with burnt areas across all reserves.

Human activities also influenced fire patterns, though their effects varied by location. In Kawal Wildlife Sanctuary, population density was strongly associated with fire activity. Communities use fire to facilitate the collection of forest products such as mahua flowers and tendu leaves and to improve grazing conditions. Population density was also positively associated with fire activity in Nagarjunasagar-Srisailam Tiger Reserve.

But in Karnataka's Nagarahole National Park, higher population density was associated with less burning. Researchers attributed this partly to land-use changes and active fire suppression by the state forest department.

Nearly 85% of the burnt area across the reserves occurred between Jan and March, underscoring the need for greater preparedness during the peak fire season.

Region-specific strategies

The researchers cautioned against blanket fire suppression, noting fires are not inherently harmful to forest ecosystems. While excessive burning can threaten biodiversity, completely excluding fire can also alter vegetation structure, ecosystem diversity and ecological processes in certain landscapes.

The study called for region-specific fire management strategies that account for climatic conditions, species' fire resilience, habitat characteristics and traditional burning practices among communities living along forest fringes.

It also stressed the need for early-warning systems, better preparedness among forest departments and local communities, and long-term research to understand how climate change could reshape wildfire patterns.

Plan to build 500km new roads in Bengaluru: Shivakumar

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: CM DK Shivakumar said he will hold a series of meetings with Karnataka legislators, including those from the opposition, over the next few weeks, grouping them by caste and regional backgrounds.

Shivakumar told reporters in Belagavi: "I will soon meet with SC/ST legislators, after which I will meet with OBC, minority, Lingayat and Vokkaliga legislators."

The meetings are aimed at understanding legislators' concerns and gauging their communities' perception of the Congress govt.

On Tuesday he met with Bengaluru city MLAs and asked legislators to submit constituency-level demands, which govt would consider on a "need basis". However, an opposition legislator said the meeting focused on long-term projects rather than immediate measures for constituency development.

"We were in a room where the CM and minister in charge of Bengaluru (Krishna Byre Gowda) spoke about their long-term ambitions and projects but did not utter a single word on short term measures the govt will take to develop constituencies," said one opposition legislator.

TOI

HOLDING COURT: Chief minister DK Shivakumar at the meeting with Bengaluru MLAs on Tuesday

Meanwhile, Congress MLAs said the meeting sought to bring legislators across parties together and explain govt's plans for major infrastructure projects. "Politics aside, the CM and govt tried to explain to opposition legislators the intent of big-ticket projects like the tunnel road, infrastructure projects and Metro expansion," said a Congress MLA.

Shivakumar later said his govt will focus on improving Bengaluru's basic infrastructure, with plans to build 500km of new roads and develop 1,500km of arterial and sub-arterial roads. Another 18km of roads on the city's outskirts is being considered for white-topping.

In a statement, Shivakumar said Bengaluru lags other major cities in terms of quality road length, prompting greater emphasis on road infrastructure. He said the govt will not discriminate between constituencies represented by governing party members and opposition MLAs while allocating funds. The govt is also preparing a 10-year development blueprint for Bengaluru, ahead of the city's 500th anniversary in 2027. The proposed projects are estimated to require Rs 1 lakh crore, he said.

On waste management, Shivakumar warned strict action would be taken against contractors found negligent in waste disposal. He said 33 packages had been announced across Bengaluru's 27 city constituencies, with tenders for 21 packages being opened now. The new tenders would cover the collection and disposal of 9,000 tonnes of waste daily, based on vehicle capacity.

ED attaches more properties of MLA

Bengaluru: Enforcement Directorate (ED) Tuesday said it had attached assets worth over Rs 23 crore in its money laundering investigation against Congress legislator KC Veerendra and his associates Gulshan Khattar and Neha Tandon in an alleged online betting network.

The latest attachment follows provisional attachment of properties worth Rs 177.3 crore, subsequently confirmed by the adjudicating authority under Prevention of Money Laundering Act, taking the total value of assets attached, seized or frozen in the case to around Rs 343 crore, ED said.

The investigation, based on multiple FIRs alleging cheating, impersonation, criminal conspiracy and extortion through online betting and gambling platforms, uncovered a nationwide network of betting websites, payment gateways, shell companies and mule accounts allegedly controlled by Veerendra and his associates.

ED claims the accused operated illegal online betting platforms, including King567, through which players were allegedly induced to deposit money and cheated through manipulated betting and blocked withdrawals. TNN

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-18773)

TENDER ENQUIRY No.: QQ-1353/PO-C&S

Chief Purchase Officer/MM, Central Purchase Organization, PSPCL, 2nd floor, Multistorey Building, The Mall, Patiala, invites e-Tender for procurement of 4Cx50 sq.mm-888 Km as per tender specification no. QQ- 1353/PO/C&S.For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https: //eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 28.10.2026 (11.00 AM) onwards.

NOTE: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1015/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16542

Expression of Interest (EoI) for Empanelment of Secure Printers

An Autonomous Society of Government of India is in the process of empanelling secure printers for printing, packing and transportation of Question Papers, OMR Sheets etc. EoI is invited from Printing companies possessing requisite experience, resources and capabilities for secure printing, packing and delivery at designated locations in a very secure manner for participation in limited tender process.

Company registered under Indian Company Act, 2013 or Society Registered under Society Registration Act, 1860 or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) firm registered under LLP Act and meeting the following eligibility criteria/compliance certificate(s) are eligible to participate in the EoI:

1. GST Registration
2. Valid PAN Card
3. Trade License / Registration of Establishment issued by respective state.
4. In operation for at least 5 years
5. Should be ISO Certified for 9001:2015, 27001 or IBA/RBI certified; CMMI Level 3 certification will be an added advantage.
6. Experience in providing services of printing of question papers for various National Level Examination during in last three Financial Years ending 2025-26.
7. Should have printed at least 9,00,000 Question Papers (cumulative) in last 3 years ending FY 2025-26.
8. Should have at least 15 regular employees on the payroll of company.
9. Should have successfully completed Question Paper Printing jobs for Examinations conducted by any Government organization ie. Department/University/Institute in India during last 3 years ending FY 2025-26 for minimum three lakh Question Papers every year.
10. Should have successfully executed at least one work of Question Paper Printing jobs for Examinations of value not less than 1 crores or two works (for different customers) of value not less than 70 lakhs for any Government organization i.e., Department/University/ Institute in India during last 3 years ending FY 2025-26.
11. Should have the Average annual turnover of at least Rs. 20 Crore (Rupees twenty Crores only) during the last three financial year ending FY 2025-26.
12. Should be a profit-making company with positive Net-worth.

The printers fulfilling the above criteria may submit EoI in the following performa along with copies of documents in support of their eligibility in the company's letter head. The documents must be signed by the authorised signatory.

1	Name & Designation of Authorized Signatory	
2	Registered/Head Office Address including website address	
3	Name & Telephone Number(s) and Mobile of the designated contact person	
4	Security Measures	
5	List of Machinery	
6	Number of years of experience in confidential printing	
7	Printing capacity per day in Reems	
8	Any other details and capabilities of the company	

Signature of Authorized Signatory.
Seal of the Organization:
Place:
Date:

Note: (1) This is only an Expression of Interest, no financial quote should be made by the applicants.

(2) Parties meeting the eligibility criteria will be sent a copy of tender document for submitting Technical and Financial bid. Site visit of the technically eligible printers will be done before considering the financial bid.

EoI must be sent to **Post Box No. 9626, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058.** Last date for submitting EoI is seven days from the date of publishing of the advertisement in the newspapers. EoI received after the last date will not be considered.

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003
Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 214/GATP/IMD/50007822 dated 27/10/2026**
"Award of Service Contract for Servicing and overhauling of motorized actuator at both the Units of GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."
Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-102/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16538

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. JHS-N-GSU-17-26 **Dated:- 26.10.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Dy.Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/GSU/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of india invites open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works:-

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-GSU-17-26, **Description of work:** EI alteration and other S&T work in connection with provision for extension of A&D siding for full length shunting neck & conversion of ballast siding to full length goods line at Chirgaon station of Jhansi division.

Approx. Cost : ₹ 1,19,67,321.88	**Earnest Money:** ₹ 2,39,400.00
Cost of Tender Form: Nil	**Opening of tender :** 18.11.2026 Time 15:00.
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 12 Months	

(1) Tender on line can be submitted upto **15.00** hrs on **18.11.2026**. **(2)** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** (JHANSI DIVISION-GATI SHAKTI, NORTH CENTRAL RLY). **2447/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003
Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 213/GATP/IMD/50007821 dated 27/10/2026**
"Award of Service Contract for Servicing and overhauling of Pneumatically Operated Actuators and Cylinders at both the Units GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."
Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-101/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16537

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invites tenders in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the following works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount put to Tender / EMD Amount
	Office of the Chief Engineer (South), 7th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bangalore - 560 009.	
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4445/2026-27	**Date:23.10.2026**
1	Providing and Laying of 300/230mm dia Sewer Lines to improve sewerage facilities to Lakshmi Layout, Hongasandra, Bommanahalli & surrounding area coming the jurisdiction of Kodichikkanahalli Service Station of AEE S-2-1 Sub Division.	Rs. 103.03 Lakhs / Rs. 1.55 Lakhs
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4446/2026-27	**Date:23.10.2026**
2	Providing and Laying of 300/230mm dia RCC/SW Line around Krishna Layout, Devarachikkanahalli and surrounding areas coming under the jurisdiction of KCH Layout Service Station of AEE S-2-1 Sub Division.	Rs. 122.55 Lakhs / Rs. 1.83 Lakhs
	No.:BWSSB/EIC/CE(S)/ACE(S)-I/DCE(S)/TA(S)/4447/2026-27	**Date:23.10.2026**
3	Providing and Laying of 230/300mm dia GSW/RCC UGD pipeline Missing bit at G.K. Layout, Parappana Agrahara and surrounding areas coming under Kudlu Service Station of AEE (S)-2-2 Sub Division.	Rs. 129.56 Lakhs / Rs. 1.94 Lakhs

For all the above works, Last date for receipt of tenders : **11.11.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs.** The Tenders will be opened on: **12.11.2026 after 16.00 Hrs.**

Sd/- Chief Engineer (South)

The details regarding the tender and participatin in the e-procurement process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.

DIPR/CP/JA/3352/2026-27

ODISHA POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LIMITED

CIN : U40104OR1984SGC001429
Zone-A, 7th Floor, Fortune Towers, Chandrasekharpur, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, India
Phone: +91-674-2303765-66, Fax: +91-674-2303755-56, Website : www.opgc.co.in

POWER YOUR CAREER WITH OPGC

Odisha Power Generation Corporation Ltd. (OPGC), a Government of Odisha Company, operates state of the art thermal power plants at Ib Thermal Power Station (ITPS), Banharpalli, Jharsuguda. It has a total generation capacity of 1740 MW (2x210 MW in first phase and 2x660MW in second phase). We are looking for experienced and dynamic professional for the following position under **Market Based Salary (MBS) structure** on our regular rolls. Reservation laws as notified by Govt. of Odisha will be followed.

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	Grade	No. of Post
1	Senior General Manager – Finance	E-9	1

For detailed advertisement, please logon to our website: **www.career.opgc.co.in.** The last date for online application is **07-11-2026 and to receive the hardcopy of application is 13-11-2026** Candidates are advised to go through the detailed advertisement carefully before applying. Corrigendum, if any will be published in our official website.

No. OPGC/CO/HR/04/2026 Dated: 28/10/2026

Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board

Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010.
Website : https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com
Advt. No. :–JCECEB/48 /26 - 114 Ranchi/Dated: 27/10/2026

Notice regarding 3rd Round of Online Counselling for MDS All India Quota Seats of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Garhwa; Hazaribagh College of Dental Sciences and Hospital & Awadh Dental College & Hospital, Jamshedpur on the basis of NEET MDS-2026 Result

Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Govt. of India, New Delhi has reduced the Qualifying percentile and cut off marks for NEET (MDS) 2026 vide letter F.No.V.12025/84/2024-DE dated 12.10.2026 NBE notice dated 12.10.2026 is available on the Board's website.

The minimum qualifying percentiles and Cut-off score have lowered as follows:-

CATEGORY	REVISED MINIMUM QUALIFYING CRITERIA	REVISED CUT-OFF SCORE
General(UR/EWS)	29.424th Percentile	234
General -PWD	24.424th Percentile	218
SC/ST/BC-I/BC-II Including PWD of SC/ST/BC-I/BC-II	19.424th Percentile	200

Online Application Forms are invited from qualified eligible candidates of NEET MDS-2026 examination for the preparation of all India merit list, for All India Quota M.D.S. seats of Vananchal Dental College & Hospital, Farathiya, Garhwa; Hazaribagh College of Dental Sciences and Hospital & Awadh Dental College & Hospital, Jamshedpur.

2. Interested eligible candidates are requested to fill the **Application Form Online** from **29.10.2026 to 01.11.2026** on Board's official website **http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in** by Clicking on " **Click Here for All Online Application Submission – JCECEB 2026**" tab by following the given directions.

The Candidates already enlisted in All India & NRI Quota merit list of 2nd Round and already applied for 3rd round Counselling need not have to apply again. Other terms and conditions and Eligibility criteria are same as per Advt. No.– JCECEB/48/26-86 dated-18.09.2026 which can be seen on Board's website **http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in** in Important Notice Column.

Revised Time Schedule for Online 3rd Round of Counselling for MDS All India Quota Seats:-

Sl. No.	Activity	Re-Scheduled Date
1.	Online form filling & Document Uploading	**29.10.2026 to 01.11.2026**
2.	Publication State Merit List for 3rd Round of Online Counselling	**03.11.2026**
3.	Online Registration & Choice Filling for Seat Allotment	**04.11.2026 to 07.11.2026**
4.	Issue of Provisional Seat Allotment Letter	**10.11.2026**
5.	Certificates/Documents Verification and admission in concerned Institute	**11.11.2026 to 16.11.2026**

Application Fee:- Applicants will required to pay Application Fee through Payment Gateway by Credit Card/Debit Card/Net Banking as given below:-

Sl. No.	Category	Fee
1.	General / EWS/BC– I / BC – II	` 1000/-
2.	SC/ ST / Female Candidate of All Category	` 500/-
3.	Divyang	–

Counselling Fee:–

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	General/ EWS/ BC& I/ BC & II	` 2000/–
2.	SC/ST / Female Candidate of All Category	` 1200/–

Security Deposit:-

Sl. No.	Institution	Security Deposit
1.	GOVERNMENT	30,000/- (UR/EWS) 15,000/- (ST/SC/OBC/PWD)
2.	Private	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
3.	Both (Government/Private)	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
4.	Stray/Mop-up	50,000/-

(a) Security Money will be forfeited if admission is not taken after seat allotment in Second Round and next Round of Counselling. Apart from this, Security Money will not be returned even in case of cancellation of admission in case of giving wrong information by the candidate at the time of registration and not presenting the required original certificates at the time of admission.

(b) The Security Money will be refunded if the candidates have taken valid admission and no seat is allotted after any stage of Counselling.

By the order of Controller of Examination,
Sd/-
Officer on Special Duty

PR 392627 Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board(26-27)D

25001/1385/2627

By E_Mail/e-Despatch
E_Mail ID: serwcbaripada@gmail.com
Ph-No-06792-261343/261344
Gangraj, Baripada

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
"e" Procurement Notice for Bridge Works
Identification No.- Online Tender- Bridge N.C.B. No. 435 for 2026-27.
Letter No. 5543 / Date: 26.10.2026

1. Name of the work : Bridge works under SBY in the District of Mayurbhanj
2. Total No. of work : **05** No (Five)
3. Estimated Cost : **Rs.317.94 Lakhs to Rs.899.57 lakhs** (approximately).
4. Eligible Class of Contractor : **As per annexure.**
5. Period of Completion : **As per annexure.**
6. Other details

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding From	To	Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/O C.C.E.R.W. Circle, Baripada Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baripada	Bridge On- line N.C.B. No. **435**	Dt. 13.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Dt.30.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt.27.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt.01.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

- Further details can be seen from the website: **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
- Any Corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the above e_tender website only.

Sd/- **Er. A.K Naik**
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Baripada

OIPR-25001/25181/1/26-27/0021

34001/1066/2627

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
KATAKA (R&B) CIRCLE, KATAKA
Email ID -sectcrb_2006@yahoo.co.in
Order No. 5865 Dt. 22.10.2026
1st Corrigendum to Bid Identification No. CCE.Ctc.(R&B) 12/2026-27

The following modification has been made for the works invited vide Bid Identification No. CCE.Ctc. (R&B) 12/2026-27;
The critical dates stipulated are hereby modified as follows:

Sl No.	Particulars	Original Date & Time	Revised Date & Time
1	Availability of Bid Documents in the e-procurement portal	22.10.2026 to 17.30 Hrs. of 09.11.2026	30.10.2026 to 17.30 Hrs. of 16.11.2026
2	Last Date & Time for Submission/Receipt of Bid in the e-procurement portal	09.11.2026 up to 17.30 Hrs.	16.11.2026 up to 17.30 Hrs.
3	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid in the e-procurement portal	10.11.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.	17.11.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

All other terms, conditions, eligibility criteria, technical requirements, evaluation criteria and financial conditions of the Tender shall remain unchanged.

This corrigendum shall be deemed to form a part of the Tender document and shall be considered along with the original Tender while preparing and submitting the bid.

Any further Addendum / Corrigendum shall be published in the e-procurement portal **https://tendersodisha.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Kataka (R&B) Circle, Kataka

OIPR-34001/34012/1/26-27/0032

34001/1064/2627

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
DHENKANAL (R&B) DIVISION, DHENKANAL
Email - eedklpwd@gmail.com
INVITATION FOR BIDS THROUGH e-Procurement
Bid Identification No. SE DKL (R&B). 27/ 2026-27
Invitation for Bids

1.	The Superintending Engineer Dhenkanal (R&B) Division, Dhenkanal, on behalf of Governor of Odisha, invites percentage rate bids in single cover system in ONLINE MODE only, for Construction of Building work as detailed below.		
2.	Nature of work	:	05 Nos Electrical works
3.	No. of work	:	05 Nos.
4.	Bid Cost.	:	Rs. 6,000/-
5.	Class of Contractor	:	"Empanelled fire licensed agency of Class D or above authorized by Odisha Fire & Emergency Service having MoU with associate electrical contractor (MV/HT or above) having valid license from ELBO. The Court Affidavit should have specific mention of name, address of the two parties, license number, date of validity and issuing authority, name of the work for which the agreement is signed for"
6.	Availability of Bid Documents in the website	:	From 10.00 AM of 29.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of 12.11.2026
7.	Date of Opening of Bid	:	Dt. 13.11.2026 at 11:00 AM.
8.	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website only.		

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Dhenkanal (R&B) Division

OIPR-34001/34016/1/26-27/0031

34001/1065/2627

E-mail ID:cebuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in
cebuildings@rediffmail.com
Tel. (0674)-2391523

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)

File No.-B-I-Home-54/2026 38566 / Bhubaneswar, the 16th Oct., 2026

Invitation for Bids
1st Corrigendum

Tender Reference No. CE-Bldg-II-40/2026-27

Name of the Work : (1) Construction of Block Level Stadium in Saintala Block (with Indoor Hall) in Balangir District.
(2) Construction of Block Level Stadium in Deogaon Block (with Indoor Hall) in Balangir District.
(3) Construction of Block Level Stadium in M. Rampur Block (with Indoor Hall) in Kalahandi District,
(4) Construction of 40 Nos. of E-type Staff Qrs. (Block-I (S+3) and Block-II (S+2)) at Parlakhemundi, Gajapati
(5) Construction of the Office Building and Record Room of the Additional Sub- Collector (Settlement and Consolidation), Puri".

The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No. **CE-Bldg-II-40/2026-27**

1. Bid documents such as DTCN/BOQ etc. can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. www.tendersorissa.gov.in, during the period from **dt.30.10.2026 to 17.00 hours of dt.16.11.2026** instead of dt.12.10.2026 to dt.27.10.2026 for ONLINE BIDDING respectively.
2. Online bids shall be received till **17.00 Hours of dt.16.11.2026** instead of dt.27.10.2026.
3. The technical bids will be opened at **11.30 A.M. of dt.17.11.2026** instead of dt.28.10.2026.

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer, Buildings-II, Odisha, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-34001/34117/1/26-27/0087

32001/1137/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
ANUGOLA IRRIGATION CIRCLE, ANUGOLA, ODISHA, PIN-759143
email :aceangulirrigationcircle@gmail.com
Government of Odisha "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Bid Identification No. ACEAIC- 05/2026-27

Sl. No.	Name of work	Estimated cost	Class of Contractor	Period of completion	Date and Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal	Name & Address of the Officer Inviting Bid
01	Protection to Right scoured bank of river Brahmani near village Santhapada under Talcher Block.	Rs.495.77 lakh	"A"	08 (Eight Calendar Months)	29.10.2026 at 10.00 AM	13.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM	Additional Chief Engineer, Anugola Irrigation Circle, Anugola
02	Flood Protection to Left scoured bank of river Aunli near village Patakamunda of Chhendipada Block.	Rs.496.66 lakh	"A"	08 (Eight Calendar Months)	29.10.2026 at 10.00 AM	13.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM	

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal **http://tendersodisha.gov.in**.
Any corrigendum/ addendum/cancellation will be displayed in the **Govt. Website only.**

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer,
Anugola Irrigation Circle, Anugola.

OIPR-32001/32081/1/26-27/0006

CHENNAI METRO RAIL LIMITED

(A JOINT VENTURE OF GOVT. OF INDIA & GOVT. OF TAMIL NADU)
(ISO 9001:2015 AND ISO 14001:2015 CERTIFIED)
METROS, ANNA SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI - 600 035.

E-Tender Notice

CMRL invites bids through open tendering on the CPP Portal **(https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app)** from eligible firms who fulfil the qualification criteria as mentioned in the tender document under the Single Stage Two Cover (Technical & Financial) system for the work mentioned below:

CMRL/CP/TDR-79-CON/2026: "Balance and Miscellaneous Works for OCC and Madhavaram Depot of CMRL Phase II Project"

(i) **Tender document available from: 03/11/2026**

(ii) **Deadline for Bid submission: 01/12/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.**

For Notice Inviting Tender (NIT), please visit:

www.chennaimetrorail.org>Tenders >NIT (Project)>Civil

The corrigendum/addendum to this publication & tender document, if any, would appear only on the CPP Portal and will not be published through newspapers.

Sd/-
For Managing Director
Director (Projects)
Chennai Metro Rail Limited

DIPR/3225/Tender/2026

13001/2244/2627

Bhubaneswar Municipal Corporation

ICOCMC Tower, Satya Nagar, BHUBANESWAR-751022
No: 63490 /BMC DT: 26.10.2026
XXXXX-II-SWMPMU-59/2021-22

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

On behalf of the Commissioner, Bhubaneswar Municipal Corporation (BMC), Dy. Commissioner (Sanitation), BMC invites expression of interest from the experienced and qualified interested Proprietorship firm/Company/registered partnership firm, registered company, registered society or registered trust for **"Empanelment of agencies for Disposal of Recyclable and Non- Recyclable waste generated from different Material Recovery Facility (MRF) Centres operated in the territorial jurisdiction of Bhubaneswar Municipal Corporation for a period of 2 years"**. The detail EOI document can be seen and downloaded from BMC website **http://bmc.gov.in.**

For queries, interested parties may contact the office of Deputy Commissioner (Sanitation), Bhubaneswar Municipal Corporation at ICOMC Tower at Satya Nagar, Infront of Satya Nagar Kali Temple on Janpath, Unit-IX, Bhubaneswar- 751022, Odisha, India.

1. Schedule of Events :

Availability of EoI document	**28.10.2026 (11:00 AM) to 06.11.2026 till 5:00 pm** (Downloadable from website: (**http://bmc.gov.in**)
Last date & time for receipt of EoI	**05.11.2026 by 05.00 PM** (Through **Speed/Registered post/Courier/Hand delivery**)
Place of submission of EoI in hard Copy	**Office of Dy. Commissioner (Sanitation) Bhubaneswar Municipal Corporation**, ICOMC Tower at Satya Nagar, Infront of Satya Nagar Kali Temple on Janpath, Unit-IX, Bhubaneswar-751022, Odisha, India.
Date and Time of opening of EoI	**07.11.2026 at 4:00 PM**
For further enquiries, please email at:	**dc-sanitation@bmc.gov.in / swmpmubmc@gmail.com**

2. All amendments, Clarifications, time extension etc. will be uploaded in the website only interested parties should regularly visit the above website to keep themselves updated.

By Order of Commissioner, BMC
Sd/-
Dy. Commissioner (Sanitation)
Bhubaneswar Municipal Corporation

OIPR-13001/13002/1/26-27/0131

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invites tenders in Two Stage Tender System from eligible Contractors for the following Works.

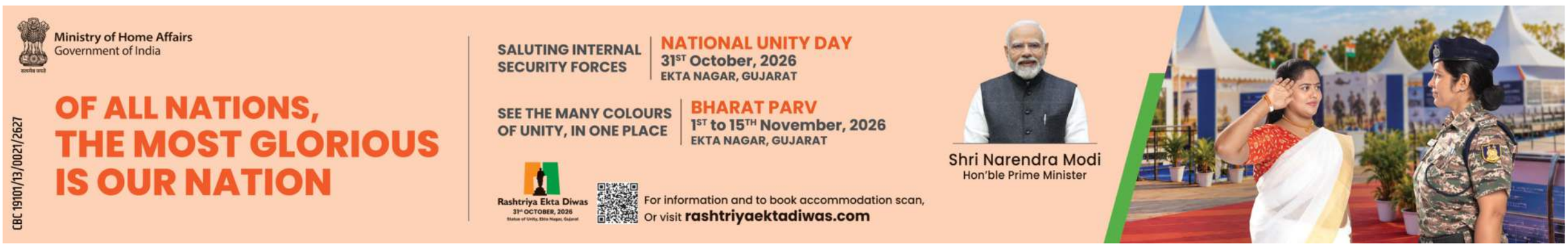
Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount Put to Tender / EMD Amount
	Office of the Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT), 9th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bengaluru - 560009.	
	IFT No.:BWSSB/CE(D&QA)/ACE/TA/2423/2026-27	**Date: 27-10-2026**
1	Work of Sinking of 6.5 inch Dia New Borewells and Energizing with Necessary Accessories at Various Locations in 110 Villages pertaining to North GBA **(35 Nos.)**	**Rs. 379.43 Lakhs / Rs. 5,70,000/-**
2	Work of Sinking of 6.5 inch Dia New Borewells and Energizing with Necessary Accessories at Various Locations in 110 Villages pertaining to East GBA **(30 Nos.)**	**Rs. 372.53 Lakhs / Rs. 5,58,800/-**
3	Work of Sinking of 6.5 inch Dia New Borewells and Energizing with Necessary Accessories at Various Locations in 110 Villages pertaining to West GBA **(35 Nos.)**	**Rs. 374.59 Lakhs / Rs. 5,62,000/-**
4	Work of Sinking of 6.5 inch Dia New Borewells and Energizing with Necessary Accessories at Various Locations in 110 Villages pertaining to South GBA **(30 Nos.)**	**Rs. 333.80 Lakhs / Rs. 5,00,800/-**
5	Work of Sinking of 6.5 inch Dia New Borewells and Energizing with Necessary Accessories at Various Locations in K.R. Puram Constituency coming under 110 Villages **(30 Nos.)**	**Rs. 372.53 Lakhs / Rs. 5,58,800/-**

For both the above works, Last Date for Receipt of Tenders: **11-11-2026 upto 16.00 Hours.**
Bids will be Opened on: **12-11-2026 at 16.05 Hours.**

Sd/- Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT)

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement Process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.

DIPR/CP/3361/Adverto/2026-27



SC: Cannot let pharma industry 'run amok' in name of free mkt

Is Commerce More Important Than Life Of Citizens: SC

AmitAnand.Choudhary
@timesofindia.com

"People are living in a daydream that someday they will benefit from the drugs prices control order (DPCO)... The policy is only to give benefit to the corporate. We are thinking from the point of view of poor patients," the bench observed

New Delhi: Observing that corporate interest cannot be given precedence over the life of citizens, Supreme Court on Tuesday said the pharma industry cannot be allowed to "run amok" in the name of the free market to fix the MRP of medicines at an exponentially high level, which in some cases happens to be more than 1,000% of the price at which they are sold to retailers.

Expressing anguish over the suffering of the common man who had to pay the price, a bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said that the court is "pained" by the "loot" and repeatedly asked the Centre to explain the rationale behind allowing a high MRP and who ultimately benefits from the policy. It reserved its order on plea to bring all non-patented medicines and medical consumables under price control mechanism like scheduled drugs

Additional solicitor general Aishwarya Bhati, who had to face a volley of questions from the bench, tried to convince the court that govt was aware of the problem and that was why it recently decided to cap the price of anti-cancer drugs. But the court responded that govt "woke up" only after it intervened and passed harsh observations on the prevailing system. She, however, said that the deliberation was already on and SC's intervention expedited it.

"People are living in a daydream that someday they will benefit from the drugs prices control order (DPCO)... The policy is only to give benefit to the corporate. We are thinking from the point of view of poor patients," the bench observed.

Bhati thereafter submitted that medicine prices in India are among the lowest in the world due to the free market and govt cannot take control of the entire pharma market, but the bench told her, "You are either not aware about the problem or not keen to solve the problem. Can you give one justification for keeping the MRP so high and where does the profit go... Why is the entire system working for the benefit of few people."

"The Indian drug market is fairly competitive, with a large number of pharmaceutical companies in every drug segment, resulting in one of the lowest prices in the world. Ordinarily, where there is substantial competition, there is no need to regulate prices. It is not that the govt has left the market unregulated but the complete control of the market is not feasible," Bhati said, adding that the issue pertains to economic policy and commerce and the court should desist from interfering.

Not convinced of the response, the bench said, "Should they (pharma companies) be allowed to run amok? What is the justification for the difference in prices? You are not able to come with an answer. We have asked you 30 times. Do not talk about control... You are talking about economic policy and commerce. Is commerce more important than the life of citizens and be given precedence?"

The court, during the hearing, said that the wife of a medical distributor of anti-cancer medicine got admitted to a reputed hospital in Delhi for cancer treatment and he requested the hospital to allow him to bring the injection as he was himself a dealer of the medicine, which comes at a dealer price of Rs 11,000. The hospital, however, refused his plea and charged Rs 1,30,000 for that injection.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for private hospitals, submitted that his clients charge MRP from patients and the excess amount is used for cross subsidisation for treatment of patients . But the bench said that the private hospitals can increase the charge for treatment and the common man should not suffer because of high MRP.

Nine TN prison officials suspended for negligence

▸ Continued from page 1

Efforts were on to trace the remaining four prisoners. DGP (prisons) Sandeep Rai Rathore attributed the escape to "human error" and a breach of security protocol. Nine prison staff have been suspended for negligence, while a detailed probe is underway into the circumstances that led to the jailbreak.

The incident has also exposed security lapses as the centralised siren system was not functioning when the inmates escaped. Opposition leaders targeted TVK govt, describing the escape of prisoners as a sign of total breakdown of law and order. Prisons dept minister CTR Nirmalkumar said govt would ensure that all the escaped prisoners were captured.

Preliminary inquiries revealed that five of the prisoners, accused in a murder case, had planned the escape and other inmates of their block joined them. Prison officials said one inmate faked an epileptic seizure around 10.30 pm on Monday. When a member of prison staff came to his rescue, other inmates threw a blanket over him, assaulted him and snatched the keys. They attacked other personnel, too, before fleeing through the main entrance. One prison guard was severely injured in the attack, while two others had minor injuries.

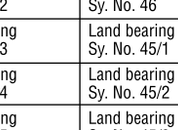
One of the escapees, Praveen Kumar, hid behind bushes near a watchtower outside the prison premises. He returned and sat near the tower, where police apprehended him. By then, 300-odd personnel were on the search operation and split into 17 teams.

STATOISTICS A slice of life in numbers

At 81, Lula is far from the oldest head of govt

Brazil's president Lula da Silva turned 81 today, just two days after winning re-election. Meanwhile, Israel goes to the polls with 77-year-old Benjamin Netanyahu seeking another term, putting the spotlight on elected leaders governing well beyond 75

Serving elected leaders of democracies aged 75+, Oct 2026



Source: Pew Research Center, Freedomhouse.org

Country	Leader	Age
Malawi	Peter Mutharika	86
Liberia	Joseph Boakai	81
Brazil	**Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva**	**81**
US	Donald Trump	80
Mauritius	Navin Ramgoolam	79
Malaysia	Anwar Ibrahim	79
Fiji	Sitiveni Rabuka	78
Israel	Benjamin Netanyahu	77
India	**Narendra Modi**	**76**

98 held in Assam crackdown on child marriage

A statewide overnight crackdown on child marriage led to the arrest of 98 people across Assam, including 64 in Dhubri district and 34 others in Nagaon, Boko, Chhaygaon and Bongaigaon. The operation targeted people allegedly linked to child marriages in line with the govt's intensified enforcement drive against the practice, police said on Tuesday. TNN

HC fines chief secy ₹1L over DA orders

Chandigarh: Punjab and Haryana HC Tuesday ordered Punjab chief secretary KAP Sinha to deposit costs of Rs 1 lakh for failing to file a status/compliance report on the dearness allowance (DA) case, observing that the "defiant attitude" adopted by govt respondents regarding compliance with its orders couldn't be ignored.

Justice Harsh Bunger also directed Sinha to file a personal affidavit by Oct 30 to explain the non-compliance of its earlier orders on release of pending DA and dearness relief instalments to state employees and pensioners.

The court is hearing a contempt petition filed by Nirmal Singh Dhanoa and others, alleging non-compliance with directions issued by a division bench on Aug 3 to Punjab govt and Punjab State Power Corporation Limited to release all pending DA/DR instalments to members of all-India Services serving in Punjab within a fortnight. TNN

Abbott Healthcare Private Limited
CIN: U24200MH1997PTC104834
3, Corporate Park, Sion-Trombay Road, Chembur, Mumbai – 400071
Telephone No.: +91-22-50461000 / 2000
Email: webmasterindia@abbott.com • Website: in.medicines.abbott

PUBLIC NOTICE

Abbott Healthcare Private Limited (Abbott) hereby informs its distributors, dealers, stockists, retailers, hospitals, health centres, and consumers that, pursuant to the **National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA)** Order **S.O. 5690(E) dated 17 October 2026** regarding **Trade Margin Rationalization (TMR)** of non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs, the prices of certain medicines marketed by Abbott will be reduced with effect from **9 November 2026.**

All dealers, retailers, hospitals, and medical institutions are requested to implement the revised **Maximum Retail Prices (MRPs)** and ensure that the benefit of the price reduction is passed on to consumers. Consumers are advised to verify the updated MRPs at the time of purchase. The list of relevant products, along with the **revised MRPs, can be accessed by scanning the QR code.**

PUBLIC NOTICE

We are investigating the title of landowners as detailed in the table below with respect to land parcels situated at Kaggaleepura Village, Uttarahalli - 2 Hobli, Bengaluru South Taluk, Bengaluru (more fully described in the schedule hereunder and hereinafter referred to as the "**Schedule Property**").

Any person having any right, title, claim or interest in the Schedule Property must notify the undersigned with documentary proof thereof within 15 days of this publication. In case no such notice is received by us within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice, it shall be presumed that the title of the landowners with respect to the Schedule Property is clear, marketable and free from encumbrance/s of any kind whatsoever and no person has any claim, right, title or interest of any nature whatsoever in respect of the Schedule Property or any part thereof. Claims or alleged interest, if any, which are not received within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice shall be deemed to have been waived and disregarded for all intents and purposes and shall not be binding on our client.

SCHEDULE PROPERTY

All that piece and parcel of land parcels situated at Kaggaleepura Village, Uttarahalli – 2 Hobli, Bengaluru South Taluk, Bengaluru totally admeasuring 14 Acres 23 Guntas and 10 Guntas of Kharab which is more fully detailed in the table herein below:

Converted Land Parcels									
Details of the land parcels						Boundaries			
Sl. Nos.	Survey Nos.	A	G	Kharab	Landowners	East	West	North	South
1.	44/1	1	-	-	Mrs. Gowramma, W/o. late (legal heirs of late Mrs. Nanjammma)	Land bearing Sy. No. 46	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/4	Land bearing Sy. No. 43/3	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/4
2.	44/2	1	20	-	Mr. H Nagaraj S/o. Mr. Hanumappa	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/4	Land bearing Sy. No. 386/1	Land bearing Sy. Nos. 44/3 & 44/4	Land bearing Sy. Nos. 45/1, 45/2, 45/3, 45/4 & 45/5
3.	44/4	1	30	-	Mr. A Macheal Raj S/o. late Mr. Anthoni Das	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/1 and 46	Land bearing Sy. Nos. 44/2 & 44/3	Land bearing Sy. Nos. 44/1 & 43/4	Land bearing Sy. Nos. 45/5 & 45/6
4.	45/1	-	05	-	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/2	Land bearing Sy. No. 46	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/2	Land bearing Sy. No. 46
5.	45/2	-	17	-	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/3	Land bearing Sy. No. 45/1	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/2	Land bearing Sy. No. 46
6.	45/3	-	14	-	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/4	Land bearing Sy. No. 45/2	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/2	Land bearing Sy. No. 46
7.	45/4	-	25.08	-	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/5	Land bearing Sy. No. 45/3	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/2	Land bearing Sy. No. 46
8.	45/5	-	19	-	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/6	Land bearing Sy. No. 45/4	Land bearing Sy. Nos. 44/2 & 44/4	Land bearing Sy. No. 46
9.	45/6	-	19	-	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.No. 46	Land bearing Sy. No. 45/5	Land bearing Sy. No. 44/4	Land bearing Sy. No. 46
10.	386/1	2	30.08	10	SLV Housing Development Corporation	Land bearing Sy.Nos. 44/2 & 44/3	Land bearing Sy.No. 386/2	Land bearing Sy.Nos.41 & 42	Land bearing Sy.No.46
11.	426	1	-	-	Mr. H Nagaraj S/o. Mr. Hanumappa	Land bearing Sy.No. 386/2	Land bearing Sy.No. 427 & 46	Land bearing Sy.No.387	Land bearing Sy.No.46
12.	427	1	-	-	Mr. H Nagaraj S/o. Mr. Hanumappa	Land bearing Sy.No. 426 & 41	Land bearing Sy.No. 46	Land bearing Sy.No. 387	Land bearing Sy.No. 46
Agricultural Land Parcels									
	Details of the land parcels					Boundaries			
13.	386/2	2	28.08	-	Mr. H Nagaraj S/o. Mr. Hanumappa	Land bearing Sy.Nos. 386/1	Land bearing Sy.No. 426	Land bearing Sy.No. 41	Remaining portion of Sy.No. 46
14.	44/2	-	04	-	Mr. Hanumappa son of Mr. Thayappa	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 44/2	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 44/2	Land bearing No. 44/2	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 45
15.	45/1	-	01	-	Mrs. Venkatamma & Others	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/2	Land bearing Sy.No. 46	Land bearing Sy.No. 44/2	Land bearing Sy.No. 46
16.	45/4	-	1.08	-	Mrs. Venkatamma & Others	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/5	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/3	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 45/4	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 45/4
17.	45/6	-	08	-	Mrs. Muniyellamma & Others	Land bearing Sy.No. 46	Land bearing Sy.No. 45/5	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 45/6	Remaining portion of land in Sy.No. 45/6

Place : Bengaluru
Date : 28.10.2026

Gerald Manoharan, Partner, JSA, Advocates,
18th Floor, SKAV 909, No. 9/1,
Residency Road Richmond Circle,
Bengaluru 560 025, Karnataka, India.
Ph. +91 80 4350 3600/ +91 80 4350 3617

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client has intended to purchase the portion of immovable property bearing converted Sy. No. 70, old Khatha No. 232 and 234, New No. 132, Old CMC Khatha No. 362, BBMP Khatha No. 386/1/383/362/70, presently coming under the limits of GBA of Jaraganahalli Ward (Ward No. 186) having E Aasthi Property No. 386/1/383/362/70, EPID No. 9879780600, situated at Kanakapura Main Road, Jaraganahalli Village, Uttarahalli Hobli, Bangalore South Taluk, measuring East to West 10.00 Meters or 32.781 Feet and North to South 44.085 Meters or 144.75 Feet, totally measuring 440.85 Square Meters or 4745 Square Feet, together with a commercial building constructed thereon having total super built up area around 1998.76 square meters or 21514 square feet, comprising of Basement floor 3244 square feet, Ground floor 4035 square feet, 1st Floor 4745 square feet, 2nd floor 4745 square feet, and 3rd floor 4745 square feet from its present owner **M/s. MANOI INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED**, A Private Limited Company having its registered office at No. 72/2, Ground Floor, Railway Parallel Road, Kumarapark West, Bengaluru - 560020 Represented by its Directors **MR. SHARASCHANDRA SANIL B.** and **MR. ROHANTH S.**

The said owners represented that the they are the absolute owners of the said Property and apart from them, no other person/s, having any right, title or interest. They further represented that they have not entered into any agreement of sale with anyone and the said property is not mortgaged or charged to anybody else by them to any third person/s or Banks. Any person/s, having any claim, interest or right over the above said Property may contact or write to the undersigned with documentary proof to substantiate such claim/s or interest within **Seven (7) days** from the date of this publication. In the absence of any such claim or objection within the stipulated time, it will be construed that there is no one having any claims or objection on the said Property and my client will proceed with the sale transaction.

H. NAGESH. Advocate,
No. 46, Z Plaza 2nd Main, Sheshadripuram,
Bangalore-20. Mob: 9902201565, 9448625402.
Place: Bangalore Date: 27/10/2026

HBSU
Dr Homi Bhabha State University, Mumbai
The Search-cum-Selection Committee invites Applications/Nominations for
THE POST OF VICE-CHANCELLOR

Applications/Nominations are invited for the post of Vice-Chancellor, Dr Homi Bhabha State University, Mumbai. Candidates who fulfil the prescribed qualifications and experience may submit applications in the prescribed format to the Nodal Officer on Email ID: **nodal_sesc@hbsu.ac.in** on or before **Monday, 28th November, 2026.** The application format and other details are available on the website: **www.hbsu.ac.in**. The candidates are also required to submit two (02) hard copies of the application, along with supporting documents (to a maximum of 50 pages) by post. so as to reach on or before **15th December, 2026** at the following address:

The Nodal Officer (Search-cum-Selection Committee – VC).
Dr. Homi Bhabha State University,
Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Chowk, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai-400 032.

Eminent Persons/Peers may also nominate suitable candidates in the prescribed format (A soft copy by email and two hard copies of the same on the above address as well). The timeline and other conditions for the nominations will remain the same as for other applicants. Applications received after the due date shall not be considered.

Date: 28/10/2026

Chairman
Search-cum-Selection Committee

DGIPR/2026-2027/3416

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY
Yelahanka, BANGALORE - 560 064
Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER & TENDER NOTICE No.: RWF/PCEE/EL/TD/2026-27/07 dt: 24.10.26

E-Tender: On behalf of the President of India, Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer invites E-Tenders for the work of **"Provision of Outdoor Lighting System at RWF"** on IREPS E-Portal **http://www.ireps.gov.in(Works).**

Estimated Cost: Rs. 1,05,56,240/-; **EMD:** Rs. 2,11,100/-; **Due Date & Time:** 17.11.26 @ 15:00 Hrs.

Detailed Tender Notice, Tender documents, Eligibility Criteria & corrigendum (if any) will be available in IREPS E-Portal/RWF website.

Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer

INSTITUTE FOR SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC CHANGE
Dr. V.K.R.V. Rao Road, Nagarabhavi P.O., Bangalore - 560 072.

Advertisement No. A/1/2026 **27th October 2026**

APPLICATIONS ARE INVITED FROM THE ELIGIBLE CANDIDATES FOR THE FOLLOWING BACKLOG FACULTY POSTS

Sl. No.	Designation	Pay and Academic Level	No. of Posts	Reserved for	
				SC	ST
1.	Professor	Rs. 1,44,200/- (Academic Level 14)	3	2	1
2.	Associate Professor	Rs.1,31,400/- (Academic Level 13A)	2	-	2

The detailed advertisement and procedure for applying for the above posts is available at our Website: **www.isec.ac.in.**

The last date for receipt of applications is hereby extended upto **16th November 2026**

DIPR/CP/3358/Shirdi Sai/2026-27 **Sd/- Registrar ISEC**

INTERNATIONAL FINANCIAL SERVICES CENTRES AUTHORITY
Building ID 12-B, Block-12, Zone-1, Road-1A,
GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat

File No. 73/IFSCA/Consultants/2020-21 **October 26, 2026**

VACANCY NOTIFICATION

International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA), a statutory unified regulatory body under the Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India, invites applications for the following positions at GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat:

1. Young Professionals/consultants on contract basis. Advt. dated 09.10.2026
2. Executive Director on deputation/contract basis. Advt. dated 19.10.2026

2. The candidates willing to apply are requested to refer **www.ifsca.gov.in/career** for detailed vacancy notification/s and corrigenda issued. The last date for receipt of application along with requisite documents by post is 16.11.2026 by 6.00 PM.

General Manager
CBC 15228/11/0003/2627 **Dept. of General Administration**

भारतीय गुणवत्ता परिषद्
QUALITY COUNCIL OF INDIA
Creating an Ecosystem for Quality

The Quality Council of India (QCI) is a premier autonomous body set up by Government of India. QCI is responsible for creating a Quality Mindset and envisions to ensure quality across products and services that touch every citizen. As an independent and autonomous body, QCI creates a mechanism for independent third-party assessments of products, services, and processes, coordinating its activities through its constituent boards and divisions. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce & Industry, serves as the nodal point for QCI.

QCI hereby invites proposals for:

1. **Engagement of an implementation agency for Setting up Chemical Section of Food Testing laboratory on turn-key basis – GEM/2026/B/8195653**
2. **Engagement of an Implementation agency for Setting Up of Microbiology Section of Food Laboratory on turn-key basis – GEM/2026/B/8195423**

The Request for Proposal (RFP) document along with detailed set of requirements may be found on GeM portal: **https://gem.gov.in/** and QCI's website: **www.qcin.org** under the tenders' section **(https://qcin.org/work-with-us/#tenders)**.

Interested parties may submit their proposals in accordance with the guidelines provided in the RFP/bid document on GeM portal.

QCI'S BOARDS AND DIVISIONS
NABCB NABH NABL NABET PADD PPID NDIE Strategy & Policy ONDC FOUNDED & SUPPORTED BY QCI

Quality Council of India, World Trade Center, J-200, Block J, Narouji Nagar, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi- 110029
@QualityCouncilofIndia @QualityCouncil qualitycouncilofindia quality-council-of-india-qci- info@qcin.org

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Commissioner, RHB Colony, ITPL Main Road, Mahadevapura, Bengaluru-560048.

No: BECC-LADR0OTH/10/2026-LAQ TDR/ E-209209 /2026-27 **FORM – III (See Sub-rule (3) of rule-3)** **Date: 22.10.2026**

PUBLIC NOTICE

In exercise of powers conferred under section **14-B of the Karnataka Town and Country Planning Act,1961** the following 'Area' mentioned in the schedule below is required by the Commissioner, Bangalore East City Corporation for the public purpose of **Widening of Varanasi Main Road from TC Palya Main Road (Aneppa Circle) to Varanasi village Boundary (upto BBMP Limit) As per RMP-2015 and for a length of 18.00 mtrs** (Corrigendum Notification No: BBMP/ C.Comm/ PSR (G)/1293/2025-26, Date: 30.08.2025)

The following land / building owners have opted for Development Rights **in lieu of** monetary compensation under the Right to Fair Compensation and transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013. The Development Rights will be given by the Authority as twice the land area surrendered and two times the building area surrendered and as estimated by the value of the building area surrendered (valuated as per PWD norms) divided by the market value of the land on which the building is constructed.

The public is hereby informed about the below details of the land and land owners and interested persons whose lands are required for the public purpose and Development Right Certificate (DRCs) are to be issued in lieu of monetary compensation. Any objections and suggestions are to be addressed to the O/o the Deputy Commissioner (Land Acquisition and TDR), Bengaluru East City Corporation, RHB Colony, ITPL Main Road, Mahadevapura, Bengaluru-560048. within thirty days from the date of publication of this Notification.

List of land / building area surrendered and land owners for which DRC is to be issued.

Name of the District: **Bengaluru Urban** Name of the Taluk: **Bengaluru East** Name of the Village: **Varanasi**

Sy.No/ Katha No.	Type of Land		Nature of Land			Dimension of the land / plot and extent in Sq.m		Boundaries of the land / plot				Building Details			Present activity on land/ Building (Specify Specific activity such as shop, office, factory, apartment, individual house etc.,	Market (guide lines) value of the land per Sq.m	Name and address of the owner of the plot/ land for which DRC is to be issued
	Vacant	Built up	Agriculture	Converted undeveloped	Approved layout / Developed land Building Site	Dimension	Extent	East	West	North	South	Extent in Sq.m	Type of Construction and No. of floors	Floor Area Ratio			
Sy No:1/4 EPID 6650751208	Vacant Land		Residential Converted Land			155.80		Remaining Portion Of Sy No 1/4	Remaining Portion of Sy No 1/4 & EPID No EPID no. 6650751208 & EPID No 3058061332	Remaining Portion of Sy No ¼ & EPID no. 5777688224	Sy No . 1/3	None	None	None	Vacant	40,000/-	N Paramesh S/o Late B Narayanappa No.32, Joddidar Nilaya, 2 Floor, Opposite Kangaroo Kids Pree School, Kanaka Nagara Main Road, Varanasi Village, K R Pura Post, Bengaluru-560036

Note: Market/ guideline value of this property is considered subject to conditions of payment of fee as per Government Order No: ನಅಇ 137 ಎಂಎನ್‌ಯು 2024 (ಇ), ದಿನಾಂಕ: 09.09.2024 and as per the Circular No: ಆಯುಕ್ತರು/ಜಿ.ಎಸ್.ಆರ್/ಜಿ/1802/2024–25, ದಿನಾಂಕ: 21.09.2024.

Commissioner
Bangalore East City Corporation

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)

Office of the Special Land Acquisition-1, No. 39, Shanti Gruha,
Scouts & Guides Building, 4th Floor, Palace Road, Bengaluru-560 001.

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTIFICATION UNDER SECTION 28(1) OF THE KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT ACT, 1966

The properties mentioned in the Schedule below are required by the Government of Karnataka for the purpose of the Metro Project, for the development of the area from J.P. Nagar 4th Phase to Mysore Road Metro Station under **Bengaluru Metro Rail Project, Phase 3, Package 1,** through the Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board.

This notification is published with the intention of acquiring the said properties in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 28(1) of the Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Act, 1966 (Act No. 18 of 1966).

All persons interested in the said properties are hereby cautioned not to prevent or obstruct any person from carrying out work on these lands under Section 35 of the aforesaid Act.

After the date of publication of this notification, the said properties shall not be disposed of, nor shall any agreement be entered into for their sale, lease, exchange or otherwise, without the permission of the Special Land Acquisition Officer-1, KIADB, Palace Road, Bengaluru. Further, no buildings shall be constructed, nor shall any other development works be undertaken on the said properties after the publication of this notification. In the event of any such construction or development, the same shall not be taken into consideration while determining the compensation, and the properties shall ultimately be acquired.

A copy of the plan of these lands has been kept for scrutiny at the Office of The Special Land Acquisition Officer-1, Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board, No. 39, KIADB, Bharat Scouts and Guides Building, "Shanti Gruha", 4th Floor, Palace Road, Bengaluru - 560 001. Details of the Lands for Acquisition are as below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Khatedar	Name of Anubhavadar	Identification No.	LA/City Survey No.	BBMP PropertyNo./ PID No.	Acquisition Area (in Sq. Mtr.)
	Viaduct, Ramp, Parking **Village: Bilekahalli Hobli: Beguru Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban**					
1.	1. C.M. Srinivas 2. V. Prasanna 3. M.V. Manjunatha 4. C.M. Rajanna	1. Ramanashree Properties 2. M/s Mandovi Motors	C1-08A	76 170	57-137-1 57-137-2	126.25 1322.47 **1448.72**
	Total (A)					**1,448.72**
	Village: Sarakki Agrahara Hobli: Beguru Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban					
2.	Kumari D.R. Sirigowri	Kumari D.R. Sirigowri	C1-11	20/5	4449011531 57-166-8	30.69
3.	Y. Hema W/o Nagaraj	Domino's Pizza / Brand Crest Holdings	C1-12	20/5	57-166-7	38.94
4.	1. Savithri Sathyanarayana W/o N.S. Sathyanarayana 2. S. Sathyanarayana S/o Seetharamaiah N.; 3. Vivek S. Nittoor S/o Sathyanarayana Nittoor	Residential Houses	C1-13	20/5	57-166-5	13.67
5.	1. Syed Siraj Ahmed 2. Syed Kabir Ahmed 3. Syed Junaid Ahmed	1. Syed Siraj Ahmed 2. Syed Kabir Ahmed 3. Syed Junaid Ahmed	C1-14	20/5	57-166-4 7064856051	46.15
6.	Suresh Kumar Agarwal S/o Govind Ram Agarwal	1. Tea Day Shop 2. K.C. Das Shop 3. Sapthagiri Astrology 4. Clean Over Dry Shop; 5. Healings Homeopathy	C1-15	20/5	57-166-1	46.17
7.	Karnataka State Cooperative Apex Bank Ltd., represented by Jangamappa	Karnataka State Cooperative Apex Bank Ltd., represented by Jangamappa	C1-24	20/3	57-164-636	68.38
8.	T. Narayana	T. Narayana	C1-23	20/3	57-164-635	20.40
9.	1. Suma N. Shetty 2. R.Nagaraj Santhosh	R. Nagaraju	C1-22	20/3	57-164-634	49.13
10.	M.N.R. Gowda and Ajay Gowda	Shekhar Eye Hospital	C1-21	20/4	57-164-633	63.32
11.	S. Prasad	**Ground Floor:** 1. Chaitanya Cafe; **1st and 2nd Floors:** 2. Sri Guru Enterprises	C1-20	20/4	57-164-135/15	4.45
12.	1. K. Bhaskar Raju 2. Ashwin Bhaskar Raju 3. Kumari Khushi B. Raju; 4. Master Dhruva B. Raju	1. Acro Lab 2. Life Science Possibility 3. Big Heart	C1-16	19/3 19/4	57-316-11/1	72.67
13.	1. Sri Ashwin Shetty 2. Nishali Rai 3. Aditya N. Rai 4. Ritika Shetty 5. For Axis Infinity: R. Harish Babu and 6. Jayanti A.N.	1. Nenapu 2. Saira Style Studio	C1-17	19/1	57-316-12	73.55
14.	C. Chandrappa	H.C. Neeravari, S/o Late Sri Chandrappa	C1-18	19/1	57-316-13	9.80
15.	1. Keshava Murthy P.C., S/o Chennigaraayappa 2. Arpoova	Adalco LLP (Levels), Pub and Kitchen	C1-19	18	2579834885 57-316-14	46.74
16.	1. M.S. Samyuktha 2. M.N. Satish	Stanley Sofas and More	C1-28	14	57-108-683/A	60.18
17.	1. K.S. Ganesh 2. Sunitha Ganesh	Solitone	C1-28A	14, 15/1	57-108-683	13.47
18.			C1-27A	15/1		5.40
19.	Gautam Reddy	Indian Oil Petrol Bunk	C1-27	15/1	57-108-682	68.67
20.	S. Shanthi	S. Shanthi	C1-26	15/1	57-108-681	44.69
21.	S.A.L. Vinay	Ditto Tacterial Consultancy Pvt. Ltd.	C1-25	15/1	57-108-680	22.98
22.	1. A. Chennareddy S/o A. Guruvi Reddy, 2. A.G. Harinath Reddy S/o A. Chennareddy, 3. P. Lakshmidevi D/o Bhaskar Reddy A., 4. Tanu S. Reddy D/o P. Jagannath Reddy, 5. Veena S. Reddy D/o P. Jagannath Reddy	1. A. Chennareddy S/o A. Guruvi Reddy, 2. A.G. Harinath Reddy S/o A. Chennareddy, 3. P. Lakshmidevi D/o Bhaskar Reddy A., 4. Tanu S. Reddy D/o P. Jagannath Reddy, 5. Veena S. Reddy D/o P. Jagannath Reddy	C1-31	21/2	2777064812	27.64
23.	1. Binod H.R. S/o Late H.S. Rangadore, 2. Sai Ram S.	Ranga Nilaya	C1-32	21/2	57-208-11	39.77
24.	Vivek Ramanujapuram	Century Arena	C1-33	21/2	57-208-12	40.81
25.	Dr. M. Doreswamy Naidu S/o M. Perumal Naidu	Federal Bank	C1-34	21/2	57-208-13	43.13
26.	N.S. Nagaraj	S.S. Nagaraj	C1-35	21/2	57-208-14	47.17
27.	R. Sridhar S/o K. Rajanna	SBI Bank, J.P. Nagar	C1-36	21/2	57-208-15	49.82
28.	1. Sri. Abhinay V. S/o Venkata Shivareddy V. 2. Smt. L. Monica W/o Abhinay V.	Delhi Public School	C1-37	21/2	57-208-16	48.78
29.	B.S. Ashwath Narayana S/o Late B.S. Sundar Rao	Maple House	C1-38	21/2	57-208-597	49.40
30.	M/s P.N.B. Realty Limited, represented by M.D. V.G.P. Babu Das	Auric Hotel	C1-38A	21/2	57-208-598	66.87
31.	S.M. Sundar Raju	S.M. Sundar Raju	C1-39A	21/1	57-50-780	24.18
32.	Sampritha Kantharaju W/o B.S. Kantharaju	Sampritha Kantharaju W/o B.S. Kantharaju	C1-39	21/1	57-50-779	22.39
33.	M/s M.C. Credé Software Pvt. Ltd. (Asia Pvt. Ltd.)	M/s M.C. Credé Software Pvt. Ltd. (Asia Pvt. Ltd.)	C1-40	21/1	57-50-778	32.77
34.	M/s Suvarna Family Trust	Shell Petrol Bunk	C1-41	21/1	57-50-777	36.47
35.	Ajay Kumar Agarwal S/o Late Harish Kumar Agarwal	Ajay Kumar Agarwal S/o Late Harish Kumar Agarwal	C1-42	21/1	57-50-776	37.33
36.	1. Savita Machani Somanna 2. Kavita Gautam Jayaram 3. Anita Ramanath 4. M.S. Nanda Prakash 5. Nesar Budanur Shivaram 6. M.S. Bhagirathi	1. Savita Machani Somanna 2. Kavita Gautam Jayaram 3. Anita Ramanath 4. M.S. Nanda Prakash 5. Nesar Budanur Shivaram 6. M.S. Bhagirathi	C1-43	21/1	57-50-775	37.48
37.	Sunil Rander S/o Shyam Sundar Rander	Absarment Montessori School	C1-44	21/1	57-50-774	15.42
38.	Mani M. Rai	Mani M. Rai	C1-38 B	21/2	Property No. 599	53.64
39.	Kannan R.	Kannan R.	C1-38C	21/2	Property No. 600 / 3108381651	48.25
40.	M/s M.C. Credé Software (Asia) Pvt. Ltd., represented by Soundarya Raghu	1. The Cake Shop 2. Sky Line Pizzeria	C1-38D	21/2	8671605491	44.08
41.	1. Umaswamy; 2. Aarathi S. Kamath	The Big Market	C1-38E	21/2	Property No. 602 / 2847328791	22.06
42.	M/s Jagadale Industrial Pvt. Ltd.	M/s Jagadale Industrial Pvt. Ltd.	C1-38F	21/1	3911246101 & 3353368810	23.54
43.	M/s Jagadale Industrial Pvt. Ltd.	M/s Jagadale Industrial Pvt. Ltd.	C1-38G			35.59
44.	M/s Jagadale Industrial Pvt. Ltd.	M/s Jagadale Industrial Pvt. Ltd.	C1-38H			27.06
	Total (B)					**1,673.10**
	J.P. Nagar Metro Station & FOB **Village: Sarakki Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban**					
45.	Passage	Passage	ST 03-19	50/2	-	10.67
46.	P.C. Dhananjay S/o P. Chinnaswamy Naidu	P.C. Dhananjay S/o P. Chinnaswamy Naidu	ST 03-13	50/2	57-265-13	4.81
47.	Ashwin P. Tallam S/o Prem Kumar Radhakrishna Tallam	Ashwin P. Tallam S/o Prem Kumar Radhakrishna Tallam	ST 03-18	50/2	57-265-12	43.17
48.	Somanna	Maruti Industries	ST 03-17 (A)	50/2	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	108.50
	M. Ushareddy D/o Late U. Munireddy		ST 03-17(B)	50/2	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	139.78
	M. Lalithareddy D/o Late U. Munireddy		ST 03-17 (C)	50/2	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	149.01
	M. Sathya Reddy S/o Late U. Munireddy		ST 03-17 (D)	50/2	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	76.95
	N. Shobharani D/o Nagesh Reddy		ST 03-17 (E)	50/2	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	78.99
	N. Umesh Reddy S/o Nagesh Reddy		ST 03-17 (F)	50/2	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	80.95
	N. Vishwanath & N. Chandrashekar, sons of Nagesh Reddy		ST 03-17 (G)	50/2, 46	Site No. 18; 57-264-46	36.85 77.63 **114.48**
49.	1. Leela Reddy M.	Car Shed	ST-03-20	50/2	Site Nos. 14, 15	28.46 28.01
	2. Somanath	Lakshmi Venkateshwara Nilaya	ST-03-20(A)	50/2	Site No. 11A	18.72
	3. M. Devendra	Car Shed Garage	ST-03-20(B)	50/2	Site Nos. 10, 11	28.48 28.37
	1. Ramesh R. Patel 2. Amrit Lal R. Patel 3. Dilip R. Patel 4. Vijay Kumar R. Patel	1. Ramesh R. Patel 2. Amrit Lal R. Patel 3. Dilip R. Patel 4. Vijay Kumar R. Patel	ST-03-20(C)	50/2	Site Nos. 6 and 7	28.20 28.20
	5. Ajjappa Varalakshmi	Ajjappa Varalakshmi	ST-03-20(D)	50/2	Site No. 3	22.35 32.42
	6. Thyagaraja Cooperative Bank Ltd.	Thyagaraja Cooperative Bank Ltd.	ST-03-20(E)	50/2	Site No. 2	27.82
	Total (C)					**1,078.34**
	Kadirenahalli Metro Station, Ramp & Pillar **Village: Jaraganahalli Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban**					
50.	Sri Syed Zaheeruddin Husaini S/o S.F.R. Husaini	1. T.M. Timbers Furniture Shop 2. Modern Furniture 3. Karnataka Dalit Sangharsha Samiti 4. H.K.G.N. Traders	C1-446 C1-446A C1-446B	46/2	55-927-51	3.28 29.27 6.74 **39.29**
51.	Swaminathan S/o Chikka Swamigowder and Kasturi W/o Late C. Ramu	Furniture Scrap Shops	C1-449	58	-	343.62
52.	Geological Survey of India (GSI)	Geological Survey of India (GSI)	C1-450	56	-	211.03
53.	Sri Banashankaramma Goddess Bengaluru Development Authority	Sri Banashankaramma Goddess	ST 04-07	63/2	-	988.14
	Total (D)					**1,582.08**
	Village: Kadirenahalli Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban					
54.	B.R. Sudeesh Kumar	Navarit Technology Pvt. Ltd.	C1-464	6/2J1	55-160-9	7.92
	Total (E)					**7.92**
	Viaduct and Road Widening **Village: Karisandra Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban**					
55.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike – Stormwater Drain	C1-471	29/13	-	112.66
56.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	C1-472A	30	-	63.77
57.			C1-472B		-	6.26
58.			C1-472C		-	33.97
59.			C1-473		-	9.36
60.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	C1-472	29/13, 30	-	11.23
61.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	C1-69	30	-	59.56
62.			C1-69B	30 (Kadire-nahalli-3)	-	131.30
63.			C1-69C	30	-	23.77
	Total (F)					**451.88**
	Kamakhya Metro Station, Viaduct, Ramp **Village: Kathriguppe Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban**					
64.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Chairperson, Regional Institute of Cooperative Management Kunnirukatte C/o Training College	C1-475	67	55-23-CA1	22.85
65.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Assistance	C1-477A	-	-	49.20
66.	1. Y.A. Subramanyam S/o Late Y.S. Adinarayana Shetty 2. Y.A. Shivakumar S/o Late Y.S. Adinarayana Shetty 3. Y.A. Balachandra S/o Late Y.S. Adinarayana Shetty	Sofas and More Stanley	C1-477	63/2	Site No. 311; 55-699-311	63.53
67.	Shivalingaiah M.	Ferment Energy TVS	C1-478	63/2	55-699-310	59.66
68.	Chandrashekhar I.R.	Residential House	C1-74	63/1	55-699-300	4.00
69.	Ruthvik Krishnamurthy	Federal Bank	C1-75	61, 63/1	55-699-299	16.22
70.	P. Ramesh	Mia by Tanishq	C1-76	61	55-699-298	16.80
71.	Smt. Lakshmi Iyengar, W/o M.S. Iyengar	1. Indian Bank 2. Baby Hub	C1-77	61	55-699-297	18.03
72.	E. Girija	Reliance Jewels	C1-78	61	55-699-296	18.94
73.	K.M. Vadiraj Hebbar	1. Cake of the Day 2. Brahmin Mane Tindi	C1-79	61	55-699-295/1	19.68
74.	Siddalingeshwara Enterprises, represented by K.S. Tontadappa	1. Siddalingeshwara Kalyana Mantapa 2. The Carpenter Concept	C1-79A	60	55-699-294	14.36
75.	Dr. T.R. Prem Kumar	1. Triumph 2. Popular Bajaj	C1-79B	60	55-699-293	14.89
76.	S.V.C. Co-operative Bank Pvt. Ltd.	C.V.C. Co-operative Bank Pvt. Ltd.	C1-79C	60	55-699-292	15.19
77.	M.S. Chandrashekhar Nair	M.S. Chandrashekhar Nair	C1-79D	60	3370821691, Site No. 291 and 1537394547	15.46
78.	T.K. Nityananda	**Ground Floor:** 1. Sri Ganesh Juice and Condiments 2. Pan Shop **First Floor:** 3. Linnet Bar and Restaurant	C1-80	60	4632146317	37.77
79.	1. Sridhar B.K. 2. Andal Sridhar	1. Tyre Care Centre 2. G.K. Iyengar Tower 3. Pratibha Mehta & Co.	C1-81	60	56-198-1/Y	39.23
80.	1. Nanjappa K.R. and Lilavathi B.R.; 2. K. Mithun and K.N. Prajwal, sons of Nanjappa K.R. ; 3. Dr. Richa Paul	**Basement:** 1. ACT Fibernet Ground Floor: 2. Nanjundeshwara Medicals 3. Union Bank and ATM 4. Benaka Enterprises; **First Floor:** 5. Navishka Women and Children Centre **Second Floor:** 6. Cricbuzz Platforms Limited	C1-82	60	56-198-190/B; 56-198-190/B-1	84.34
81.	1. K. Venugopal, S/o K. Kannayya Naidu; 2. V. Varalakshmi, W/o K. Venugopal	**Ground Floor:** 1. Kotak Mahindra Bank and ATM **First Floor:** 2. Eat Fit Cake Office 3. Food Delivery Office **Second Floor:** 4. New International Spa	C1-83	60 61	56-239-59	55.70
82	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike	C1-84	61	-	300.92
83.	1. B.N. Suresh; 2. B.N. Srinath 3. B.N. Srirangarajan 4. B.N. Srivatsa	1. IFB Points; 2. You Look Great; 3. Chimmie's Gallery	C1-79E	60	4276645678 55-699-290	15.73
84.	Manjula Venkatramanan, W/o Dr. V.K. Venkatramanan	Saraswati Villa	C1-79F	60	55-699-289	17.10
85.	A.R. Ramaprasad, S/o A.S. Ranganatha Shetty	1. Titan World 2. Helios	C1-79G	60	1154391437	19.53
86.	Dr. Kattoola Srinivasa Nanda Kishan	Carrot Line	C1-79H	60	2740770084	21.97
87.	Pooja Amruth Sampige @ 1. Pooja B. Chatlani 2. Naina P. Chatlani 3. Nishka P. Chatlani	Kalyan Jewellers	C1-79I	60 54	4081345716; Property No. 286	24.43

88.	A.H. Ramarao	Rama Nivasa	C1-79J	54	3910140829; Property No. 285	25.53
89.	1. V. Chandrashekhar Reddy 2. Lakshmi Shekhar 3. Manjunath C. 4. Shwetha S.	Snitch Cloth Shop	C1-79K	54	2276018867	14.53
90.	1. Balareddy Seetharamaiah, Ramakrishna 2. K.C. Vijayamma	**Basement:** 1. Timber Dye **Ground Floor:** 2. Aaruhi Handloom 3. Pan Shop Ground, **First and Second Floors:** 4. Paradise Premium Restaurant	C1-79L	54	8146723563	26.43
91.	M.S. Jaganath S/o M.J. Sampath Iyengar	1. Kurlon Homes 2. B. Iyengar Bakery	C1-79M	54	5288834746; Property No. 169/Y	32.70
92.	1. Mekala; 2. G. Praveen Kumar	1. Airtel 2. Looking Good Furniture	C1-79N	54 60	5944314289	68.47
93.	Aruna D.R.	**Ground Floor:** 1. Kanthi Sweets **Ground and First Floors:** 2. Clove Dental; **Second Floor:** 3. Premier Neurology Clinic	C1-79O	60	3818782926	36.84
94.	1. G. Nagarathna 2. C.S. Jayalakshmi 3. G. Vasudeva Rao 4. Bharathi C.S.	1. G. Nagarathna 2. C.S. Jayalakshmi 3. G. Vasudeva Rao 4. Bharathi C.S.	C1-79P	60	Property No. 57Y; 1636788676	36.48
95.	Anand Rao A. S/o Late A. Ananth Ramaiah	Prajna Brain and Mind Clinic	ST 05-07	55	55-699-281	2.56
96.	1. Shiva Kumar 2. V. Swapna	1. Shiva Kumar 2. V. Swapna	ST 05-09	46	54-96-241/A; 8008578494	3.90
97.	V. Murali S/o G. Venkatappa	1. M.R. Traders, 2. Hotel 3. Shops	ST 05-10	45	-	13.75
98.	BMTC Depot	BMTC Depot	ST 05-11	46, 53	-	28.23
	Total (G)					**1,254.95**

Viaduct and Ramp
Village: Ittamadu Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban

99.	1. Dr. B. Manjunath 2 Tanuja	Dr. B. Manjunath	C1-87L	8	Property No.: 04 2634726267	0.91
100.	Subhadra Devi P.B.	**Ground Floor:** Flipkart Minutes **2nd Floor:** Assets Square **3rd Floor:** RASP & Associates LLP	C1-87K	8	6095018824; Property No. 03	21.02
101.	1. Dr. H.R. Nataraj 2. Tanushree Nataraj	**Ground Floor:** 1. Van Heusen 2. Mahindra Kotak Bank 3. Ramaiah Pinnacle **1st and 2nd Floors:** 4. Agarwal Eye Hospital	C1-87J	8	Property No. 2; 1182827159	29.66
102.	N. Muniyappa	N. Muniyappa	C1-87I	9	55-445-001 3291466152	31.51
103.	Dr. S. Gurumurthy	1. Curtains & More 2. Happy Times Pre-School and Day Care	C1-87H	9	Property No. 1A; 5900080014	21.77
104.			C1-87G			24.01
105.	Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike (BBMP)	Sterling Terraces Apartment	C1-87F	9 6	-	68.20
106.	N.R. Basavaraju	N.R. Basavaraju	C1-87E	6	3383884093; Old PID: 55-445-79	24.59
107.	1. Concorde Tower Private Limited / Concordes Tower LLP; 2. H.B. Susheelamma	Dr. Heal Pain Relief Hospital	C1-87S	7	Property Nos. 208 & 209; 4296244411 & 1165594973	57.18
108.	1. S.R. Rajesh 2. S.R. Srinivasa Gupta 3. S.R. Praveen 4. N.P. Raghavendra 5. N. Purushotham 6. N. Suryanarayana 7. K. Ramkumar 8. K. Muralidhar 9. N.R. Divya	1. S.R. Rajesh 2. S.R. Srinivasa Gupta 3. S.R. Praveen 4. N.P. Raghavendra 5. N. Purushotham 6. N. Suryanarayana 7. K. Ramkumar 8. K. Muralidhar 9. N.R. Divya	C1-87RA	7	Property No. 210; 3242217419	28.56
109.	T. Krishnarao	T. Krishnarao	C1-87R	7	Property No. 211; 3289581839	29.51
110.	M/S. MASTER COM TECHNOLOGY SERVICES INDIA PVT. LTD. REPRESENTED BY. ITS DIRECTOR	M/S. MASTER COM TECHNOLOGY SERVICES INDIA PVT. LTD. REPRESENTED BY. ITS DIRECTOR	C1-87Q	7	Property No. 212; 5162240808	30.28
111.	K.R. Nanda	Clamshell Mount	C1-87P	8	Property No. 213; 2301600156	29.66
112.	Yashodhara Kalegowda	Ode Spa Wellness	C1-87O	8	Property No. 214	27.97
113.	R. Subramanyam Iyer	OVUM Fertility Hospital	C1-87N	8	Property No. 215	24.65
114.	Dr. Yatindra Siddaramaiah	OVUM Fertility Hospital	C1-87M	8	Property No. 216/A; 3861484097	4.28
115.	Saraswathi	C.K. Furniture	C1-87D	6	Property No. 78; 7726001640	14.36
116.	1. Anand Puttaswamy 2. Rohini Anand	**Ground Floor:** 1. IDFC Bank 2. Oben Electric 3. Loon Thai Spa	C1-87C	6	Property No. 77; 1121466321	13.93
117.	Shivamurthy B. Hiremath	**Ground Floor:** 1. Pawn Shop 2. Tele Solution **Ground, First and Second Floors:** 3. Mandara Bar and Restaurant	C1-87B	7	Property No. 76; 4481814544	16.76
118.	BBMP Assistant Engineer's Office, Hosakerehalli	1. BBMP Toilet 2. Sri Lavanya Condiments 3. Bengaluru One	C1-87A	7	-	47.00
119.	C. Shivakumar	**Ground Floor:** 1. Mailari Biryani 2. The Mirrormens and Womens Beauty Salon **First Floor:** 3. K.C.S. Party Hall	C1-87	7	55-445-06/1 4817174583	17.40
120.	A. Renukumar S/o Dasappa	Samruddhi Cars	C1-88	7	55-445-07 4320184724	9.30
121.	Sri Anjaneya Swamy Gruha Nirmana Sahakara Sangha Niyamitha	**Ground Floor:** 1. Ayodhya Upachara 2. Sri Anjaneya Swamy Gruha Nirmana Sahakara Sangha Niyamitha	C1-100	7	3353342014 / 1568879763 / Old PID 54-33-199	1.44
122.	G.R. Eshwaramma	**Ground Floor:** 1. Swarga Hotel 2. Vinayaka Glass and Plywood **First Floor:** Pixel Technology	C1-101	7	54-33-200 4594033047	26.27
123.	1. R.K. Lokesh Kumar 2. R.K. Geethanjali 3. R.K. Harikrishna	1. R.K. Lokesh Kumar 2. R.K. Geethanjali 3. R.K. Harikrishna	C1-102	7	53-33-201 5753192703	36.45
124.	C.R. Samyuktha	C.R. Samyuktha	C1-103	7	54-33-202 3811578244	35.45
125.	G.M. Nouse Mohiyuddin	G.M. Nouse Mohiyuddin	C1-104	7	54-33-203 5758035519	34.47
126.	A.M.E. Foundation (Regd.) Trust, represented by Executive Director M.S. Ravi Prakash	Franke Faber Ideas	C1-105	7	Property No. 204 / 8355276111	33.40
127.	B.R. Suresh	Ever Fine Super Market	C1-87V	7	Property No. 205 / 8811685531	32.26
128.	1. Deepa Jayam 2. Vinod K.S. Jayam	Plotting Walls	C1-87U	7	Property No. 206 / 3330351960	31.12
129.	1. B.K. Suvarna 2. T. Manjunath	Silicon Honda	C1-87T	7	Property No. 207 / 2546358223	30.16
	Total (H)					**833.53**

Hoskerehalli Metro Station, Viaduct, Parking, Pocket Track
Village: Hoskerehalli Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban

130.	Secretary, NCERT	National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT)	ST 06-13	108	-	778.84
131.			ST 06-14			195.72
132.	Chayadevi D.	**Ground Floor:** Sri Sai Association **First Floor:** Paryad Nirvar **Second Floor:** Residential House	ST 06-19	108	54-17-191	283.23
133.	1. G.V. Venkatesh 2. G.V. Hemanth	1. Ritika Daga, W/o Anoop Daga 2. Krishna Daga, S/o Late J.K. Daga	C1-568 A	108	54-17-181	376.06
134.	1. M.N. Venkataram, S/o M.V. Nagaraj 2. Jayashree Venkataram, W/o M.N. Venkataram	Venkataram Leather Works	C1-568 B	108	54-17-182	390.76
135.	S. Rajkumar Pai, S/o Late D. Srinivas Pai	Bus Parking	C1-568 C	108	54-17-183	380.89 (K)3.76 **384.65**
136.	Dr. Mangala T.M., D/o Late T.M. Manjunath	T.M. Mangala, D/o Late T.M. Manjunath	C1-545	96	PID No. 55-445-812	44.58
137.	Nichi-In Software Solutions Pvt. Ltd.	Nichi-In Software Solutions Pvt. Ltd.	C1-546	96	PID No. 55-445-813	11.06
138.			C1-546A			26.77
139.	Shantala	Ashirwad Shivalila Residential Lodge	C1-547	96	PID No. 55-445-814	4.40
140.			C1-547A			77.84
141.			C1-547B			6.42
142.	Satish Gopinath, S/o Late S. Gopinath, represented by GPA Holder Sujay Gopinath	1 Nuh Amari Furnishing 2 Haikons Bioenergy Private Limited	C1-548	96	55-445-815	74.64
143.			C1-548A			15.08
144.	G.V. Rajasekhar, S/o Late G. Veerabhadrappa	Nya Corner Cafe	C1-549	96	55-445-816/817	32.34
145.			C1-549A			8.25
146.			C1-550			2.62
147.			C1-551			2.39
148.	Sri Narasimhappa, S/o Late Adappa	Sri Narasimhappa, S/o Late Adappa	C1-552	96	55-482-942/K	4.98
149.	S. Shankarappa, S/o Late G. Siddappa	**Ground Floor:** 3 residential houses **First Floor:** 1. Losini Motors 2. Puncture Shop **Second Floor:** Residential houses	C1-554	96	55-482-1262	16.83
150.	Bengaluru Development Authority	Uma Maheshwara Temple	C1-556	94	-	14.54
151.	Rakesh, S/o R. Parasmal	Rakesh, S/o R. Parasmal	C1-557	92	55-251-28	8.47
152.	B.N. Vinay	Commercial Shops	C1-557A	-	55-251-28; Property No. 86-168A-28	6.66
153.	V. Gangadharaiah	Commercial Shops	C1-558	92	8799860429 Property No. 23	50.73
	Total (I)					**2,817.86**

Dwarakanagara Metro Station
Village: Hoskerehalli Hobli: Uttarahalli Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban

154.	M/s. People's Education Society	M/s. People's Education Society	ST 07-02A	76	880/76/77/83/85	9.63
155.	Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board	Peg Point and Bar and Restaurant	C1-575	75/1		41.53
156.	Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board	1. Manjunatha Condiments 2. Y.D. Service Station 3. Hotel 4. Vinayaka Condiments and Juice	C1-577	73		28.97
157.			C1-577A	73		7.10
158.	Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board	1. Dimpan Protein Drinks; 2. Guru Manneeshwara Swamy Automobiles 3. Sahana Condiments; 4. Hango Ice Creams 5. Shop; 6. Kabbalamma Hotel 7. Aparna Wines 8. Venkateshwara Associates	C1-578	73		24.36
159.			C1-578A			12.93
160.			C1-578B			20.23
161.			C1-578C			48.70
162.			C1-578D			30.38
163.	Property acquired by KIADB	Nandi Infrastructure Corridor Enterprise (NICE)	C1-578E			5.05
	Total (J)					**228.88**

Viaduct and Pillar
Village: Pantharapalya Hobli: Kengeri Taluk: Bengaluru South District: Bengaluru Urban

164.	Property acquired by KIADB	Nandi Infrastructure Corridor Enterprise (NICE) / Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board	C1-115	50		407.24
165.			C1-116	12		590.62
166.			C1-117	42		241.73
167.	Property acquired by KIADB	Nandi Infrastructure Corridor Enterprise (NICE) / Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board	C1-586	40 41		610.71
168.	Property acquired by KIADB	Nandi Infrastructure Corridor Enterprise (NICE) / Karnataka Industrial Areas Development Board	C1-586A	40		77.76
169.	M. Krishnappa, S/o Late Munibeerappa, Dadoḍḍayya, Karagappa, Muniveerappa, Ramaiah M. Krishnappa, S/o Late Munibeerappa (joint)	Total Energies Gas Bunk	C1-600	15, 16	-	15.50
170.	H. Ramaiah, S/o Late Hanumappa, H. Narayanappa, S/o Late Hanumappa, H. Krishnappa, S/o Late Hanumappa, H. Govindaraju, S/o Late Hanumappa, H. Hanumanthu, S/o Late Hanumappa, H. Vasu S/o Late Hanumappa, Namababa M. Patel, Bengaluru Development Authority, Muniraju S/o Late Doddaiah, Munichandra S/o Late Doddaiah, Muniyappa S/o Late Doddaiah, K. Muniyappa S/o Late Karagappa, K. Gopal S/o Late Karagappa, (jointly with the above), K. Manjunath S/o Late Karagappa, K. Chandra, S/o Late Karagappa, K. Ravikumar S/o Late Karagappa, Bhu.Pa., Doddaiah, Karagappa, Muniveerappa, Ramaiah, M. Krishnappa, S/o Late Munibeerappa.	1. Mahadeva Condiments 2. Scrap Shop	C1-601	4/1, 4/2, 15	-	88.23
	Total (K)					**2031.79**
	Total (A-K)					**13,409.05**

:: ABSTRACT ::-

Sl. No.	Name of Village	Area (in Sq.Mtrs.)
1	Bilekahalli	1,448.72
2	Sarakki Agrahara	1,673.10
3	Sarakki	1,078.34
4	Jaraganahalli	1,582.08
5	Kadirenahalli	7.92
6	Kareesandra	451.88
7	Katriguppe	1,254.95
8	Ittumadu	833.53
9	Hoskerehalli	2,817.86
10	Hoskerehalli (Dwarakanagar Metro Station)	228.88
11	Pantharapalya	2,031.79
	Total	13,409.05

For the Metro Rail Project in Bengaluru City, for acquisition of total 13,409.05 Sq. Mtr. area from the above villages under KIADB Act 1966 Sec 28(1) Notification No. 99 SPQ 2026 dated 16.10.2026 has been published in State Gazette dated 16.10.2026. Notice has been issued to the concerned Property Owners/Anubhavadhars. Further, Property Owners/ Anubhavadhars or other interested persons who have not received the Notice, if they have any objections related to the acquisition of these lands, they should be submit their objections along with the relevant documents in writing, in person or through a person authorized by them at the below mentioned place, date and time.

Failing which it will be considered that there are no objections for acquisition of these properties and further action will be taken in accordance with the law.

Sl. No.	Date and Time	Enquiry Venue
1 to 98	20.11.2026, 11.00 a.m.	Bharat Scouts and Guides Building, T.V. Hall, Palace Road, Bengaluru – 560 001.
99 to 170	21.11.2026, 11.00 a.m.	

DIPR/DD-C.P/3351/KSMCA/2026-27 **Sd/- Special Land Acquisition Officer-1, KIADB, Palace Road, Bengaluru**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. Dy. CE/C/AGC/TN/2026/11 Dated: 26.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Deputy Chief Engineer(Construction), North Central Railway, Agra Cantt for and on behalf of the President of India invites in **SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM** open tender on prescribed forms online **(E-Tendering).** Tender offer can be submitted on line up to **15.00 hours** of **20.11.2026,** on website **http://www.ireps.gov.in.** The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC1126	**Approx Cost:** Rs. 1.17 Cr. (App.)
Description of work: Maintenance of GC line DHO-GIS section (Km 1290/0-1309/0) section of jurisdiction of SSE/PW/DHO.	
Earnest Money in Rs.: 2,34,100/-	**Completion Period:** 06 Months
Date of opening: 20.11.2026	**Validity:** 60 days

Note:- For complete details and submission of tender please see Indian Railway's website **htpp://www.ireps.gov.in.** 2445/26(K)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

HSCC (INDIA) LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)
A Miniratna Co. E-6(A), Sector-1, Noida – 201301 (U.P.)

NIT No.: HSCC/AIIMS-DARBHANGA/EPC/2026/138 Date: 28.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

HSCC (India) Limited invites **online open tenders** from experienced and eligible contractors for execution of the following work on an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) basis:

Name of Work: Construction of Hospital, Academic Block, Residential Campus and Allied Infrastructure, including Maintenance during the Defect Liability Period, for AIIMS Darbhanga, Bihar.

Estimated Cost: ₹1,549.25 Crore, **Completion Period:** 30 Months, **Last Date for Submission of Bids:** 27.11.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.)

The detailed Notice Inviting Tender(NIT), eligibility criteria, tender documents and other terms and conditions are available on the e-tendering portal and the official website of HSCC (India) Limited. **HOD (CPG)**

ebalbharati

Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research (Balbharati), Pune- 411004

E-TENDER NOTICE

Request For Proposal (RFP) Design, Development, Supply, Installation, and Maintenance of 16,000 Interactive Fiber Statues with AI-based Voice Assistant Functionality and Backend Server Infrastructure' for Balbharati. Balbharati intends to select an agency through this RFP for Design, Development, Supply, Installation and Maintenance of 16,000 Interactive Fiber Statues with AI-based Voice Assistant Functionality and Backend Server Infrastructure' for Balbharati.

Interested Agencies may contact on any working day between 10:30 to 16:00 HRS (IST) at the above address. Bid Documents can be downloaded online from 31th **October 2026, 12:00 HRS (IST).** For detailed tender notice and to download bid document please Visit ***https./mahatenders.gov.in***

The last date for submission of Bid form duly filled: **25/11/2026 till 18:00 HRS (IST).** The Balbharati reserves the right to accept/reject any offer, without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Name	**Request For Proposal (RFP) Design, Development, Supply, Installlation, and Maintenance of 16,000 Interactive Fiber Statues with AI-based Voice Assistant Functionality and Backend Server Infrastructure' for Balbharati**
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	₹ 50,00,000 (refunded after completion of 100% delivery, installation, training)
Online Tender Fees	₹ 11,800 (Tender Fee-₹ 10,000 + GST-₹ 1,800) (non-refundable)

Date : 26/10/2026
No. : 1091

Director,
Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research (Balbharati), Pune - 411004

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.-74/E/Tender/DEN/V/9320262027 Dated : 24.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) / North Central Railway / Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **13:30** hrs. on **18.11.2026.** The details of the tenders are as under:

S N	Tender No.	Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.)	Earnest Money (Rs.)
1	195	2,92,60,662.24	5,85,200.00
Name of Work : Kanpur-Central:- Furnishing of Running room at CNBN (New Kanpur) under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.			
2	196	3,93,00,427.27	7,86,000.00
Name of Work : (a) TSR(P) by PQRS and Manually in CNB-RRH Section under DEN/V/PRYJ. (b) TFR and other Ancillary work in CNB-RRH Section under DEN/V/PRYJ.			
3	197	13,37,32,000.00	26,74,600.00
Name of Work : Supply, stacking and loading into Rly, Wagons/Hoppers/ KC Wagons etc. 100000 Cum machine crushed track ballast of 65 mm gauge as per Rly. Specification IRS-GE-I June 2016 at GMC Depot under ADEN/Line/CNB.			
4	198	22,58,42,076.02	45,16,900.00
Name of Work : Construction of 400 bedded capacity Hostel Building at MDDTI/CNB for Railway Loco Running Staff under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.			

Completion period: For SN. 1 to 4- 12 months, **Date of Opening : For SN. 1 to 4-** 18.11.2026, **Similar work for Eligibility Criteria : For SN. 1- (a)** For Building works component: Value of component = **Rs. 2,35,91,842.09** Definition of similar work = Construction of Building. **(b)** For Electrical works component: Value of component = **Rs. 56,68,820.15** Definition of similar work = Satisfactory execution of any electrical work related to HT/LT installation. **For SN. 2-** Any P.Way work. **For SN. 3-** Supply of machine crushed stone ballast / machine crushed coarse stone aggregate. **For SN. 4-** Construction of RCC framed structure building of Ground Floor + 2 Storeys or more, typically consisting of HVAC System, Fire-Fighting Services, Plumbing Services, Electrical Works.

Note: 1. Tender online can be submitted up to **13:30** hrs. on **18.11.2026. 2.** The complete information along with tender document of the above E-Tenders are available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **13:30** hrs. on the due date of tender opening, i.e. **18.11.2026.** 2444/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-42/3791/2026-27 Date: 27.10.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

Name of the Work: Improvements to Industrial Layout including Reconstruction and strengthening of 18.0 m, 24.0 & 30.0m Wide Roads including Flexible pavement, Construction of RCC Side Drains, Storm Water Drainage, Chainlink Fencing and Balanced portion of Works in Gowribidanur 1st & 2nd Phase Industrial Area, Chikkaballapura District **(2nd call)**

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **11.11.2026** upto **4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

Sd/-
DIPR/CP/3366/SMCL/2026-27 **Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru**

BANGALORE DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

T.Chowdaiah Road, Kumara Park West, Bangalore-560 020.

No: BDA/EE(East)/TEN/724/2026-27 Dated: 27.10.2026

NOTICE OF INVITATION FOR TENDERS (IFT) (TWO COVER SYSTEM)
(Through GOK e - Procurement Platform http://eproc.karnataka.gov.in)

Bangalore Development Authority has proposed for Construction of Housing project at Sy No 117/1 117/2 of Neelasandra (Austin Town) village, Kasaba Hobli, Bangalore tenders are invited through electronic tendering system (e-procurement) for the said work.

Sl. No.	Name of work	Approx cost put to tender (Rs. In Lakhs)	EMD amount in Rs.	Tender Processing Fee in Rs.	Time of Completion
1	Construction of Housing project at Sy No 117/1, 117/2 of Neelasandra (Austin Town) village, Kasaba Hobli, Bangalore	Rs. 3200.00 LAKHS	32,00,000/-	As per KPPP procurement portal	18 (Eighteen) months. (Including Monsoon)

Tender document can be downloaded from **28.10.2026** onwards from the Government of Karnataka e-Procurement Website **http://eproc.karnataka.gov.in** under login for Contractors/ Vendors. For Additional information Registration and e-payment, visit GoK e-Procurement helpdesk contact no. +91 80 46010000, +91 80 68948777 and e-Procurement Cell contact no. 080-22230960, 080-22234115. Helpline/Whatsapp: 9483166622 (24x7) @BDAOfficialGok

Sd/- Executive Engineer, East Division, BDA, Bangalore.

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003 Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of :

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 215/GATP/IMD/50007829 dated 27/10/2026**
"Award of Service Contract for Servicing and overhauling of motorized actuator at both the Units of GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."
Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-103/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16541

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003 Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD -MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Carbon Steel Plates (Sail Hard) which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 208/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018375**
"Procurement of Carbon Steel Plates (Sail Hard) used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27.10.2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-105/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16543

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHANSI/W/T/Tender General/243-245 Date : 26.10.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through Online (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG- HQ-2026-243

Description of work : Augmentation/upgradation of facilities & infrastructure in various lobbies/Crew depots including logistics and furnishing and misc items at JHS.

Approx Cost : ₹ 16830762.65	**Earnest Money :** ₹ 336600.00
Date of closing Tender : 20.11.2026 at **15:00** hrs.	
Date of completion / period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Month	
E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG- HQ-2026-245	
Description of work : Heavy repair to RE officer rest house under ADEN/HQ-II/JHS jurisdiction.	
Approx Cost : ₹ 3651593.19	**Earnest Money :** ₹ 73000.00
Date of closing Tender : 20.11.2026 at **15:00** hrs.	
Date of completion / period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Month	

• Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs on **20.11.2026** • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** 2436/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

TELANGANA MEDICAL SERVICES & INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION DIRECTOR OF HEALTH CAMPUS,

SULTAN BAZAR, HYDERABAD -95, TELANGANA
(An ISO 9001:2015 Certified Organization)
Phone: 040 -40032555 Email id: md_msidc@telangana.gov.in

1. Tender Notice No.12/2026-27/Medicine /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
2. Tender Notice No.13/2026-27/Medicine /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
3. Tender Notice No.14/2026-27/Medicine /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
4. Tender Notice No.15/2026-27/Medicine /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
5. Tender Notice No.16/2026-27/Medicine /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
6. Tender Notice No.17/2026-27/Medicine /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
7. Tender Notice No.18/2026-27/ Material & Supplies (Surgical) /MW/ TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
8. Tender Notice No.19/2026-27/ Material & Supplies (Surgical) /MW/ TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
9. Tender Notice No.20/2026-27/ Material & Supplies (Surgical) /MW/ TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
10. Tender Notice No.21/2026-27/ Material & Supplies (Surgical) /MW/ TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
11. Tender Notice No.22/2026-27/ TGMSIDC /EMP-LABS, Dt:26/10/2026
12. Tender Notice No.23/2026-27/DIAG/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
13. Tender Notice No.24/2026-27/DIAG/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
14. Tender Notice No.25/2026-27/DIAG/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
15. Tender Notice No.26/2026-27/DIAG/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026
16. Tender Notice No.27/2026-27/ Miscellaneous /MW/TGMSIDC, Dt:26/10/2026

The above-mentioned tenders are invited through e-procurement platform (online) for Procurement and supply under Rate contract as detailed below:

For period of Two years
T.No.12,13,14,15,16 & 17:- Medicines
T.No.18,19,20 & 21:- Materials & Supplies (Surgical)
T.No.22:- Empanelment of NABL accredited Laboratories
T.No.23,24,25 & 26:- Diagnostic Kits & Reagents
T.No.27:- Miscellaneous

Above mentioned tenders are invited through e-procurement platform (online) for Procurement, supply of following under Rate contract for a period of Two Years and Managing Director, TGMSIDC reserves the right to cancel the tender at any time without assigning any reason. For complete details, please visit Web site: **https://tender.telangana.gov.in** from **01.11.2026** onwards.

R.O. No. : 703-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Date: 27-10-2026 **Sd/- Managing Director, TGMSIDC**

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

CORRIGENDUM

No. PCMM/CLW/HWH/E-Procurement/CORRIGENDUM/26/11, Dated: 23.10.2026. The following Corrigendum of E-Tender/s is for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website **www.ireps.gov.in** for detailed instructions. These are E-Tenders only electronic offer bids shall be accepted. **Sl. No.; Tender Notice No.; Tender No.; Tender Opening Date are as follows: [01];Sl. No.149** of PCMM/CLW/HWH/ E-Procurement/26/37, Dated:21/09/2026;**31261174B;** Tender Opening Date is to be read as **"13/11/2026"** instead of existing entry. **[02]; Sl. No 150** of PCMM/CLW/HWH/E-Procurement/26/37, Dated:21/09/2026; **31261174C;** Tender Opening Date is to be read as **"13/11/2026"** instead of existing entry. **[03];Sl No 144** of PCMM/CLW/HWH/E-Procurement/26/36, Dated:15/09/2026; **31262506;** Tender Opening Date is to be read as **"30/11/2026"** instead of existing entry.

PR1/529 **PCMM/CLW/Howrah**

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VISVESVARAYA TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY

"Jnana Sangama", Belagavi - 590018, Karnataka

Ref.No: VTU/BGM/RE/2026-27/IFT No.82/4189 Date: 24-10-2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Two Cover System) - (Through KPP Portal Only)

The e-Tender is invited in duplicate from eligible Tenderers, registered Class-I Electrical Contractor, by the Registrar, Visvesvaraya Technological University, "Jnana Sangama", Belagavi - 18, under standard tender document procedure K/W format for the work of **Replacement of Damaged Old HT/LT UG Cable and Fabricating, Testing, Installing and Commissioning of new feeder pillars at various locations at "Jnana Sangama", VTU, Belagavi. Amounting to Rs. 3,56,59,068/- (Excluding GST).** Other details log on to Website: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in on 27-10-2026.**

Sd/- Registrar
DIPR/Belagavi/1021/Adverto/2026-27 VTU, Belagavi

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
(O/o Controller of Stores & Disposal (South), PSPCL, Patiala)
(Email - cosandds@gmail.com, Mobile No. 96461-19412, 96461-48165)

Scrap e-Auction Notice

Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) will conduct a forward e-auction on 29.10.2026 for the disposal of approximately 34830 Damaged/Unserviceable Distribution Transformers (Approximate Total Start price Rs. 51.82 crores), lying at various Transformer Receiving Yards and General Scrap, Battery Scrap, E-waste, Plastic Waste (Approximate Total Start price Rs 5.50 crores) lying in various central Stores, TRYs and Outlet stores across Punjab. offered in separate multiple lots for each location. The e-auction will be conducted on the website portal **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/index_new.jsp.** The Detailed auction catalogue with Terms & Conditions of e-auction, corrigendum and material list etc. will be available on the website **https://www.mstcindia.co.in/content/Forthcoming_e_Auctions_For_All_regions.aspx** and on **https://www.pspcl.in/e-auction-notice.aspx.** For queries related to registration, please contact at Phone No. 7229068247 or 7230022882.

C1016/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16552

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: T_26-27_Air_Brake_NOTICE Date: 24.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Chief Workshop Manager, Coach MLR Workshop, Jhansi for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-tender from reputed contractors for following work:-

Tender No.	Description of work : Stripping, Transportation, Rectification, Testing and Refitment of BMBC System Components including BP/FP Pipe Modification, AR Tank Cleaning & Testing, Coupler Overhauling and Bogie IOH Work of Coachs at CMLR Workshop, Jhansi.
T_26-27_Air_Brake	
Qty.	**Tender cost :** Rs. 4,65,34,632.80/- (Rs. Four Crore Sixty Five Lakh Thirty Four Thousand Six Hundred Thirty Two and Paise Eighty only.)
One work	

Completion period	Earnest money	Tender doc. cost
36 months	Rs. 930700/-	Rs. 0/-

1. Tender will be closed at 15:30 Hrs. on 17.11.2026 and is available on Indian Railway E-Tendering website **www.ireps.gov.in**. **2.** For detailed information please visit Indian Railway E-Tendering website **www.ireps.gov.in**. **3.** Tenderers should watch the website for the corrigendum/addendum to the NIT/e-tender document, if any as there will not be any separate communication for the same. 2427/26 (D)

North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. Agra/W/Tender/Publication Date : 23.10.2026

E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-Oct-05 dated 23.10.2026

E-Tendering Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through Online only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

SN.1.	**Tender No. :** 2026-Oct-05-01	**Approx Cost :** ₹ 46625504.87	
Description of work : Composite tender (Civil+Electrical) work for Replacement of 20 unit Type II qtrs at south colony Agra cantt.			
SN.2.	**Tender No. :** 2026-Oct-05-02	**Approx Cost :** ₹ 21003521.52	
Description of work : (A) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/P. Way/AA under ADEN/HQ/Agra. **(B)** Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/PW/N/AGC under ADEN/Line/IDH.			

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **"www.ireps.gov.in"**. Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **15.00** hrs on **16.11.2026.** 2428/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Government of Karnataka

DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS, HALIYAL DIVISION, HALIYAL

Near Basaveshwar Circle, Dharwad Road Haliyal (U.K)
Tele Phone: 08284-220128 e-mail: dcfhaliyal@gmail.com
No.B5/Auction/CR-08/2026-27 Date:16-10-2026

Tender Notice for e-Auction of Forest Produce

The following dates have been fixed for the Desposal of forest products stored in the Government timber depot under Haliyal Division through e-auction in the months of November 2026. All the bidders can participate in the said auction subject to all the conditions mentioned in the detailed auction notice of this office vide No. B5/Auction/CR-08/2026-27. Date:16-10-2026. For more information regarding the e-auction, this office can be contacted during office hours. Details of the e-auction can also be obtained through the official website of the Karnataka Government www.mstcecommerce.com & www.etimber.in.

GTD Dandeli Depot: 16-11-2026 to 20-11-2026, (All Four Sessions) First Session: 10:00 hrs to 10:45 hrs
Second Session: 12:00 hrs to 12:45 hrs. Third Session: 14:00 hrs. to 14:45 hrs Fourth Session: 16:00 hrs to 16:45 hrs
Bhagawati Depot: 21-11-2026 (Two Sessions) First Session 10:00 hrs to 10:45 hrs. Second Session 12:00hrs.to 12:45 hrs
Kulagi Depot: 21-11-2026 (Two Sessions) Third Session: 14:00 hrs. to 14:45 hrs. Fourth Session: 16:00 hrs to 16:45 hrs

For further information related to the e-auction, the following address may be contacted during office hours.:

(1) Deputy Conservator of Forests, Haliyal dcfhaliyal@gmail.com 08284-220128
(2) Assistant Conservator of Forests, Govt. Timber Depot, Dandeli acfgtd.dandeli@gmail.com 8861724343
(3) Range Forest Officer, Virnoli (Kulgi Depot) virnolirfo96@gmail.com 9035751595
(4) Range Forest Officer, Bhagawati bgtirfo97@gmail.com 9035739684
Range Forest Office. Jagalbetrfojbt93@gmail.com 7829251189

DIPR/KWR/KSMCA/475/26-27 dt. 27.10.2026 **Sd/- Deputy Conservator of Forests, Haliyal Division, Haliyal.**

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/EIA/ETND-EC-06/3792/2026-27 Dated: 27.10.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER TO PROVIDE CONSULTANCY SERVICES FOR OBTAINING ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE (EC)
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB is inviting tender under two cover systems for providing Consultancy Services from Environmental Consultant of NABET under 7(c) category with NABL Accredited Consultant/MOU with NABET & NABL Accredited Consultancy Services Accredited Consultant are eligible to participate in this tenders.

Name of the Work: Providing Consultancy Services for preparing EIA, SIS studies etc., to obtain Environmental Clearance (EC) from State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority(SEIAA) Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) and Consent for Establishment (CFE) from Karnataka State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) and submission of Half-yearly compliance Report for all the conditions of EC & CFE for 3 years for Gowribidanur 5th Phase Industrial Area, Gowribidanur Taluk, Chikkaballapura District in an extent of Extent 810.36 acres . EMD**: Rs. 2.00 Lakhs.**

Last date for submission of bids is: **11.11.2026 upto 04:00 pm**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

Sd/-
DIPR/CP/3365/SMCL/2026-27 **Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru**

Puri: No plans to raise ethanol blending beyond 20% for now

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Margao: Centre has no immediate plans to increase ethanol blending in petrol beyond the existing 20% target, Union petroleum and natural gas minister **Hardeep Singh Puri** said Tuesday, dismissing concerns about E20 fuel compatibility and allegations of engine damage as a "contrived narrative" driven by misinformation.

Speaking on the sidelines of the 29th Energy Technology and Innovation Meet in Goa's Betul, Puri said the ethanol-blending programme had generated savings of Rs 1.6 lakh crore, of which Rs 1.4 lakh crore had gone back to farmers. The programme strengthened farmers' role in the energy economy, transforming them from traditional "Annadatas" (providers of food) into "Urjadatas" (providers of energy), he said.

"In so far as biofuels are concerned, 20% was the target, and there is no desire, just now, to increase it beyond 20%," Puri said.

Rejecting allegations that E20 petrol caused engine damage, he said vehicles designed and certified to use the blended fuel were compatible with it, while older vehicles, particularly those manufactured before 2003, could face compatibility issues. He also suggested that some complaints could stem from fuel transportation and handling practices. Puri said widespread engine damage would have been evident given that around six crore vehicles visit fuel stations daily.

Campaign against E20 'paid propaganda', says Gadkari

Dipak.Dash@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: The campaign against E20 fuel 3-4 months back was "paid propaganda", road transport and highways minister **Nitin Gadkari** alleged on Tuesday, a day after govt notified norms for rollout of E100 vehicles that can run on nearly pure ethanol.

Speaking at a conference of industry body CII, the minister said, "Since 2022, four crore cars and 20 crore two-wheelers have been running on E20 fuel. Three months back, there was a lot of uproar (halla) over ethanol. Now there is quiet. E20 is being used since 2022; has anyone's vehicle broken down yet? It was entirely paid propaganda."

The minister said govt is focussing on alternate fuels and reducing India's dependence on imports of crude.

While govt notification for E100 vehicles will enable vehicle makers to manufacture Flex Fuel Vehicles (FFVs), it won't be enough to push the adoption of these vehicles, experts said.

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003 Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Hot Air Control Dampers used in Mills of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 210/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018313**
"Procurement of Hot Air Control Dampers used in Mills of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27.10.2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-107/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16545

BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED

(Wholly Owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)

TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through KPP Portal Only)

BESCOM invites tenders vide inquiry No: **BESCOM/2026-27/IND0283** through KPP Portal from eligible bidders for **"Supply of EHV Grade Transformer Oil-New-2000KL".** Bid documents Available from: **29.10.2026 Onwards.** Last date for submission of Bids: **30.11.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.** Opening of Bid Document: **01.12.2026 17:15 Hrs.**

The Tender can be obtained through KPP portal website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** Aspiring Bidders need to register on KPP portal. Further Bidders can take assistance with KPPP help desk contact numbers 91-8046010000, +91-8068948777 or e-mail at **support@eprochelpdesk.com**

Sd/-
Chief General Manager(Ele.),
Procurement, 2nd Floor, Corporate Office,
BESCOM, K.R. Circle, Bengaluru- 560 001.

For Electricity Related Complaints Call: 1912
Download BESCOM MITHRA Mobile App.

कार्यालय नगर निगम जयपुर

पण्डित दीनदयाल उपाध्याय भवन लालकोठी, जयपुर
फोन नम्बर. 0141-2742054 ई.मेल:- dcudt.jmc@gmail.com
क्रमांक:–एफ–6 ( ) उपा.राज.(प्रथम) / हॉर्डिंग / ननिज / 2026 / 149 दिनांक:–26.10.2026

ई–ऑक्शन (होर्डिंग) विज्ञप्ति सं. 53 / 2026–2027

नगर निगम जयपुर के क्षेत्राधिकार में सार्वजनिक स्थलों पर विज्ञापन के लिए विभिन्न विज्ञापन साईटों का ई–ऑक्शन निम्नानुसार किया जाना है :–

क्र. सं.	विज्ञापन का नाम	संख्या	ई–ऑक्शन दिनांक	समयावधि
1.	1. निर्मित बसशैल्टर्स साईटें (समूह में), (एम.आई.रोड, जे.एल.एन. मार्ग बसशैल्टर्स,)	20	17.11.2026	प्रातः 11.00 बजे से 5.30 बजे तक (अंतिम 5 मिनट में संवेदक / फर्म द्वारा बोली दिये जाने पर ई–नीलामी की समयावधि में प्रत्येक बार स्वतः ही 15 मिनट की वृद्धि हो जायेगी जिसकी अधिकतम समय सीमा की बाध्यता नहीं होगी।)
	2. सिविल लाईन जोन, आमेर जोन, हवामहल जोन एवं किशनपोल जोन यूनिपोल	38		
	3. लघु विज्ञापन बोर्ड 8x4 (समूह में) कुल ग्रुप–8	33		
2.	1. कियोस्क बोर्ड, (बिजली के खंभो पर लगने वाले छोटे बोर्ड) ब्लॉक– A (कियोस्क बोर्ड) ब्लॉक–B (कियोस्क बोर्ड) ब्लॉक – F (कियोस्क बोर्ड)	3	18.11.2026	प्रातः 11.00 बजे से 5.30 बजे तक (अंतिम 5 मिनट में संवेदक / फर्म द्वारा बोली दिये जाने पर ई–नीलामी की समयावधि में प्रत्येक बार स्वतः ही 15 मिनट की वृद्धि हो जायेगी जिसकी अधिकतम समय सीमा की बाध्यता नहीं होगी।)
	2. विद्याधर नगर जोन, मानसरोवर जोन, मुरलीपुरा जोन, सांगानेर जोन एवं मालवीय नगर जोन यूनिपोल	27		
	3. निर्मित ओवरहैड साईनैज गैन्ट्री	9		
	4. टोंक रोड, गोपालपुरा फ्लाईओवर के नीचे चौराहे के आस–पास, फ्लाईओवर के खंभे (खंभो पर समूह में 8'x4' की 30 खंभे)	30		
3	1. निर्मित बैकलिट टॉवर 6 मीटर	22	19.11.2026	प्रातः 11.00 बजे से 5.30 बजे तक (अंतिम 5 मिनट में संवेदक / फर्म द्वारा बोली दिये जाने पर ई–नीलामी की समयावधि में प्रत्येक बार स्वतः ही 15 मिनट की वृद्धि हो जायेगी जिसकी अधिकतम समय सीमा की बाध्यता नहीं होगी।)
	2. नये चिन्हित बैकलिट टॉवर	15		
	3. निर्मित सुलभ शौचालय (ग्रुप वाईज–14)	14		
	4. निर्मित सुलभ शौचालय एवं नये चिन्हित सुलभ शौचालय	26		

महत्वपूर्ण निर्देश बिन्दु :–

1. उक्त ई–ऑक्शन कार्यक्रम, शर्ते, अमानता राशि, भागीदारी राशि तथा ई–नीलामी बिजनेस रूल्स आदि की जानकारी हेतु नीलामी वेबसाईट www.jaipurmc.org में (E-Auction) पर देखी जा सकती है।
2. उक्त वेबसाईट पर वित्तीय वर्ष 2026–27 के लिए इच्छुक फर्मे / व्यक्ति निर्धारित पंजीयन शुल्क राशि 1,000 / – (एक हजार रूपये) जमा करवाकर, पंजीयन करवाकर ई–नीलामी में भाग ले सकते हैं।
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Realigning HI With AI Realities

By James Agrawal

AI is deepening uncertainty for employees and jobseekers alike. As companies cut jobs and signal further reductions, the pace of change is raising urgent questions about which roles will survive and what skills will secure the next job.

According to a study by McKinsey & Company, considering various rates and scenarios of AI adoption, it is likely that between 400-800 million jobs will be affected worldwide by 2030. This is in addition to the concern of entry-level jobs being taken over by AI adoption, leaving fresh graduates also wondering about what the future holds. This raises anxiety about future career prospects for everyone in the job market, and jobseekers have responded by trying to reskill and adapt to avoid unemployment.

Many jobseekers are actively seeking AI training to stay employable. However, this is a reactionary, short-term measure, and companies need to rethink how humans can work with AI as the future rolls in much faster than any of us expected.

AI can be formidable at logic, analysis, and technical problem-solving, but it often falters where context, setting, and tone matter most. A machine may have extraordinary computational ability, yet it cannot always read the room, sense a shift in tone or instinctively adapt a presentation to the people in front of it. Understanding context, responding to ambiguity, and arriving at solutions that are not merely intelligent but workable remain distinctly human strengths.

Companies that adopt AI based on the 'promise of what AI could do' rather than 'what AI should do' will struggle to roll out AI projects that deliver tangible returns. Without designing for humans who will lead the AI rollout, make the right decisions in a crisis/unexpected situation, adapt to the business context, and take responsibility for the outcome, AI solutions are bound to fail. The current rates of failure of AI projects are due to lapses in implementation, with companies treating AI as a one-stop solution and a tool to cut employee costs. AI cannot replace humans; it needs humans who can use it to improve outcomes.

Creating an environment where employees feel valued will be the differentiator for companies going forward. When leadership enables HR to create environments where employee contribution matters more than machine output, employees will use AI to enhance their work experience instead of feeling threatened by it. This is not to say employees should be kept in the dark about which job roles will be affected. HR needs to recognise the communication intelligence of humans – recognising the tone in a meeting, reading the energy levels of the team, prioritising real conversations over automated responses to implement AI that can enable employees. No machine can replace the intuitive faculty, that only humans have, to communicate intelligently.

There might come a time when machines are able to respond to tone, atmosphere and feelings of humans too, but that time will only come when human intelligence leads machines and not vice versa. Human intelligence will always be a step ahead of algorithmic machine intelligence. Now it is up to humans to use their intelligence to cut through the hype around AI and look beyond it to build real solutions that align with the company's objectives.

(The writer is MD, BTI Executive Search)

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Imran's 'leave India' notice to be in abeyance till Nov 2: HC

Mumbai: Bombay high court Tuesday posted to Nov 2 the hearing on actor Imran Khan Pal's challenge to a notice directing him to leave India and till then kept the notice in abeyance. The Oct 28 deadline under the Oct 14 notice issued by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) under the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, was extended till the next hearing after Additional Solicitor General Anil Singh appearing for the Centre sought a short adjournment.

Khan, born in the US, has been in India for 42 years since the age of two years. He holds an Overseas Citizen of India status under the Citizenship Act, 1955. The HC bench of Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and Justice Advait Sethna recorded in the order that senior counsel V R Dhond appearing for the actor had "fairly" not opposed such a request for adjournment.

Khan's plea says power to remove a person under Section 29 of the Foreigners Act was intended to safeguard national sovereignty and security, and could not be used to punish a public figure merely for being present near a protest site. TNN

Why should acid be allowed to be sold in open mkt: SC

SC Says Existing Guidelines Have Failed Badly

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Concerned by spiraling incidents of acid attacks, mostly on women by jilted lovers, Supreme Court on Tuesday told the Union govt about the urgent need for a revisit of the existing guidelines to put in place a robust preventive mechanism and consider heavily regulating retail sale of acid.

"Why should acid be sold in the open market? What is the compulsion of govts to allow such sales? It is no longer needed in the households because of availability of better substitutes," the bench said and told additional solicitor general Archana Pathak Dave that the Union govt must rethink its strategy to prevent acid attacks that physically and mentally scar and disfigure people for their entire life.

Dave said that the Centre had framed guidelines and circulated among states for implementation but found that there is laxity in enforcing the mechanism suggested by the Union govt. "The increasing incidents of acid attack indicates that the guidelines have failed miserably," the bench said.

It asked the Centre - "Have you sought explanation from any state which was lax in implementing the guidelines? Maybe in the federal framework it is difficult, but this shows that either there are loopholes in the guidelines or laxity in the implementation. If there are loopholes, the Centre needs to revise and reframe them."

Citing the example of Bangladesh, which regulates and restricts sale and distribution of acid, the bench said, "The additional solicitor general informs the court that the Centre will file an affidavit on the regulated sale of acid in open market and the steps that should be taken by the states to prevent acid attacks."

During the hearing on Aug 31, the CJI-led bench had asked the Centre and states why retail sale of acid be not banned after an acid attack survivor complained that the SC-prompted 2013 guidelines framed by the Union govt remained on paper as girls continue to suffer physical disfigurement and lifelong mental trauma from acid attacks. SC had given four weeks to the Centre to respond on the need of a policy decision to either ban acid sales or impose stringent restrictions on it.

Bombay HC: Adult unmarried daughter can seek maintenance from father

The Nagpur bench of Bombay high court recently upheld a family court order directing a father to pay monthly maintenance of 7,000 to his unmarried adult daughter, reports **Vaibhav Ganjapure.** It ruled that an alternative remedy under the Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act cannot, by itself, defeat her claim under Section 125 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC). Justice Mehroz Pathan dismissed a criminal revision filed by the father challenging Nagpur family court's Dec 7, 2019, order. The family court had declined maintenance to the wife, who earned 40,000 a month as a teacher, but directed the father, also a teacher earning 71,000 monthly, to support their two children, including a minor son, by providing 7,000 per month maintenance to each.

HC quashes case against student over her repost after Op Sindoor

Mumbai: The Bombay high court on Tuesday quashed a criminal case registered against a 20-year-old engineering student for reposting a controversial comment after 'Operation Sindoor', observing that the post was an isolated act followed by voluntary deletion and remorse.

A chance is required to be given in such cases, a single bench of Justice Milind Jadhav said, noting that the student has already suffered custody.

"That in itself for a young student is a scar which cannot be erased easily," Justice Jadhav said.

The woman engineering student from a private college in Pune was arrested on May 9, 2025, over the controversial Instagram repost related to Indo-Pak tensions following Operation Sindoor.

Justice Jadhav observed that the accused was a young student, and the incident appears to be an isolated act of re-posting (content), followed by its voluntary deletion and an expression of remorse, probably because of the exuberance of youth and age.

The student was not the author or creator of the original post, the high court noted in its order. PTI

Centre to bring bill to curb child porn, sexual content: SG tells SC

Dhananjay.Mahapatra
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: The Centre on Tuesday informed the Supreme Court that it is in the process of drafting a bill to prevent social media circulation of child pornography, vindictive uploading of videos of consensual sexual acts after souring of relationships and morphing of videos to ridicule or defame personalities and permitting any person to file police complaint against such offensive contents.

Solicitor general Tushar Mehta told a bench of CJI Surya Kant, and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana that deliberations are going on for legislative intervention to prevent circulation of sexual contents, child pornography and morphed videos on social media platforms.

Mehta said he is not opposing the two PILs, one by Uday Mahurkar and another by NGO 'Prajwala', both of which seek robust mechanism to stop circulation of child pornography, sexual assault videos, uploading of videos of consensual adult sexual acts by jilted lovers and morphed videos.

When a counsel said that at present only the aggrieved person, in most cases the women, can file police complaints against the person uploading such videos, the SG said that the intermediary should not only be directed to immediately take down such offensive contents but also mandatorily file police complaint against the handle or digital device from which such contents were uploaded.

Recently, a video was uploaded on social media depicting AI-generated imagery of an imaginary courtroom conversation between CJI Kant and Rahul Gandhi on the lines of a scene from film 'Jolly LLB 3', in which the judge reprimanded the counsel for filing a PIL with numerous mistakes.

The proposed legislation may also require platforms to remove offending material promptly and enable complaints against those responsible for uploading it

HC ends rape trial, cites survivor's wish to move on

Lisa.Monteiro
@timesofindia.com

Panaji: A survivor pursuing a professional course told Bombay HC that a rape trial would disrupt her studies, career and normal life, prompting the court to quash charges against a 23-year-old man while ordering both parties and her mother to jointly pay Rs 3 lakh in costs to Goa bar association.

Justice Amit Jamsandekar quashed the FIR, citing inadequate prosecution evidence and the survivor's unwillingness to continue with the case. HC said continuing the trial would prolong distress.

The survivor was 17.5 years old and the accused was 21 at the time of the alleged offence. They met on Instagram and were in a consensual relationship, she said, adding that differences arising from their different social backgrounds led to the FIR.

The survivor and her mother filed affidavits expressing concern that continuing the proceedings would affect her mental health. A court-appointed counsellor found that the survivor was mature enough to make an informed decision and had acted of her own free will.

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To apply, visit: www.oxfordpublicschool.net.in.

ONLY SHORTLISTED CANDIDATES WILL BE CALLED FOR WRITTEN TEST & INTERVIEW.
NOTE: Applications will be accepted till 20 days of publication of this notice.

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SECRETARY

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File No: 4-ITPO(3)/E-I/2026 Date: 28.10.2026

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File No.: 1460/HBTU/Estt/01/2026 **FACULTY RECRUITMENT** Date: 24.10.2026

Online Applications in the prescribed format are invited from eligible candidates for direct recruitment to the regular faculty positions in various departments and administrative positions in the University as per the details given below:

A) Faculty Positions

Advt. No.	Department	Professor				Associate Professor				Assistant Professor
		UR	EWS	OBC	SC	UR	EWS	OBC	SC	UR
DC-01	Oil Technology	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	1	-
DC-02	Electronics Engineering	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1*
DC-03	Electrical Engineering	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1
DC-04	MCA	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-
DC-05	Mechanical Engineering	-	-	-	-	-	-	1**	-	-
DC-06	Chemical Engineering	-	-	1	-		1	-	-	-
DC-07	Chemistry	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-
DC-09	Paint Technology	-	-	1	-	1	-	1	-	1***
DC-10	Plastic Technology	1	-	-	-	2	-	-	-	-
DC-11	Physics	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1
DC-12	Food Technology	-	1	-	-	-	1	-	-	-
DC-15	Mathematics	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1+1****
DC-16	Leather Technology	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-
DC-17	Civil Engineering	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
DC-18	Humanities (Economics)	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-
	Total	02	01	03	01	05	02	02	02	06

B) Administrative Position

Advt. No.	Position	Vacancy				
		UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST
PC-21	Assistant Workshop Superintendent	1	-	-	-	-

* To be vacated on 01/03/2027.
** To be vacated on 01/08/2027.
*** To be vacated on 01/12/2026.
**** 01 post of Assistant Professor in Mathematics will be vacated on 01/01/2027.

Note: 1. Reservation will be as per UP Government Norms (Vertical & Horizontal).
2. UR: Unreserved, EWS: Economical Weaker Section, SC: Scheduled Caste, ST: Scheduled Tribes, OBC : Other Backward Class
3. The number of posts advertised is indicative and the University reserves the right not to fill up any post, decrease or increase the number of posts.
4. Eligible persons may submit their applications through online mode only by visiting HBTU, Kanpur website http://www.hbtu.ac.in. The details of the procedure for online submission of applications, General Information & Instructions, Recruitment Rules, Screening and selection criteria, tentative schedule of Recruitment Process etc. are available on the University website.
5. The last date for submitting the complete application with all documents in online mode is **08-12.2026 (Tuesday)** till 11:59 pm. The candidates need to upload all relevant documents with the application form only.
6. Any correspondence in regard of this recruitment should be addressed to the Email ID: **recruitment2026@hbtu.ac.in** only.

(Registrar)

भारतीय भूचुंबकत्व संस्थान, मुंबई
Indian Institute of Geomagnetism, Mumbai
(विज्ञान एवं प्रौद्योगिकी विभाग भारत सरकार के अधीन एक स्वायत्त निकाय)
(An Autonomous Body under Dept. of Science & Technology, Government of India)

Advt. No.06/IIG/HRD/2026 **Dated: Oct 16, 2026**

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For detailed advertisement, please visit: **https://iigm.res.in/careers/position vacancies**.

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Faculty Positions Date: 28-10-2026

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For detailed advertisement and to apply online, please visit **www.iimbg.ac.in**. Last date of application submission and *cut-off date of the Ongoing Rolling Faculty Advertisement* is **18th November 2026**.
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Core-4, 9th Floor, SCOPE Minar, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092
Website: www.hurl.net.in

UP's workforce drives progress

The latest recruitment drive reflects Uttar Pradesh's expanding opportunities, with appointments spanning education, technical services, agriculture and other key departments across the state

Uttar Pradesh is widening the path from employment to empowerment by creating opportunities within the state while opening new avenues for its workforce beyond its borders. From 9.5 lakh+ government jobs delivered over the last 9.5 years to a fresh target of 1 lakh+ appointments in six months, the state is accelerating recruitment across police, education, technical and administrative services.

The recent employment drives include 3,567 UPESSC candidates receiving appointment letters as assistant teachers, lecturers, headmasters and principals across UP's secondary education system; 3,446 technical assistants (Group-C) appointed under Mission Rozgar; 818 candidates receiving appointment letters for posts across various departments; and 126 mandi secretaries appointed in the Agriculture Department.

The state is also strengthening livelihoods through wider social-security measures. Around 3.5 lakh outsourced workers are covered under the broader welfare initiative, with families potentially reaching 17-20 lakh people. Cashless healthcare, financial assistance, and expanded protection are adding resilience to households, while overseas opportunities in Japan, Germany and Israel are creating new pathways for skilled youth and supporting a stronger state economy.

Together, these measures connect recruitment, income security, and global mobility, reinforcing a broader livelihood ecosystem for workers, families, and vulnerable citizens across Uttar Pradesh.

PHOTOS: DPR, GOVT OF UP

People-powered growth

1 lakh+ jobs
UP's six-month employment target, signalling an accelerated recruitment drive across key sectors.

Over 36,000 police posts
Recruitment is underway for more than 36,000 positions in the Police Department.

25,000-30,000 appointments
Upcoming UPSSSC results are expected to generate a substantial number of appointments.

15,000-16,000 appointments
Expected through UPPSC examinations, adding momentum to government recruitment.

41,000-42,000 home guard posts
Recruitment is progressing for a large intake into the Home Guard Department.

20,000-25,000 appointments
Youth are expected to secure positions, including 12,405 teachers under Super TET 2026.

Global opportunities
Japan, Germany and Israel are showing interest in UP's skilled workforce, creating overseas employment avenues.

5,000 youth in Israel
Around 5,000 UP youth have secured employment opportunities in Israel.

3.5 lakh+ outsourced workers
UPCOS is bringing outsourced employees and their families within a wider welfare framework.

1.18 crore+ pension beneficiaries
A ₹1,500 monthly pension to support senior citizens, destitute women, and persons with disabilities.

Mid-day meal cooks

A stronger welfare package is supporting 3.53 lakh mid-day meal cooks. Their monthly honorarium has increased from ₹2,000 to ₹3,000, while cashless healthcare is extended to ₹5 lakh. Uniform allowance has doubled from ₹500 to ₹1,000, combining income enhancement with health and livelihood protection for frontline workers across Uttar Pradesh.

Pension support

As per a recent announcement, monthly pension to increase by 50%, from ₹1,000 to ₹1,500, benefiting senior citizens, destitute women, and persons with disabilities. Around 1.18 crore beneficiaries across the three categories now receive higher recurring support, providing greater financial assistance for everyday needs and strengthening household security for vulnerable sections of society statewide today.

Outsourced workforce

Uttar Pradesh Corporation for Outsourcing Services (UPCOS) is bringing wider welfare protection to outsourced workers and their families. Around 3.5 lakh outsourced employees are covered under the broader initiative, with potential reach estimated at 17-20 lakh people. The approach shifts assistance from individual workers towards family-oriented social security and protection.

Anganwadi workers

Anganwadi workers are receiving stronger support through a 50% rise in monthly honorarium, from ₹8,000 to ₹12,000. The initiative strengthens protection for workers delivering essential services at the grassroots. Helpers also receive enhanced support, while health insurance forms part of the welfare measures supporting these frontline workers and their families.

Healthcare access

Cashless healthcare has been extended to teachers, PRD personnel, mid-day meal cooks, Anganwadi workers and helpers. By reducing the fiscal impact of medical emergencies, the measure adds another layer of livelihood security. Health protection alongside income support demonstrates a broader welfare approach designed to strengthen resilience among workers and households.

Strengthening policing

More than 2.25 lakh recruitments have been made in the state's police department over the past nine years. Recently, the Uttar Pradesh Police inducted 470 sportspersons under the skilled players quota, including 422 constables and 48 sub-inspectors.

TIMES GLOBAL

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026

HOLLAND TAYLOR SAYS WAS 'NEVER PAID VERY WELL' ON 'TWO AND A HALF MEN': 'I GOT 4 EMMY NOMS, BUT NEVER A RAISE'

THE MOST DIFFICULT THING IS THE DECISION TO ACT, THE REST IS MERELY TENACITY — AMELIA EARHART

ROBERT PATTINSON PRAISES STEVEN SODERBERGH FOR STEPPING IN TO FINISH 'BATMAN 2' FILMING: 'SO SELFLESS'

Israelis shatter turnout records to pass wartime judgement on Bibi

66.7% Voters Cast Ballots Within First 9 Hours; No Party Expected To Have Majority

Jerusalem: Israelis surged to the polls Tuesday at a pace that shattered records, to pass wartime judgment on PM Benjamin Netanyahu in what voters described as the most consequential election in the nation's history. Long queues formed outside polling stations for the first election since the Oct 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks, with voters engaged over the trauma of the country's deadliest day and the ensuing wars in Gaza, Lebanon and Iran.

The Central Elections Committee reported that 66.7% of eligible voters had already cast their ballots within the first nine hours of voting, a record by that point in the day with six more hours to go.

Policies of Netanyahu's right-wing coalition have been divisive at home and have deepened Israel's international isolation, while he has defended his record, calling himself the only leader with the mettle to face down Israel's foes. Netanyahu, Israel's longest-serving leader with 19 years in office, is an unmatched political survivor, and his nationalist politics are increasingly entrenched. Israel's fragmented system makes it difficult for an array of opponents to force out his coalition of right-wing, far-right and ultra-Orthodox parties.

His main rival Gadi Eisenkot, a military ex-chief of staff and security hawk, aims to unseat him with the support of parties on the right and centre, as well as the rump of an increasingly marginalised left. Opinion polls show a close race.

In a message to supporters, Netanyahu urged them to vote, saying turnout was high among his opponents on the left and among Israelis of Arab heritage, around a fifth of the country. "We need it to be high too. You all need to stream to the polls," he said. "This is a fateful moment."

Voter sees election as 'most important of all ones'

"I think these elections are the most important of all the ones I've known," said Ruth Epstein, an 81-year-old longtime left-wing voter in Ramat Gan near Tel Aviv, who voted for the opposition Democrats. "I'm really scared about what will be here."

Netanyahu has campaigned on an endorsement from US President Trump, his ally in war against Iran, who has said they should "finish the job". If neither Netanyahu nor Eisenkot can form a governing coalition in the 120-seat parliament, Netanyahu could stay on as caretaker until another election is held. His opponents have managed to wrest him from the premiership only once since 2009, and that took four inconclusive elections in two years. He was back 18 months later.

Eisenkot sees 'new spirit'

For many of Netanyahu's opponents, the election turns on accountability for the security failures of Oct 7. Opposition groups have promised to hold a national inquiry, which Netanyahu's govt has resisted. "I am convinced that by the end of today, we will see a change — a new spirit for the State of Israel — that will serve as a rectification for the past three years and for that terrible day," Eisenkot said. Eisenkot says Israel's response was a failure because Hamas remains in charge. He repeated his commitment to dismantle or destroy Hamas' military and governing power in Gaza within 18 months of forming a govt.

Arab turnout a key

Ahmed Tibi, a candidate from an Arab party, said the record turnout from Israel's Arab minority would "pave the way for an alternative govt and change the grave reality". Eisenkot has ruled out partnering with Arab parties, citing a lack of shared values, although some possible scenarios envision them propping up a minority govt to topple Netanyahu. Netanyahu has repeatedly described Arab-Israeli voters as a threat in language his opponents say crosses into racism.

Like nearly all Jewish party leaders in Israel, Eisenkot opposes the two-state solution that once underpinned decades of peace negotiations with the Palestinians. But he has criticised Jewish settler violence against Palestinians in the Israeli-occupied West Bank, which has surged since 2023 and strained Israel's ties with Western states. And he opposes Netanyahu's far-right coalition partners. REUTERS

BIBI BLOC AND OTHER CAMPS

From long-standing leaders to key challengers, these are the party heads competing for control of the 120-seat Knesset. Facing off across security, national identity, and governance, these key figures will decide Israel's next PM and define the coalition that forms its future:

NETANYAHU'S CAMP

Benjamin Netanyahu, 77 (Likud)

PM and **right-wing** nationalist framing the race around security and countering Iran. Opponents blame him for Oct 7 security failures, war management, and the hostage crisis; he also denies ongoing corruption charges

Itamar Ben-Gvir, 50 (Otzma Yehudit)

Far-right national security minister and key ally advocating West Bank expansion, tighter control, and a hardline stance toward Palestinians

Bezalel Smotrich, 46 (Religious Zionism–Zehut)

Far-right finance minister pushing West Bank annexation, settlement expansion, and weakening the Palestinian Authority

Aryeh Deri, 67 (Shas)

Leads the **ultra-Orthodox** Sephardic party, prioritising welfare, religious education, and military exemptions for ultra-Orthodox men

Ya'akov Asher, 59 (United Torah Judaism)

Heads the **ultra-Orthodox** Ashkenazi alliance focused on protecting community funding and preserving seminary draft exemptions

OPPOSITION AND CHANGE CAMP

Gadi Eisenkot, 66 (Yashar)

Centrist former IDF chief of staff and chief challenger, demanding universal military conscription, professional governance, and an October 7 inquiry while rejecting Hamas rule

Naftali Bennett, 54 (Beyachad)

Right-wing former prime minister running jointly with Lapid; pairs hardline security views with anti-Netanyahu governance across ideological lines

Yair Lapid, 62 (Beyachad / Yesh Atid)

Centrist former prime minister campaigning on secular civic rights, draft requirements for the ultra-Orthodox, clean governance, and pragmatic security

Yair Golan, 64 (The Democrats)

Centre-left former general uniting Labour and Meretz traditions; backs an Oct 7 probe, curbing settler violence, and a Palestinian statehood horizon

() Names within the brackets indicate political parties

ARAB-PARTY REPRESENTATION

Mansour Abbas, 52 (Ra'am)

Pragmatic Islamist seeking municipal and civic funding through coalition participation; ballot eligibility is contested following a disqualification vote by the Central Elections Committee

The Joint List | Unites Hadash, Ta'al, and Balad across Jewish-Arab leftist and Palestinian nationalist lines; similarly disqualified pending appeal, their participation remains critical to potential coalition math

It could take weeks to declare Israel's new PM. It might even require another election as Israelis vote for parties and not candidates. None of the main parties is expected to get majority. So the next PM will have to cobble together a coalition

STORY BEHIND LULA'S 6.7M VOTE SWING

Trailing after round one, Lula staged a historic turnaround in Brazil elections by expanding voter turnout through a massive digital mobilisation drive and flipping the state of Minas Gerais which sealed his comeback, explains **Aishwarya Shukla**

Indicator / Metric	1st Round	2nd Round (Runoff)	Net Shift / Impact
Lula's vote share took a major leap, eventually crossing majority	**45.2%** (53.8m)	**51.8%** (64.2m)*	+10.4m votes (+6.63 pp)
Flavio Bolsonaro attracted more voters too, but it wasn't enough	**47.1%** (56.1m)	**48.2%** (59.8m)	+3.7m votes (+1.18 pp)
Lula's defeat-to-victory differential	Trailing by **2.3m (-1.87 pp)**	Won by **4.4m (+3.58 pp)**	+6.7m net vote swing
% of voters who didn't vote	21.1	19.2	-1.88 pp (about 3m more voted in R2)
Social media mobilisation, WA channel supporting Lula sees massive surge	53,000	10.8m	More than 10.7m followers added
Municipalities which had chosen Bolsonaro in R1 vote for Lula in R2	-	213	Flipped to Lula across 18 states
Lula won Minas Gerais in R2, preserving the bellwether state's streak of picking the nat'l winner	Lead was with Bolsonaro	Lula secured lead with 50.4% votes	76 municipalities flipped to Lula

*In R2, Lula absorbed most of the 9.3m votes (7.8%) cast for minor third-party candidates in R1 PP = Percentage point

Bolsonaro has left for US after party conceded defeat: Report

Flavio Bolsonaro fled Brazil hours after losing the presidential election and being ordered to surrender his passports, Folha de S.Paulo reported citing allies of the conservative senator.

Brazil's federal police cancelled Bolsonaro's passports after he failed to surrender them within a 24-hour deadline imposed by the Supreme Court, according to a police official familiar with the matter. Justice Alexandre de Moraes, whom the Bolsonaro family has long accused of political persecution, issued the order amid concerns Bolsonaro posed a flight risk while facing criminal investigations.

Moraes' decision, coming on the heels of Bolsonaro's failed attempt to challenge the election results, injected tension into an already tumultuous election and reinforced perceptions among his supporters that the court is determined to persecute their political movement. Police have no official record of Bolsonaro leaving Brazil. Bolsonaro's allies told Bloomberg News on Tuesday that they tried to contact him in the morning but had not heard back.

AFP

Flavio Bolsonaro's passport has been cancelled after he failed to comply with an order to surrender it, a police source said Tuesday

The press secretary for Argentine President Javier Milei denied that Bolsonaro had entered the country after Infobae reported that he had crossed into Argentina through Misiones ptovinvce and planned to travel to US from there. A spokesman for Bolsonaro didn't respond to requests for comment. Brazil's federal police have likewise found no record of Bolsonaro passing through an official Brazilian immigration checkpoint, the Brazilian police officer said.

On Monday, Bolsonaro said in a social media video that federal police had ordered him to surrender both his regular and diplomatic passports and told him he was barred from leaving Brazil.

Bolsonaro is subject to at least two federal investigations. The first involves allegations of money laundering, corruption and tax evasion. The other stems from a police investigation that identified ties between Bolsonaro and a lawyer under scrutiny over allegations of money laundering. A Brazilian Supreme Court justice Tuesday ordered federal authorities to open an investigation into possible illegal foreign financing of Bolsonaro's presidential campaign, including by a group linked to US Vice President JD Vance.

Bolsonaro lost Brazil's presidential runoff to Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva Sunday. He initially said he would request the annulment of the results due to a supreme court decision to extend voting hours, before backing off those plans. In a statement signed Monday, Bolsonaro's Liberal Party recognised the result and conceded defeat while criticising the increase of public spending in the run-up to the vote and its impact on the race. BLOOMBERG

5 mths after fastest Everest climb, US cancer survivor sets mountain run record

Vishant.Agarwala
@timesofindia.com

Five months after he broke the Everest speed record, US endurance athlete Tyler Andrews, 36, set another high-altitude mark on Tuesday, completing the 54.4km trail from Everest Base Camp to Lukla in seven hours and 43 minutes. He beat the previous record of nine hours, 47 minutes and 59 seconds, set by David Byrne and Majell Backhausen in Dec 2023, by more than two hours.

Andrews started from Everest Base Camp at 7.45am and recorded his finishing time on his watch, as stated in his update. Earlier that morning, he had travelled by helicopter from Namche Bazaar to Gorakshep before trekking to base camp to begin the attempt.

The route, which involves approximately 3,000m of elevation loss, typically takes trekkers three to four days to complete. It passes through settlements including Pheriche, Tengboche, Namche Bazaar and Phakding before ending at Lukla, the mountain town whose airport serves as the main gateway for Everest trekkers and climbers.

Dawa Steven Sherpa, managing director of Asian Trekking, Tyler's expedition organiser, told **TOI**, "His satellite navigation tracker placed him near Lobuche at 8.50am. He passed through Namche Bazaarat 12.41pm and Phakding at 2.21pm before completing the final stretch to Lukla." In May this year, Andrews scaled Everest from Base Camp in nine hours, 55 minutes and 43 seconds, breaking the 23-year-old oxygen-assisted ascent record of 10:56:46 set by Nepal's Lhakpa Gelu Sherpa in 2003. With Tuesday's run, Andrews now holds speed records in both directions on the Lukla–Base Camp and Base Camp–Everest summit routes, with supplemental oxygen used for the summit records.

Localised truce brokered by Melania begins in Ukrainian city

Russia and Ukraine began observing a localised ceasefire around Russian-occupied Oleshky on Tuesday, ahead of a humanitarian aid mission that White House said was brokered by US first lady Melania Trump. The pause began at 3am and is due to continue until 10.59pm local time on Sunday, according to Ukrainian lawmaker Davyd Arakhamia. Its exact geographical scope remained unclear, though it covered Oleshky and nearby parts of Kherson region.

Melania said in a post on X that the ceasefire began two days earlier than initially planned "to protect the safety of civilians and to facilitate the delivery of critical humanitarian aid." She said it extended beyond Oleshky to enable safe passage for humanitarian convoys. Food and medical supplies are running perilously low for as many as 2,000 people remaining in Oleshky city. Negotiators said doctors, medicines, food supplies and water would arrive before evacuation corridors opened there. AP

Manga artist Tetsuya Chiba, known for his boxing series 'Ashita no Joe,' passes away

Tokyo: Legendary Japanese manga artist Tetsuya Chiba, who caused a national sensation with his boxing series "Ashita no Joe" or "Fighting for Tomorrow," a story about an orphan becoming a professional boxer, has died at 87. Chiba's masterpiece series became so popular that fans even attended a mock funeral for the protagonist Joe Yabuki's rival. Chiba died at a Tokyo hospital last Thursday, his publisher Kodansha Ltd. said Tuesday, without specifying the cause of his death.

While he depicted aspiring young athletes fighting for their lives and careers, Chiba was a vocal supporter of peace and freedom of expression, telling stories of his harrowing memories of war as a child in autobiographical stories and manga. Months after he was born in Tokyo in Jan 1939, his family moved to China, and Chiba spent his early childhood there during Japan's occupation in the region.

At age 6, Chiba and his family marked Japan's surrender on Aug 15, 1945, while they were still in China. There, they faced danger and hunger in the face of anti-Japanese riots, but survived. The family eventually fled to China's port city of Huludao and returned to Japan in 1946.

The memories later influenced his work and activity with an anti-war theme. Chiba debuted as a manga artist in 1956. In 1961, he debuted in a boys' comic magazine with a baseball manga "Chikai no Makyu (The Magic Ball)," paving the way for a new genre of sports-themed manga in Japan.

Chiba's sports-themed manga also included "Ore wa Teppei (I'm Teppei)," the story of a high school student training in the martial art of kendo, "Notari Matsutaro", about sumo wrestling, and "Ashita Tenki ni Naare (Let's hope the weather's fine tomorrow)", about a teenage golfer. AP

Russian sats helping Iran's allies strike Saudi: Officials

Beirut: Iranian-backed militias carried out a precision strike last month, hitting the pumping stations of Saudi Arabia's most important oil pipeline. Days later, another attack hit a Saudi military air base, damaging an Italian fighter jet inside a hangar.

Crucial to the strikes' success was what was happening in the skies overhead: For days beforehand, Russian spy satellites converged over the pipeline and the air base to gather intelligence.

A private geospatial intelligence firm said it examined 40 missile and drone attacks against Saudi Arabia by Houthi rebels in Yemen and militias in Iraq between July 1 and Oct 19. In every case, the firm found the same pattern of Russian govt and military satellites orbiting above the areas for days before and after. "What we found is a 100% match" between the satellite activities and strikes, said Nawaf Obaid, founder of Geneva-based AURORAH Geosignal Intelligence. AP

Houthis claim attacks on Saudi defence ministry

Yemen's Houthis said they fired missiles at Saudi Arabia's biggest oil refinery and defence ministry Tuesday, as shrapnel from interceptions caused damage in Riyadh. Saudi Arabia, the world's top exporter of crude, has suffered weeks of strikes by the Iran-backed Houthis against oil and civilian sites including Riyadh's international airport.

"Our armed forces targeted the Ministry of Defence in the enemy Saudi capital, Riyadh, with a ballistic missile and the hit was direct," Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree said. The Houthis were also "able to target the Ras Tanura refinery in the Eastern Province with a ballistic missile", he said in a separate post, adding the strike caused "massive fires".

Saudi authorities did not comment on specific targets, but said they shot down missiles over Riyadh and the Eastern Province. AFP correspondents in Riyadh heard explosions on Tuesday. A text message alert warned residents to seek shelter as blasts rattled windows in the city centre. Saudi authorities said they shot down two ballistic missiles launched towards the capital, with shrapnel hitting a building, a construction project and a car. AFP

How Cheesecake Factory became new front in Trump-Obama war

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: American fast food chain Cheesecake Factory has spent decades perfecting the art of serving customers an expansive menu in portions that suggest they may never eat again. It has achieved something even more remarkable now: become a central character in the long-running Trump-Obama feud that has devolved into a culinary spat wrapped in a culture war.

The MAGA boss Monday went after Obama, calling him a "lousy president," after his predecessor mocked Trump's obsession with a White House makeover, likening its gilded accents and gold platings to a Cheesecake Factory that Saddam Hussain may have opened. Peeved at the perceived slight to upgrades he thinks are required to restore the White House to pristine glory — but which critics think are gaudy and garish — a clearly annoyed Trump, in a lengthy rebuttal, said Obama was "not a smart guy" because he did not recognise the importance of showcasing class and quality.

It was a remarkable amount of presidential indignation to expend over a joke invoking comparisons to a restaurant chain famous for serving enough food to require a congressional inquiry into portion control. It was also a cue for Trump's MAGA minions to order the outrage platter, with extra umbrage on the side, by seizing on Cheesecake Factory's iconic status as one of the top family restaurants in Middle America, a place that makes a glutton's pulse quicken and arteries thicken.

Trump went after Obama Monday, calling him a 'lousy president', after his predecessor mocked Trump's obsession with a WH makeover, likening its gold platings to a Cheesecake Factory that Saddam Hussain may have opened

Conservative commentator Scott Jennings jibed that a man like Obama, who "makes speeches for 500k a pop, hasn't eaten dinner that costs less than $250 in a year, has never been in a Cheesecake Factory," was being condescending towards Americans who are not part of the elite class. Radio host Clay Travis recalled that eating there had been a special occasion for his family, as it remains for millions of others.

And just to drive home the point, treasury secretary Scott Bessent, a billionaire former hedge-fund manager, duly dined at a Washington-area Cheesecake Factory, emerging to tell a conveniently waiting cameraman the "Martha's Vineyard set" (Obama and his ilk) should give the restaurant a try. Criticism of the place that occupied a storied place in Middle America's heart had come from a man whose presidential library resembled "Darth Vader's tomb," Bessent jibed. The White House itself joined the food fight, posting a list of Trump's accomplishments in a format that resembled Cheesecake Factory's menu.

Obama's defenders, trying to forestall the "deplorables" debacle that convulsed America (after Hillary Clinton characterised Trump supporters in those terms in 2016) insist the point was not that Cheesecake Factory patrons are deplorable or declasse or that the food is beneath liberals.

While conceding that Trump has a legitimate point when he says the White House should be clean, well maintained and beautiful, they argued the question is one of proportion. If Obama had compared the White House to French Laundry, a rarefied Michelin-star California restaurant, the snobbery charge might have had more seasoning; Cheesecake Factory, they acknowledge, is practically a national dialect.

But when a president devotes excessive attention to gold trim, ballroom plans and a reflecting pool, as Trump is doing to the point of making it a fetish amid ongoing war, they say the optics become cheesy. Trump may regard the work as a labour of love, but right now critics see a commander in chief who seems preoccupied with cushions and drapes — while the house is on fire.

DAILY PLANET

AP

Venezuelan opposition leader and Nobel Peace Prize laureate Maria Corina Machado greets supporters upon her arrival in Caracas

'Maxxing' is Dictionary.com's word of 2026

In the age of constant self-improvement, simply getting better at something is no longer enough; you have to "maxx" it. The internet's go-to term for taking things to the next level has now earned wider recognition, with Dictionary.com naming "maxxing" its Word of the Year for 2026, ABC News said. Announced Monday, the word refers to "the practice of pursuing an activity to the fullest or optimizing a certain aspect of your life", according to Dictionary.com. The term comes from "maximum" and "max" and is often paired with other words to describe efforts to improve or push something to its limit. One of the most prominent examples is "looksmaxxing", a trend centred on maximising physical appearance.

Man slips through fence and escapes prison in US

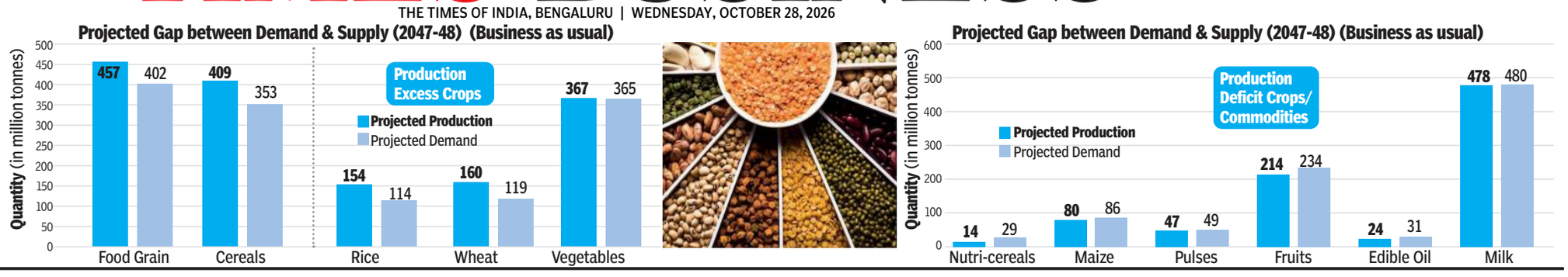
A man serving a life sentence for killing his co-worker four years ago has escaped from a prison in northwest Tennessee by slipping through a fence, authorities said. Officials realised Jacob Morley, 28, was still unaccounted for. Investigators looked at security cameras and saw Morley escaped while wearing his prison uniform, officials said. They did not release any other details, including how he got through the fence.

TIMES BUSINESS
THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026

Will India Produce Enough Food To Meet Future Demand?

According to United Nations' World Population Prospects, India's population is projected to rise from about 1.4 billion in 2023 to approximately 1.7 billion by 2050. Meeting the needs of this large population would require productivity gains that are resilient to climate variability and do not accelerate the depletion of land and water resources

Source: KPMG



Govt takes step to ease GST notices, litigation

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Following up on GST Council decisions, Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs has issued over half a dozen detailed circulars on steps to reduce litigation and appeals, issuing show cause notices to taxpayers and speeding up registrations and changes that businesses need to make.

Tax authorities have underlined the need to facilitate registration while ensuring that there is no misuse. "While there is a need to exercise due diligence in processing registration application to prevent GST registration form being obtained by unscrupulous and fraudulent elements for passing on input tax credit (ITC) without any underlying supply, at the same time, it is also important to ensure that genuine applicants seeking registration are able to complete the process without undue inconvenience," CBIC said in the circular.

It specifies that pre-show cause notice intimation may be given to taxpayers, wherever feasible, so that they can clarify their position prior to the start of formal proceedings. This will promote voluntary compliance and reduce the necessity of issuing such notices, the department said.

'Cos rebrand layoffs as workforce planning'

▶Continued from page 1

As all tech companies figure out how to get closer to this benchmark, they are engaging in long-term employee mix planning at a never-before scale," she said.

> Corporate HR is notorious in its verbiage for layoffs. Whatever you call it, a layoff is a layoff. Even if we call it by any other name, a thorn remains a thorn. Apologies to William Shakespeare
> **Harish Bijoor** | BRAND AND BUSINESS STRATEGY SPECIALIST

"Companies want to make a distinction between longer-term personnel planning and distress-based terminations, so they're coming up with new language. It will standardise soon," she added.

While the corporate world may find yet another gentler term for sacking, the person carrying a box out of the office probably won't care.

RIL board to consider fund-raise on Oct 30

Mumbai: Reliance Industries on Tuesday said its board will meet on Oct 30 to consider a fund-raise programme through the issuance of listed redeemable non-convertible debentures. On Friday, the company is scheduled to review and approve its financial results for the second quarter of FY27. TNN

Focus on covering more people and not just higher covers: Irdai

Regulator Wants Effective Protection For Every Rupee Spent

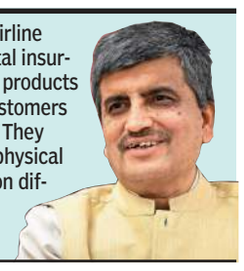
TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: Insurance companies must focus on covering more people and delivering effective protection for every rupee spent, rather than seeking higher premiums from existing policyholders, Irdai chairman Ajay Seth said.

He also called for online insurance platforms to stick to their core role of helping customers compare products and buy policies, rather than expanding into physical distribution, using dynamic pricing or demanding contact details and do-not-disturb waiver before providing quotes.

"We have to change our lens," Seth said. "Instead of measuring insurance penetration and density, the industry should track lives and businesses covered, the effectiveness of protection and cover per rupee spent." He was speaking during a fireside chat at a Business Standard BFSI event.

> Dynamic pricing works in the airline industry, not in insurance. Digital insurance platforms should offer simplified products for easy price comparison and help customers find suitable cover at the lowest price. They should not dilute this role by building physical distribution networks, which operate on different dynamics
> **AJAY SETH** | CHAIRMAN, IRDAI



Insurers serve the top 10-15% of the population reasonably well, but extending meaningful cover to the top 50% requires better affordability and quality. "Instead of chasing existing people for higher cover we should go for covering more people," he said, adding that insurance must grow faster than the economy, not slower.

Seth said digital insurance platforms should offer simplified products for easy price comparison and help customers find suitable cover at the lowest price. They should not dilute this role by building physical distribution networks, which operate on different dynamics. He also cautioned against the practice of offering dynamic pricing for covers by online platforms.

"Dynamic pricing works in the airline industry, not in insurance," he said, ruling out price changes on digital platforms. Customers should be able to compare prices without sharing personal details. Regulatory guardrails are needed to keep platforms focused on their core purpose.

Health insurance is growing general insurance at 1.3 times the economy's pace, but high customer dissatisfaction threatens to undermine growth. Seth called this an "uneasy, unstable equilibrium" and said insurers must disclose how much of the premiums they collect, they actually pay out in health insurance claims. Current settlement rates do not show this. "That information neither we track nor is it in the public domain," he said. Seth was critical of the high churn in the health insurance portfolio under the guise of portability to show increased new business.

Irdai is consulting insurers, intermediaries and policyholder representatives on distribution reforms to cut acquisition costs and ease premium pressure. Health insurance commissions average 24% across new policies and renewals; reducing them to 15-20% is the objective, he said. The regulator also wants to cut health insurance paperwork through the National Health Exchange. Cashless treatment accounts for around 60% of cases, rising by 1-2 percentage points a year, against a 90% longer-term target, he said.

Govt identifies 120 items for local production push

Wants To Reduce Dependence On Imports, Mainly From China, And Increase Capacity

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New Delhi: Govt has identified around 120 products, including intermediates and capital goods, for domestic manufacturing push and to reduce dependence on imports, with a separate plan for tunnel boring machines in the works after China imposed restrictions on their shipments.

As part of the exercise, which is being driven by the department for promotion of industry and internal trade (DPIIT), the range of products includes chemicals such as acetic acid, pharmaceutical products and inputs, medical technology related items, machine tools, including some textile looms, construction equipment, cranes, products used in the aerospace sector as MROs (maintenance, repair and operations) are coming up in the country. Besides, the list also includes some consumer goods, including products that are part of the footwear value chain, persons familiar with the discussions told **TOI**.

While discussions are currently underway with other govt agencies, three types of intervention are planned. One, short-term protection that will enable products, which are identified, to deal with competition from overseas, especially China, till supplies are diversified. A similar strategy had been adopted in the case of mobile phones in the initial years.

The second set of measures will deal with cost disability through incentives that could be capital incentives or phased over a period and may be linked to turnover. Also, on the menu is the option to provide R&D assistance as some of the products need to be developed locally as technology is not available.

Over the last six-to-eight years, govt has sought to provide support to companies, both domestic and international, across sectors ranging from pharma and electronics to semiconductors, solar power equipment and white goods to encourage local production. A large part of the money has flown through PLIs, along with two semiconductor missions as well as a scheme aimed at enhancing production of electronic components in the country as demand for inputs has soared after domestic manufacturing of phones took off.

Govt is also considering easing of press note 2 paperwork to promote investments. Also, easing of application forms to help boost investments from companies with less than 10% Chinese stake.

Support for R&D probably flows from the experience in battery production as companies that have begun "local production" are essentially importing cells from China and selling battery packs as the entire production chain and technology is controlled by companies across the border. A similar experience was seen in the case of solar panels. The plan flows from the overall Atmanirbhar Bharat strategy of govt, which has received renewed attention after the West Asia crisis, when several critical items were in short supply locally due to large import dependence. Even during Covid, supply of several products, including medical inputs, was hit as China controlled the production chains.

Incentives In The Works

GOVT IS PLANNING 3 TYPES OF INTERVENTION

- Short-term protection to enable identified products to deal with overseas competition, mainly from China
- Steps to deal with cost disability through incentives
- R&D assistance as some products need to be developed locally as technology is not available

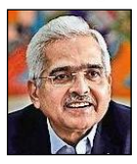
Centre mulls easier paperwork for Chinese FDI

New Delhi: Govt is considering simplifying the application process for Press Note 2 to ease foreign direct investment (FDI) in local entities holding less than 10% investment from countries sharing a land border with India, sources said.
Govt had relaxed FDI restrictions imposed under Press Note 3 for countries sharing land borders with India, such as China and Pakistan, through Press Note 2 in March. AGENCIES

Das flags priorities for banks to sustain growth

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: India's 8% growth target is within reach, but sustaining that pace will require banks and financial institutions to finance infrastructure, advanced manufacturing and smaller businesses while expanding insurance and pension coverage, former RBI governor Shaktikanta Das said on Tuesday.



He called for deeper credit and bond markets and a shift in household savings from physical assets to productive financial investments to support India's ambition of becoming a developed economy by 2047.

"In fact, in the recent months, I have stated on record that India is in a striking distance of 8% growth," Das said in his keynote address at the Business Standard BFSI Summit 2026 here. He attributed the momentum to "the triple engines of macroeconomic stability; continuing structural reforms; and strategic policy initiatives to develop domestic capacity where we are largely import dependent".

Sustaining growth would be harder amid geopolitical conflicts, trade barriers, sanctions, unilateral tariffs and supply chain disruptions. Unlike earlier shocks, these disruptions had become prolonged, threatening energy and commodity markets, economic activity and financial stability. He said consumption-related household borrowing required "careful and consistent monitoring", signalling the need for continued scrutiny even as aggregate indicators improved.

Premium liquor demand holds up in Sept quarter

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Bengaluru: Indians continued to spend on pricier beer and spirits in the Sept quarter, helping liquor makers post stronger sales and profits even as costs remained high.

Radico Khaitan reported total income of Rs 5,588 crore for the quarter, up 10% from a year earlier, while net profit rose 66% to Rs 232 crore. The maker of Magic Moments vodka and Rampur whisky saw volumes of its Prestige & Above, or higher-priced, liquor rise 35.8%, while volumes of its regular products fell 9.7%.

Premium products now account for 77.1% of Radico's Indian-made foreign liquor revenue, up from 68.6% a year earlier. Managing director Abhishek Khaitan told **TOI** that the company was increasingly focusing on premium liquor and would sell regular products selectively in states where they remained profitable. Vodka has been a major driver. Khaitan said vodka now accounts for 6.3% of liquor sold in India, compared with 3.7% about two years ago, while Radico controls around 60% of the vodka market. He expects the shift to continue for several years.

United Breweries, the maker of Kingfisher beer, reported total income of Rs 4,664 crore, up 24% from Rs 3,752 crore a year earlier. Profit for the quarter nearly tripled to Rs 135 crore from Rs 46 crore. Overall beer volumes rose 16%, but premium beer volumes jumped 38%. Heineken Silver volumes grew 67%, while Kingfisher Ultra volumes rose 44%. United Breweries said higher volumes, price increases and consumers trading up to premium beer helped sales, while cost savings also boosted profitability.

Allied Blenders and Distillers (ABD), which makes Officer's Choice and ICONiQ White, reported total income of Rs 2,089 crore, up 7%, while profit rose 10% to Rs 69 crore. ABD showed a somewhat different trend. Volumes of its Prestige & Above products rose 6.1% to 4.5 million cases, while its lower-priced Mass Premium & Others portfolio grew faster, rising 15.5% to 5.5 million cases. However, revenue from the premium portfolio still rose 13.4%, as the company earned more on every case sold.

Advent raises $30 billion, launches mid-mkt fund

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Bengaluru: Global private equity investor Advent International has raised $30 billion across its funds, including nearly $27 billion for its 11th flagship fund and more than $3 billion for a new mid-market strategy, expanding its investment capabilities and international presence.

Advent International GPE XI raised more than its $26 billion target, while the new Advent Mid-Market Private Equity fund is the firm's first dedicated vehicle for smaller buyouts and growth investments. It will target equity investments of $100 million to $350 million in companies with enterprise values of up to $1.2 billion, primarily in North America and Europe.

The mid-market strategy will complement the flagship fund, applying Advent's sector-led, operationally intensive approach to companies of a different scale. Both funds will draw on the firm's global network and expertise across business and financial services, consumer, healthcare, industrial and technology sectors.

Shweta Jalan, managing partner at Advent, said, "We're proud to have raised $30 billion across our global fund complex and excited about what it means for India, where Advent has built a strong track record through recent investments including Yatharth Hospitals, Iscon Balaji, Aditya Birla Housing Finance, Svatantra and Apollo 24/7. These funds reinforce our commitment to India and give us even greater capacity to back ambitious entrepreneurs and management teams as they build for the future."

TVS family feud deepens

▶Continued from page 1

The March 2024 agreement was intended to prevent competition between family members and set out arrangements governing the use of TVS brands and other business interests. Mallika and Lakshmi, however, argue that no formal process involving valuation, discussions and mutual consent has been undertaken to settle the family's economic interests.

On the other hand, Venu Srinivasan, chairman emeritus of TVS Motor Company, maintains that the businesses and assets belonged to him and that he had the discretion to distribute them in the family's best interests. He has said the separation was intended to give the next generation ownership and control, with Lakshmi taking forward the Sundaram-Clayton business and Sudarshan the motor business.

Venu maintains that the division was fair and transparent and followed consultations with the family. He has also cited factors such as Mallika's stated intention to pass on ownership and control of TAFE to Lakshmi.

The dispute appears to have intensified earlier this year following a boardroom confrontation at Sundaram-Clayton. After Lakshmi raised a governance complaint, Venu Srinivasan moved to convene an emergency board meeting. It was subsequently learnt that decisions taken by the board in the preceding days had been reversed, and he returned as CMD, while Lakshmi continued in her operational role as managing director.

The caveats filed by Venu, his son Sudarshan, VS Trust, Mallika and Lakshmi are intended to ensure that the parties are heard before a court passes any order in proceedings arising from the dispute. The filings signal that the family is preparing for possible legal action even as Mallika and Lakshmi continue to advocate an amicable resolution.

India open to free, fair trade with China: Goyal

Hague: India is open to promoting free and fair trade with China and hopes to expand its exports of goods and services to the neighbouring country and Asean region in the coming years, commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal said late Monday, signalling scope for deeper trade engagement with Beijing. Goyal told reporters that India believed in open trade across the world and was looking for open markets in different countries on a reciprocal basis to sell Indian goods and services. "Yes, at some stage maybe we will do that also," he said when asked if India was considering a similar exercise with China after concluding talks on a trade agreement with the European Union (EU).The minister said he had met his Chinese counterpart in Yaoundé, Cameroon, earlier this year and again in New Delhi during the latter's visit for the Brics summit in Sept. "We are open to working and encouraging free and fair trade with every country around the globe. We are looking to open markets in different countries on a reciprocal basis for our goods and services also," he said. TNN

Exit mode: Microsoft employees face tough stay-or-leave call

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Bengaluru: When Microsoft rolled out its voluntary exit option (VEO), it surprised India-based employees who received the email, even if workforce changes were not entirely unexpected. For Gandhi, a software engineer at the company who chose to be identified this way, the immediate reaction was anxiety about what the future might hold.

"It is quite scary, to be honest, because we don't know where the future is heading and what will happen," she told **TOI**. Gandhi said the option had been extended to eligible employees across participating organisations.

But deciding whether to take the offer is not straightforward, particularly in a difficult job market. Employees have time to consider their options, and Gandhi said she was still trying to make sense of the situation.

"Everything is so hazy right now. We can't determine everything at this moment because they have given us time. So, we'll think about it, get to know what is happening, and see how things unfold. It's a very tight market," she said.

The prospect of switching jobs adds to the uncertainty. "Even switching jobs is a big thing. I have seen my friends trying to switch, but it's very difficult," she added.

Microsoft is learnt to have offered the VEO to 60,000 employees across eligible organisations. Microsoft's VEO covers AI experiences, Copilot, agents & platform, CoreAI, finance, human resources, office of the CTO, strategy & transformation, Windows + Devices, and Xbox. Cloud + AI, corporate, external, and legal affairs (CELA), and Microsoft AI (MAI) are partially participating; employee eligibility varies, and leaders are expected to share further details by team. Marketing, Microsoft Commercial Business, Microsoft Discovery & Quantum, and Microsoft Security are not participating in the programme.

TAKE THE EXIT?

Eligible employees are in India, the US, the UK and Canada	**NOT EVERY TEAM** Marketing, Microsoft Commercial Business, Microsoft Discovery & Quantum, and Microsoft Security are excluded.
WHO QUALIFIES? Employees at level 70 and below, across participating teams	completed year of service, plus health insurance and career-transition support
THE PAYOUT One month's base salary for every	**THE DEADLINE** Employees must decide by Dec 1

Microsoft has about **23k employees in India**

Ironically, a day before Microsoft announced its voluntary exit option (VEO), co-founder Bill Gates was quoted in an interview published in The Observer on Sunday as saying: "The incentive structure is wrong. It's 'hire the robot, fire the human and don't look back'." The company has about 23,000 employees in India, though the number who received the offer in the country could not be independently ascertained.

The programme is available to eligible employees in Canada, India, the UK and the US at level 70 and below. It is a time-limited, voluntary offer that allows employees to leave Microsoft with financial support and career-planning resources. Employees opting for the VEO must decide by Dec 1. The payout includes one month's base salary for every completed year of service, health insurance and career-transition services.

"There is no one-size-fits-all approach for every team or every employee. These are a few of the ways we're trying to meet different business needs while continuing to create opportunities for our own people to grow and contribute," said Amy Coleman, executive vice-president and chief people officer at Microsoft, in a blog post on Tuesday.

Level 70 corresponds to the vice-president or partner-level/senior director tier. When contacted by TOI, Microsoft said, "India continues to be an important place for Microsoft's business and talent to grow. VEO is a voluntary, time-limited offer for eligible employees who are thinking about their next chapter. For most eligible employees, now won't be the right time to consider what's next outside of Microsoft, but we are giving them that option. Future workforce needs will continue to be based on business needs and priorities. VEO is one option within a flexible set of workforce approaches."

Simplismart gets $14mn, Nvidia backs AI startup

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Bengaluru: AI infrastructure startup Simplismart has raised $14 million in a Series B round led by Dallas Venture Capital, with Nvidia among the investors, to expand its software that helps businesses run AI applications more efficiently. Accel, Shastra VC and Micromax also participated in the round. The company did not disclose its valuation following the funding. The proceeds will support product development, cloud partnerships and expansion across North America and other markets.

TOI first reported on April 11 that NVentures, Nvidia's venture capital arm, was investing in Simplismart as part of the funding round. Simplismart focuses on inference, the process through which a trained AI model responds to a request, such as generating a video or answering a question. Its software helps companies manage the speed, cost and reliability of AI models across cloud services and their own infrastructure.

"The advantage comes from how you run them: what each interaction costs, how quickly the application responds, and whether it stays reliable as demand grows," said Amritanshu Jain, co-founder and CEO. The company said its annualised revenue run rate grew 14-fold over six months, without disclosing the revenue figure.

SNAP SHOTS

Morkel, Mohit join CSK

Chennai Super Kings on Tuesday announced wholesale changes to their support staff ahead of the 2027 season, bringing in the likes of Albie Morkel and Mohit Sharma. Former South Africa international Morkel joins CSK as an assistant coach, while Mohit has been appointed as the bowling coach of a side he represented for many seasons. Former England cricketer Gareth Batty has also been signed as an assistant coach.

Aditya crowned champion: Asian silver medallist Aditya was on Tuesday crowned the men's 55kg champion at the World Boxing U-19 Championships in Budva, Montenegro. The Indian fought back after narrowly losing the opening round to beat Islam Magomedov of Russia 4:1 in the final. India finished with a gold, one silver and two bronze medals. However, India's hopes of winning a second gold were shattered after Megha Sheokand lost 0:5 to Ekaterina Frolova of Russia in the women's 80kg final.

Shubhankar finishes 11th: India's Shubhankar Sharma found form at the right juncture to finish tied 11th in the Genesis Championship at Woo Jeong Hills CC in Cheonan, South Korea. Sharma finished alongside Daniel Hillier with a score of 9-under par.

Nadal to return for hardcourt event: Rafael Nadal will return to hardcourt competition for the first time since his retirement in Nov 2024 in a one-night Las Vegas exhibition event next Feb, organizers announced on Monday. The 40-year-old Spanish left-hander will compete in "The MGM Slam" on Feb 28, 2027, at T-Mobile Arena.

Venus suffers 16th defeat in a row: Venus Williams suffered her 16th loss in a row in singles tennis as the 46-year-old was defeated by teenager Lilli Tagger in straight sets at the Guangzhou Open on Tuesday. Austria's Tagger, who is 28 years younger than the former world No. 1, eased through 6-2, 6-2 in southern China.

Ronaldo in line for Portugal return: Cristiano Ronaldo is in Portugal's preliminary squad for next month's Nations League matches, opening the door to an international return after his fallout with coach Jorge Jesus, a federation source told AFP.

Savin wins gold: Karnataka's Savin Thingalaya (21.26s) bagged gold in the men's U-20 200m event on the final day of the National Junior Athletics Championships in Chennai on Tuesday. **Results (only K'taka): Men's U-20: 200m:** 1. Savin Thingalaya (21.26s); 2. Ayush SR (21.30s). **Women's U-18: 200m:** 2. Suchithra S (24.52s).

First day's play washed out: The opening day of the CK Nayudu Trophy clash between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu was called off due to wet outfield in Dindigul on Tuesday.

K'taka fail to seize the moment

Hosts Squander Good Starts But Take 103-Run Lead Against Tripura

Manuja.Veerappa
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Mysuru: Exploiting an opponent's weakness is par for the course in sport. Karnataka were expected to do just that against Tripura, but have missed a trick or two. After letting the visitors off the hook on the opening day of their Ranji Trophy Group B match at the SDNRW Ground here, the hosts failed to make the most of promising starts on Tuesday, leaving themselves with plenty of work to do despite securing their first innings lead of the season. At stumps, Karnataka were 297/7, ahead by 103 runs.

In normal circumstances, three points from a drawn game could have been acceptable. But, as head coach R Vinay Kumar pointed out, this is a must-win match. With just two points from as many games, Karnataka need a victory to keep their knockout hopes alive.

RANJI TROPHY

In a game of fine margins, Karnataka have been struggling to get ahead. Tuesday was another case in point. Against a bowling attack that was, at best, ordinary, the hosts had an opportunity to build a substantial lead, with both young batters keen to make a mark and seasoned campaigners at the crease. Instead, they scored at just 3.2 runs an over and lost wickets at regular intervals on a surface where the odd ball kept low.

Resuming at 10/1, rookie Rohan Patil (72; 130b, 9x4) and Vyshak Vijaykumar adopted a cautious approach and nearly saw off the first hour. However, Vyshak fell while attempting to drive a fuller delivery from Sandeep Sarkar, edging it to wicketkeeper Sentu Sarkar. Karnataka had managed just 36 runs by the 20th over.

Madhusudhana SR

PATIENT KNOCK: Rohan Patil struck his maiden first-class half-century

Rohan and KV Aneesh (68; 142b, 6x4) then added 82 for the third wicket, showing patience against the Tripura attack, which didn't command that kind of an approach.

Rohan, known more as a big-hitting white-ball specialist, brought up his maiden first-class half-century off 88 balls with a back-foot punch through the covers. His promising knock ended when he attempted to flick a fuller delivery from Abhijith Sarkar (3/59) and was trapped leg-before.

The arrival of seasoned campaigner Karun Nair (68; 85b, 8x4) injected urgency into the innings, his fluent strokeplay unsettling the bowlers. Dropped on 11 by wicketkeeper Sentu off Bikram Debnath, Karun made the most of the reprieve before Sandip Sarkar (2/83) trapped him leg-before as he played forward. His partnership with Aneesh yielded 105 runs, blending aggression with caution.

Aneesh, who had looked well set, soon followed, miscuing a short ball from Parvez Sultan to Sandip at midwicket. Skipper Shreyas Gopal (19) was bowled by Sultan, while KL Shrijith (13), who had begun to find his rhythm with a classic sweep for six off Sandip, offered a regulation catch to Bikram Das at cover off Abhijith.

Aneeshwar Gautam (33 batting) and Manvanth Kumar (6 batting) saw off the remaining overs, with the former striking two sixes over long-on and midwicket.

While the advantage still firmly rests with Karnataka, the next two days will be about how they can turn into a much-needed victory.

SCOREBOARD

Tripura (I innings): 194.

Karnataka (I innings; o/n 10/1): Rohan Patil lbw A Sarkar 72, Vyshak Vijaykumar c C Sarkar b S Sarkar 12, KV Aneesh c S Sarkar b Sultan 68, Karun Nair lbw S Sarkar 63, Aneeshwar Gautam (batting) 33, Shreyas Gopal b Sultan 19, KL Shrijith c B Das b A Sarkar 13, Manvanth Kumar (batting) 6. **Extras** (LB-8, NB-2) 10. **Total (7 wkts; 95 overs) 297.**

Fall of wickets: 1-10, 2-36, 3-118, 4-223, 5-225.

Bowling: M Murasingh 14-5-38-0, Abhijit Sarkar 17-3-59-2, Bikram Debnath 11-2-35-0, Sandip Sarkar 26-2-83-2, Parvez Sultan 27-2-74-2.

Other Group B scores: At Secunderabad: Punjab 431 all out in 124.5 overs (Salil Arora 151, Prabhsimran Singh 81, Ramandeep Singh 52; Chama Milind 4-79, Rakshan Readdi 3-80) vs **Hyderabad 193/2 in 54 overs** (Abhirath Reddy 97, Rahul Radesh 72 batting).

At Rajkot: Assam 281 vs **Saurashtra 156/4 in 68 overs** (Hetvik Kotak 65 batting). **At Vijayawada: Andhra 231 all out** vs **Chhattisgarh 216/8 in 95 overs** (Amandeep Khare 74 batting, Anuj Tiwary 34; T Vijay 3-73).

KODAGU FC PREVAIL

Kodagu FC handed BDUFC a 4-1 defeat in the Karnataka Super Division league football championship in Bengaluru on Tuesday. In another match, FC Real Bengaluru rode on Ryan Wilfed's double to claim a 3-0 win over Roots FC. **Results:** Technico FF 2 (Nathan Akash Powell 65, Sochan Shatsang 73) bt FC Agniputhra 1 (Jehovah Lalthansanga 33); Kodagu FC 4 (Dhanush R 4, Jithu 11, Lalkrawsmawia 65, Mohammed Safwaan 90+2) bt BDUFC 1 (Londup Lepcha 47); FC Real Bengaluru 3 (Ryan Wilfed S 53, 57, Jangjagin Kuki 84) bt Roots FC 0.

ROUND-UP

DPS cruise to victory: Delhi Public School eased past Hindustan Friends Hockey Club 4-0 in the DS Murthy Memorial Hockey tournament in Bengaluru on Tuesday. In the day's other match, Rising Star Hockey Club played out a 1-1 draw with Rainbow Hockey Club. DPS and Rising Star will face off in the final on Wednesday. **Results:** Delhi Public School 4 (Abbas 7, Shafaz 10, Sai 18, Akshay 42) bt Hindustan Friends HC 0; Rising Star HC 1 (John Bosco 20) drew with Rainbow HC 1 (Deon Belliappa 3). **Today's matches: 3rd/4th place:** Team Wildboar vs BCYA (2 pm); **Final:** Rising Star HC vs Delhi Public School (3 pm).

K'taka hoopsters win: Karnataka boys and girls registered contrasting wins on the opening day of the Youth National Basketball Championship in Pune. While the girls held off Telangana 61-51, the boys eased to a 97-44 win over Himachal Pradesh. **Results: Boys: Level 2 (Qualifying Group): Pool D:** Karnataka 97 bt Himachal Pradesh 44. **Girls: Level 1: Pool B**: Karnataka 61 bt Telangana 51. TNN

Karnataka bowlers star

Bengaluru: Monica Patel and **Shreyanka Patil** starred with the ball to help Karnataka claim a seven-wicket win over Maharashtra in the senior women's T20 trophy in Surat on Tuesday.

Asked to bat, Maharashtra were in trouble with Monica (4/18) reducing the opposition to 14/3 in 2.5 overs. Maharashtra never recovered, with Shreyanka (5/26) running through the middle order as well. They were bundled out for 114 runs as Ishwari Savkar top-scored with 30 runs.

Karnataka did not have much trouble in the chase with opener and skipper Shubha Satheesh (53 n.o) leading her team from the front. They reached the target in the 19th over. Roshini Kiran, who struck a 51-run second-wicket stand with Shubha, chipped in with 22 runs as well. **Brief scores: Maharashtra: 114 all out in 20 overs** (Ishwari Savkar 30; Monica Patel 4-18, Shreyanka Patil 5-26) lost to **Karnataka: 115/3 in 18.2 overs** (Shubha Satheesh 53 n.o). TNN

Kane, Alexia taste Ballon d'Or glory

AFP

Harry Kane became England's first Ballon d'Or winner in 25 years in his native city of London on Monday, beating Lamine Yamal and Kylian Mbappe. Alexia Putellas claimed the women's prize for a third time to extend Spain's domination of the award, thanks to her role in leading Barcelona to last season's Champions League before moving to London City Lionesses.

The first ever Ballon d'Or ceremony on English soil got off to an inauspicious start as the London traffic caused a delay of nearly an hour, with many of the star names arriving late. But there was a happy ending for the hometown hero as Kane collected the crowning glory of his career to date, becoming the first Englishman to win the award since Michael Owen in 2001.

FOOTBALL

The 33-year-old Bayern Munich forward struck a remarkable 73 goals in 65 games for club and country last season, propelling the German giants to a league and cup double. He also scored six times as England finished third at the World Cup.

"I love to represent my country and to bring this trophy back to them and have an English winner I think is something that's really, really special, especially here in London," Kane told AFP. "What a crazy night and I'm really, really happy."

Despite being England and Tottenham's all-time record goalscorer, Kane's medal collection is limited to German domestic triumphs. He was on the losing side for Spurs in the 2019 Champions League final against Liverpool and twice tasted bitter defeat in the final of the European Championship with England.

But joining Bayern in 2023 and his remarkable goalscoring consistency have earned him the highest individual award in football. "Making the move to Bayern Munich was a big step in my career," Kane told AFP earlier. "Some people saw it as a risk but for me it was always about improving and seeing if I could get better around the team-mates, the team, the club and it has pushed me onto another level.

"Being a number nine for Bayern and England you are expected to score goals and to do that the number of times I did last year is something I'm really proud of," he added.

ALEXIA BACK ON TOP

The winner in 2021 and 2022, Putellas's third Ballon d'Or caps her return to the top of the women's game after an anterior cruciate ligament injury derailed her rise four years ago. Putellas succeeds Spain team-mate Aitana Bonmati, the winner the past three years whose season was quashed by a leg break.

Luis de la Fuente beat out Paris Saint-Germain's Luis Enrique and Arsenal boss Mikel Arteta to be named men's coach of the year after leading Spain to World Cup glory. AFP

Mbappe apologises

Kylian Mbappe apologised on Tuesday after the Real Madrid star was dropped by major Chinese brands for apparently joking about Mao Zedong in a video that has gone viral.

The row deepened when, despite La Liga also apologising, state-owned China Media Group (CMG) said Chinese state television was suspending broadcasts of matches from the Spanish league. The offending video shows Mbappe saying that the funniest internet meme he had seen involving him was of his face photo-shopped onto that of "some guy -- I think he's a Chinese dictator". This was an apparent reference to a meme of Mbappe superimposed on an image of Mao. AFP

Privacy act will hit freedom of Press: Digital news body

'Can't Sacrifice Right To Know At Altar Of Privacy'

▶ Continued from page 1

A bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymlaya Bagchi and V Mohana said: "Media must ensure that there is no misuse of the rights enjoyed by it. There must be a balance between your rights and the rights of innocent citizens. We will have to leave it to you to suggest how best you are going to ensure that the media's rights are not misused and the right to privacy of citizens are not violated."

Appearing for the petitioner, senior advocate Madhavi Divan said provisions of DPDP Act failed to provide exemption in favour of journalistic activity as a distinct class and had brought the regime of notice and prior consent within it, which would lead to closure of newsrooms as they feed live information. If journalists went around seeking consent of people, then no news could be disseminated, she said.

SC said media must ensure that there is no misuse of rights enjoyed by it

"It is not merely the fundamental right to speech and expression and dissemination of information owing to freedom of the press which has been set at nought by the aforesaid provision, but the DPDP Act places myriad restrictions in the manner in which information is accessed, processed and disseminated," DNPA said.

"In the absence of exemptions, the entire scheme under Chapter II of DPDP Act will constitute unreasonable restrictions upon journalists in the exercise of the fundamental right to freedom of speech and expression and practise any profession or to carry on any occupation, trade or business," it added.

The petitioner complained that DPDP Act imposed onerous conditions governing how information was to be disseminated and how access was obtained and cited an SC judgement, which had ruled that the fundamental right to know could not be sacrificed at the altar of privacy.

The bench issued notice to the Centre on the petition and tagged it with a clutch of petitions which are scheduled for hearing on Nov 17.

Amaravati set for India's first quantum computer milestone by month-end

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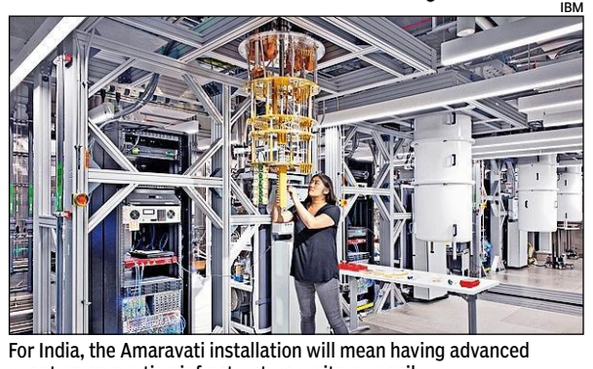
Hyderabad: Amaravati is set to cross a key milestone in India's quantum computing journey by Oct-end, when components of IBM's advanced Quantum System Two are expected to move into a specially built facility in the Andhra Pradesh capital. Parts of the machine have already reached India from the US, with commissioning targeted for Dec 2026 or Jan 2027.

IBM



For India, the Amaravati installation will mean having advanced quantum computing infrastructure on its own soil

The installation will give India one of its most advanced quantum computing facilities, allowing researchers, universities, startups and businesses to work with cutting-edge quantum hardware located within the country. The facility is expected to be formally inaugurated in the first week of Feb 2027.

"After we got the approvals for the shipment, the process began in Sept from US. The systems are being shipped part by part, and some components have already landed at IBM's Bengaluru warehouse," CV Sridhar, mission director, Andhra's State Quantum Mission, told **TOI**.

Unlike conventional computers, which process information using bits that represent either 0 or 1, quantum computers use qubits that can exploit quantum properties to perform certain kinds of calculations differently. Scientists hope they will eventually help solve complex problems in drug discovery, materials research and other fields that are difficult for even today's most powerful supercomputers. Current quantum machines, however, remain largely research tools.

For India, the Amaravati installation will mean having advanced quantum computing infrastructure on its own soil, rather than relying solely on access to machines overseas. It will also provide a base for developing Indian expertise in quantum algorithms and applications.

"A lot of testing has already been completed in US. Once the remaining systems arrive, basic testing and commissioning will be carried out here before the launch. The overall timeline is within a maximum of three months, and we have kept a buffer in the schedule," Sridhar said.

The Quantum Computer Centre, a two-storeyed building on a two-acre site near the upcoming AP legislature complex, is expected to be ready by Oct-end. It will anchor the Amaravati Quantum Valley project, which brings together IBM, TCS, L&T and academic institutions including IIT Madras and IIT Tirupati.

The machine will arrive in pre-assembled modules requiring specialised handling and infrastructure. Its superconducting processors operate at temperatures of around 10 millikelvin, colder than outer space, requiring sophisticated cryogenic cooling.

IBM Research India director and IBM India and South Asia CTO, Amith Singhee, said the company intends to install its most advanced available quantum processor. The exact configuration has yet to be finalised, though current IBM systems operate with roughly 120–150 qubits/chip.

The project has missed its original deadline. When Amaravati Quantum Valley was announced in mid-2025, a state govt order set Jan 1, 2026, as the target date. Sridhar attributed the delay to the need for a purpose-built facility.

The computer will remain IBM-owned and operated, with Indian researchers, universities, startups, enterprises and govt agencies accessing it through a service model.

Work on potential applications has already begun. Andhra Pradesh has launched a programme to develop 100 quantum computing use cases, drawing on problems identified by govt departments, industry and startups.

One of the project involves exploring whether quantum-based optimisation techniques can improve deployment of the state's 731 ambulances under its 108 emergency service. Four startups are participating. Other proposed applications range from electricity distribution and factory scheduling to drug discovery and materials research.

Special Tiger strike force unit deployed

▶ Continued from page 1

Investigators suspect a bharmar, or a traditional muzzle-loading firearm stashed with gunpowder, was used to shoot the cheetah cub. A forensic and ballistic probe, based on the nature of the pellets and the number of metal pieces recovered, will establish whether the weapon was a bharmar or a country-made 12-bore gun, officials said.

Officials said Tuesday a Special Tiger Strike Force unit had been deployed in the area along with sniffer dogs to track those responsible for the shooting. The forest department intends to request MP Police's Special Task Force to join in.

Wildlife activist Ajay Dubey demanded a CBI inquiry. The carcass has been returned to Kuno and the staff is waiting for clearances from the Union environment ministry before the next steps.

Madras HC bench flays 'chamchagiri' in politics

▶ Continued from page 1

If such entry is permitted, it would defile the sanctity of the temple. We intend to go a step further... We take judicial notice of a video doing rounds in the social media of persons wearing skull caps, pushing their way through in Thiruvannamalai Arunachaleswarar temple, notwithstanding the vigorous protests of the devotees. The HR and CE staff stood as mute spectators," the judges said.

"We take judicial notice of the fact that a minister who is a Christian by faith entered Thiruchendur temple without giving the undertaking required from non-Hindus."

The bench commended CM C Joseph Vijay for setting what it said was an "illustrious instance" of him worshipping Goddess Meenakshi after signing the mandated undertaking. "The chief minister, who is a Christian by faith, was not asked to convert to Hinduism. He was only requested to affirm his reverence for the deity. This is what we call an inclusive approach," it said.

Flaying "chamchagiri" in politics, the bench said it knew of an unnamed politician "who is a fundamentalist subscribing to a non-Hindu faith" but would "make it a point to visit a temple and also prominently display the religious mark on his forehead".

"This was to play to the gallery. The vote value of such a display is obvious. We hold that usages and customs of the temple cannot kneel before such display of chamchagiri and optics," it said.

On exceptions to the rule, the bench said, "Lord Ayyappa has devotees cutting across religions. Shirdi Sai Baba is also beyond religion. Both Hindus as well as Muslims claim him as their own. Of course, now he is more a part of the Hindu pantheon."

General med helps earn more in long run

▶ Continued from page 1

General medicine, on the other hand, remains an evergreen specialty, offering opportunities to pursue super-specialisation and earn more in the long run. However, financial settlement can take longer, as candidates must complete a DM course and then build their practice, which could take another two to three years.

"General medicine appeals to candidates who enjoy clinical challenges, patient interaction and managing complex diseases. While the financial rewards may take longer to materialise, the scope for super-specialisation and professional growth is immense. Ultimately, the choice should be guided by what fulfils you as a doctor, not just by how quickly you can start earning," said Prof Neeraj Nischal, internal medicine, AIIMS.

Protests have kept farmers away from fields

▶ Continued from page 1

In Geku, resistance ran deep, with farmers challenging restrictions and returning to their fields with the daos they have carried for generations. "We tie the dao around our waist before stepping out of our homes every morning. It is an essential part of our lives. Why should we be stopped from carrying it to our fields?" asked Panyang, a farmer in Geku. For the Adis, the broad-bladed, hand-forged tool is more than a machete. It is part of their cultural and spiritual heritage, much like the kirpan for Sikhs. Its traditional craftsmanship has earned the dao a geographical indication (GI) tag.

The larger battle is over land, livelihood and the proposed mega dam whose main reservoir is planned near Geku, about 35km downstream from Upper Siang district headquarters Yingkiong.

Twenty-seven villages across Upper Siang and Siang districts have joined the agitation. Its costs are showing: meetings and demonstrations have kept some farmers away from their fields. Along narrow strips of land between the Siang and surrounding hills, families grow rice varieties such as Gegong, Itanagar, Ngotsum and Taker. The last is prized for brewing rice beer.

Protest has taken a bite out of community life. On Sept 1, Geku's Adi community curtailed Solung, its biggest festival, limiting celebrations to flag-hoisting at Gidii Notko, the traditional festival ground. Normally, the festivities last about four days. For Geku's residents, the stakes are existential. Most depend on farming, while only about 10 to 15 govt employees live among nearly 1,000 households. Many families have occupied community land for generations. In the 1960s, they moved from Kumku, a hilltop settlement about 6km away, to the riverbank to grow rice, oranges and vegetables.

"We do not want compensation in exchange for losing our homeland. Where will we go, and what will we eat?" asked homemaker Oken Boli Panggyeng.

The resolve may come at a steep price. Paddy harvesting is due to begin in the first week of Nov, but Panggyeng said villagers were prepared to fight to save their homeland — even if it means letting their crops rot in the fields.

Bangalore Times

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026
ADVERTORIAL; ENTERTAINMENT INDUSTRY PROMOTIONAL FEATURE

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#Virosh seek action against online trolls!

The controversy surrounding Rashmika Mandanna and Vijay Deverakonda following their recent appearance on a celebrity talk show has taken a new turn. Their team has filed a formal complaint over allegedly misleading online content targeting the couple and is seeking an investigation into the matter

P6

'I NEVER IMAGINED I WOULD COME THIS FAR IN CINEMA'

FAHADH FAASIL

Divya Shree

Fahadh Faasil did not return to cinema expecting to build a career spanning more than 60 films across Indian film industries. After his debut, *Kaiyethum Doorath*, failed at the box office, he left for America, unsure if he would ever return to acting. "My first film in 2002 flopped, and two days later I left for America. I thought I would probably settle there permanently," he says.

When he eventually returned to acting, his plan was to do just one film before heading back to the US. That brief return turned into a career spanning Malayalam, Tamil and Telugu cinema, with roles that have continued to push him into unfamiliar territory. In conversation with us, Fahadh the experiences that continue to challenge him as an actor. Excerpts from a chat:

When I returned from the US, my plan was simple — do one more film and leave for America again. But that film, released in 2009, marked the beginning of a journey that has since spanned more than 60 films

A still from the film *Kaiyethum Doorathu*

'I find producing films more enjoyable than acting'

Having produced films such as *Premalu* and *Bethlehem Kudumba Unit*, Fahadh wears both actor and producer hats, but when asked which side of filmmaking he enjoys more, he says production wins hands down. "Acting is much harder. Production is actually enjoyable. I genuinely love the process of producing films," he shares.

On his approach to filmmaking, Fahadh emphasises the importance of having a clear plan without leaving no room for spontaneity on set. He prefers to know how a story unfolds before filming begins, while allowing scenes to evolve organically during the shoot. "I won't start a film without knowing the beginning, midpoint and ending. But once the shoot begins, everyone should have the freedom to organically improve scenes rather than strictly sticking to what is written on paper," he explains.

Buzzstop

JAY-Z PICKS HIMSELF FOR SUPER BOWL HALFTIME SHOW

Jay-Z will headline the Super Bowl LXI halftime show on February 14, next year, at SoFi Stadium in Inglewood, California. The NFL and Roc Nation confirmed that this will be his first time performing at the Super Bowl. Jay-Z, Roc Nation's founder, selected himself for the slot; the company has produced the show since 2019. "From Reasonable Doubt to standing on the Super Bowl Halftime stage, this has been a journey. Thirty years of music, work and culture on the world's biggest stage," he said. No additional performers have been announced yet.

Agencies

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A production by Bharatanatyam artiste Rama Kshirsagar and her team, where movement, music and story come together

'We love nature, yet we forget to live in harmony'

Bharatanatyam artiste Rama Kshirsagar on how dance and theatre can hold up a mirror to our environmental contradictions

Mehwash Hussain

What happens to our relationship with nature when we take more than we give? This question lies at the heart of *Àntarìnì – An Awakening Call*, a production by Bharatanatyam artiste Rama Kshirsagar and her team. Weaving together Bharatanatyam, Kathakali, contemporary movement and music, it traces how far we have drifted from living in harmony with the natural world.

A still from the performance

> Art has the power to move people from within. People must understand that they cannot afford to be silent
> – Rama Kshirsagar

'Awareness is not the same as action'

Rama explains the production aims to do more than lecture people about waste. "I felt that just telling people to reduce waste was a very typical approach. In this production, we hold a mirror up to the audience and show them the hypocrisies they practice," she says. One episode features a character who is deeply involved in protecting animals and wildlife but is drawn to a crocodile-leather bag. "The contradiction reflects how environmental awareness does not always translate into everyday choices," she adds.

'We have drifted away from nature'

Àntarìnì draws a contrast between a time when people lived in closer harmony with nature and today's culture of consumerism and individualism. "The production draws on verses from the Rig Veda's *Nasadiya Sukta* and the Atharva Veda's *Bhumi Sukta*, along with folk songs from Karnataka and Saurashtra, to reflect this connection between people, nature and community. Initially, we show a natural flow, and then we show how, suddenly, we begin to go against the flow of nature," says Rama.

The shift in the performance reflects how human desires and patterns of consumption disrupt the rhythms of the natural world.

Dancers showcase graceful movements on the stage

'Art inspires meaningful psychological and behavioural change in us'

Rama believes art must do more than raise awareness. It must inspire introspection and change. "I strongly believe that art can inspire meaningful psychological and behavioural change. With *Àntarìnì*, the intention is not merely to highlight environmental problems, but to encourage people to reflect on their own choices and recognise the contradictions in their lifestyles. We have moved from living in harmony with nature to working against it. Rather than prescribing a fixed set of solutions, the production invites audiences to consider what changes they can make in their own lives and circumstances," she says.

> With Āntarīnī, the intention is not merely to highlight environmental problems, but to encourage people to reflect on their choices
> – Rama Kshirsagar

UP TO DATE

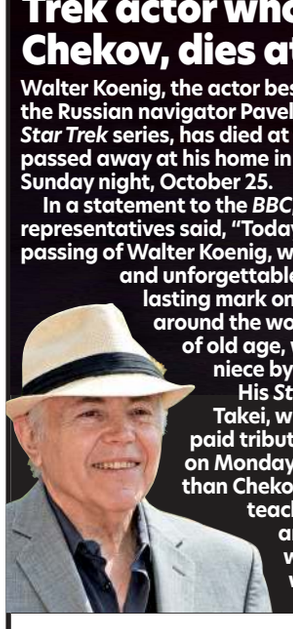
WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

Is Nicki ready for her White House era?

Could Nicki Minaj be the next White House press secretary? The White House Communications Director Steven Cheung seems to think so. The Starships hitmaker, who travelled with the US President Donald Trump to a rally in Michigan ahead of the November midterm elections, got to hear this aboard Air Force One.

In a video shared on X, Cheung interviewed Minaj about the US economy and Trump's leadership, where she voiced support for the Republican campaign. In the caption, the communications director suggested that they might have found someone to fill the post. Minaj responded by reposting it with an American flag and a laughing emoji.

Walter Koenig, Star Trek actor who played Chekov, dies at 90



Walter Koenig, the actor best known for portraying the Russian navigator Pavel Chekov in the original *Star Trek* series, has died at the age of 90. He passed away at his home in North Hollywood on Sunday night, October 25.

In a statement to the *BBC*, Koenig's representatives said, "Today we mourn the passing of Walter Koenig, whose talent, warmth, and unforgettable performances left a lasting mark on generations of fans around the world." They said he died of old age, with his daughter and niece by his side.

His *Star Trek* co-star George Takei, who played Hikaru Sulu, paid tribute on social media on Monday. "Walter was more than Chekov. He was a writer, a teacher, a thoughtful man, and a loyal friend," Takei wrote, adding, "Rest well, my dear friend."

I feel deeply concerned about what is going on at SRFTI: Kanu

After Naseeruddin Shah and Payal Kapadia, filmmaker Kanu Behl has expressed concern over the situation at SRFTI in a video on Instagram. He said, "What is happening at SRFTI, with the violence against the students, is absolutely reprehensible. And I feel deeply concerned about whatever is going on at the institute. Students are allegedly being beaten up by right-wing goons. And what is even more concerning is that, after that, students are being asked to vacate the premises..."

The *Despatch* (2024) director added, "I urge the government and the people concerned to look into it immediately and make sure the students at SRFTI remain absolutely safe and a creative environment is created for them because they're there really to study cinema..."

Instagram tests 90-minute videos for podcasters

Instagram is testing horizontal videos of up to 90 minutes with select creators in the US, according to *The Hollywood Reporter*. The product, called Features, targets podcasters, comedians and other longform creators. It will allow them to direct viewers from short-form Reels, which are typically around three minutes or less, to full-length videos on the platform. "You see a clip of a podcast that you love. Now, you can just continue watching the full video, because creators are going to be able to link the Reels to their overall feature," said Tessa Lyons, VP Product at Instagram.

Swift enters Nashville Hall of Fame

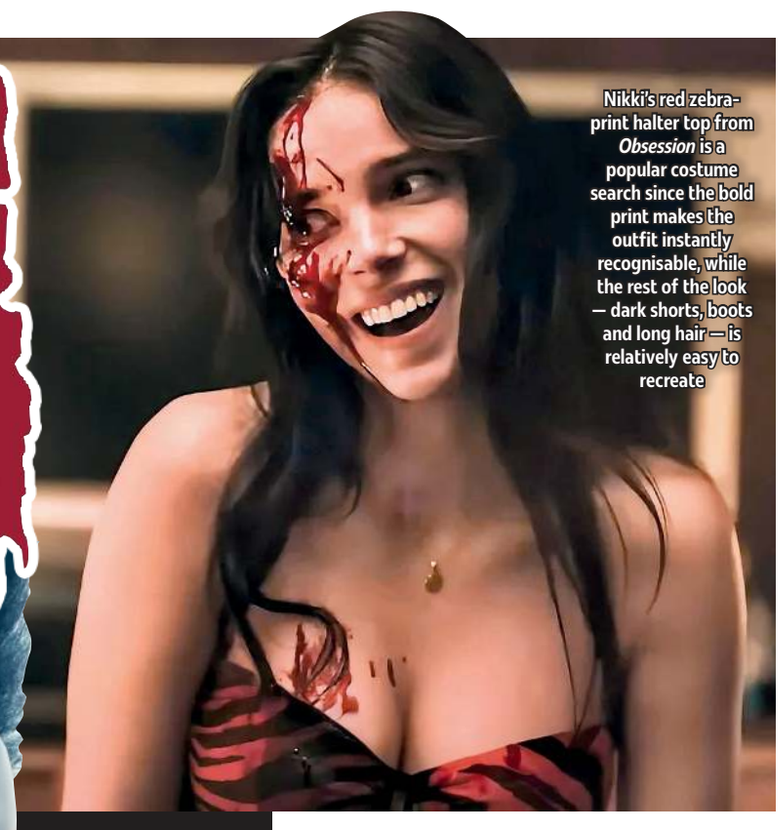
Taylor Swift has added another prestigious honour to her illustrious career, joining the Nashville Songwriters Hall of Fame. The singer was inducted at a gala in Nashville on October 26, alongside Lyle Lovett, Shawn Camp, Lee Thomas Miller, Bruce Channel and JI Allison. Swift signed her first publishing deal in Nashville at just 14, and credited the city's songwriting community with shaping her craft. She also reflected on her early collaborations with Liz Rose and the lessons she learnt from fellow writers.

HOT TAKES

iStock

Dressing up for Halloween? Internet's got some wild ideas

The bright, colourful mascot from the horror-comedy *Buddy* turns the seemingly innocent image of a children's-show unicorn into something sinister


Nikki's red zebra-print halter top from *Obsession* is a popular costume search since the bold print makes the outfit instantly recognisable, while the rest of the look — dark shorts, boots and long hair — is relatively easy to recreate

Forget witches, vampires and skeletons. Halloween 2026 is taking a bizarre pop culture turn, with a murderous unicorn, a squishy stress toy and a Greek king among the trending costumes. Google's latest searches offer a glimpse of what people want to dress up as this October 31.

A MURDEROUS UNICORN & A SQUISHY TOY LEAD THE PACK

Topping the list is Buddy the Unicorn, the colourful yet sinister mascot from Casper Kelly's horror film *Buddy*. NeeDoh, the squishy toy that has become a viral favourite, takes second place, followed by Nikki from Obsession, a film about a dangerously obsessive crush.

Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey* brings Agamemnon to the costume conversation at number four. Other picks include Lily Love-braids from horror game *Poppy Playtime*, musician Oliver Tree, Verity from a viral Minecraft horror series and Carl from *Dungeon Crawler Carl*. Hazel Hook from Disney's *Descendants* also makes the top 10, alongside a disco-inspired Scooby-Doo look.

DISCO SCOOBY-DOO BRINGS BACK THE NOSTALGIA

The nostalgia factor is strong, too. Disco Scooby-Doo paired with Shaggy tops Google's trending duo costumes. Other popular pairings include *X-Men* characters Cyclops and Jean Grey.

Oliver Tree's signature bowl cut, oversized trousers and quirky retro outfits have made his deliberately eccentric look a recognisable and easy-to-recreate Halloween costume. His death earlier this year has also renewed interest in the musician

Rakesh Bedi's Jameel Jamali became a meme sensation, with his dialogue taking over social media

Benny Safdie's Agamemnon's look offers a mythological alternative to the more contemporary costume trends. Its viral appeal comes from *The Odyssey*'s blockbuster buzz and Safdie's imposing, armour-clad appearance

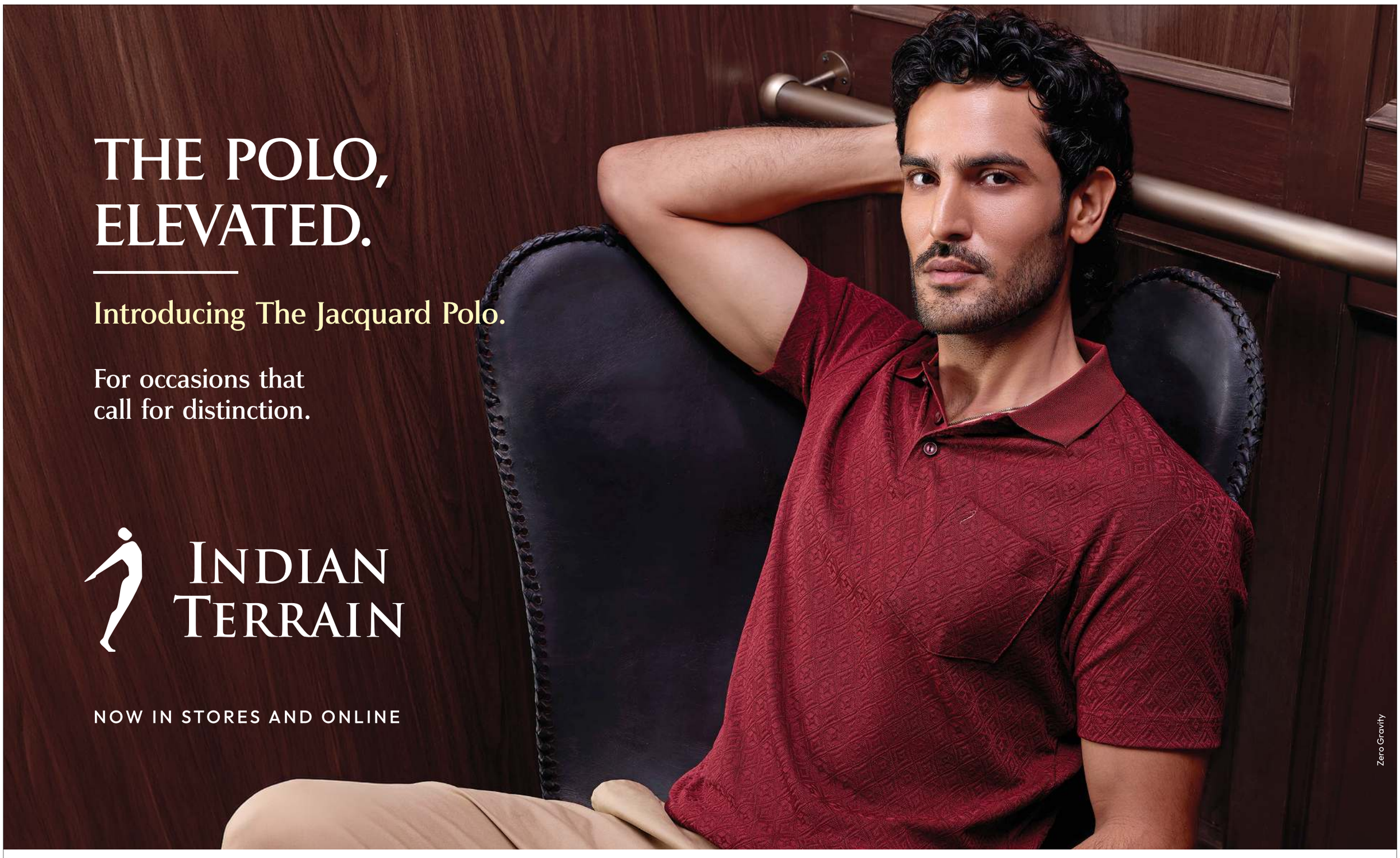
Dolly Parton leads the kids' costume searches

Singer Dolly Parton tops the kids' costume searches, followed by Ella Langley and Dumpling. Shakira, Ash Ketchum from Pokémon and Hannah Montana also feature in the list.

Pets are getting their moment in the spotlight too. Centipede leads the pet costume searches, with Dolly Parton, Bullseye from Toy Story, Diet Coke and Princess Donut from Dungeon Crawler Carl also making appearances. A baked potato and Tow Mater from Cars add to the wonderfully odd mix.

The filmi Halloween files: Four looks worth recreating

Ready to go filmi this Halloween? These Bollywood characters are worth stealing a look from. Channel Rakesh Bedi's Jameel Jamali from *Dhurandhar* with a Pathani suit, waistcoat and his iconic "*Baccha hai tu mera*" energy. For a creepier vibe, go as Hastar from *Tumbbad*, with a dark, weathered look and DIY props. Feeling glam? Kareena Kapoor's Poo from *Kabhi Khushi Kabhie Gham* calls for a pink shimmery top, mini skirt, glossy lips and oversized sunglasses. If subtlety isn't your thing, Vidya Balan's Manjulika is a desi horror classic that never misses. Pull out a yellow traditional outfit, pile on the jewellery, smudge your kajal and let your hair go gloriously wild.



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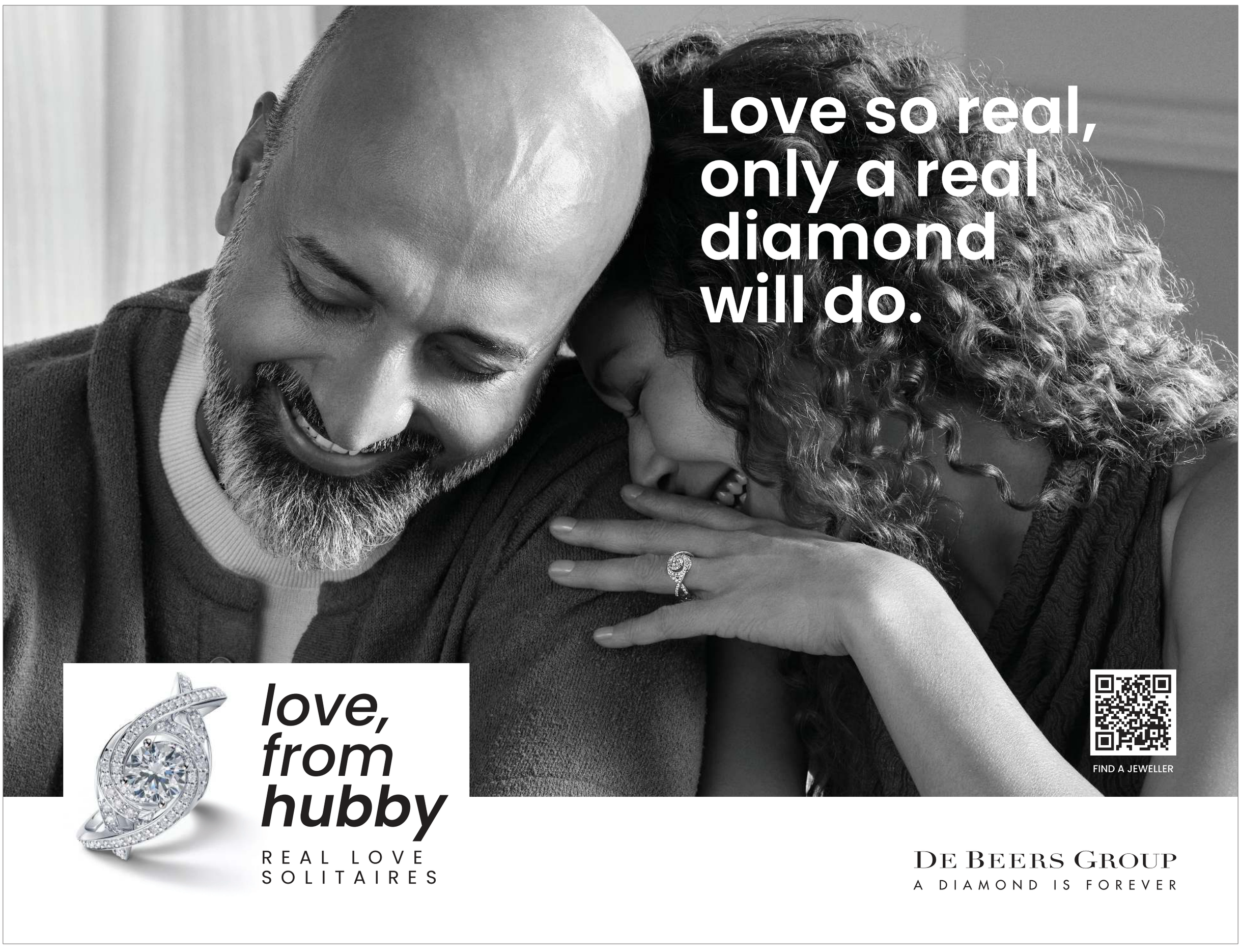

Do what you can, with what you have, where you are - Theodore Roosevelt

GARFIELD

ARCHIE

DENNIS THE MENACE

"MAYBE IF YOU TAKE OUT MY SWEET TOOTH... I WON'T GET ANY MORE CAVITIES."

How to: Make your festive curls last long

AI-generated image for representational purpose only

START WITH THE RIGHT PREP
Use a lightweight conditioner on the lengths and ends to avoid weighing hair down. Apply a heat protectant before styling and, if needed, a lightweight curl-enhancing mousse for better hold.

WORK IN SMALLER SECTIONS
Divide your hair into manageable sections and curl each individually for better definition. Choose a barrel size suited to your desired look, keeping in mind that curls tend to relax over time.

AVOID BRUSHING YOUR CURLS TOO SOON
Once your hair has cooled, loosen the curls gently with your fingers or a wide-tooth comb for a softer finish. Vigorous brushing can break up the shape and create frizz. If you prefer defined curls, leave them largely untouched and separate only the sections that need it.

Choose lightweight products that provide hold
Apply mousse or setting spray as directed, then finish with a light mist of flexible-hold hairspray. Avoid heavy serums or oils that can weigh curls down. Anti-humidity products may help control frizz, depending on your hair type.

LET EACH CURL COOL COMPLETELY
After releasing a curl, cup it in your palm or gently pin it up until cool. This helps the shape set before you loosen the curls into softer waves.

EVENTS

WORKSHOPS

Pottery Hug: Shape your own clay pot and sculpt a pair of hands giving it a warm hug at Thirdspace - Art Cafe and Community in Koramangala on October 28 from 2 pm onwards.

DIY Diwali Lamp: Create your own lamp this Diwali with craft materials like beads, flowers, cardboard provided to you at this hands-on guided workshop at Brik Oven in Whitefield on October 28 from 3 pm onwards.

Zumba Fitness Workshop: Transform your fitness routine with a combination of dance, cardio and aerobic movements for a full body workout at New York Dance Classes in Bilekahalli on October 28 from 11 am onwards.

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See what the stars have in store for you - according to your moon sign.

ARIES: Remember, abundance, like happiness, multiplies when shared. So celebrate your victory with your soul tribe in a way that feels called to you. You will be quite active socially, but do be careful of your health.

TAURUS: The day is filled with festivities and fresh faces. Someone you meet during a trip sparks a delightfully unexpected side to your personality. This time in your life has challenges, but it should also be really fun.

GEMINI: It might be a good time to keep a low profile and just let others take the spotlight. Moving forward in your life requires you to move forward in your thinking. Exciting new opportunities are coming your way.

CANCER: You spend the first part of the day exploring your rapport and enjoying each other's company. You have to learn to sell your skills and set a higher price. Let go of some things you have been carrying.

LEO: Don't focus on the past. A casual acquaintance will reveal hidden charms to you. Go out and enjoy yourself and know you are doing fine.

VIRGO: You have better things ahead of you. Make an extra big effort, especially if you are wrapping up your travels. You might want to loosen up a little with your love partner tonight rather than be too bossy or inflexible. You make a point of exploring beyond your immediate environment.

LIBRA: For those who are working within an organisation, 'dream team' is the word of the moment. Take out some time to meet and talk about whatever comes to mind.

SCORPIO: A time of planting the seeds of new, and working towards positive change systematically. Trust the ideas you're being called to work upon as they are coming from that place of wisdom within your soul.

SAGITTARIUS: Compromise is a tool to turn a choice into a triumph. Whenever you are torn two ways, it is best to make fair evaluations. You have enough space to get down everything that is going on inside your head.

CAPRICORN: Score some key support before moving on. You should be ready for a new cast of characters in your life. All this activity is great for your attitude.

AQUARIUS: Things will go well. The choices that you make about relationships may be different than the ones your friends make. Fortunately, a little diplomacy and natural charm will help you smooth things over.

PISCES: As long as you are giving your best to whatever you choose, you will always be protected and cared for. Sometimes change is bad, but most of the time the changes will be good.

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

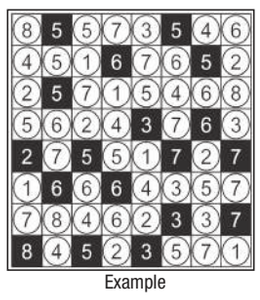
3		4					5	
9								
			1	9	5	8		
6		7			4		8	
			3		7			
	8		6			7		2
		3	2	5	6			
								5
	2					3		7

HOW TO PLAY
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

HOW TO PLAY
1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 4 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. 6 6 6)

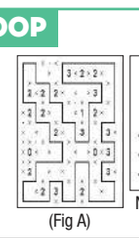
3	3	3	9	3	1	3	2
6	7	1	8	2	5	3	4
6	2	1	1	2	3	5	2
4	6	5	2	3	9	7	8
9	9	9	5	1	2	6	7
2	1	3	7	6	1	4	9
9	4	1	6	9	8	3	5
6	8	2	3	5	4	1	6



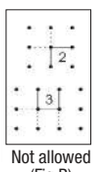
Example

LOOP THE LOOP

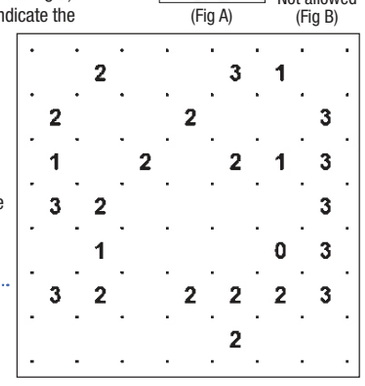
RULES
- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)



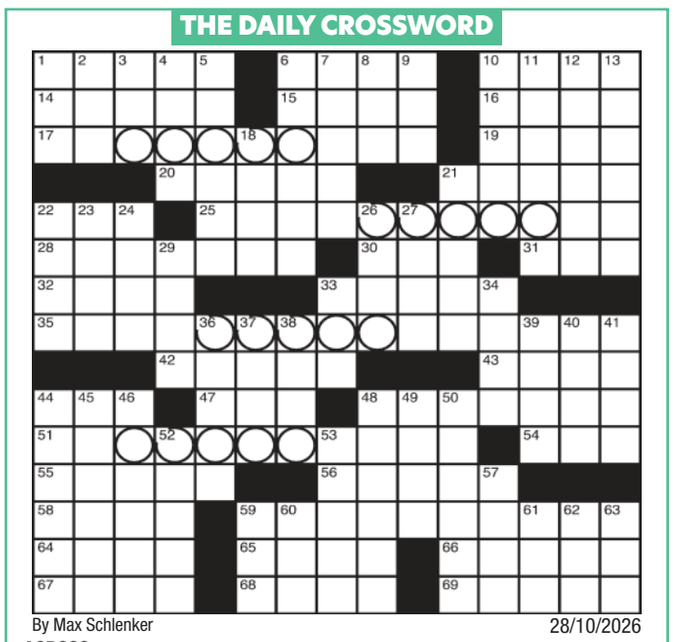
Not allowed (Fig B)



HOW TO BEGIN:
Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



By Max Schlenker — 28/10/2026

ACROSS
1 Cherubic god
6 Spot for pore strips
10 Jumbled mess
14 Stunt show setting
15 Significant work
16 Syllables for a stage magician
17 Social pariah
19 Social media spammers
20 Rectitude
21 In flight
22 Union agreement?
25 "All Eyez on Me" rapper
28 Film technique derived from the French for "to assemble"
30 "Not answering email," briefly
31 Foxy
32 Capitol canvas for "The Apotheosis of Washington"
33 Jilt
35 Laughs during an "SNL" appearance, say
42 Settle, as a debt
43 Vibe
44 "Future Nostalgia" singer Lipa
47 Some Eng. degrees
48 Truly fiendish
51 Drawing toy that uses aluminum powder
54 Opening day pitcher, typically
55 SAT prep subj.
56 "Thus with a kiss I die" hero
58 Tirade in the Times, say
59 Fast-food chain that began as a hot dog cart, and what this puzzle's circled letters do?
64 Antler point
65 FX drama about New York City's ball culture
66 Magazine release
67 Has a meal
68 Serve a meal to
69 Like a toddler mid-bath

DOWN
1 Zin alternative
2 Link destination
3 Storied cause of royal insomnia
4 Progress slowly
5 Actress Fanning
6 Pessimist's words
7 "Fire Shut Up in My Bones," e.g.
8 Litigate
9 Ability to see what others can't
10 "Se __ español"
11 Paperless reads
12 Foxy
13 Bakery offering
18 Nesting cozily
21 Now, in Nicaragua
22 Cinephile's site
23 Cuckoo clock part
24 "I'll pay this time"
26 Manilow's "hottest spot north of Havana," familiarly
27 Like a gooseberry
29 Feature of some happy and sad emoji
33 Slow to open up
34 Org. for Sarah Strong and Hannah Hidalgo
36 Shish __
37 Ice bath spots
38 Bourbon barrel
39 Protein in some melts
40 Comedian André
41 "RuPaul's Drag __"
44 Dedicate, as time
45 Harmonious society
46 Brogue, for one
48 Amped up
49 Peak
50 Grad school hurdle
52 Disney villain with hair of blue flame
53 Wipe
57 Quite a bit
59 Tanning oil letters
60 Weeding tool
61 Red __ beet
62 Chalice, e.g.
63 Decryption need

Tuesday's Puzzle Solved

A	S	N	E	R		S	T	E	M		U	M	P	S
S	T	O	K	E		H	O	R	A		S	O	Y	A
P	O	K	E	A	R	O	U	N	D		E	A	R	N
E	L	I		D	U	E	T		I	T	U	N	E	S
R	E	A	S	O	N	S		R	S	V	P			
			A	F	T		S	H	O	P		O	A	T
	P	E	R	F	O	R	M	I	N	G	A	R	T	S
A	L	L	A			I	O	N			M	E	T	A
P	I	A	N	O	A	C	C	O	R	D	I	O	N	
B	E	N		B	U	C	K		I	A	N			
			S	E	T	I		P	A	Y	O	U	T	S
N	O	M	A	Y	O		T	A	L	C		P	I	U
A	L	A	N		P	R	E	S	S	A	G	E	N	T
P	E	N	T		E	A	S	T		M	I	N	E	R
A	S	E	A		N	E	T	S		P	A	N	D	A

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SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

UZAER
NPIRT
INOONT
LORUFY

Great perils have this beauty, that they bring to light the ___ of strangers. - Victor Hugo (10)

HOW TO PLAY
Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
05-average | 06-good | 08-outstanding

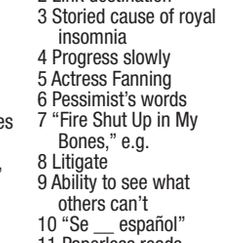
How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

7	1	3	8	9	6	4	2	5
5	2	6	4	3	9	8	1	7
8	4	9	7	2	5	1	6	3
1	7	3	2	5	4	9	8	6
4	8	5	6	1	9	7	3	2
2	9	1	3	8	7	5	6	4
6	3	7	5	2	4	1	8	9
9	5	8	1	6	3	2	7	4
3	6	4	9	7	2	8	5	1

LOOP THE LOOP



TIMES HITORI

8	2	3	5	4	1	6	
9	4		6		8		5
2	1	3	7	6		4	9
	9		1	2	5		7
4	6	5	2		1	7	3
6	7	1	8	2		3	5
	2		3	5	7		
3		9		1		5	2

SPELLATHON

deer, dyer, elder, ELDERLY, eyed, reed, reedy, yelled

SCRAMBLE

Words: Azure, print, notion, flour
Answer: Great perils have this beauty, that they bring to light the fraternity of strangers. - Victor Hugo

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GIFTING 2026

06 COLLECTIONS

19 COMBOS

WHOLESALE PRICES

MINIMUM ORDER QUANTITY 5

01 MOMENT COLLECTION

AVAILABLE IN **02 COMBOS**

01	Almonds **50g** · Raisins **50g** · Cashews **50g** · Apricots **50g** · Makhana **25g**	₹347
02	Almonds **100g** · Raisins **100g** · Apricots **100g**	₹410

02 SLIDER COLLECTION

AVAILABLE IN **04 COMBOS**

01	**Chocolate-coated** Cashew, Almond & Cranberry · **100g each**	₹499
02	Almonds **100g** · Cashews **100g** · Raisins **100g**	₹467
03	Almonds, Cashews, Raisins & Apricots **50g each · 4 chocolate boxes 30g**	₹551
04	Almonds **100g** · Cranberry **100g** · Cashews **100g**	₹473

03 GRANDEUR COLLECTION

AVAILABLE IN **03 COMBOS**

01	Almonds **100g** · Cashews **100g** · Raisins **100g** · Apricots **100g**	₹578
02	Pista **100g** · Cashews **100g** · Raisins **100g** · Almonds **100g**	₹730
03	**Chocolate-coated** Almonds · Raisins Cashews · Cranberry **– 100g each**	₹730

04 CELEBRATE COLLECTION

AVAILABLE IN **04 COMBOS**

01	Almonds · Cashews · Pista · Walnuts · Raisins · Apricots – **100g each**	₹1045
02	Apricots · Raisins · Cashews · Almonds Rose Plums · Cranberry – **100g each**	₹772
03	Almonds · Cashews · Cranberry · Raisins · Apricots · Figs – **100g each**	₹866
04	Raisins · Apricots · Flavored Cashews Cranberry · Chocolate Almonds · Rose Plums – **100g each**	₹730

05 TROVE COLLECTION

AVAILABLE IN **04 COMBOS**

01	Chocolate Almonds · Cashew Flavour · Turkish Figs · Cranberries · Raisins · Kiwi · Rose Plums · Apricots – **100g each**	₹1150
02	Almonds · Cashews · Apricots · Raisins · Kiwi · Figs · Cranberries · Flavored Makhana · Rose Plums – **100g each**	₹1150
03	Almonds · Pistachios · Cashews · Walnuts · Turkish Figs · Apricots · Raisins · Cranberries · Rose Plums – **100g each**	₹1444
04	Premium Dry Fruits **400g** · Chocolate Coated **120g** · Chocolate Discs **60g** · Royal Mukhwas Kit **200g** · Arabica Coffee **50g** · Makhana **25g**	₹1444

06 IMPERIAL COLLECTION

AVAILABLE IN **02 COMBOS**

01	Almonds · Cashew · Pista · Raisins · Cranberry · Rose Plums · Apricots · Kiwi · Fig · Mukhwas Kit – **100 g each** · Coffee ×2 · Makhana · Chocolates	1205g+ Mega Hamper ₹2305
02	Flavored Almonds · Flavored Cashew · Pista · Raisins · Cranberry · Rose Plums · Walnuts · Kiwi · Mukhwas Kit – **100g each** · Coffee ×2 · Makhana · Chocolates	1205g+ Mega Hamper ₹2620

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SCAN TO DOWNLOAD CATALOGUE

After calling out online trolls

Vijay-Rashmika approach cybercrime police with complaint

Talk of the town

After speaking out against online trolling on Monday afternoon, Rashmika Mandanna and Vijay Deverakonda have taken the issue a step further. A representative of the team representing the couple, popularly known as "Virosh" among fans, has filed a formal complaint with Hyderabad Cyber Crime authorities seeking an investigation. The team alleges that some of the material being shared online goes beyond criticism and involves the deliberate spread of false information

KEY CONCERNS IN THE COMPLAINT

As per the press release, the complaint flags several forms of online content and behaviour, including:

- Alleged false narratives and fabricated content
- Manipulated screenshots
- Impersonation
- Targeted online harassment

The team has also submitted links and supporting material to the authorities to help examine the content in question.

OCT 27

That's bullying dressed up as feminism: Rashmika

Calling the online backlash over their *Koffee With Karan* conversation an "angry mob", the actor defends her marriage to Vijay Deverakonda and her right to choose her own life

Rashmika Mandanna has a message for these questioning her marriage to Vijay Deverakonda: she would choose him a thansand times over. Responding to the backlash following their appearance on *Koffee With Karan* Season 9, the actor took to Insta-

thekasy "Kuch tho log kahenge..logon ka Kama hai kahenaa.... ". Love you both 😘❤️

@AwaaraHoon
This is exactly how Rashmika's character defended her husband in Animal. Vijay and Rashmika's relationship dynamics seem straight out of a Vanga movie script, right down to their reactions.

@runkoolletproof
Girl, the problem was never you being obsessed with him! That's great, adorable even. But the love and obsession you're speaking of should be mutual in a relationship.
You're at 💯 meanwhile he's barely showing 20!

@homelander_yyy
If you have to prove to the world how much your man loves you, so believe me you already lost him girl

chitralekha.deshmukh My perspective:
I think people completely misunderstood what you meant by making her ask 100 times! It was never about ego or making her prove herself. It was about giving her the chance to think it through, again and again, and truly ask herself if marrying you was what she wanted❤️

@shiggy187
I mean people are crossing line they are praying and wishing for couple who are love with each other to get divorced.

Rashmika Mandanna: From villain to victim, the internet still refuses to let her be

POV

The internet has a curious way of deciding who Rashmika Mandanna should be. One day, she is cast as the villain in a story strangers believe they have decoded; the next, she is framed as a victim who needs rescuing.

When her engagement to Kannada actor-director Rakshit Shetty ended years ago, the internet was quick to brand her an opportunist. A deeply personal parting was reduced to a public referendum on ambition, betrayal and ingratitude. Rashmika largely chose silence back then, enduring the noise as strangers filled the vacuum with vitriol. The episode appears to have created a template for online outrage, with the same set of trolls springing into action whenever she finds herself embroiled in controversy.

Today, the script has been reversed, but the condescension persists. Following her marriage to Vijay Deverakonda, social media has appointed itself her self-righteous protector. A candid joint interview — meant to offer a glimpse into years of shared understanding — was swiftly weaponised. Micro-expressions were dissected, casual banter diagnosed as a series of 'red flags', and viewers convinced themselves she was trapped in an unhealthy dynamic.

There is a stark difference between genuine concern and paternalistic condescension. It is deeply belittling to assume that an accomplished adult woman is incapable of recognising what is good for her simply because outsiders cannot parse the nuances of her private life.

Kavya Christopher
THE SOUTH EDIT

What makes this moment telling is Rashmika's shift from past silence to addressing the scrutiny directly. In an era dominated by viral snippets and instant moral posturing, silence is weaponised as an admission of guilt, while explanations are mined for further ammunition. Her eight-page explainer in defence of her choices, alongside Vijay's brief and rather crisp note, may have seemed like a drastic response. Yet their subsequent joint decision to pursue legal action against online harassment draws a vital boundary: public visibility does not make relentless abuse a fair price of admission. Criticism of public work is legitimate; diagnosing the intimate health of a marriage from 30-second clips is not.

The irony is glaring. If Rashmika was entitled to leave a relationship that no longer worked for her, she is equally entitled to invest in one she believes in — without requiring strangers to sanction her choices or save her from them.

The internet has tried casting her as both the villain and the victim. It is time to let her be neither. Rashmika does not need public condemnation, nor does she need unsolicited saviours. She simply deserves to be the protagonist of her own life: an adult who lives, chooses and stands by her decisions without owing the world an ongoing explanation.

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'For now, acting is not on the cards for Hrehaan'

SUSSANNE KHAN

Vinay MR Mishra

For **Sussanne Khan**, life seems to have come together in a way that allows her to embrace every role on her own terms. In a chat with us, she speaks about the bond she shares with her sons, her relationship, and how Hrithik Roshan and her nurture a modern family. Excerpts:

'HREHAAN HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN MUSIC SINCE HE WAS NINE'

Watching her son Hrehaan release his first single is a proud moment for Sussanne. It is the culmination of years of watching a young boy nurture his love for music, write his own songs and gradually find his voice as a creator. "It is incredible to have watched this boy, from a very young age, create music and write his own songs. When he was nine or 10 years old, he used to write his own music, learn the guitar and create tunes. I think the passion comes from his love for music," she tells us.

Following *Heavenly Place*, his next single, *Every Little Thing*, released recently, and Sussanne shares that Hrehaan plans to release a new single every month. "I am so proud of him because he is such a passionate person. I know that he is going to make a mark and put his heart out there," she adds.

While Hrehaan belongs to a prominent film family, his choice to pursue music prompts the question of whether he will ultimately follow his father, Hrithik Roshan, into acting. She clarifies, "For now, he is excessively interested in creating music. Of course, in the future, we don't know. Maybe in a couple of years, he might like to dive into acting. But right now, it is not on the cards because he is totally into music. So, I think he is on a good path, and we are supporting him with all our hearts."

'ARSLAN IS AN INCREDIBLE MAN AND HE COMPLETES MY HEART'

Reflecting on what her relationship with Arslan Goni means to her, Sussanne says, "I'm lucky to have met him. He is an incredible man and he completes my heart. I feel both of us met at the right time in life because we really needed each other to give each other the love that we have."

She adds, "We always tell each other that no matter what, we are going to have a really good life. We have made up our minds. Whatever the tide throws in, we've got each other. That is the main thing."

Sussanne with sons Hrehaan and Hridaan

My kids are like my friends today. We share a great friendship. It is not a typical mother-son relationship

'I still feel I am 20'

Speaking about building her individual identity, Sussanne shares, "When you put your heart and soul into something that you really love to do, it will work. There's no chance that the universe will not make it work. It's all about just enjoying the moment and giving it your best. And age is just a number. I still feel like I'm 20 years old. Also, my mom taught us to never give up on anything. God has given me this time and moment in life where I'm in a very secure relationship with Arslan. I have a great career, I have the most amazing children, I'm very happy with the way everything is."

'We are all in a happy place'

Sussanne credits everyone's maturity — including Hrithik's partner, Saba Azad — for the family's current dynamic, noting, "Even Hrithik's partner, Saba, is an incredible girl and an amazing human being. I think he is very lucky to have found her. All of us are feeling happy and secure in our relationships now." She adds, "Hrithik and I will always share a great bond. We are parents to our beautiful kids, and we all have a great connection. It is a blessing of life that we are all in a happy place."

'I want our local stories to pique global curiosity'

Says National Award-winning filmmaker Sagar Puranik about his next film that spotlights North Karnataka's artistic community

Madhu Daithota

After exploring folk traditions and community life in *Dollu* and *Venkya*, National Award-winning filmmaker Sagar Puranik is turning his attention to an artistic community in North Karnataka. Known for its distinctive craftsmanship and centuries-old cultural heritage, the community is at the heart of his upcoming film. In a conversation with *Bangalore Times*, Sagar sheds light on the inspiration behind the project and his ambition to take locally rooted stories to a global audience. Excerpts:

'THE BEAUTY OF THEIR LIVES LIES IN THEIR ART AND CULTURE'

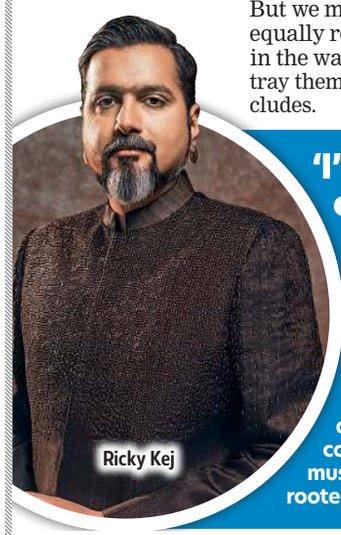
The idea was first developed by Sunil Kumar Ramachandra, who is closely associated with an NGO that works with the community. "The community we are portraying has a rich artistic heritage, so we have woven a fictional story around their lives while ensuring that their traditions and way of life are represented authentically. The idea was to tell a universal story while remaining rooted in their world," says Sagar.

'CULTURAL REPRESENTATION COMES WITH RESPONSIBILITY'

As stories rooted in local identities find greater space in mainstream cinema, Sagar believes filmmakers must approach them with sensitivity and care.

"Our culture is finally being celebrated on screen, and that is encouraging. It is wonderful when young audiences watch a film and discover traditions and communities they may know little about. But we must be equally responsible in the way we portray them," he concludes.

Sagar Puranik



Ricky Kej

'I've always wanted to explore our local culture through cinema'

For Sagar, the film is part of a larger creative journey that has drawn him to stories rooted in local culture. "I have always wanted to explore our traditions and culture through cinema. This journey has progressed naturally — from telling a story rooted in a particular community and state in *Dollu*, to exploring the national culture in *Venkya*, and now working on a story that could pique the curiosity of international audiences," he shares, adding, "We have also collaborated with global artiste Ricky Kej on the film's music. I feel privileged to be working on a film so deeply rooted in culture."

The idea is to tell a universal story while remaining rooted in the world of this Karnataka community

Saiyami Kher

'Working across cultures gives you a different perspective on storytelling'

Saiyami Kher speaks about making her international debut

Saiyami Kher is set to make her international debut in an upcoming Indo-Russian drama directed by Maksim Kuznetsov. The film brings together Indian and Russian talent in a compelling cross-cultural drama. Shot across Russia and India, the project offered Saiyami an opportunity to step into a new cinematic environment, working with a predominantly foreign crew and experiencing a different filmmaking culture.

Saiyami told us, "This was a different and new experience for me, working with an entirely foreign crew. We shot in Russia, and it was my first time there. Moscow was beautiful, and the overall experience was incredible. The working atmosphere was very different from what I'm used to, and I enjoyed being part of this collaboration."

She added, "As an actor, it is always exciting to step outside your comfort zone and immerse yourself in a new environment. Working across cultures gives you a different perspective on storytelling and allows you to learn from people who approach cinema in their own unique ways. While it's still too early to share details about the film, it is a drama with a strong female lead at its heart."

– Renuka Vyavahare

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Cinema is not a slice of life, but a piece of cake - Alfred Hitchcock

FILM REVIEWS
NOW IN CINEMAS...

A cricketing triumph inspires a young woman's fight for freedom

DOOSRA
(Sports, Drama)
★★★
Cast: Plabita Borthakur, Ankur Vikal, Krishna Gokani, Samidha Guru
Director: Abhinay Deo
Duration: 1 hr 18 mins
Language: Hindi (A)

Should you watch it?
A well-intentioned drama that scores on its central idea but falls short on emotional impact.

Review in short

Doosra draws a parallel between Sourav Ganguly's iconic shirt-waving celebration at the 2002 NatWest final and a young woman's fight against patriarchy. The Abhinay Deo film is about Tara (Plabita Borthakur), who questions restrictive expectations of her conservative Rajasthani household. Borthakur brings sincerity to Tara's defiance, while Ankur Vikal convincingly portrays her patriarchal father. However, the central metaphor is more compelling than its character development. Tara's transformation feels rushed, with little exploration of the emotional struggle and consequences of challenging years of conditioning. Despite its relevant message and evocative cricketing moments, the film's ambitions outpace its execution.

– Archika Khurana

OTT REVIEWS
NOW STREAMING...

Manoj Bajpayee anchors a fairly predictable crime thriller

GAJAB RAAT
(Thriller)
★★½
Cast: Manoj Bajpayee, Nushrratt Bharuccha, Saqib Saleem, Divya Dutta, Akshay Oberoi, Kiku Sharda, Shraddha Das
Director: Ritesh Shah
Duration: 2 hr 3 mins
Language: Hindi (UA)
Streaming on: Netflix

Should you watch it?
Watch it for Manoj Bajpayee's performance, but keep your expectations in check.

Review in short

Gajab Raat has the ingredients of a gripping crime thriller, but predictable twists and underdeveloped characters prevent it from reaching its full potential. The story follows corrupt sub-inspector Ajay Nirvit (Manoj Bajpayee), whose routine night takes a dramatic turn when an injured woman is thrown from a moving vehicle in Delhi. The single-night setting lends urgency to the narrative, while Ajay's transformation gives the story some depth. Bajpayee delivers a compelling performance. However, the supporting characters lack substance, and the revelations rarely surprise. Although the film raises relevant questions about corruption and conscience, it falls short of delivering a truly gripping thriller.

– Archika Khurana

Sumo Didi chokeslams body shaming head-on

SUMO DIDI
(Sports Drama)
★★★½
Cast: Shriyam Bhagnani, Chaitnya Sharma, Anubha Fatehpura, Nitesh Pandey, Raghav Dheer
Director: Jayant Rohatgi
Duration: 1 hr 58 mins
Language: Hindi (UA)
Streaming on: Zee5

Should you watch it?
Give it a chance for its inspiring premise and a story that challenges society's narrow ideas of body image.

Review in short

Inspired by the life of India's pioneering female sumo wrestler Hetal Dave, *Sumo Didi* is an uplifting story of resilience, self-acceptance and challenging societal prejudices. Director Jayant Rohatgi focuses on a woman who turns body shaming and social judgment into motivation to pursue an unconventional sporting dream. Shriyam Bhagnani impresses with her performance. The training sequences are engaging, while the supporting cast adds warmth and humour. The film's exploration of gender bias, body image and familial expectations gives it relevance beyond sports. However, uneven pacing and underdeveloped emotional moments prevent it from delivering the dramatic punch of a compelling sports drama.

– Archika Khurana

Want a more detailed review? Head to **etimes.in**

RATING SCALE
TRASH ★ | BELOW AVERAGE ★★ | AVERAGE ★★½ | ABOVE AVERAGE ★★★ | GOOD ★★★½ | VERY GOOD ★★★★ | OUTSTANDING ★★★★½ | MASTERPIECE ★★★★★

DJ Marshmello headlines a monster-sized musical bash

@kiraru_nx

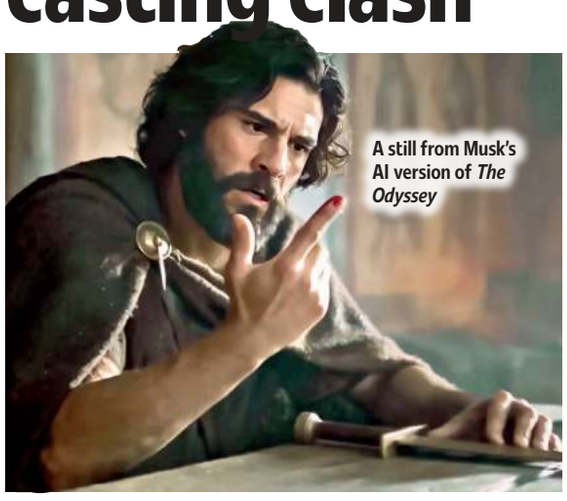
Marshmello performing his set with Mewtwo looming in the background

Pokémon marked its 30th anniversary with an electronic dance music concert featuring headliner DJ Marshmello and Australian DJ Alison Wonderland at Los Angeles' Intuit Dome on October 24. Titled *Pokémon Night Out*, the event blended the franchise's colourful creatures with lasers, immersive visuals and high-energy music.

Alison Wonderland opened the show with a countdown featuring Pokémon from across the franchise's history. A neon-lit Pikachu also made an appearance on stage. Marshmello followed with a visually extravagant set featuring animated Pokémon flying, dancing and battling across a giant video wall. In one striking scene, a sleek Corviknight glided over a sprawling cityscape. Every Pokémon type was represented: a spooky Gengar and adorable favourites Eevee, Charmander, Squirtle and Bulbasaur. Highlights included a dramatic showdown between legendary Pokémon Groudon and Kyogre, while appearances by Greninja and Mewtwo added to the spectacle.

Variety reports that the celebrations will continue with a second concert in London on November 10.

Elon unleashes AI Odyssey amid Nolan casting clash



A still from Musk's AI version of *The Odyssey*

Elon Musk's dream of an AI-powered *Odyssey* is officially taking sail. Months after Musk teased that his AI creation, Grok Imagine, would spin up an entirely AI-generated feature film of *The Odyssey,* he's finally delivered a slice of the epic. On Friday, xAI dropped the first 7-minute episode on X. According to *Variety,* in July, Musk had announced on X, "Before this year ends, Grok Imagine will make a full-length movie of *The Odyssey* that is historically accurate and true to the art of Homer."

Earlier this year, Musk spent months roasting Christopher Nolan's film, targeting the casting of Elliot Page as Sinon and Lupita Nyong'o as Helen of Troy. Musk called Nolan's choices "anti-White," saying he cast Nyong'o only because "he wants the awards."